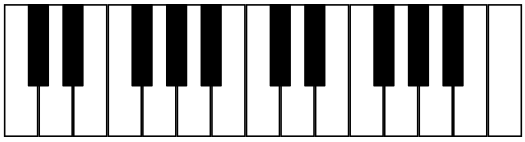
Read at Sight

A graded sight-reading course for piano

Volume 7B - Repertoire, Levels 9-10



Middle C

26 complete pieces by the great keyboard composers,
from Bach to Debussy and Joplin, to learn and keep.

Scores from the Mutopia Project: public domain or Creative Commons (see the last page).

How to use this book

What this book is

Volumes 1-6 taught you to read. This book is music to learn and keep: complete pieces, not exercises. Each one will take from a few days to a few weeks. Every piece is printed in full, exactly as its composer wrote it.

Levels

Each piece has a level. Level 7 pieces can be learned in days after Volume 6; Level 8 pieces take a week or two (faster passages, wider stretches, pedal and voicing matter). Book 7B continues with Levels 9 and 10. The index at the back lists this book's pieces by level: a suggested order.

How to learn a piece

1. Read it through once at sight, slowly, without stopping, to hear what it is. 2. Find the hard places and learn them first, hands separately, then together, slowly with a metronome. 3. Learn the piece in sections of four to eight bars, joining each to the next. 4. Raise the speed in small steps; never faster than you can play evenly. 5. Then play it for someone. A piece is learned when you can play it steadily after a day away from it.

Keep reading

Do not stop sight-reading while you learn these pieces. Ten minutes a day of new music at Level 6-7 keeps your reading growing: hymns, chorales, easier pieces by the composers in this book.

The sources

The scores were engraved by volunteers of the Mutopia Project and are public domain or Creative Commons. The note above each piece names its source; the last page lists them all with their licences.

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Section 1
Baroque

Music from about 1600 to 1750, written for the harpsichord, clavichord and organ: instruments with no sustaining pedal and little or no change of loudness from the touch. Its keyboard music is woven from independent lines. In an invention or a fugue each hand carries its own voice, the same motive passes from one to the other, and the interest is in how the lines answer each other. Dances (gavotte, bourree, minuet) and preludes built on broken chords are the other two families here.

What it asks of you

Independent hands: each voice shaped as if it were sung, with its own phrasing. Articulation instead of pedal: detach most eighths, slur most sixteenths, and use little or no pedal. A steady pulse, and ornaments (trills, mordents) played on the beat, starting on the note above unless the score says otherwise.

In this section

J. S. Bach: Fugue in C minor, BWV 847 *(Level 9)*

D. Scarlatti: Sonata in G, K. 455 *(Level 9)*
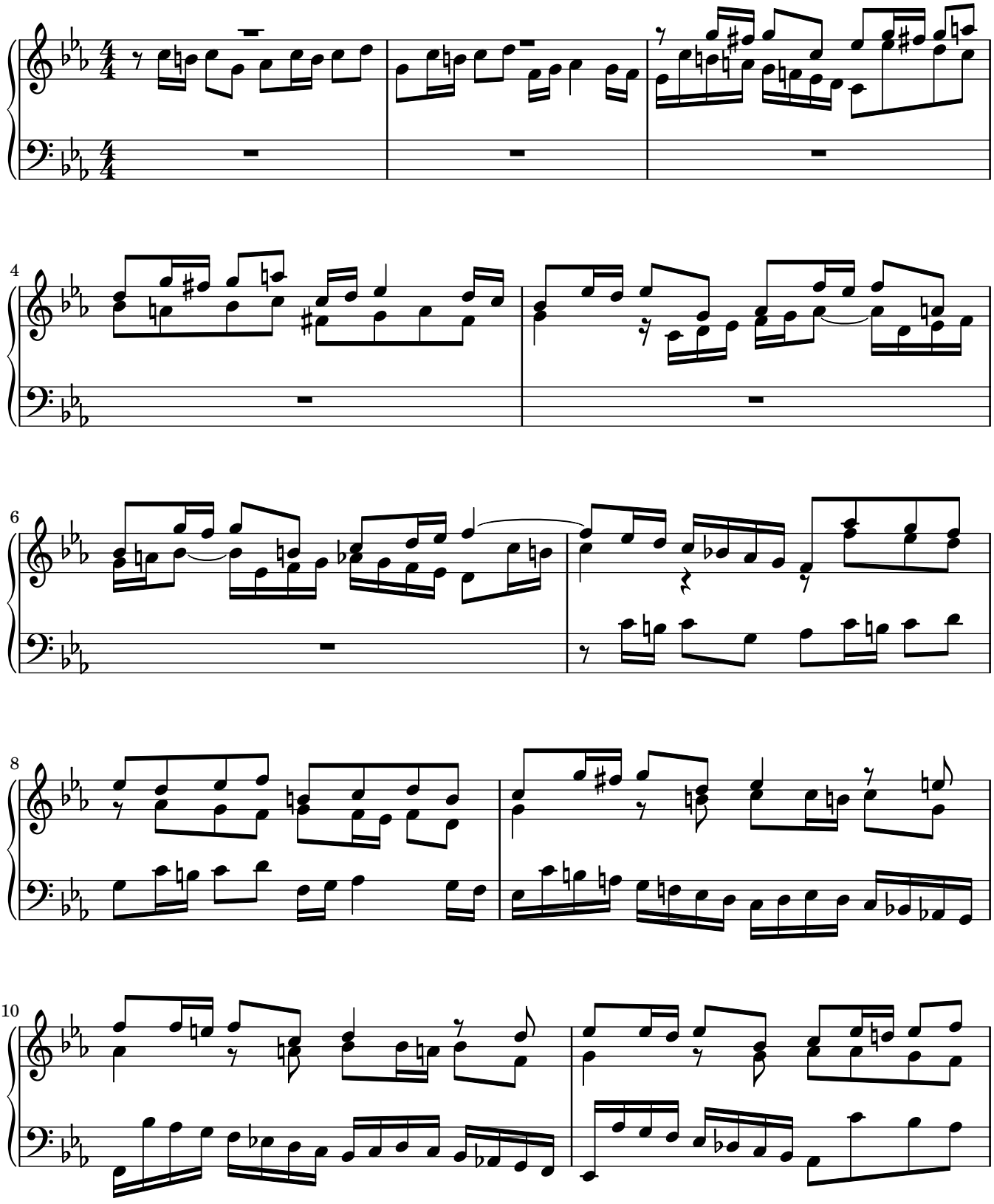
Fugue in C minor, BWV 847
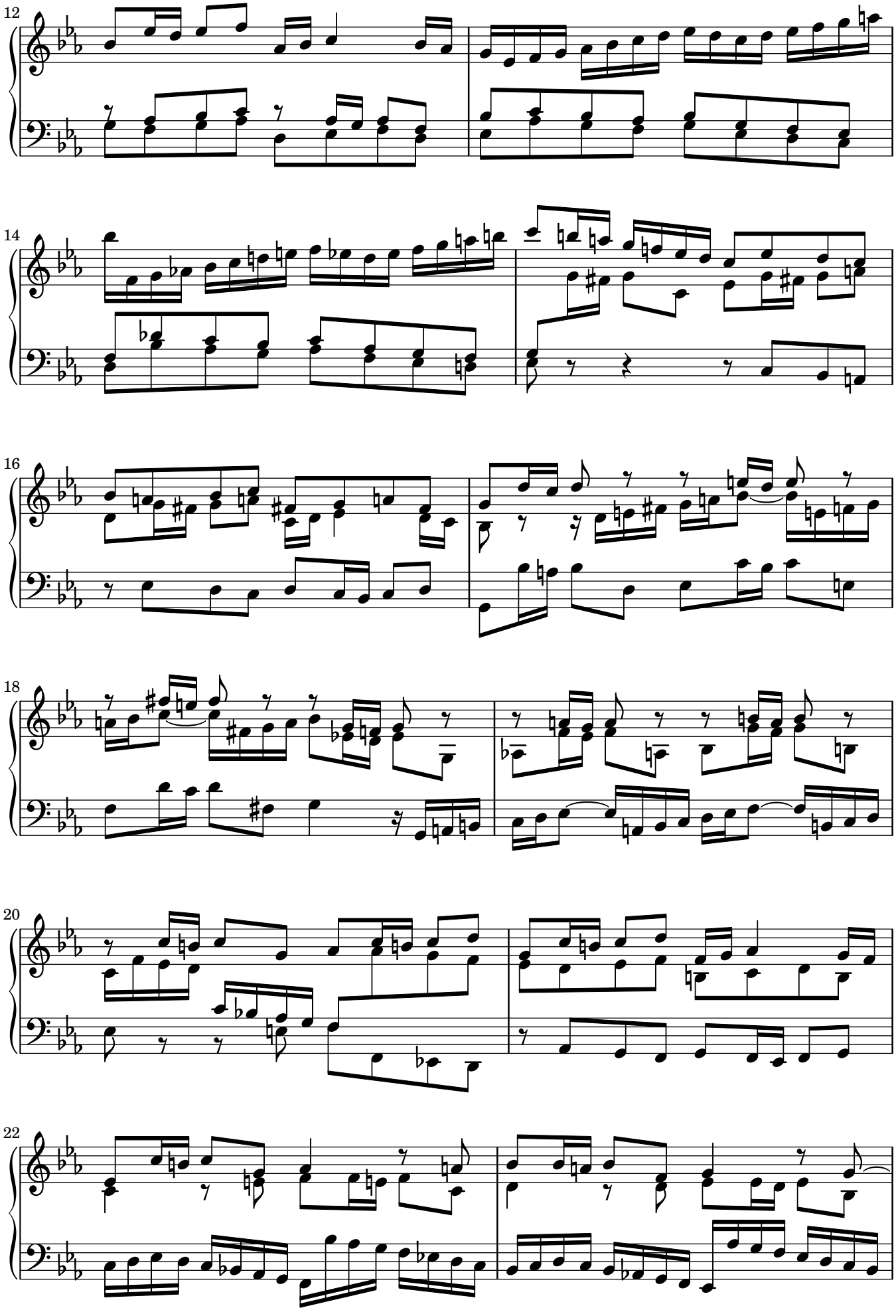
J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - The Well-Tempered Clavier, Book 1, No. 2 (1722)
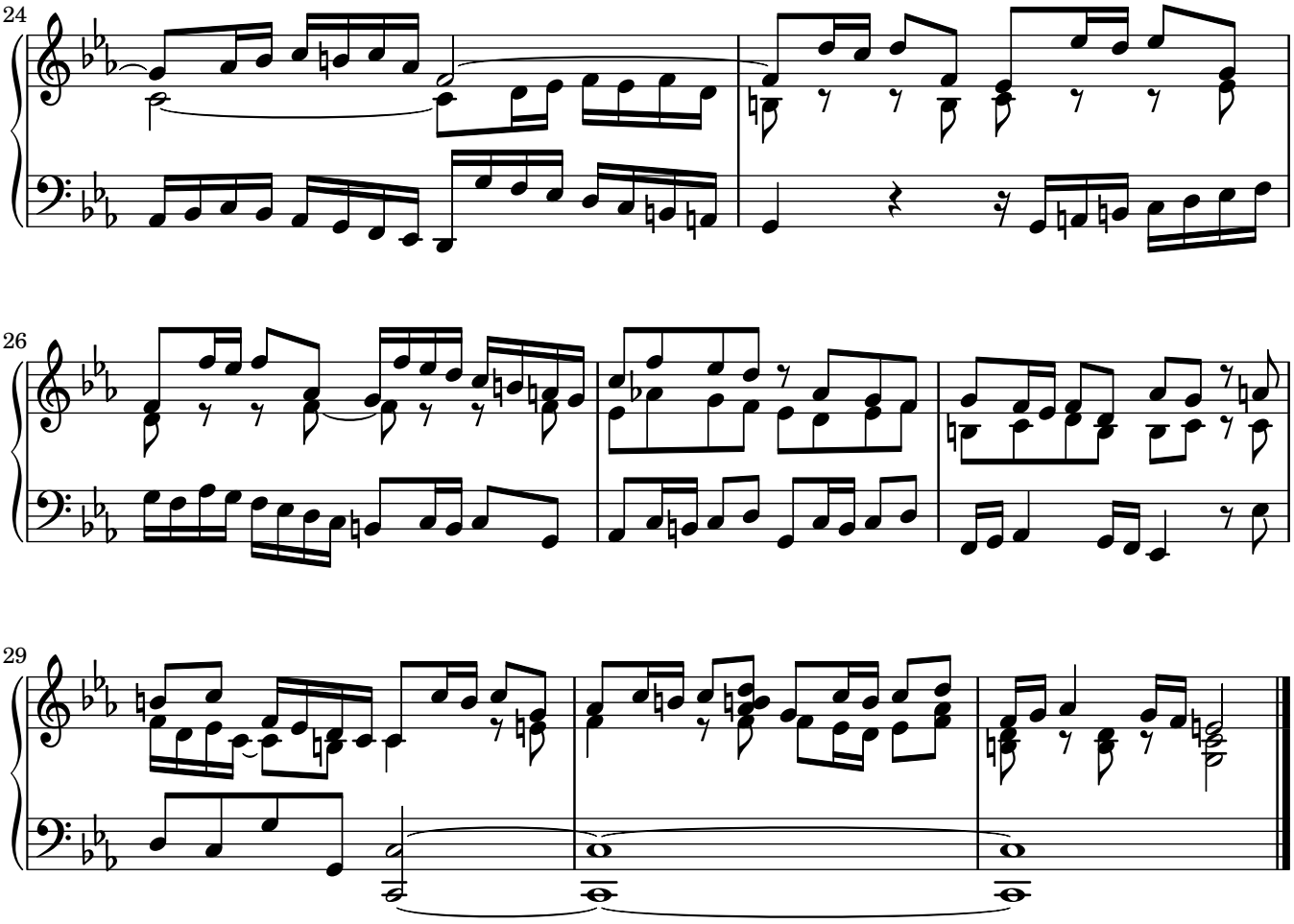
Level 9 · about 2 min

The fugue that answers the Prelude in C minor (Book 7A): three voices, with a subject of bouncing sixteenths that every voice takes up in turn. Learn each voice alone, then in pairs, and keep the subject audible wherever it enters; the short episodes between entries are made from pieces of it.

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12
14
16
18
20
22


24
26
29

Sonata in G, K. 455
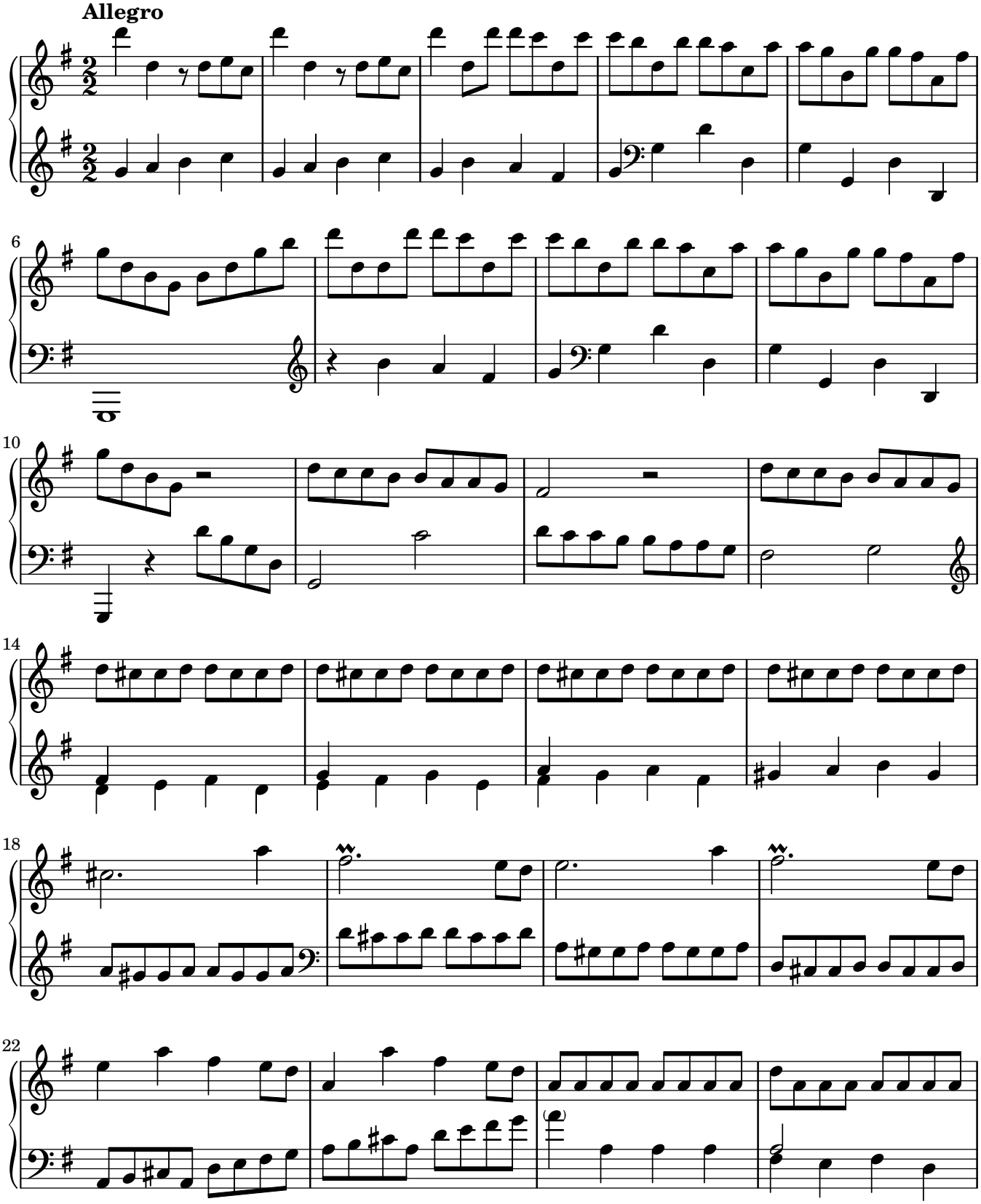
D. Scarlatti (1685-1757)
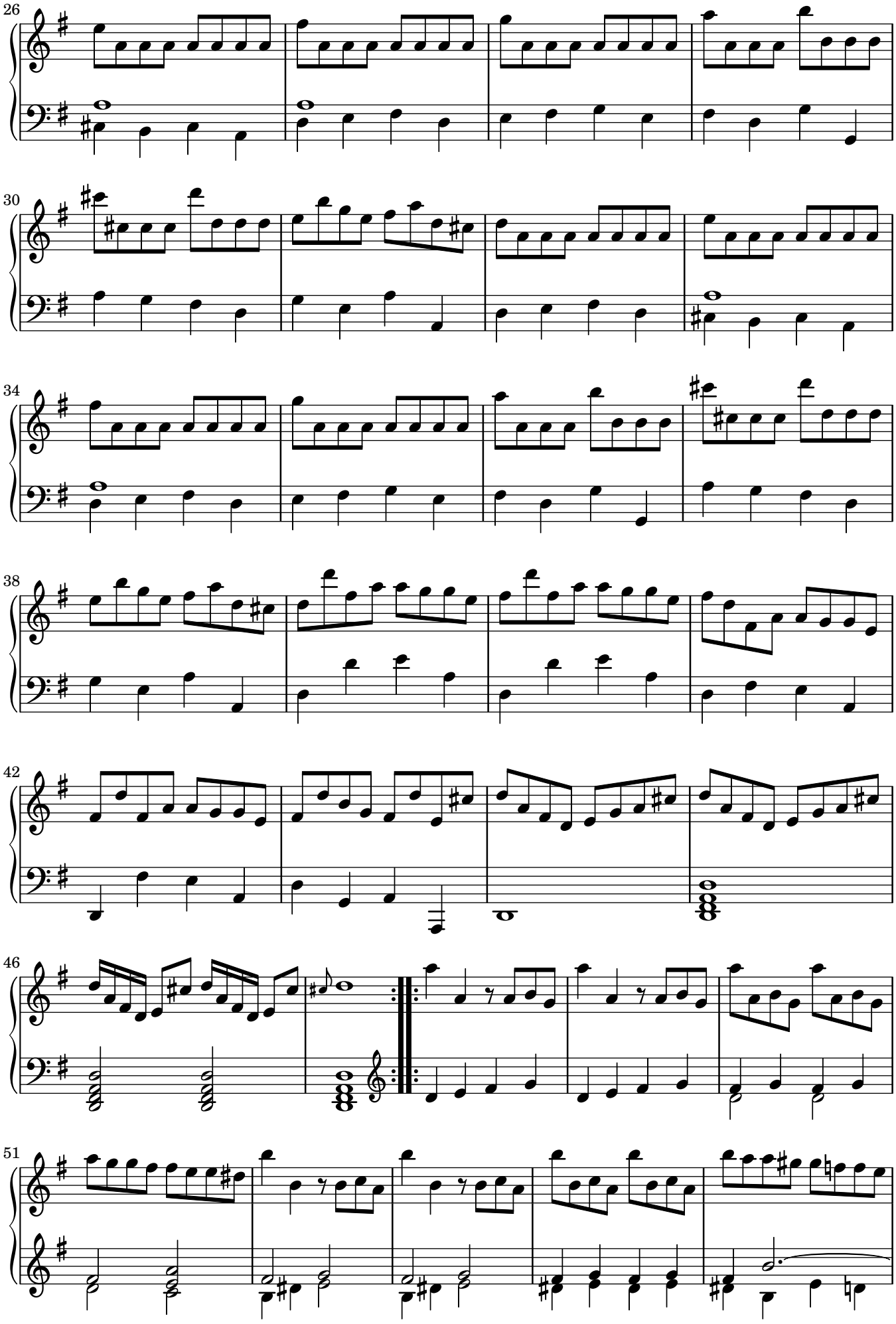
Level 9 · about 4 min
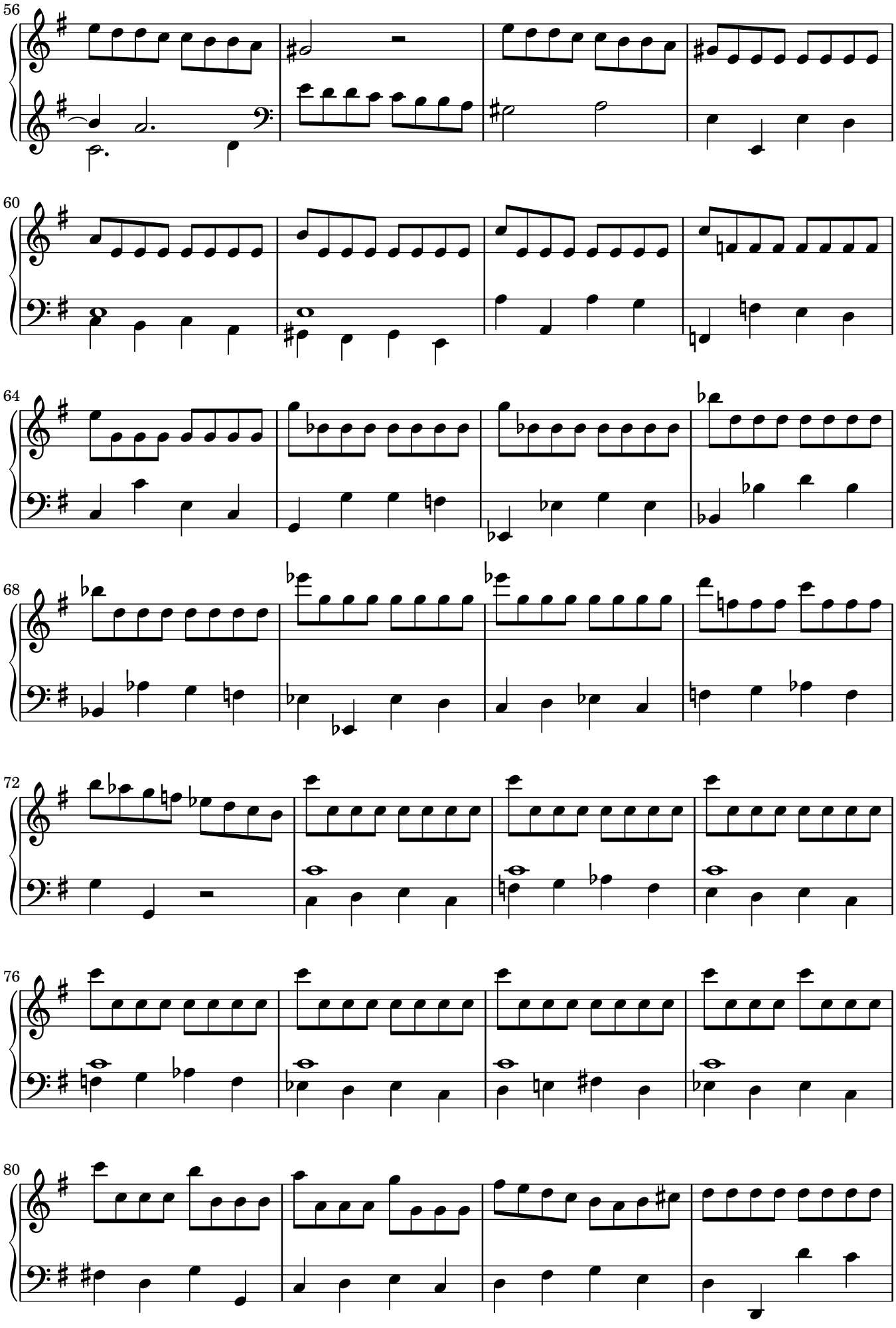
A brilliant late sonata in two halves, each repeated, full of the guitar-like repeated notes and quick hand crossings Scarlatti learned in Spain. Decide every fingering for the repeated notes first; keep the touch light and the pulse strict.
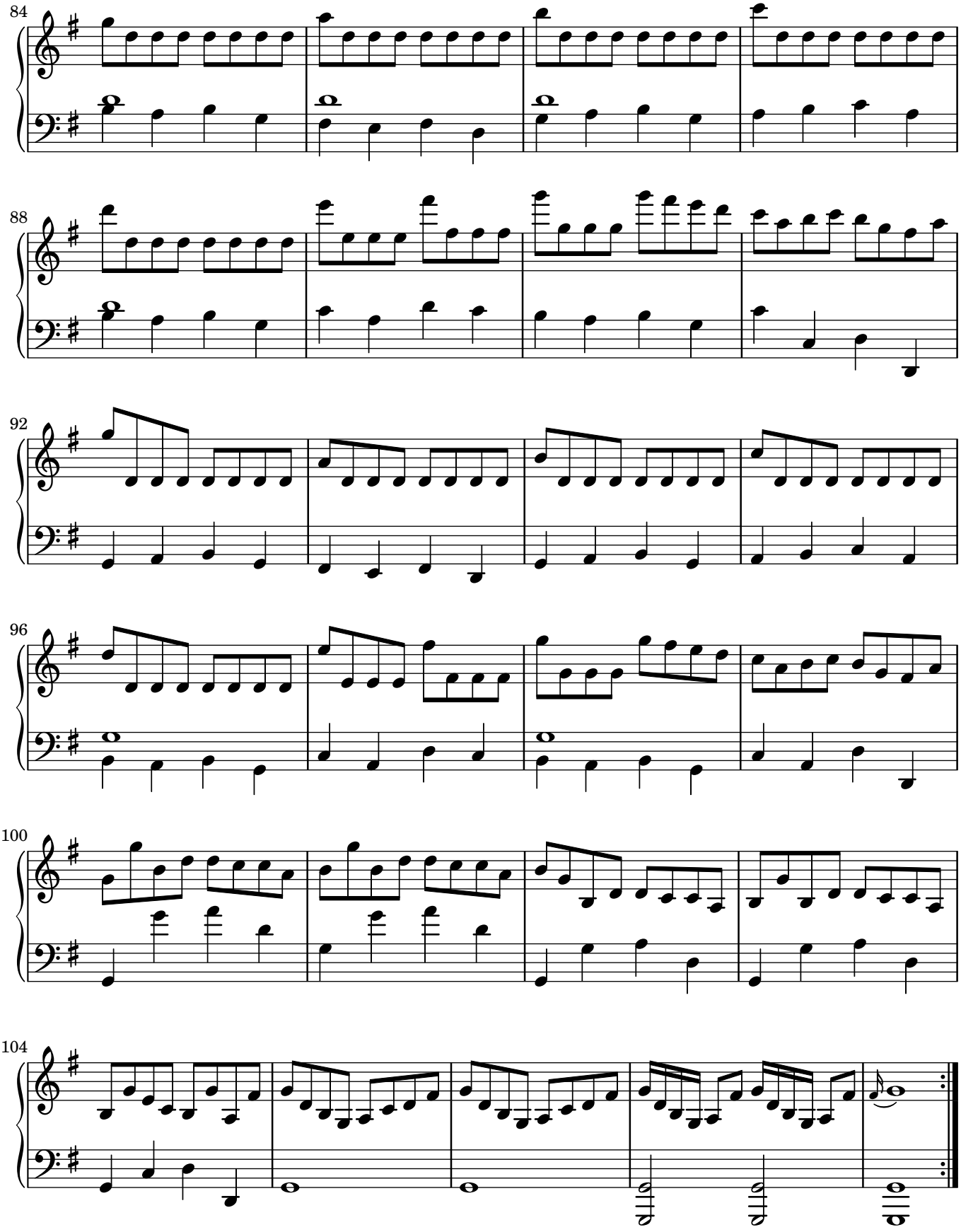
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Allegro




26
30
34
38
42
46
51


56
60
64
68
72
76
80


84
88
92
96
100
104

Section 2
Classical

Music from about 1750 to 1820, written for the new fortepiano, whose touch could play loud and soft (hence its name). Haydn, Mozart and the young Beethoven write a singing tune over a simple accompaniment, in clear phrases of four and eight bars, and build movements from contrasting themes: sonata form, rondo, minuet and trio, variations.

What it asks of you

Clean, even passagework (scales and broken chords exactly in time), a light accompaniment under a clear melody (Alberti basses quieter than the tune), and contrasts of loud and soft made by touch. Use the pedal sparingly, to join harmonies, not to blur scales.

In this section

W. A. Mozart: Sonata in A, K. 331: III. Rondo alla turca *(Level 9)*

W. A. Mozart: Sonata in C minor, K. 457: I. Molto allegro *(Level 10)*

L. van Beethoven: Sonata in G, Op. 79: I. Presto alla tedesca *(Level 9)*

L. van Beethoven: "Pathétique" Sonata, Op. 13: III. Rondo *(Level 9)*

L. van Beethoven: "Pathétique" Sonata, Op. 13: I. Grave - Allegro *(Level 10)*

L. van Beethoven: "Moonlight" Sonata, Op. 27 No. 2: III. Presto agitato *(Level 10)*
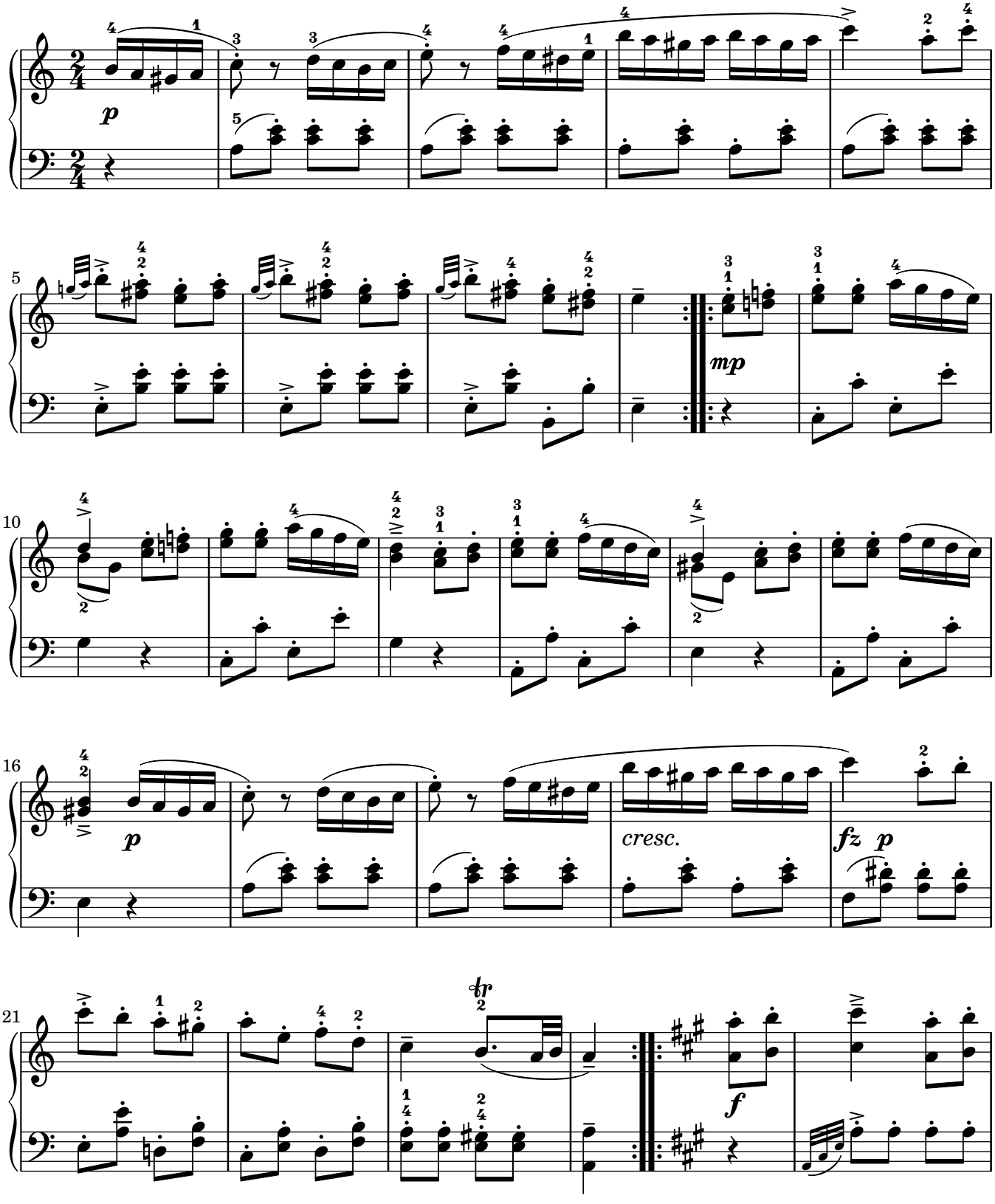
Sonata in A, K. 331: III. Rondo alla turca
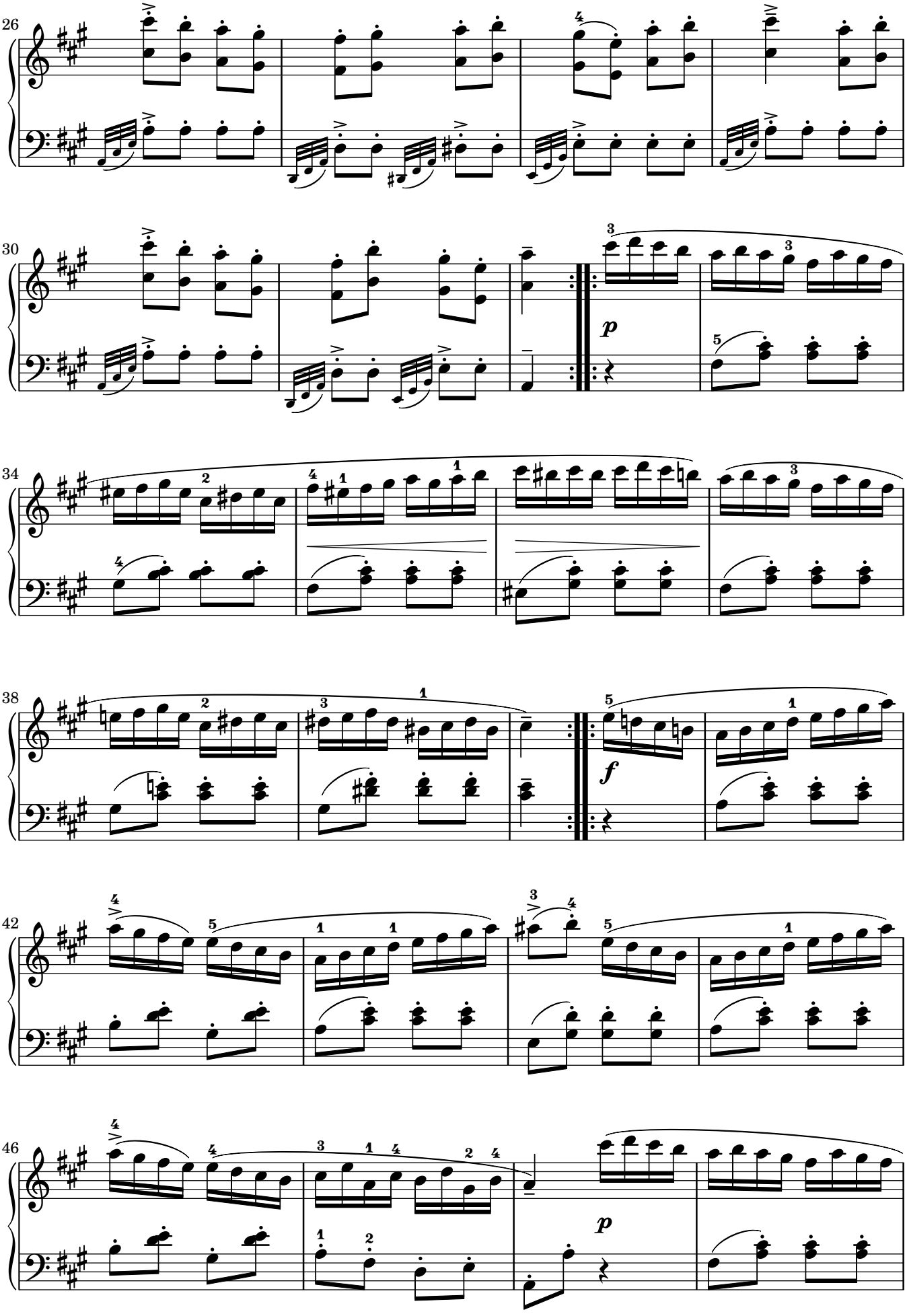
W. A. Mozart (1756-1791) - Piano Sonata in A (1783)
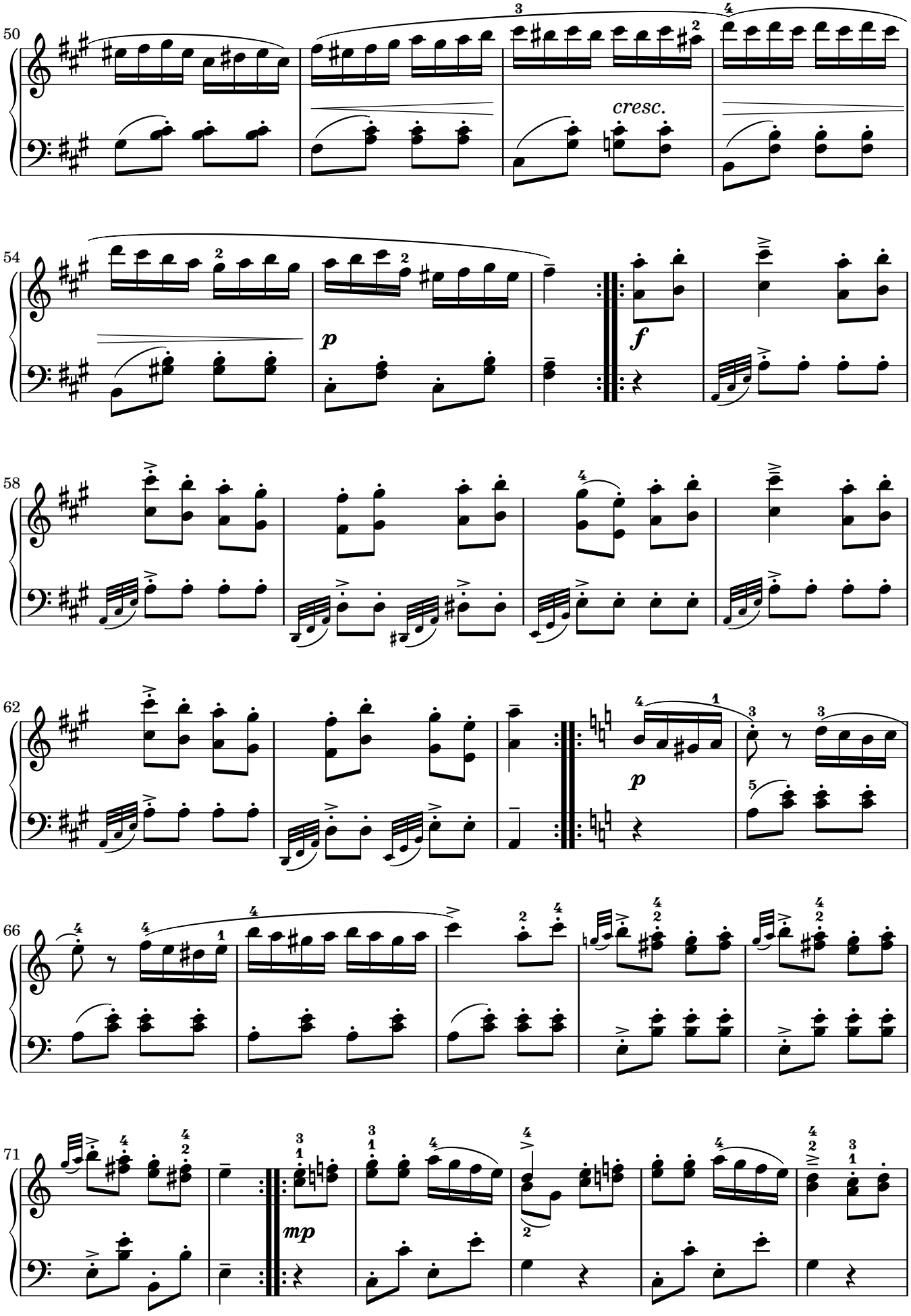
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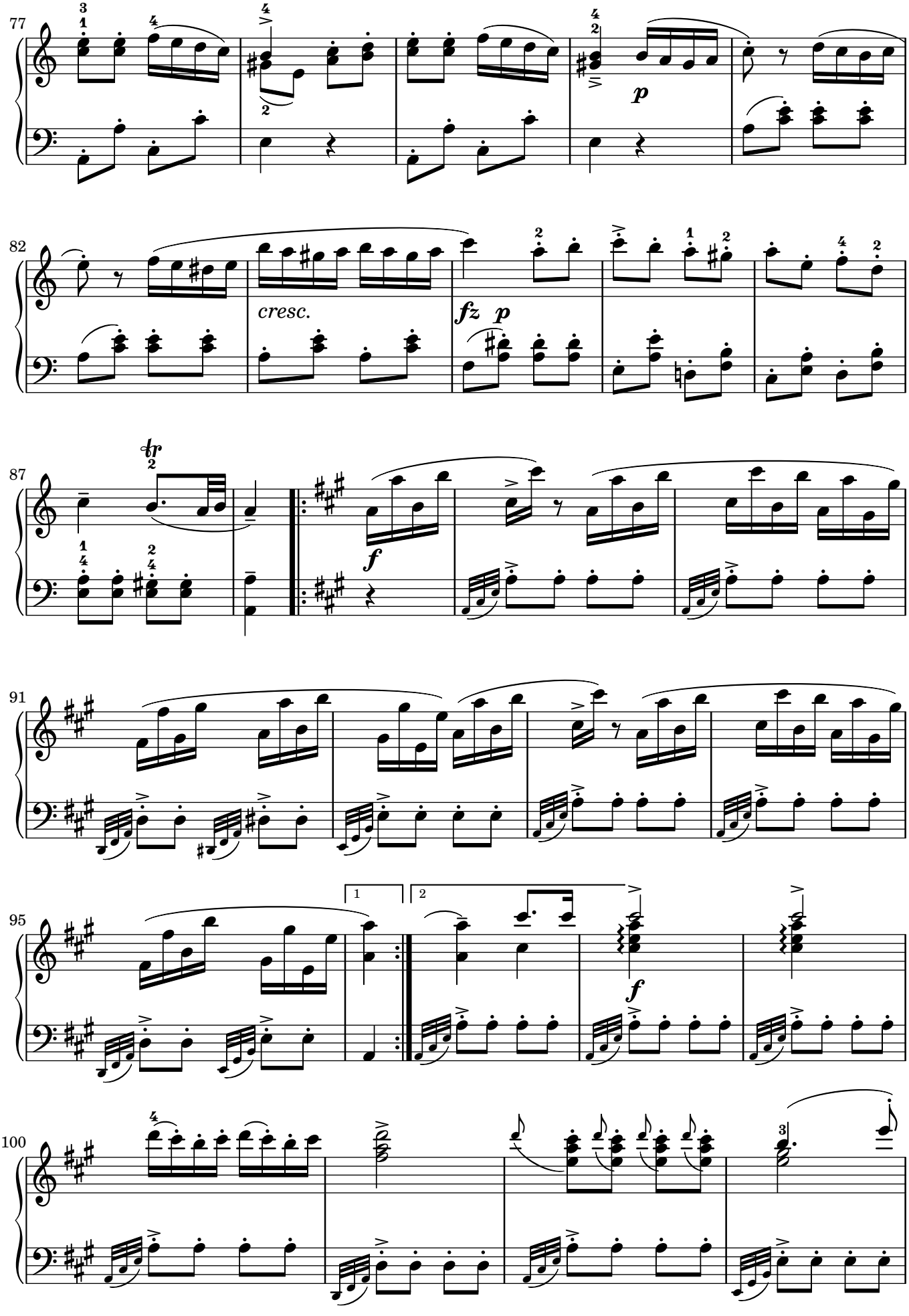
The 'Turkish March', imitating the Janissary bands that were fashionable in Vienna: the left hand's crashing broken chords are the drums and cymbals. Keep the right-hand sixteenths even and light, and do not let the loud A-major sections run faster than the rest.
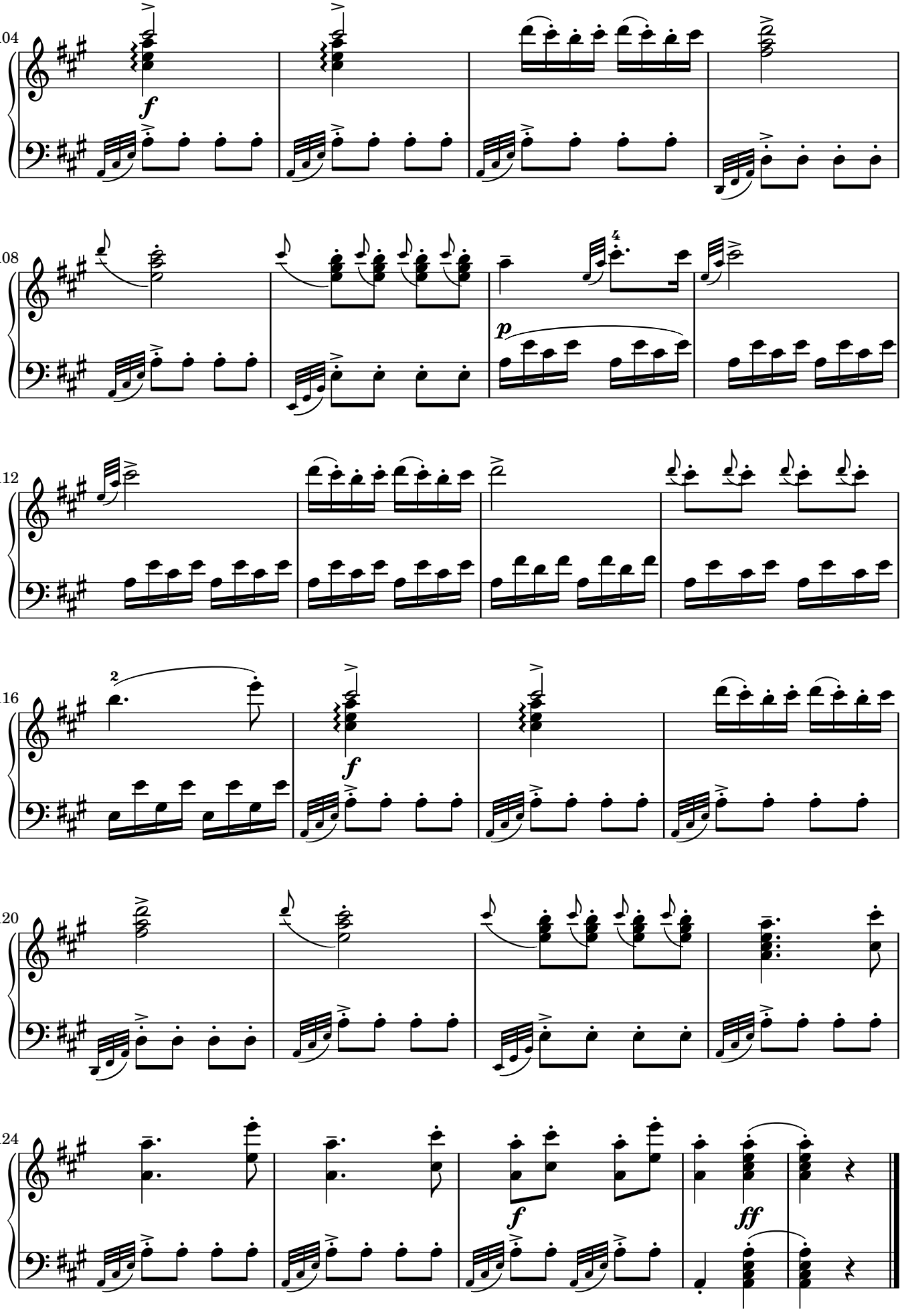
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26
30
p
34
38
f
42
46
p


50
cresc.
54
p
f
58
62
p
66
71
mp


77
p
82
cresc.
fz p
87
tr
f
91
95
1
2
f
100


104
f
108
p
112
116
2
f
120
124
f
ff
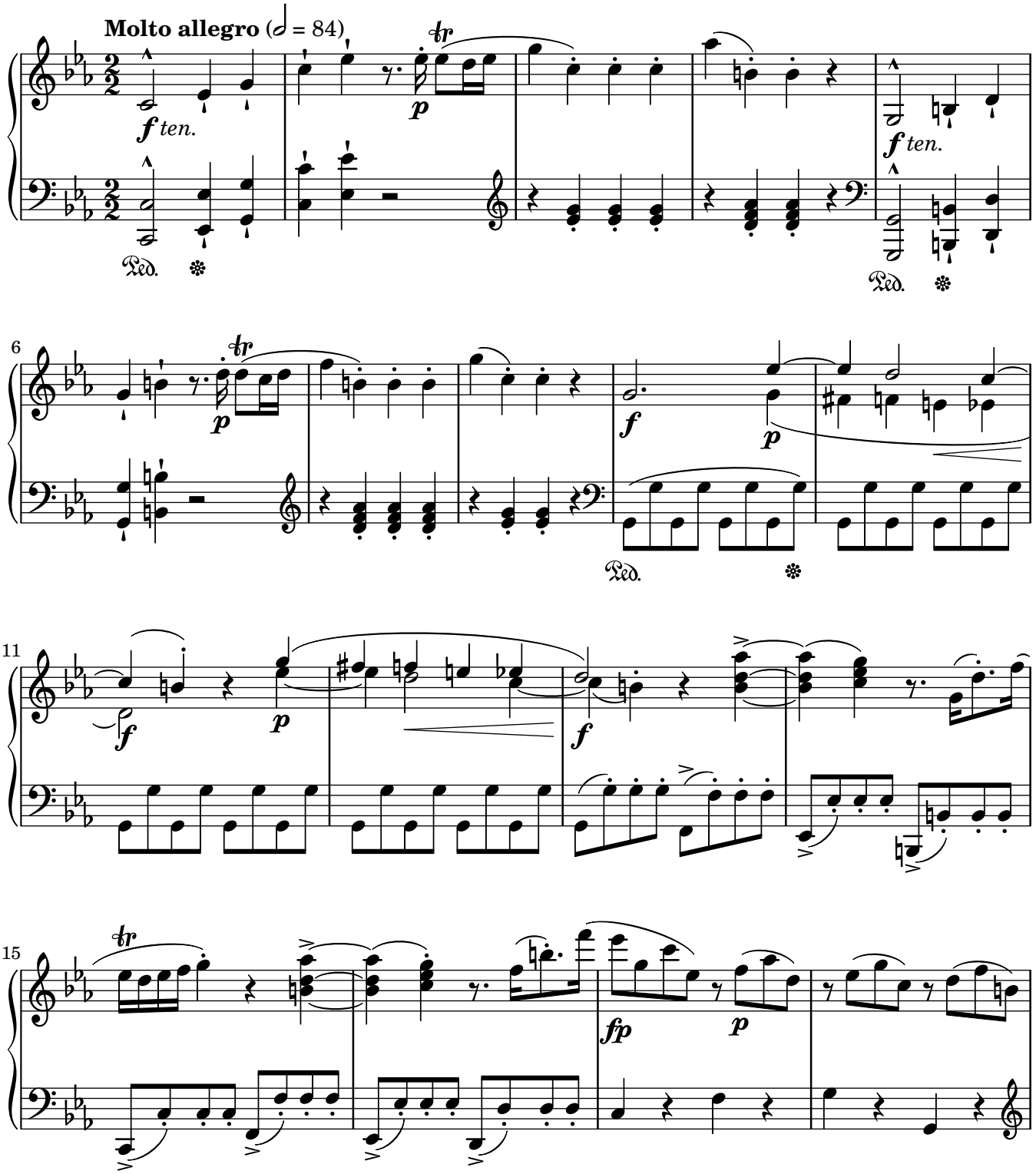
Sonata in C minor, K. 457: I. Molto allegro
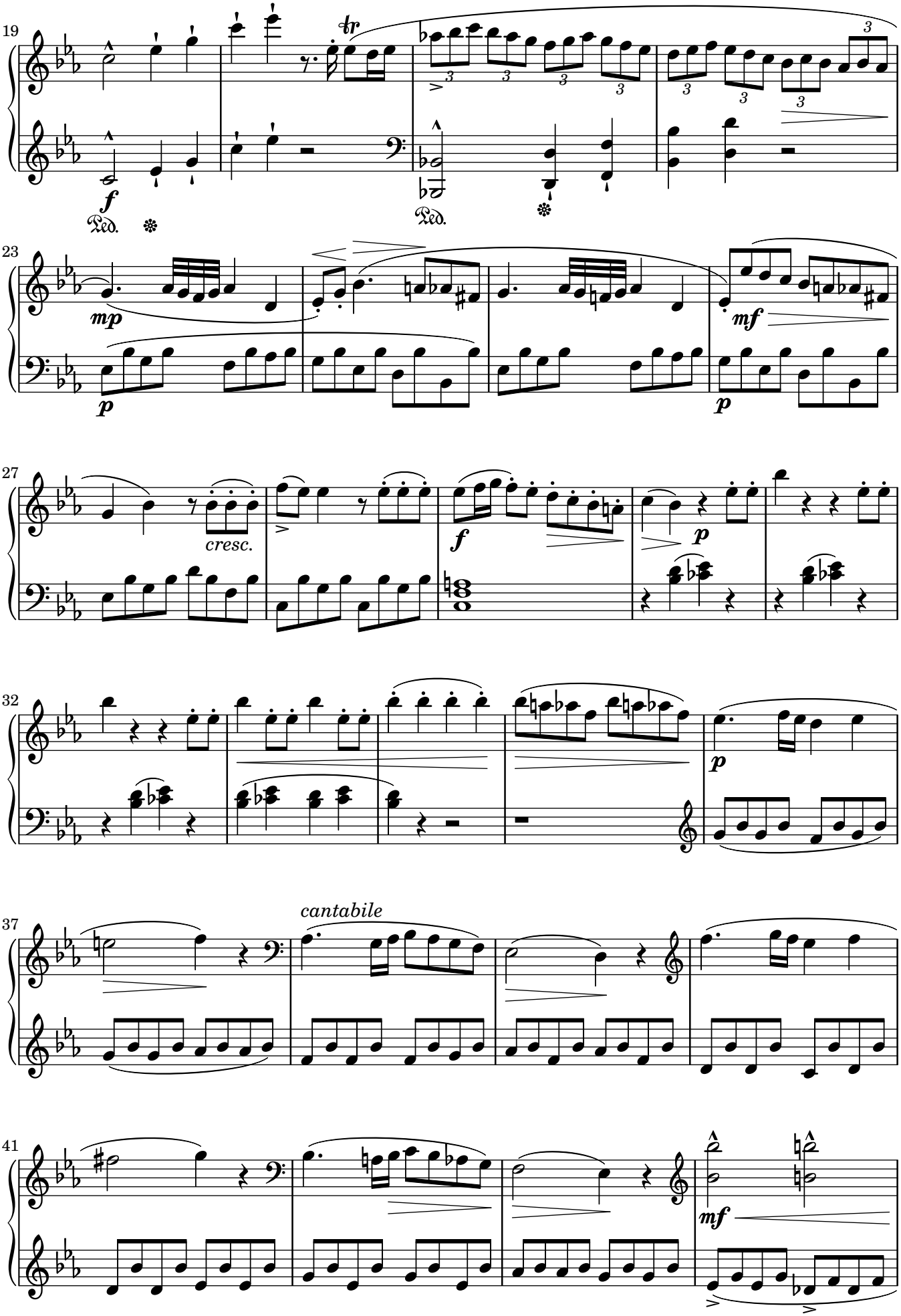
W. A. Mozart (1756-1791) - Piano Sonata in C minor (1784)
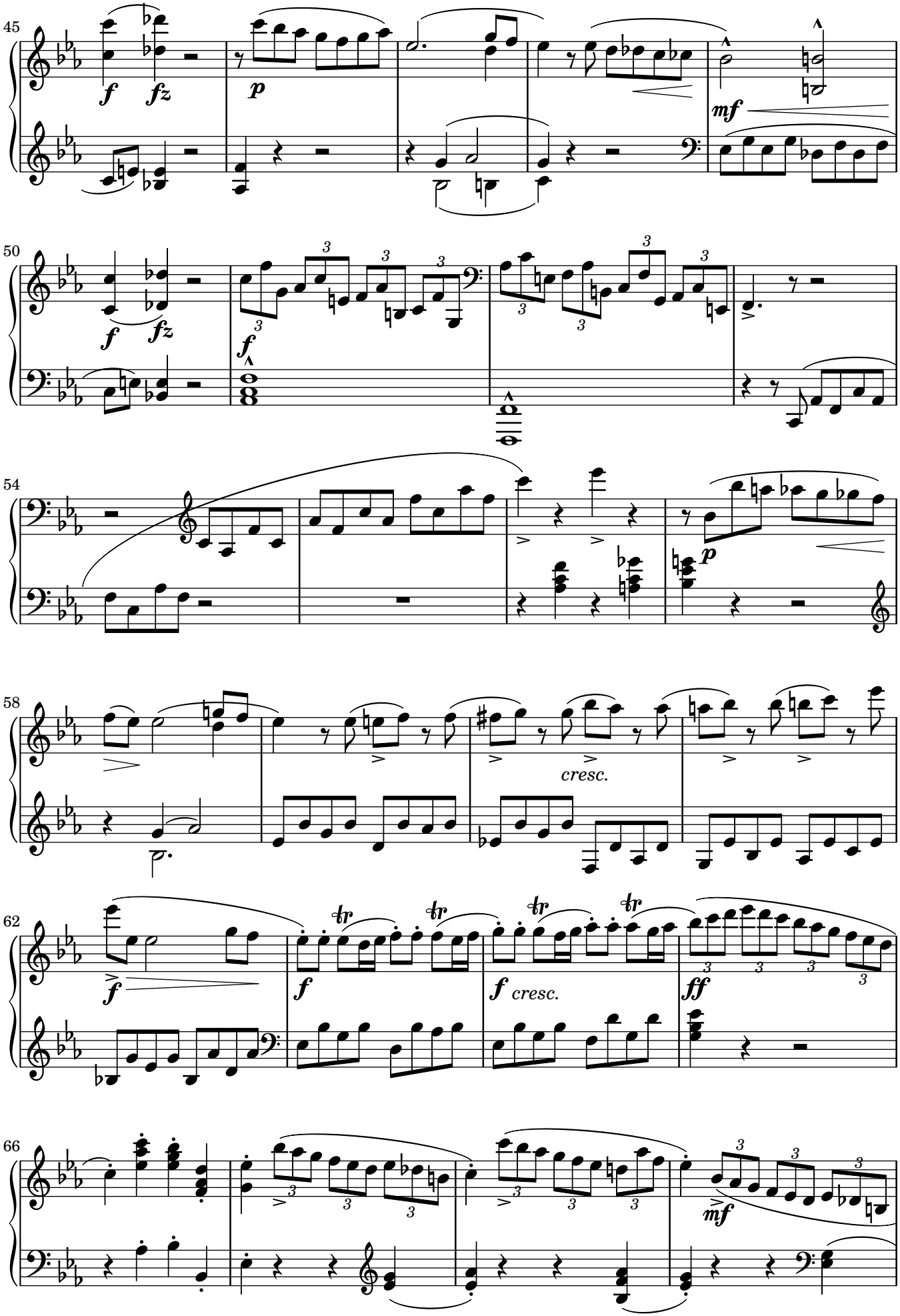
Level 10 · about 7 min
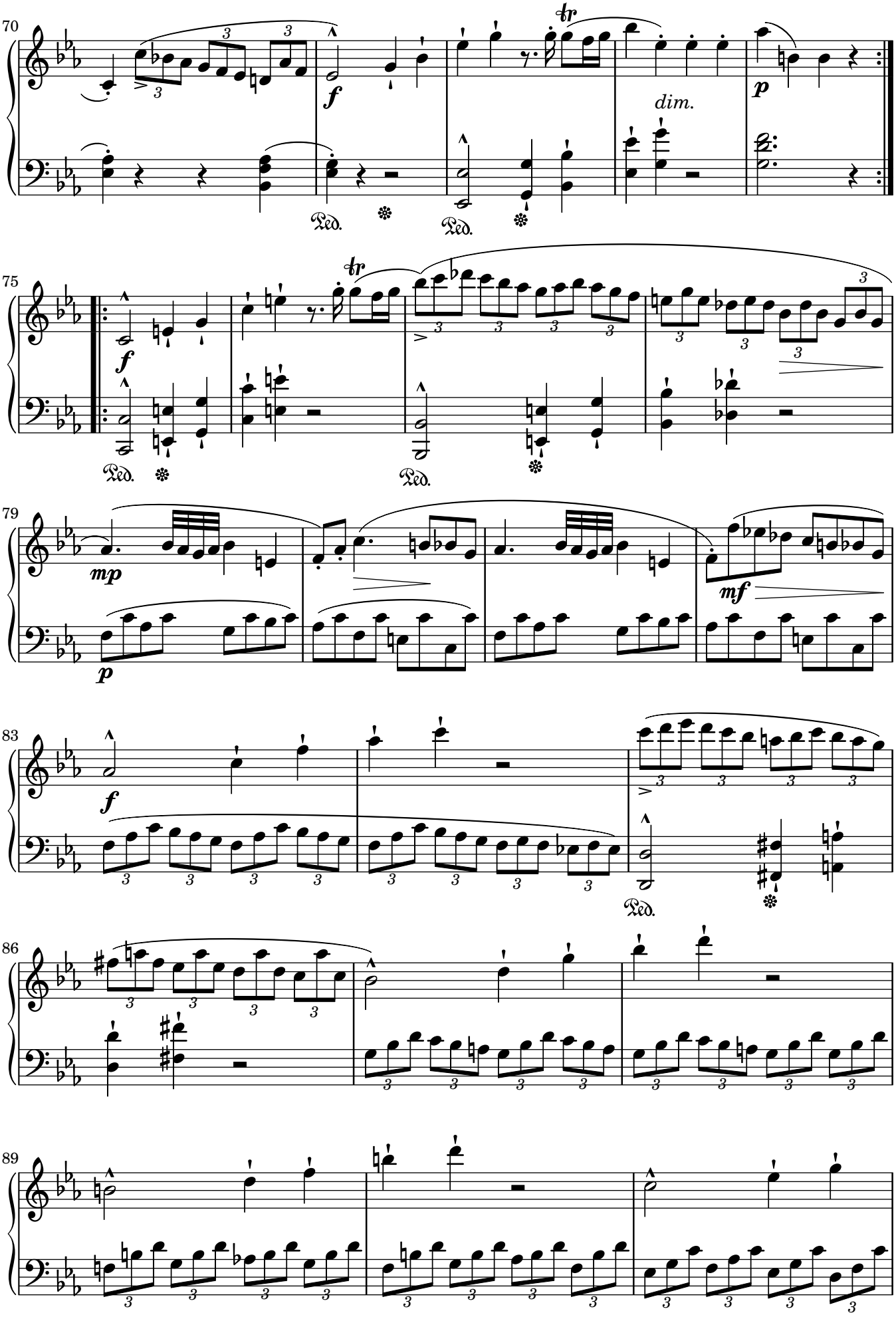
One of Mozart's most dramatic movements: a fierce rising arpeggio answered by a pleading reply, and a development full of sudden contrasts. The fast broken octaves and the long scale passages need slow, even practice; the dynamics must change instantly, as the score marks.
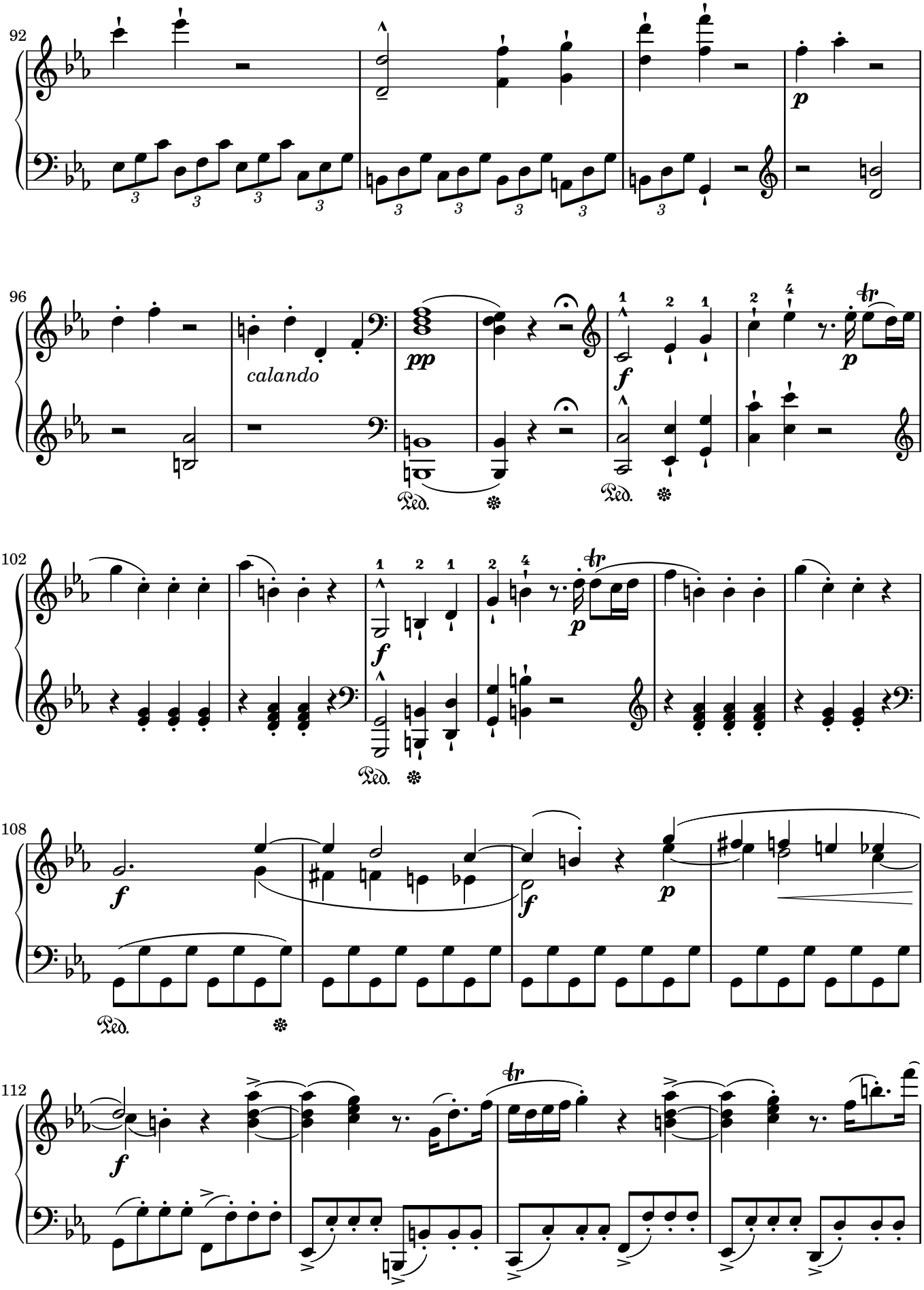
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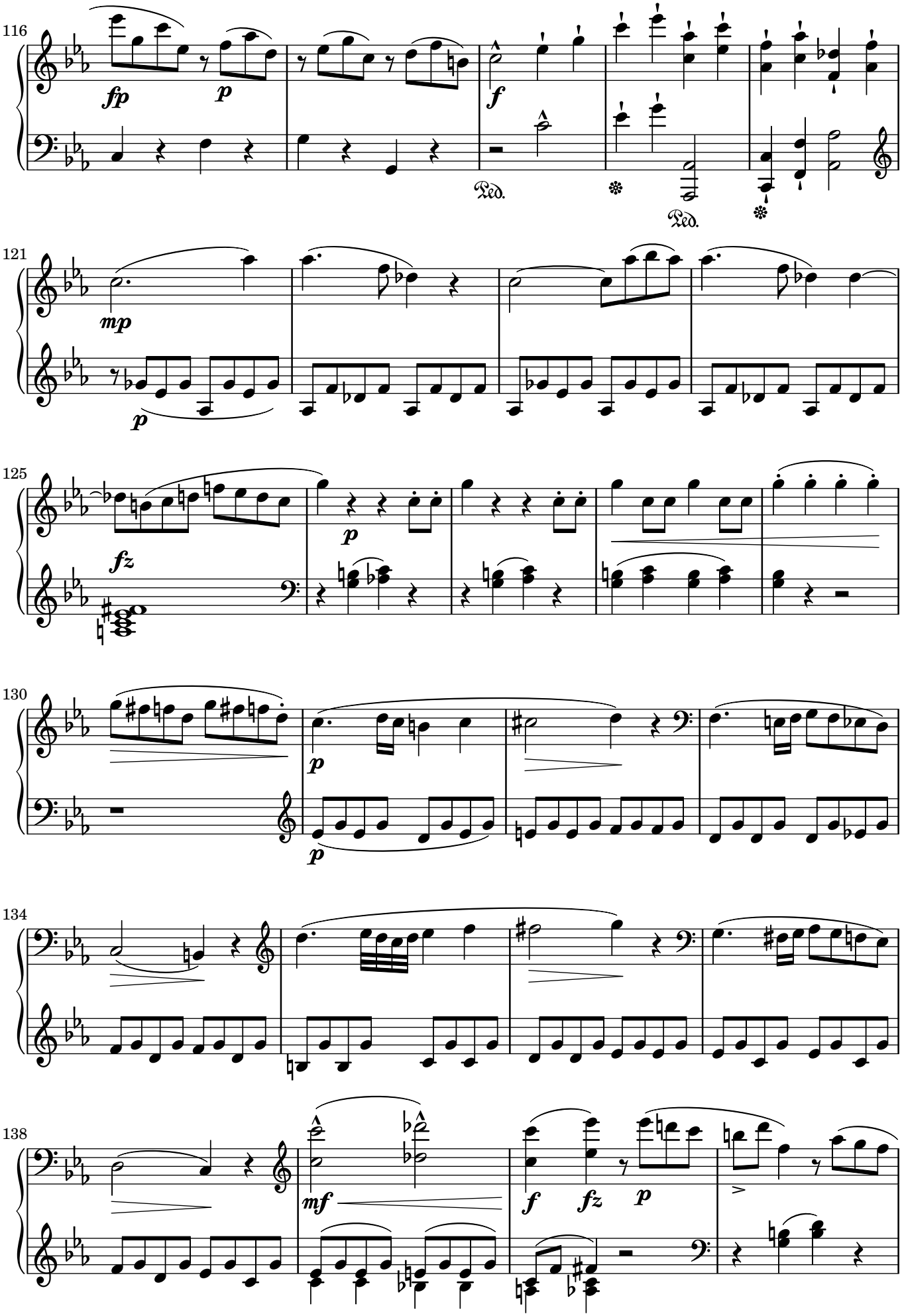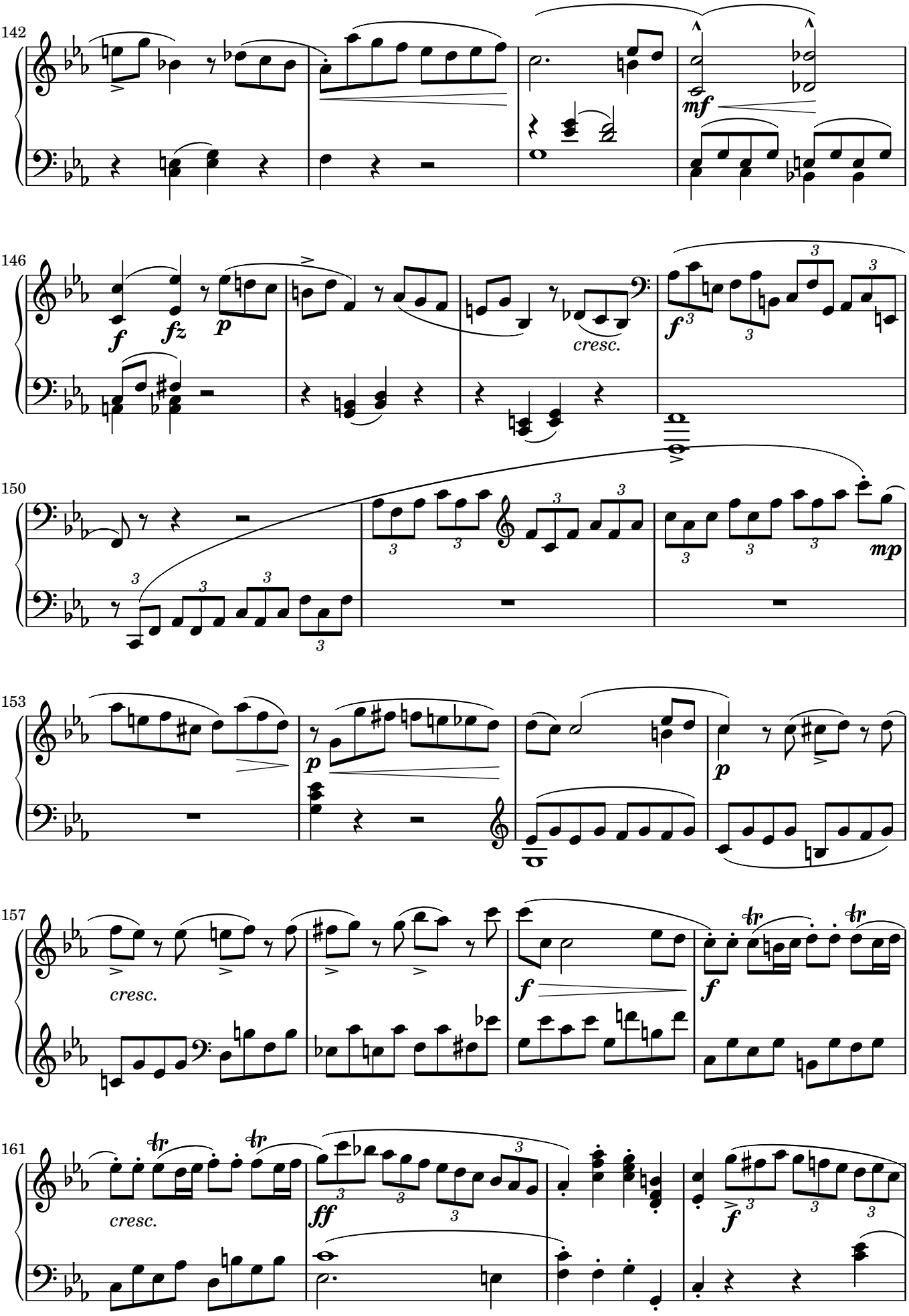



19
f
Ped.
23
mp
p
mf
27
cresc.
f
p
32
p
37
cantabile
41
mf
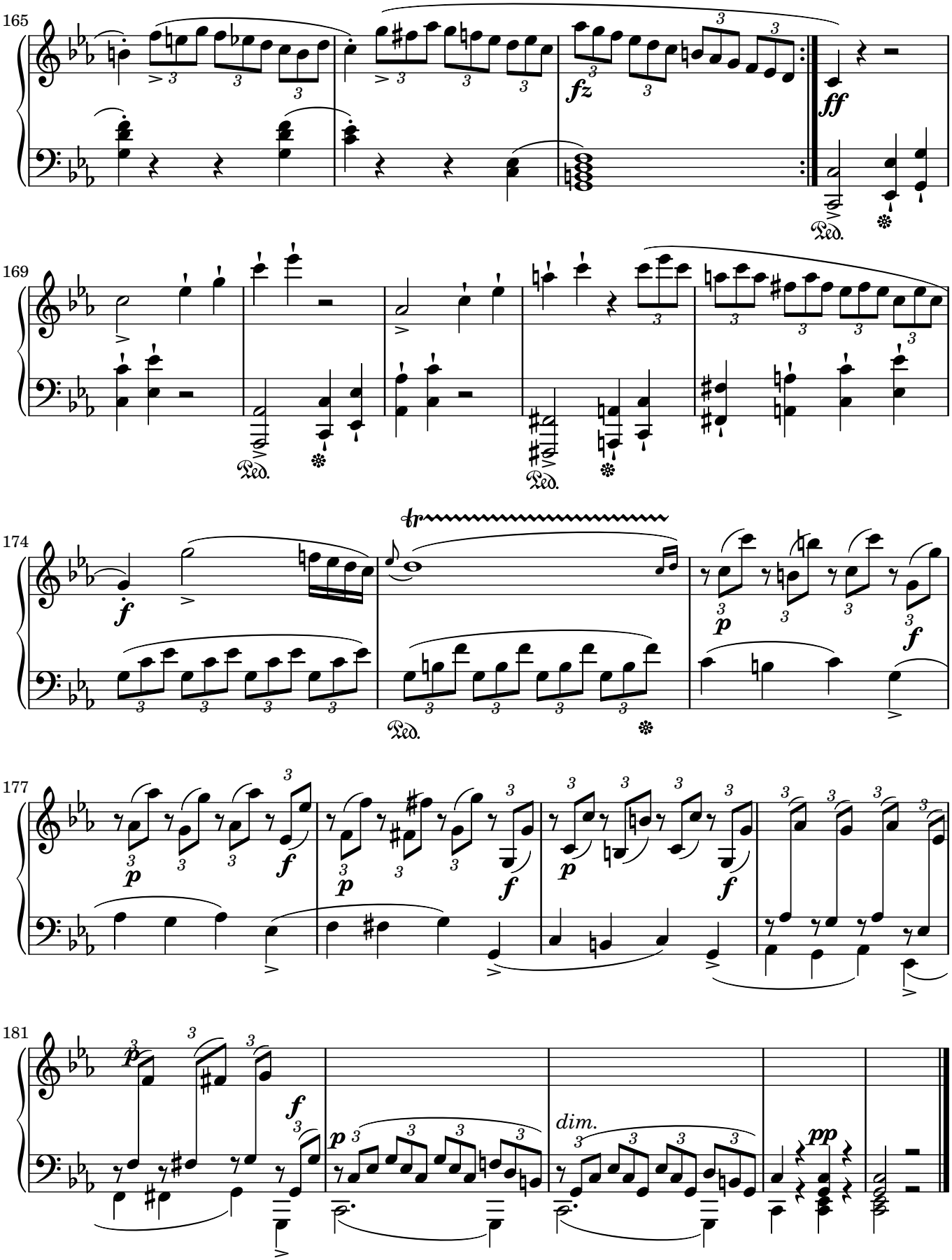

45
f
fz
p
mf
50
f
fz
f
54
p
58
cresc.
62
f
f
f cresc.
ff
66
mf


70
f
dim.
p
Ped.
75
f
Ped.
79
mp
p
mf
83
f
Ped.
86
89


92
96
calando
102
108
112


116
fp
p
f
Ped.
Ped.
121
mp
p
125
fz
p
130
p
p
134
138
mf
f
fz
p


142
mf
146
f
fz
p
cresc.
f
150
mp
153
p
p
157
cresc.
f
f
161
cresc.
ff
f


165
fz
ff
Ped.
169
Ped.
Ped.
174
f
tr
p
f
Ped.
177
p
f
p
f
p
f
181
p
f
p
dim.
pp
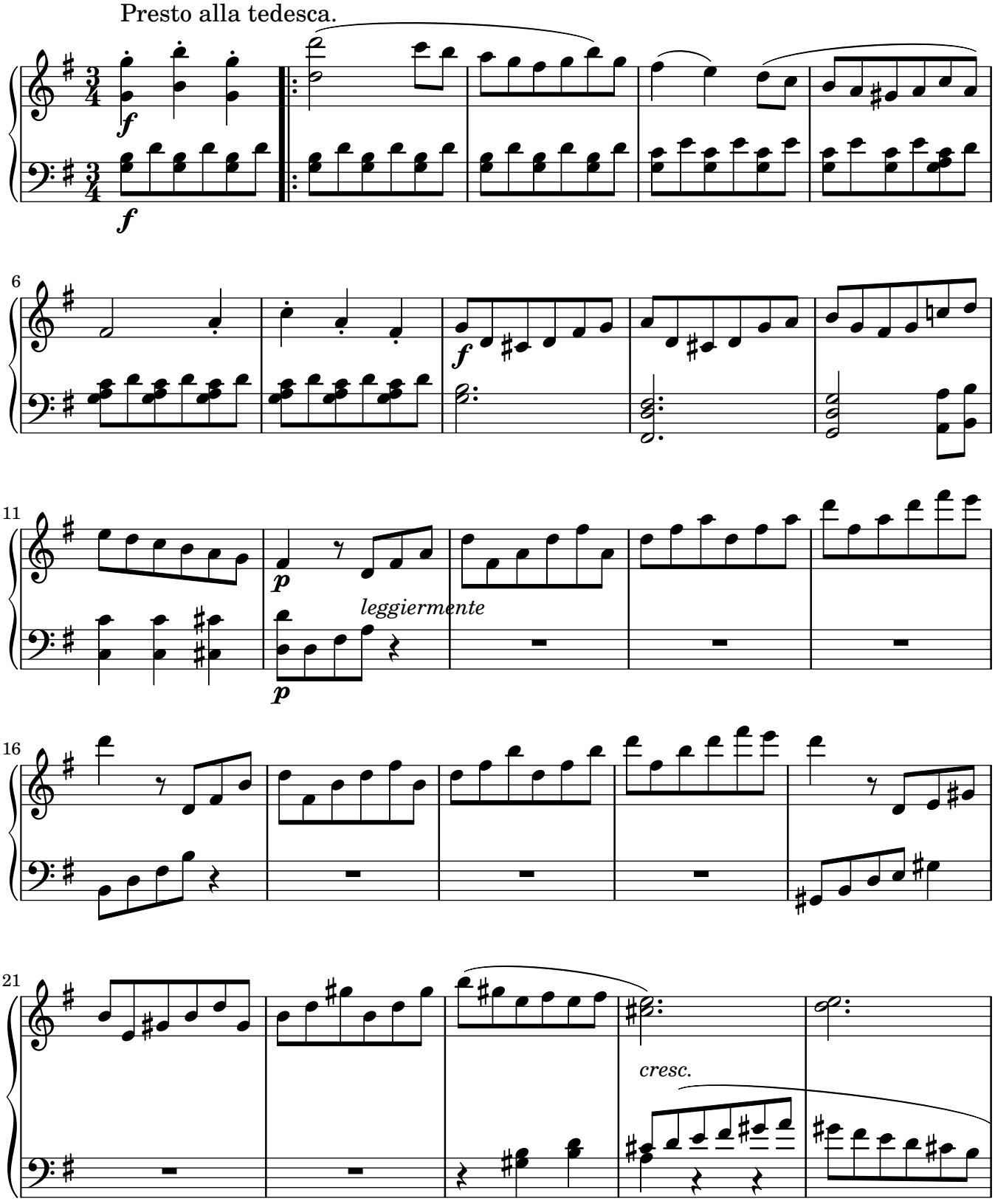
Sonata in G, Op. 79: I. Presto alla tedesca
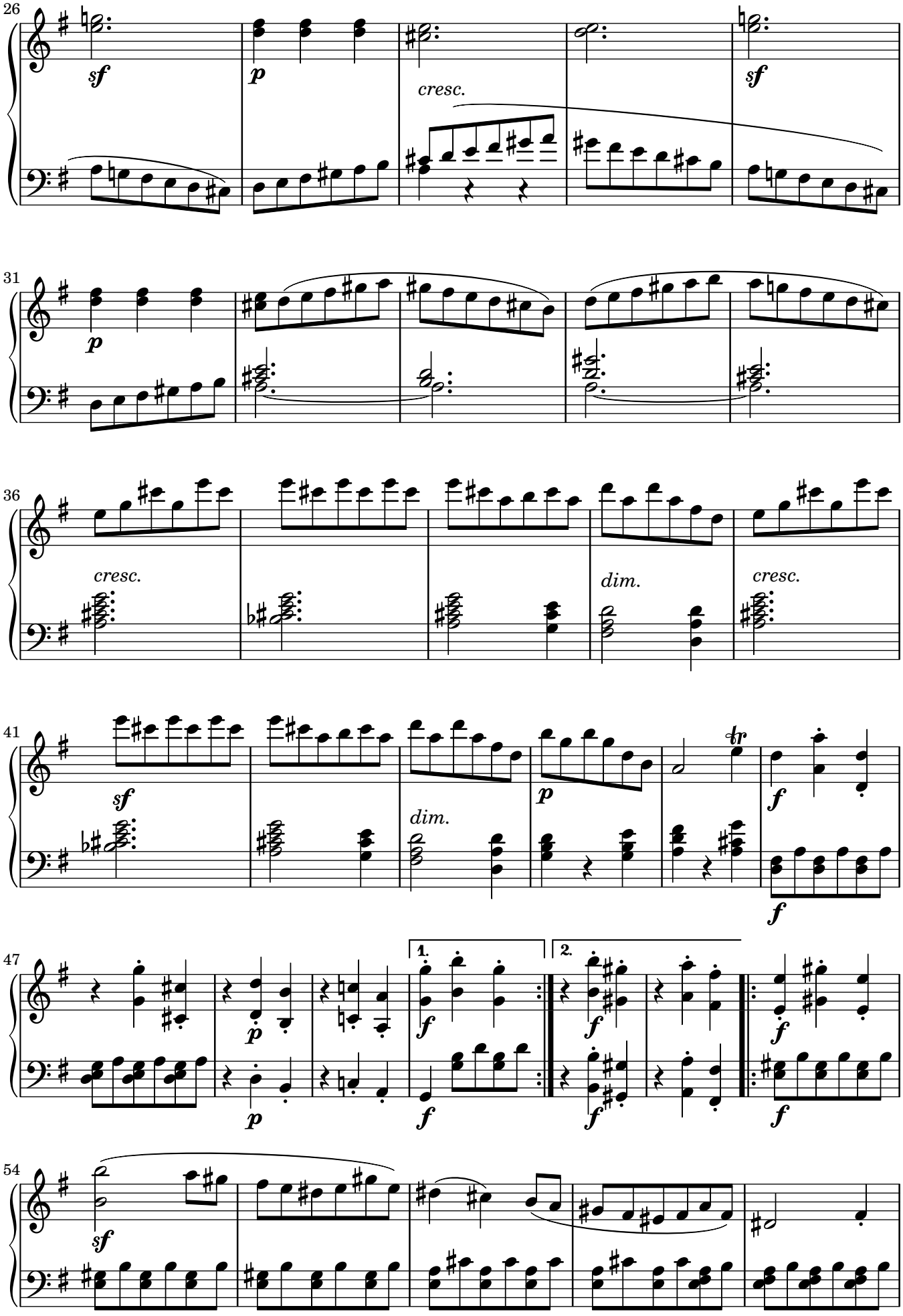
L. van Beethoven (1770-1827) - Sonatina (1809)
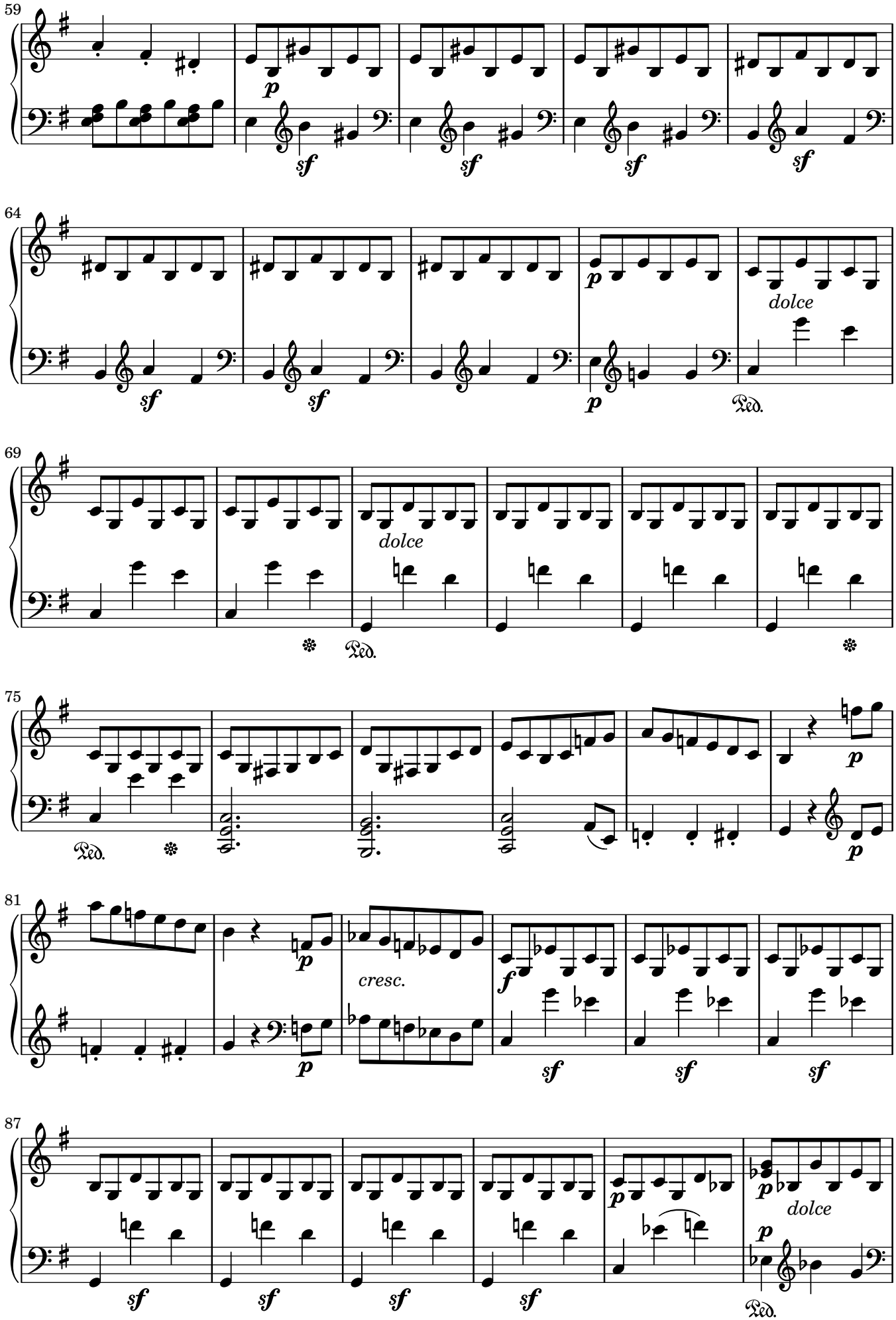
Level 9 · about 5 min
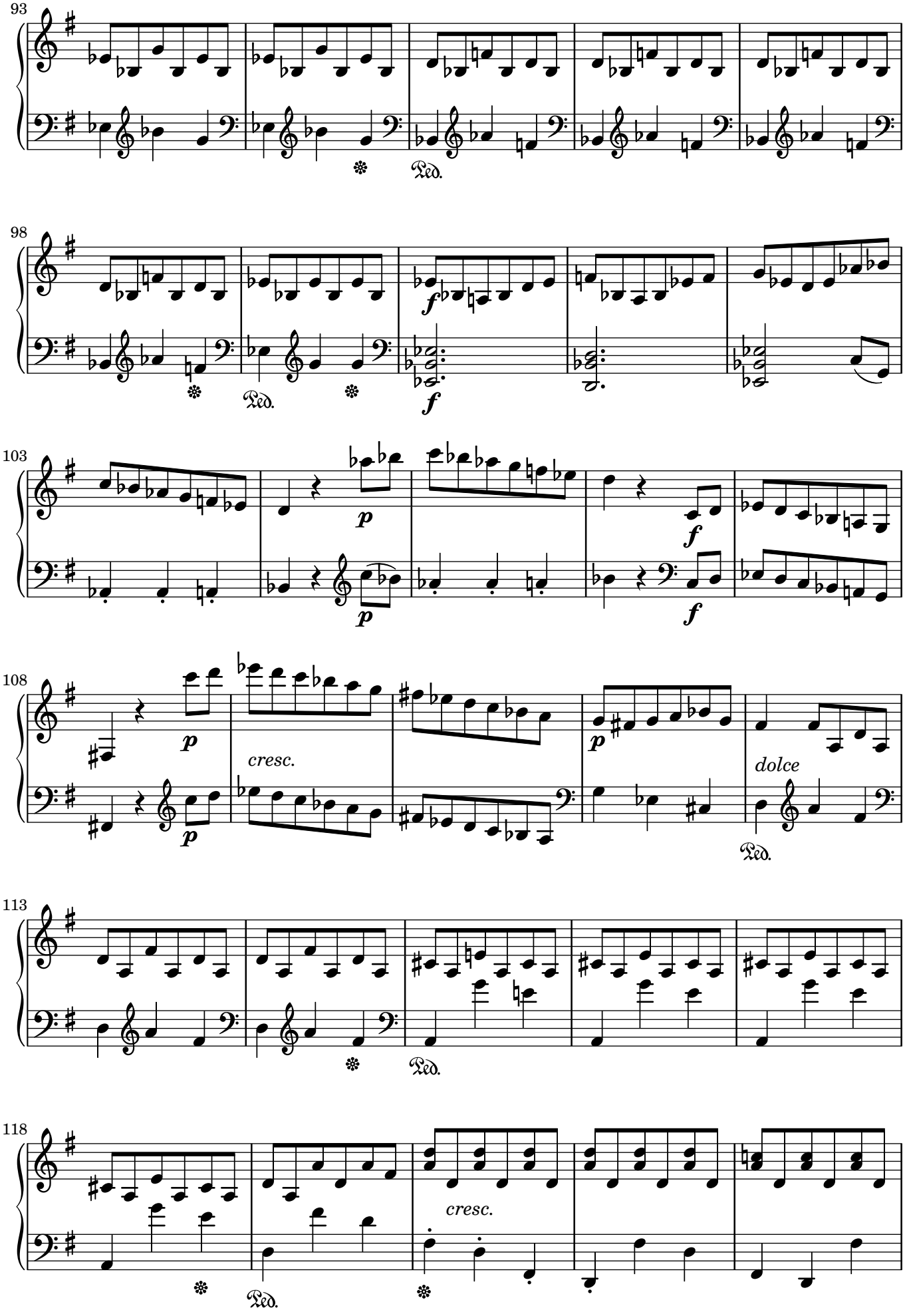
'In the German style': a quick German dance in 3/4. The hand crossings of the development, where the left hand leaps over the right for the cuckoo calls, are the hard place. Count one beat to the bar once the notes are secure.
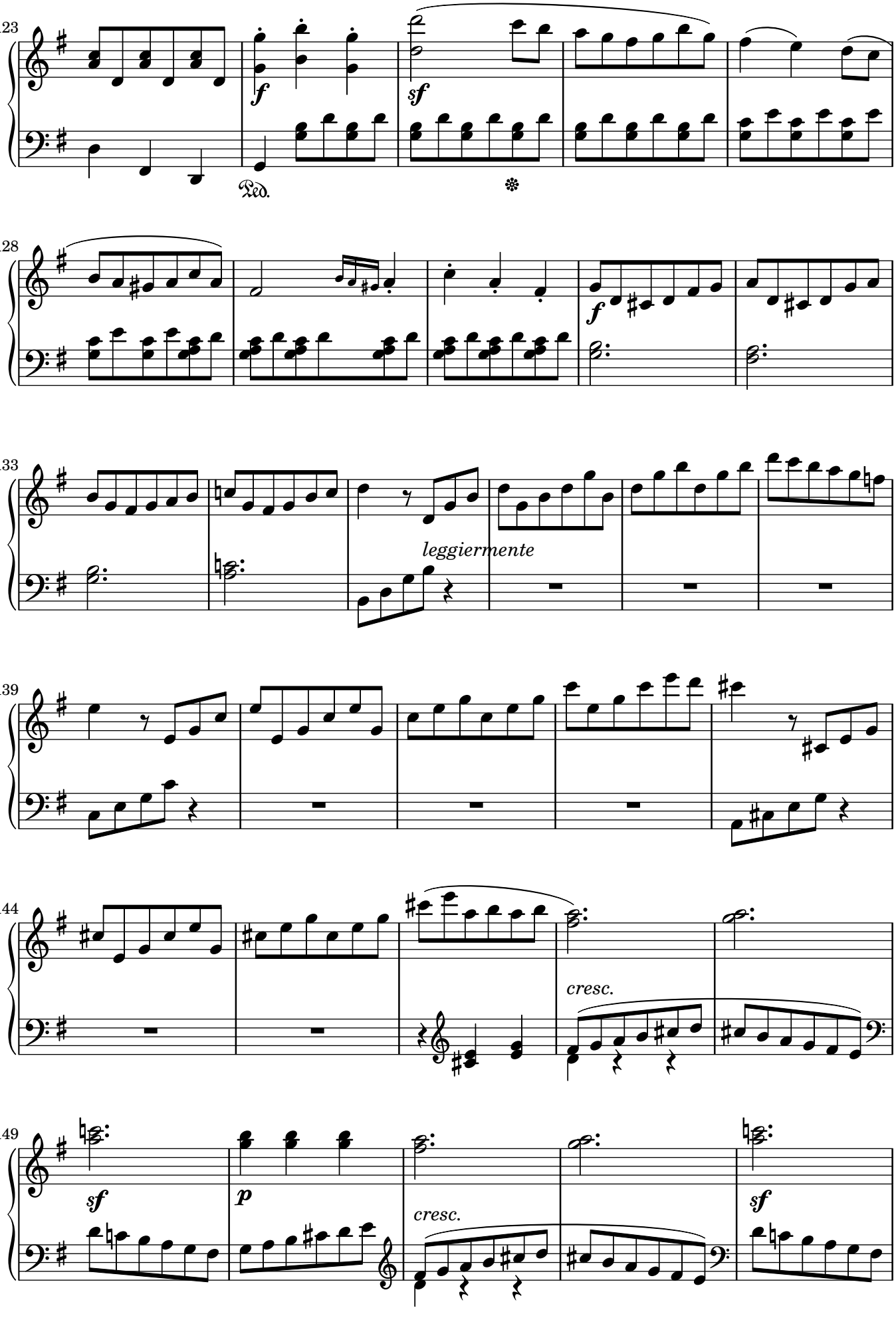
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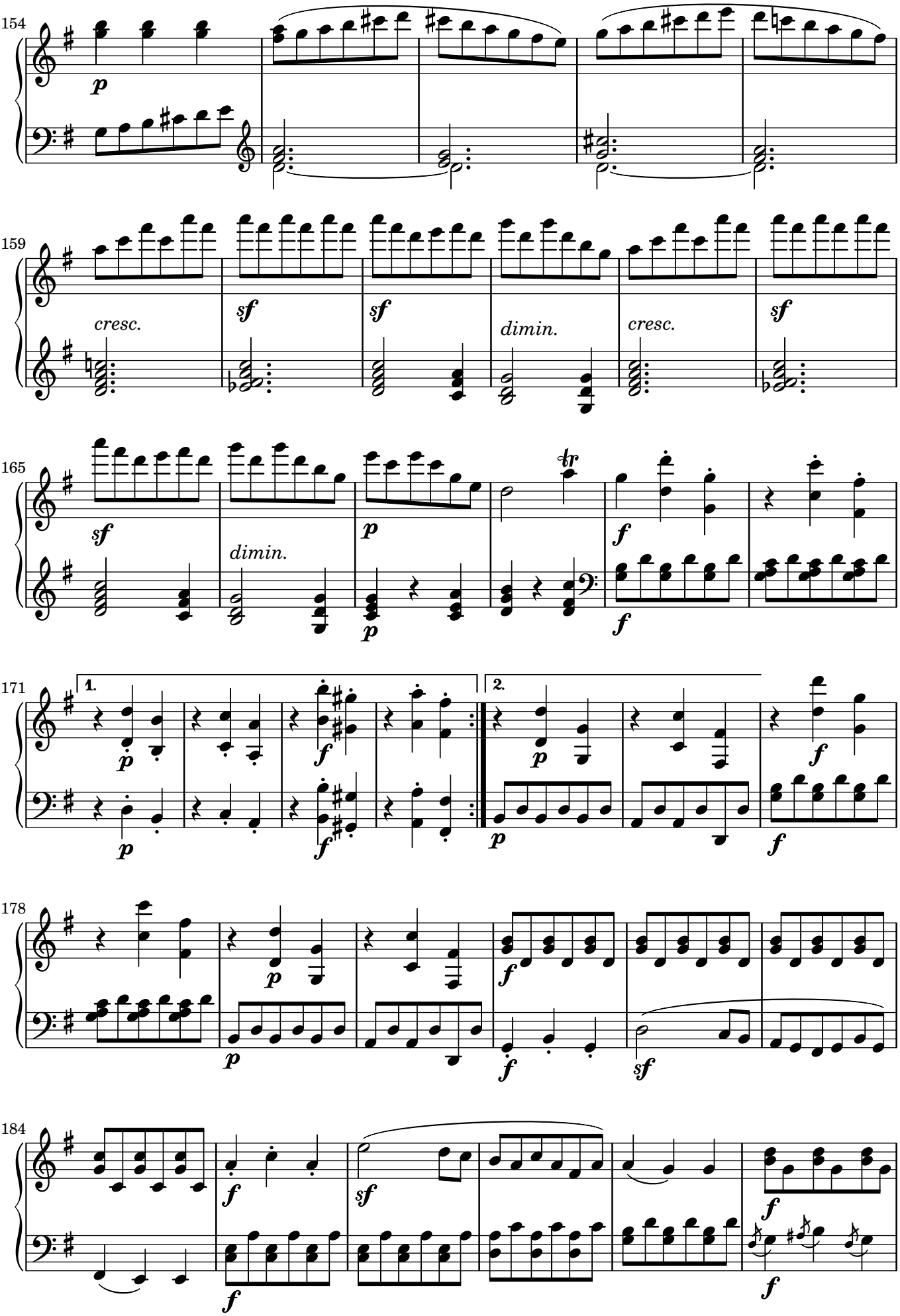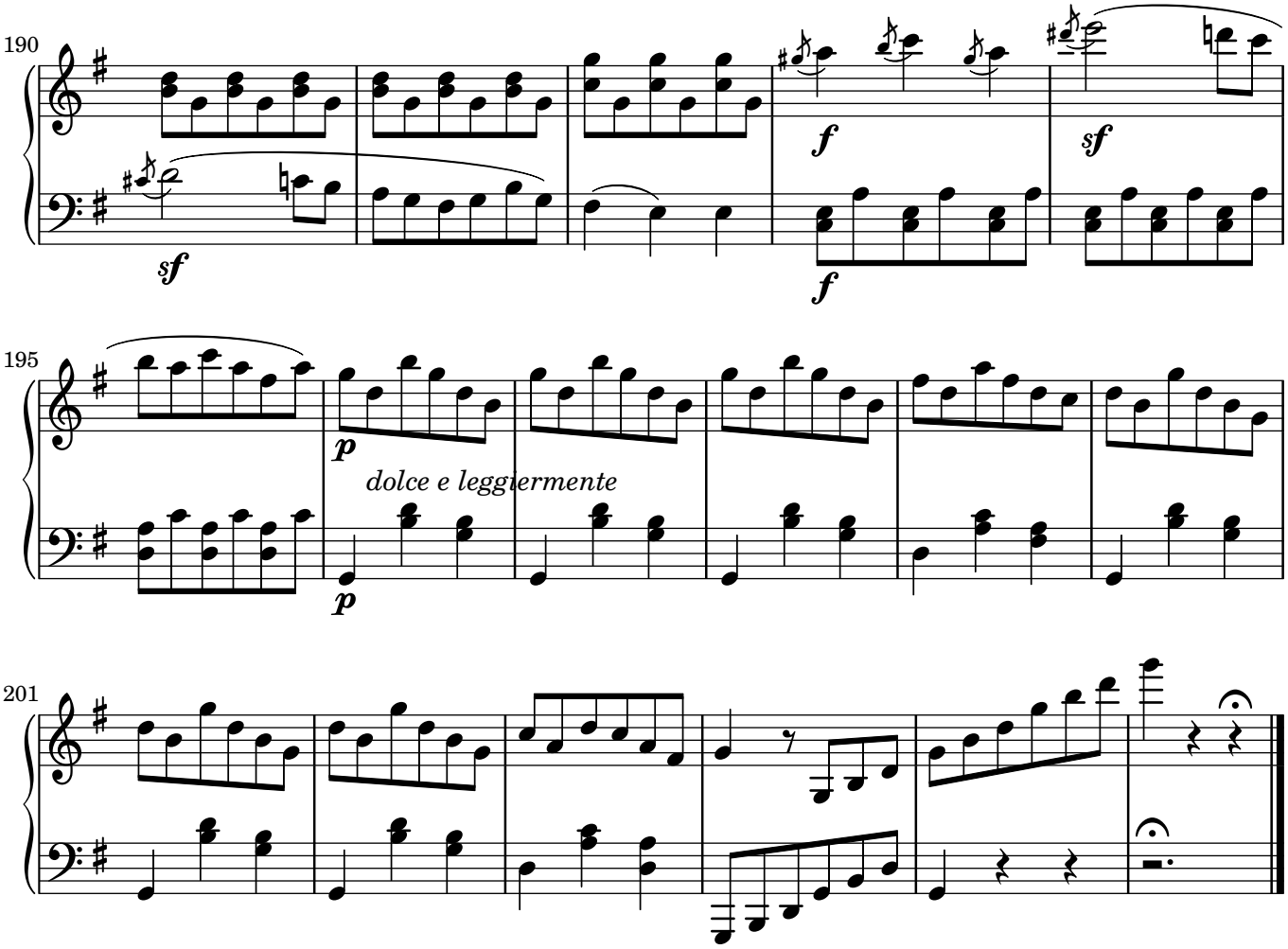



26
sf
p
cresc.
sf
31
p
36
cresc.
dim.
cresc.
41
sf
dim.
p
f
f
47
p
1.
2.
f
f
f
f
p
54
sf


59
64
dolce
69
dolce
75
81
cresc.
87
dolce


93
Ped.
98
f
Ped.
f
103
p
p
f
f
108
p
p
cresc.
dolce
Ped.
113
Ped.
118
cresc.
Ped.


123
f
sf
Ped.
128
f
133
leggiermente
139
144
cresc.
149
sf
p
cresc.
sf


154
159
cresc.
dimin.
cresc.
165
dimin.
171
1.
2.
178
184


190
sf
f
sf
f
195
p
dolce e leggiermente
p
201
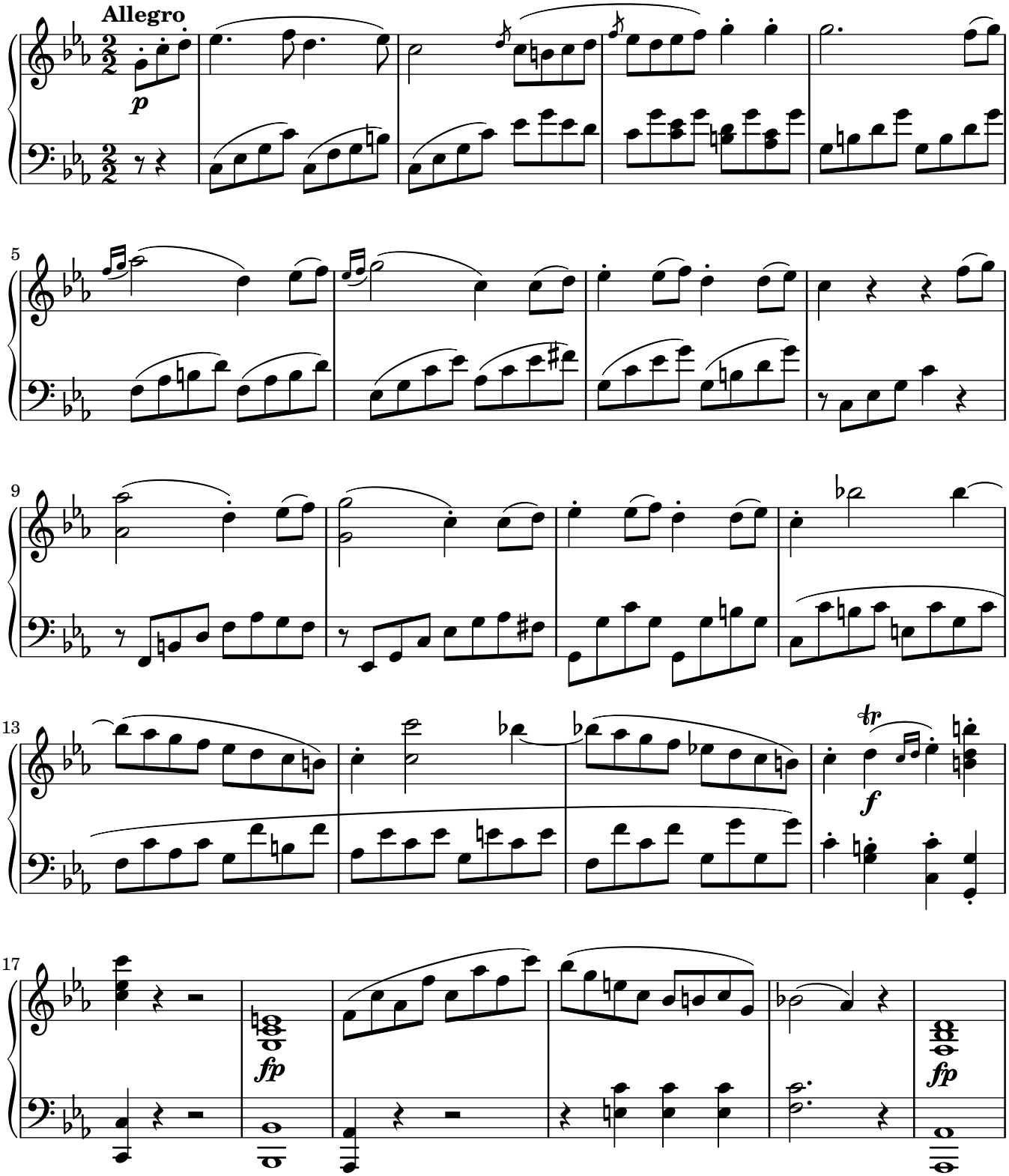
"Pathétique" Sonata, Op. 13: III. Rondo
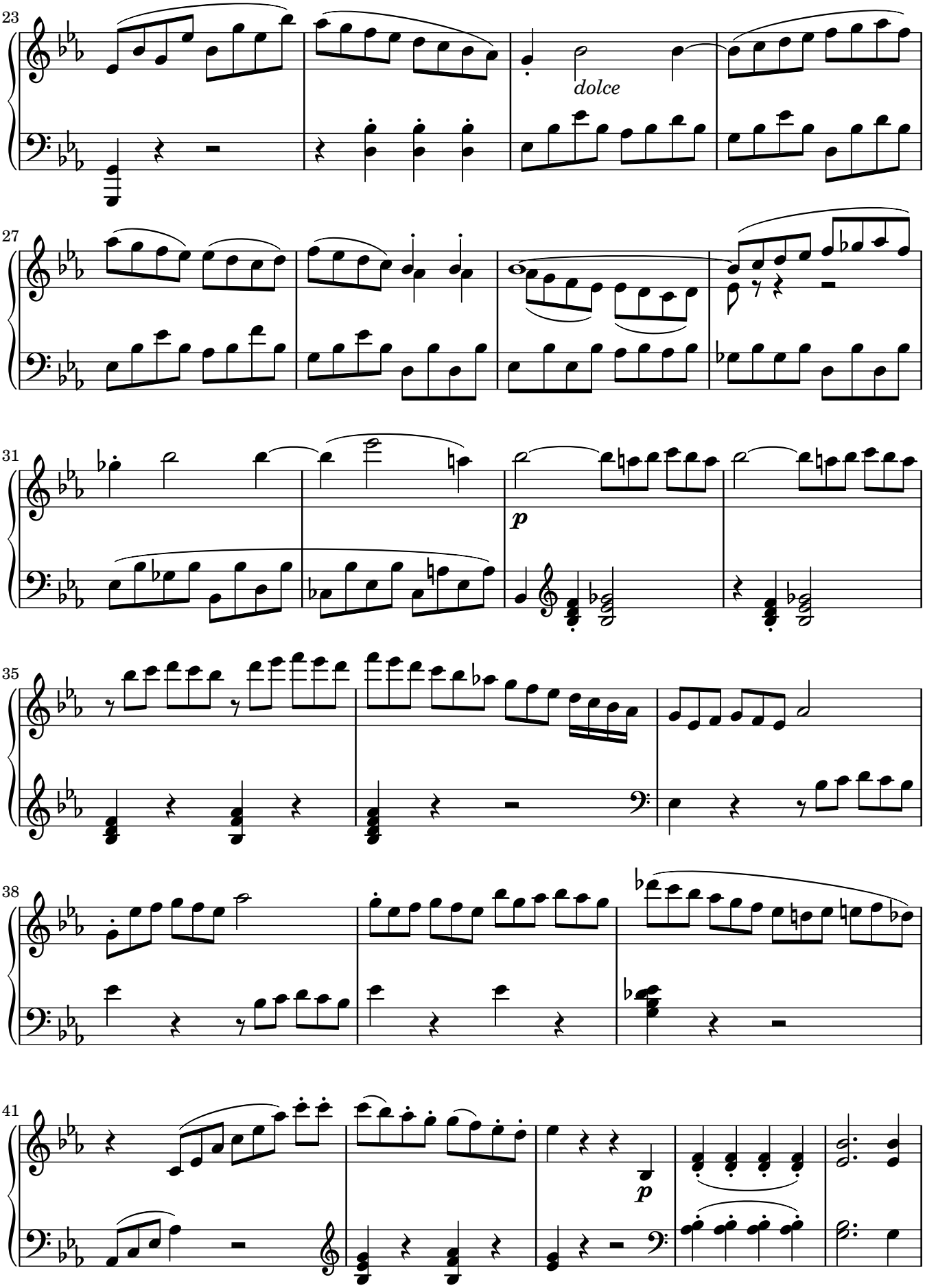
L. van Beethoven (1770-1827) - Grande Sonate pathétique (1798)
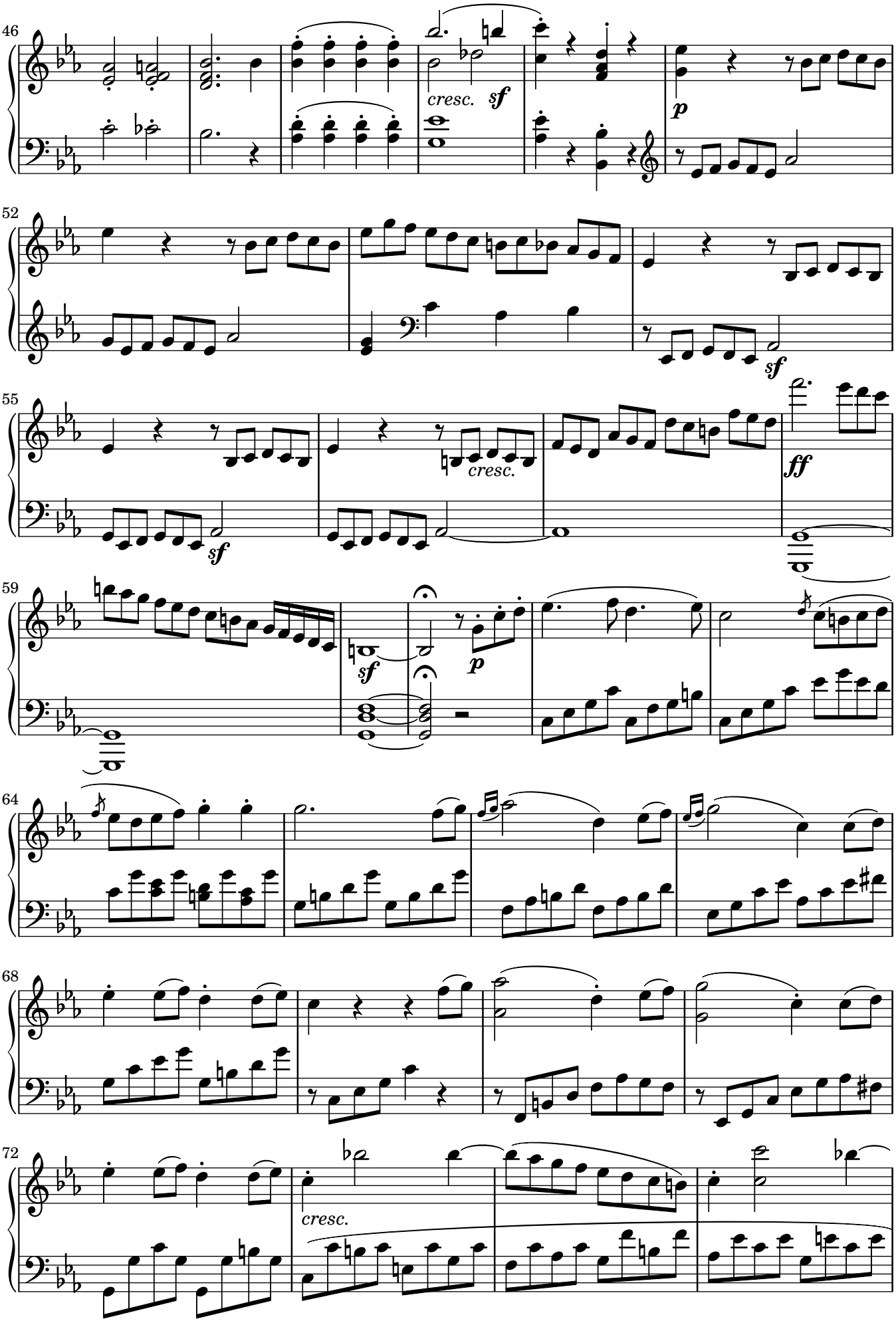
Level 9 · about 5 min
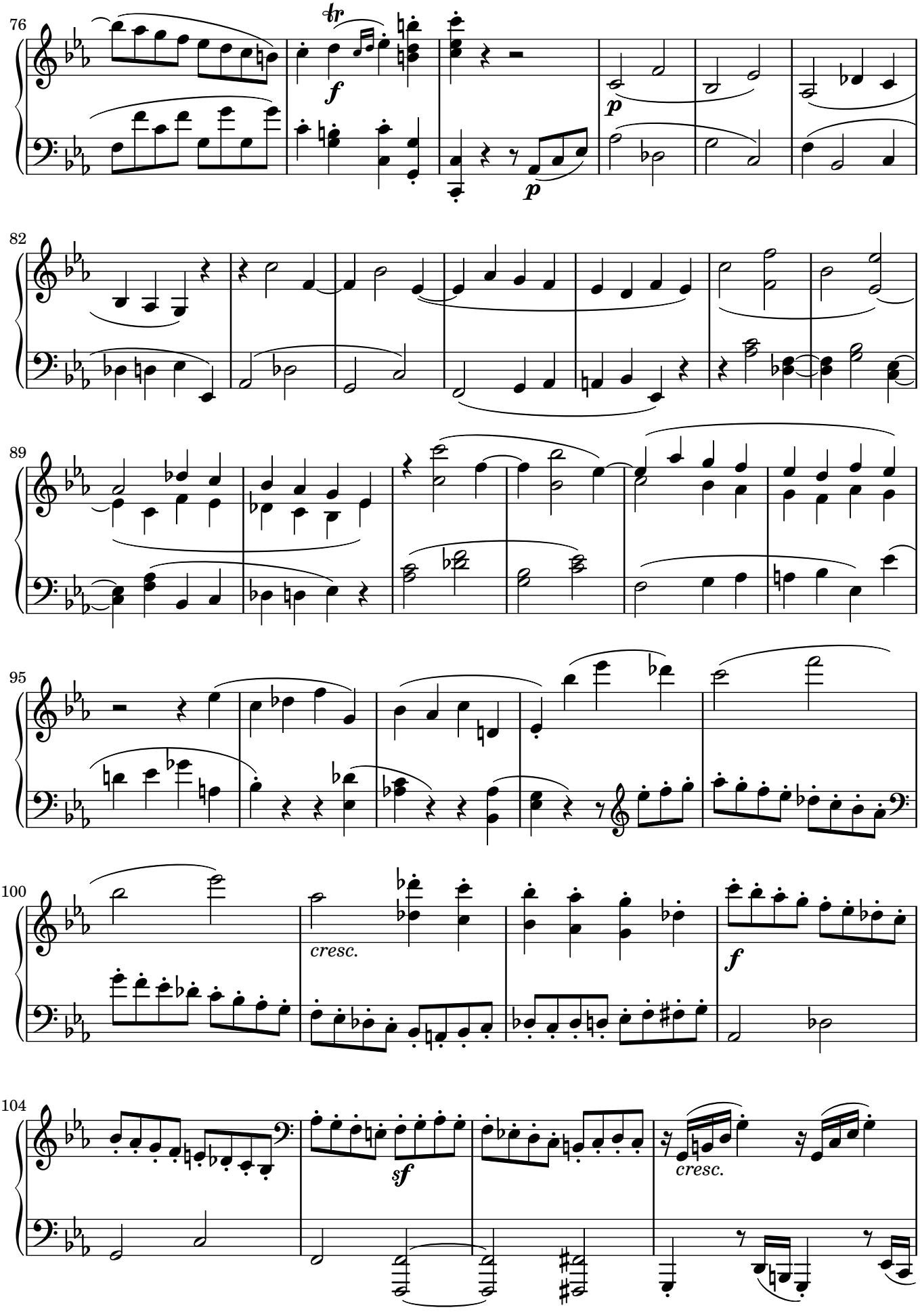
The finale of the Pathétique: a restless C-minor rondo whose theme returns three times between episodes. The triplet and sixteenth runs and the left-hand octaves need even, controlled practice; keep the theme singing, not hammered.
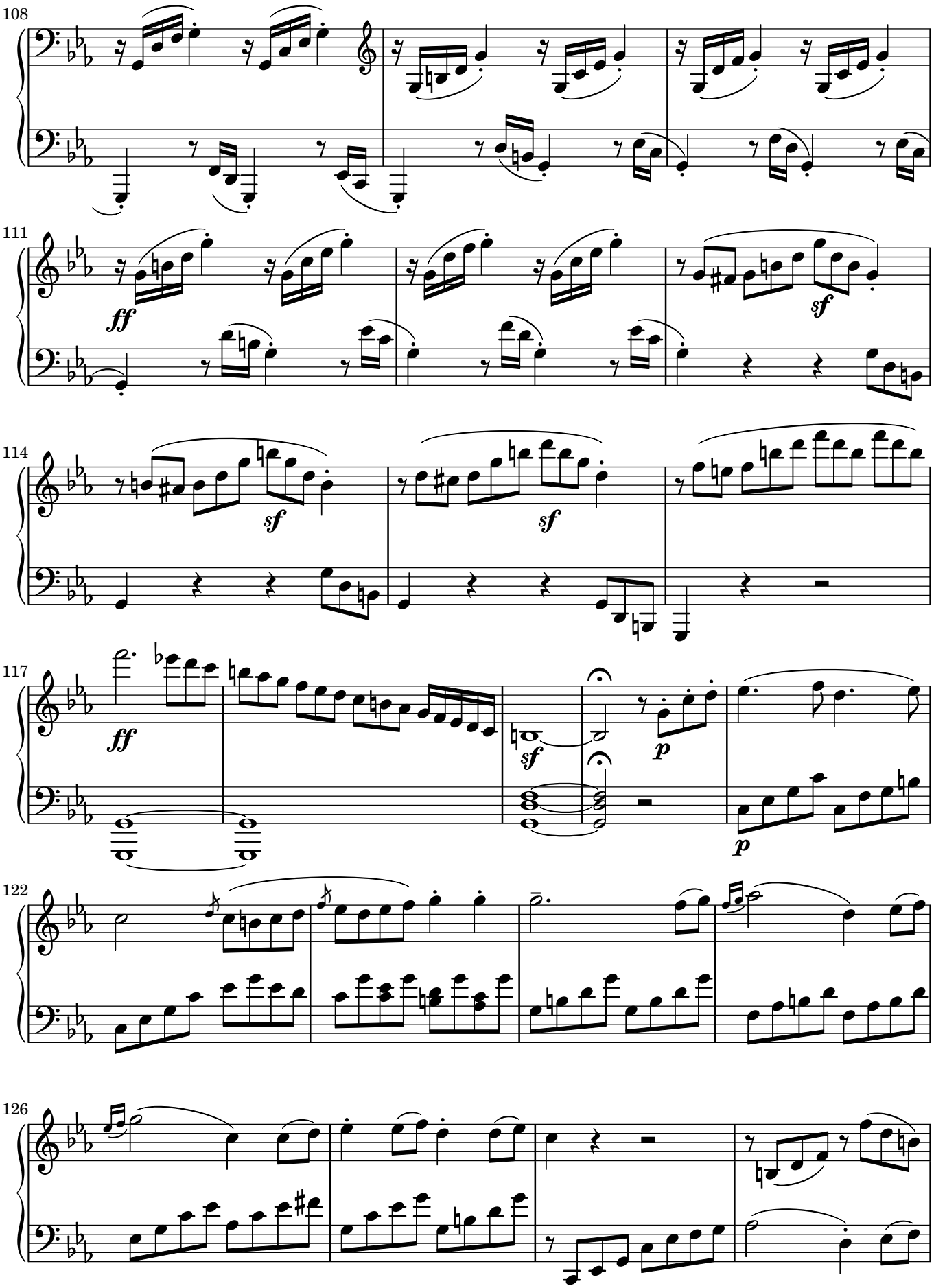
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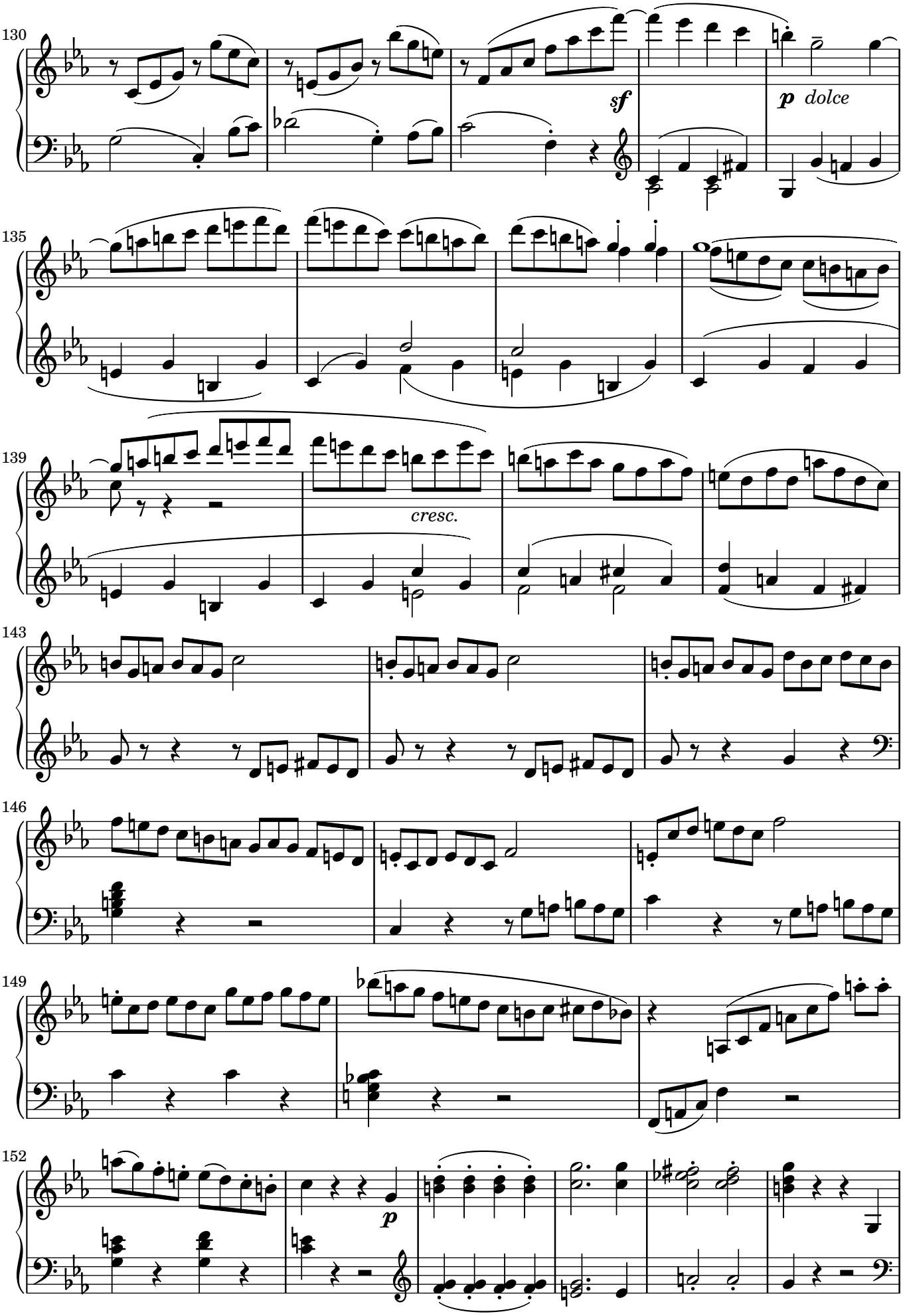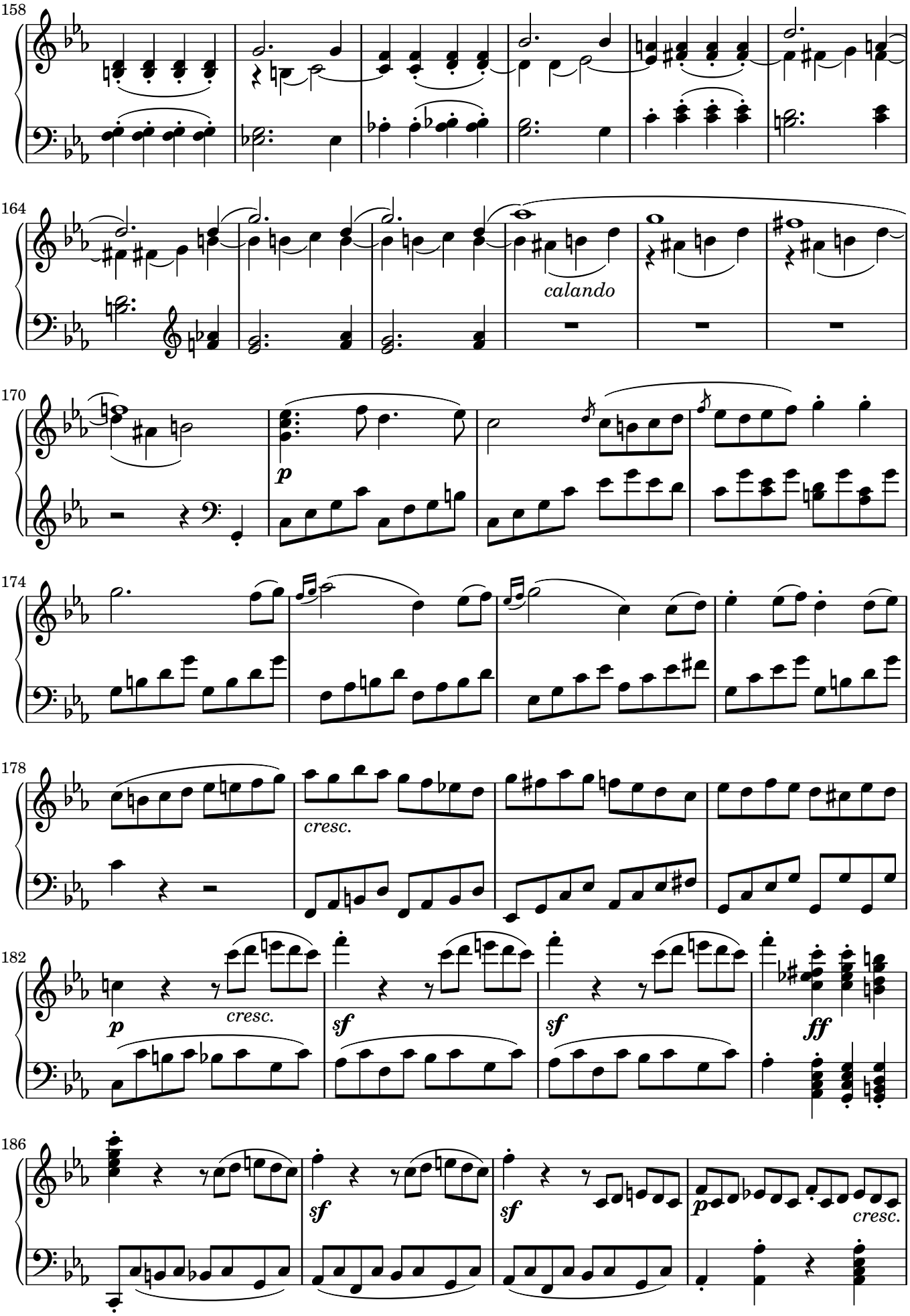



23
dolce
27
31
p
35
38
41
p
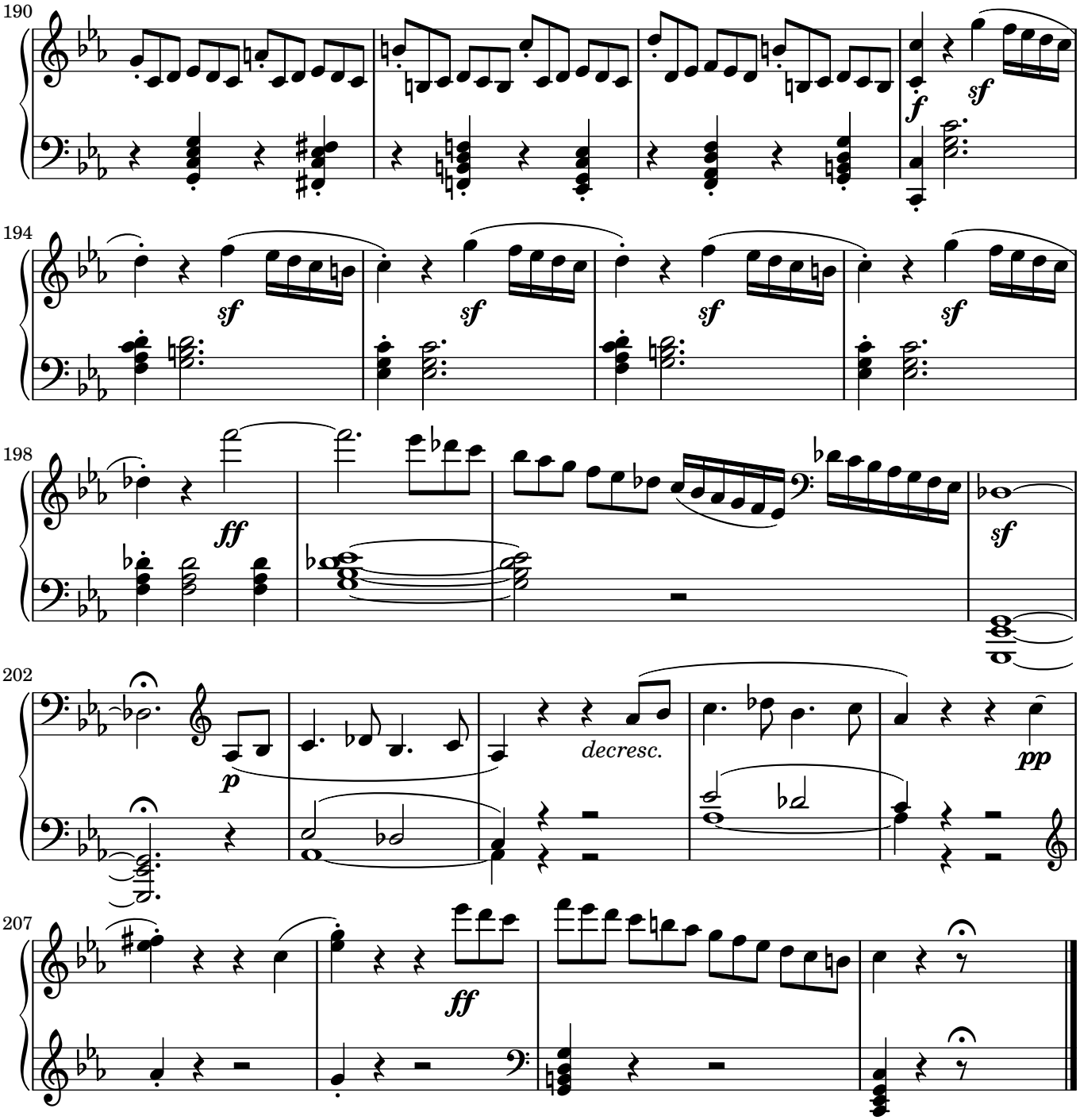

46
cresc.
sf
p
52
sf
55
sf
cresc.
ff
59
sf
p
64
68
72
cresc.


76
tr
f
p
p
82
89
95
100
cresc.
f
104
sf
cresc.


108
111
ff
sf
114
sf
sf
117
ff
sf
p
p
122
126


130
sf
p dolce
135
139
cresc.
143
146
149
152
p


158
164
calando
170
p
174
178
cresc.
182
p
cresc.
sf
sf
ff
186
sf
sf
p
cresc.


190
194
198
202
207
f
sf
ff
p
pp
decresc.
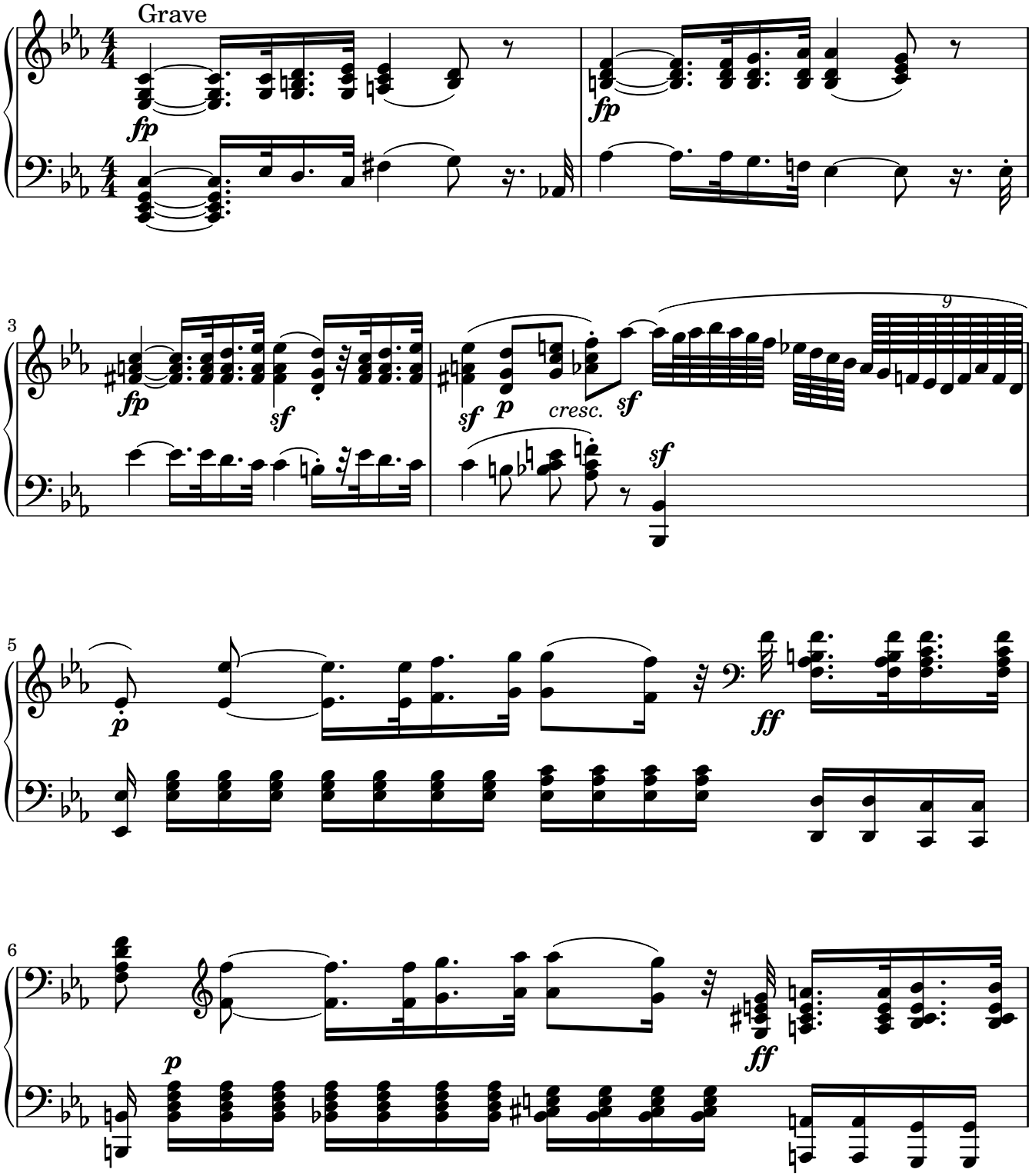
"Pathétique" Sonata, Op. 13: I. Grave - Allegro
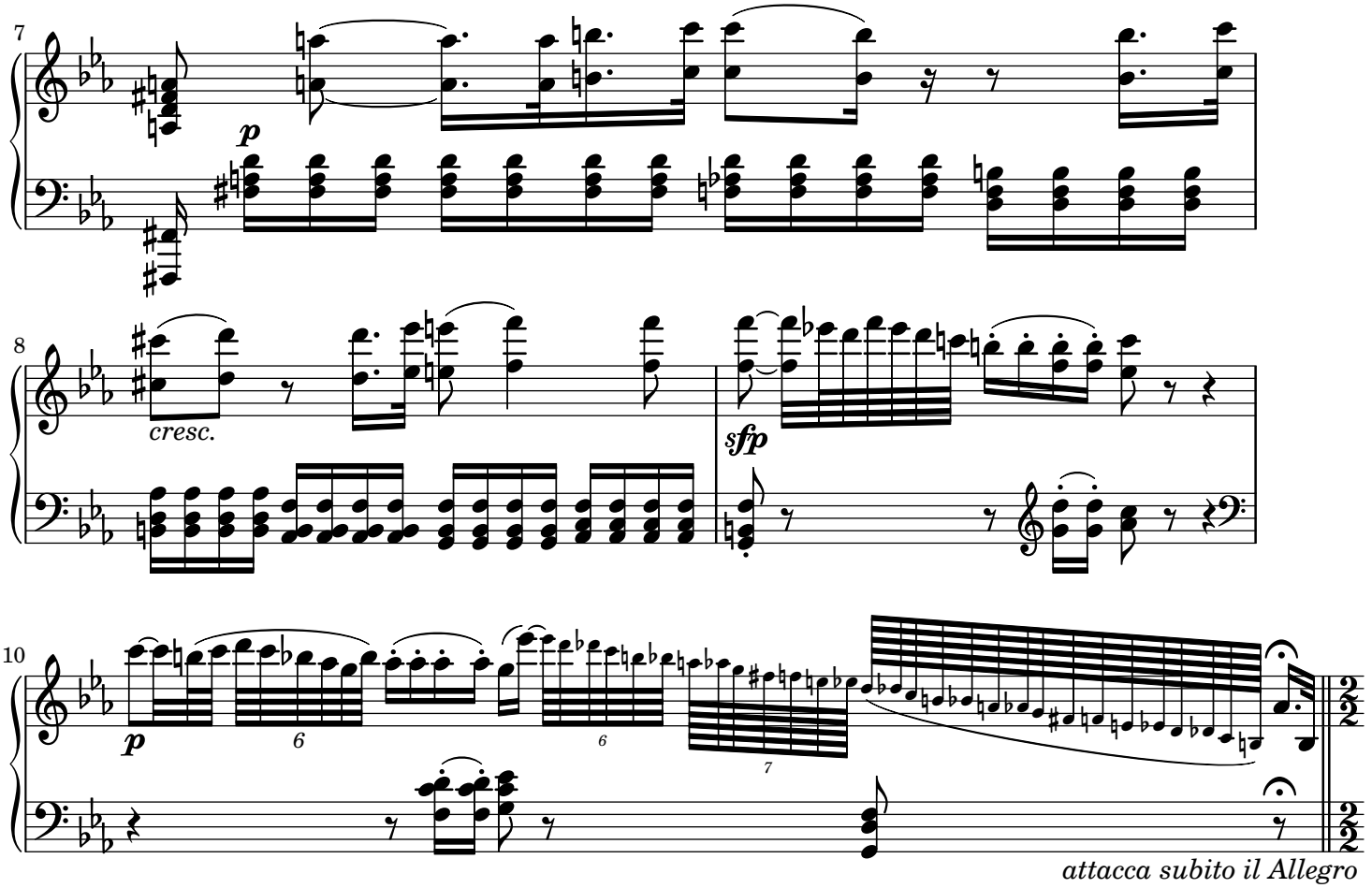
L. van Beethoven (1770-1827) - Grande Sonate pathétique (1798)
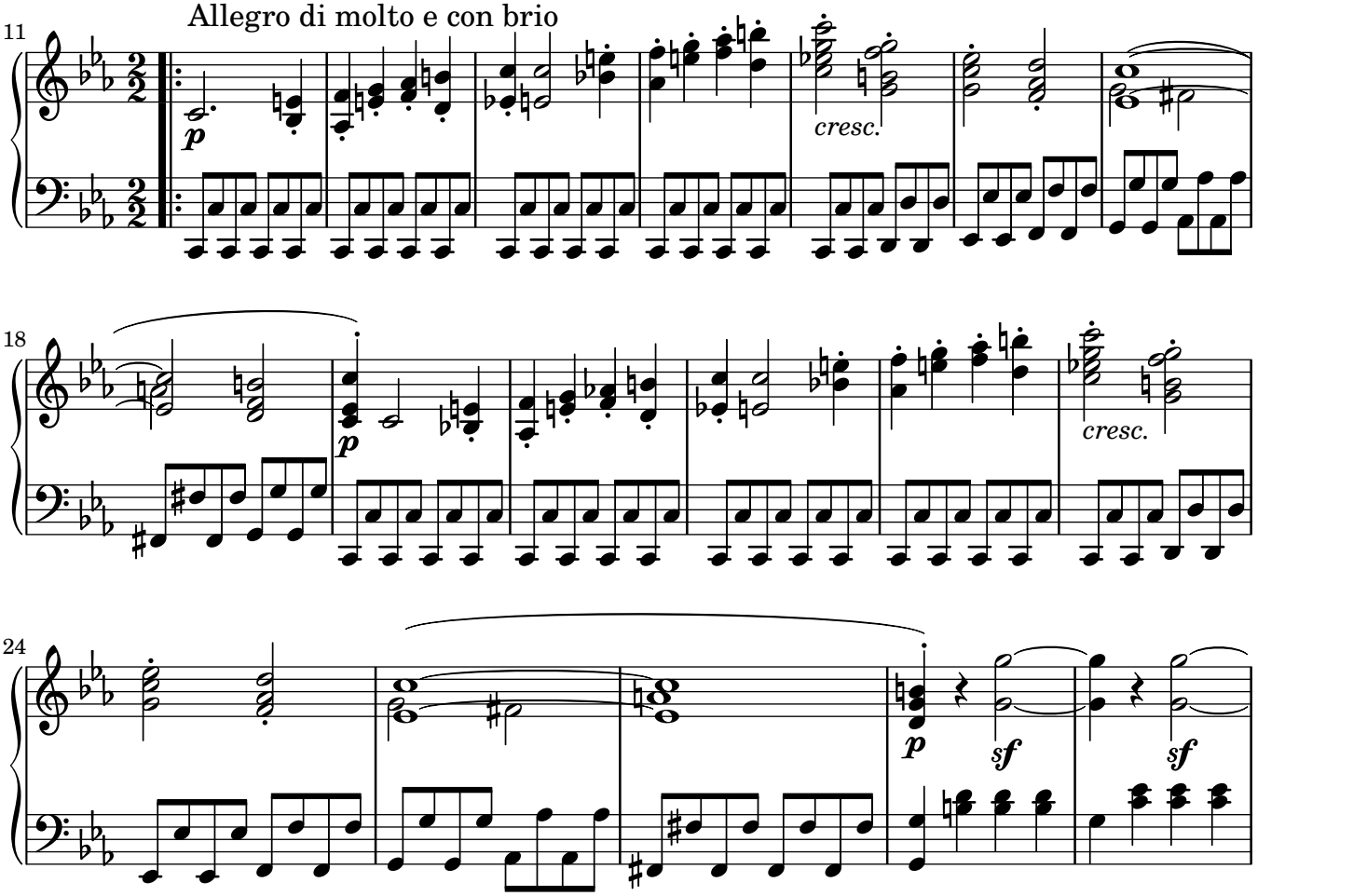
Level 10 · about 8 min
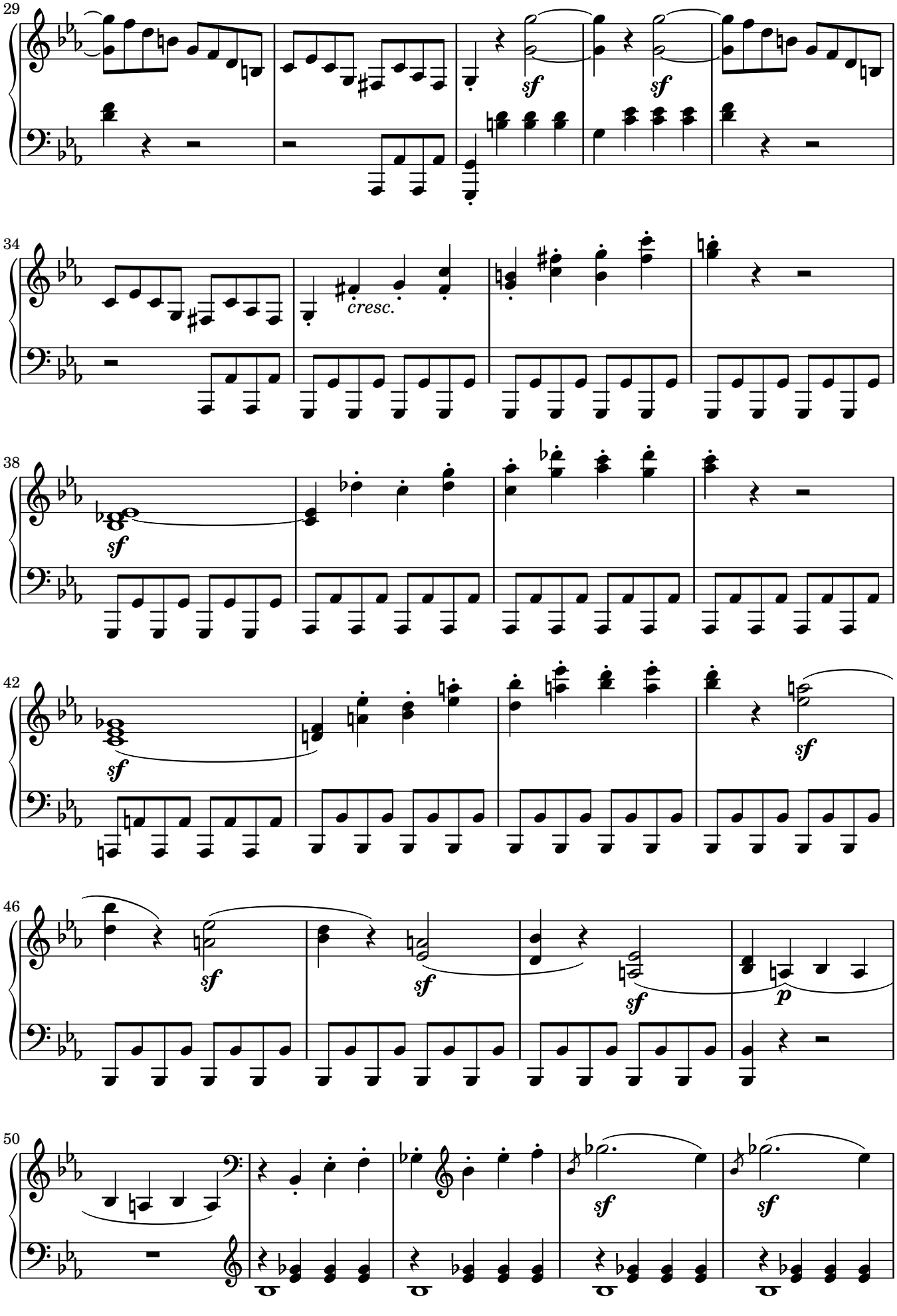
The Grave opening (an excerpt of it is in Volume 6) leads into a stormy Allegro over left-hand tremolo octaves, and returns twice. The tremolo octaves must stay light and loose: practise them with a relaxed wrist, slowly, for short stretches. Read the dotted rhythms of the Grave exactly.
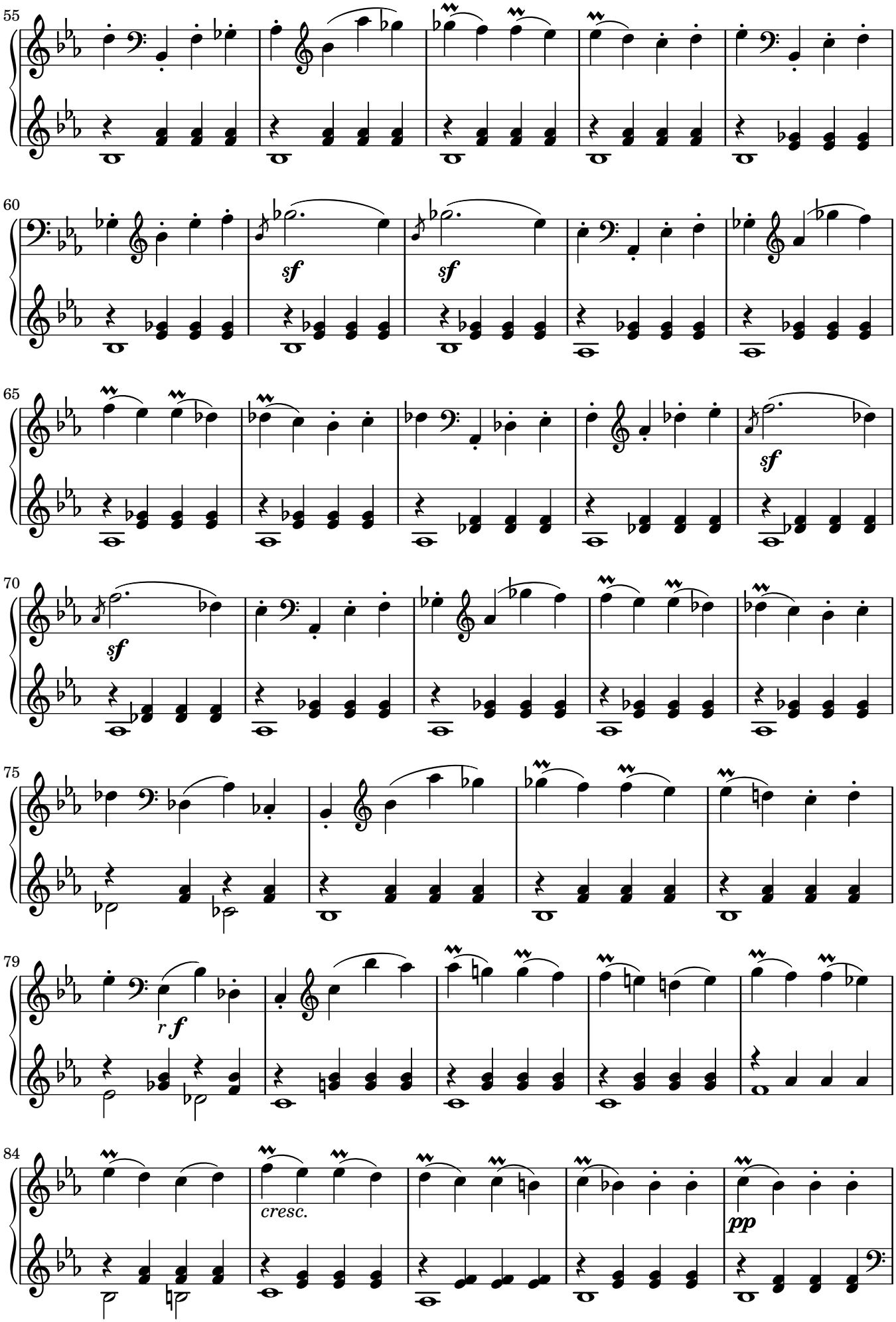
Source: Mutopia Project no. 299, typeset by Chris Sawer (public domain).
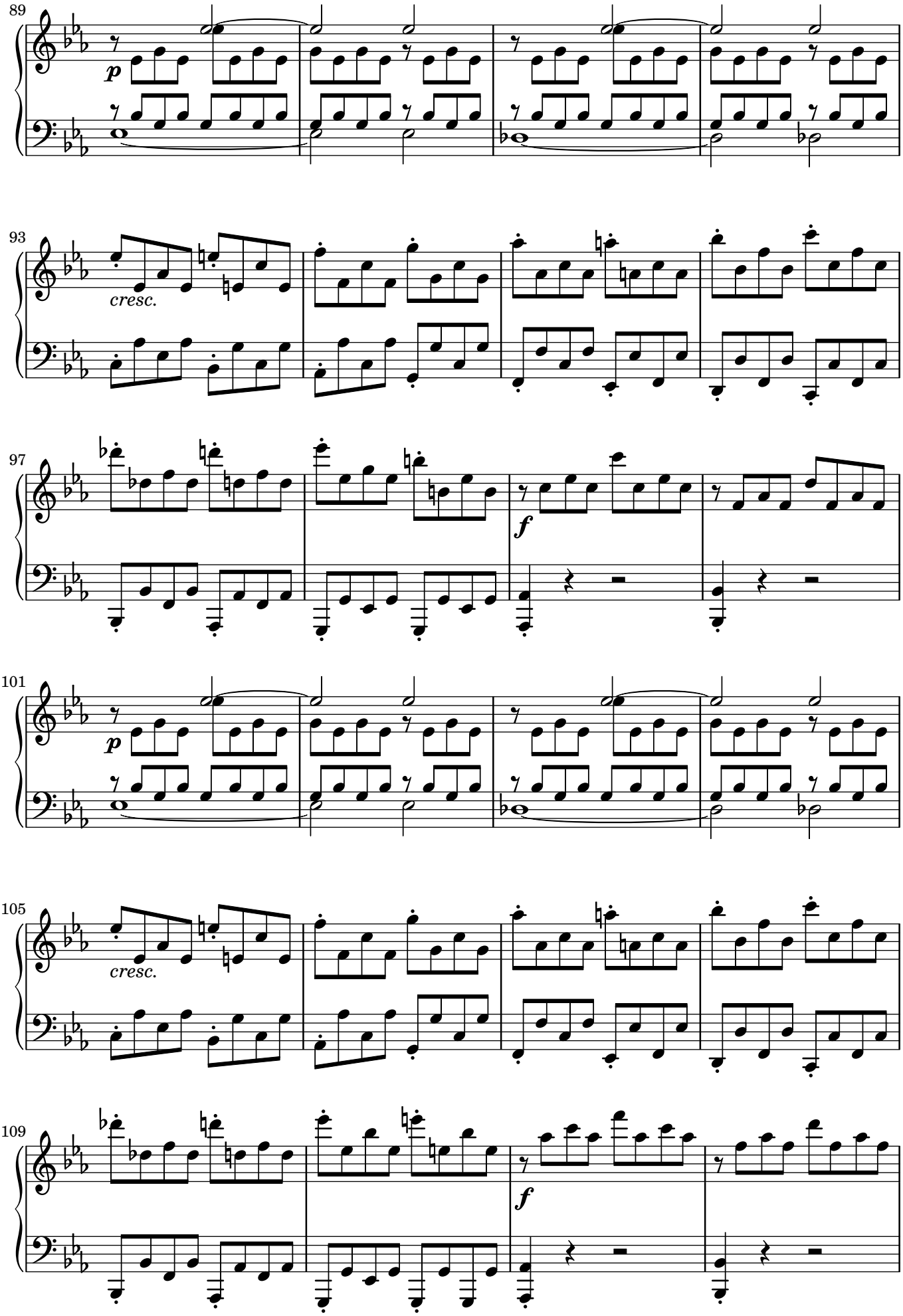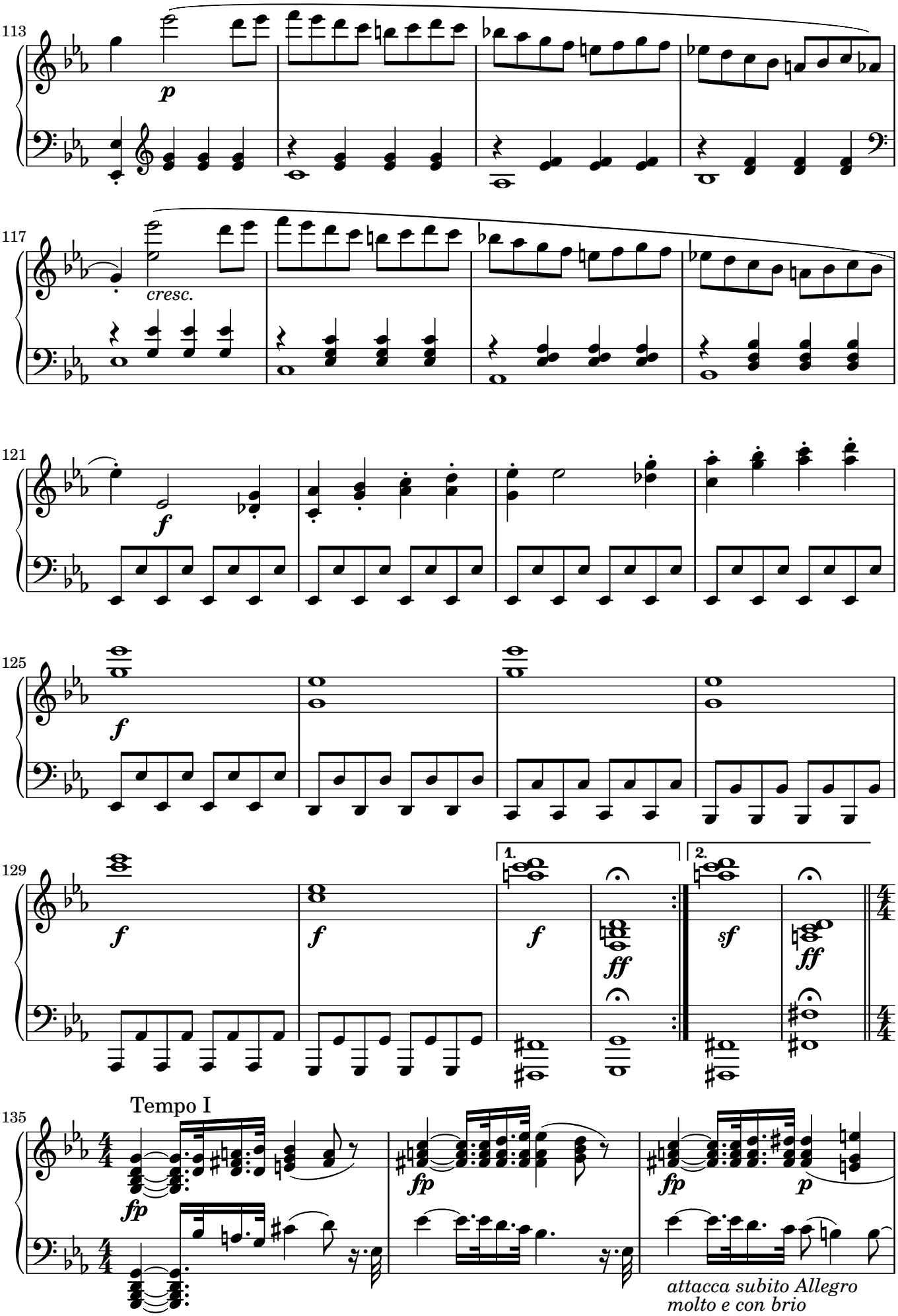



7
p
8
cresc.
sfp
10
p
attacca subito il Allegro
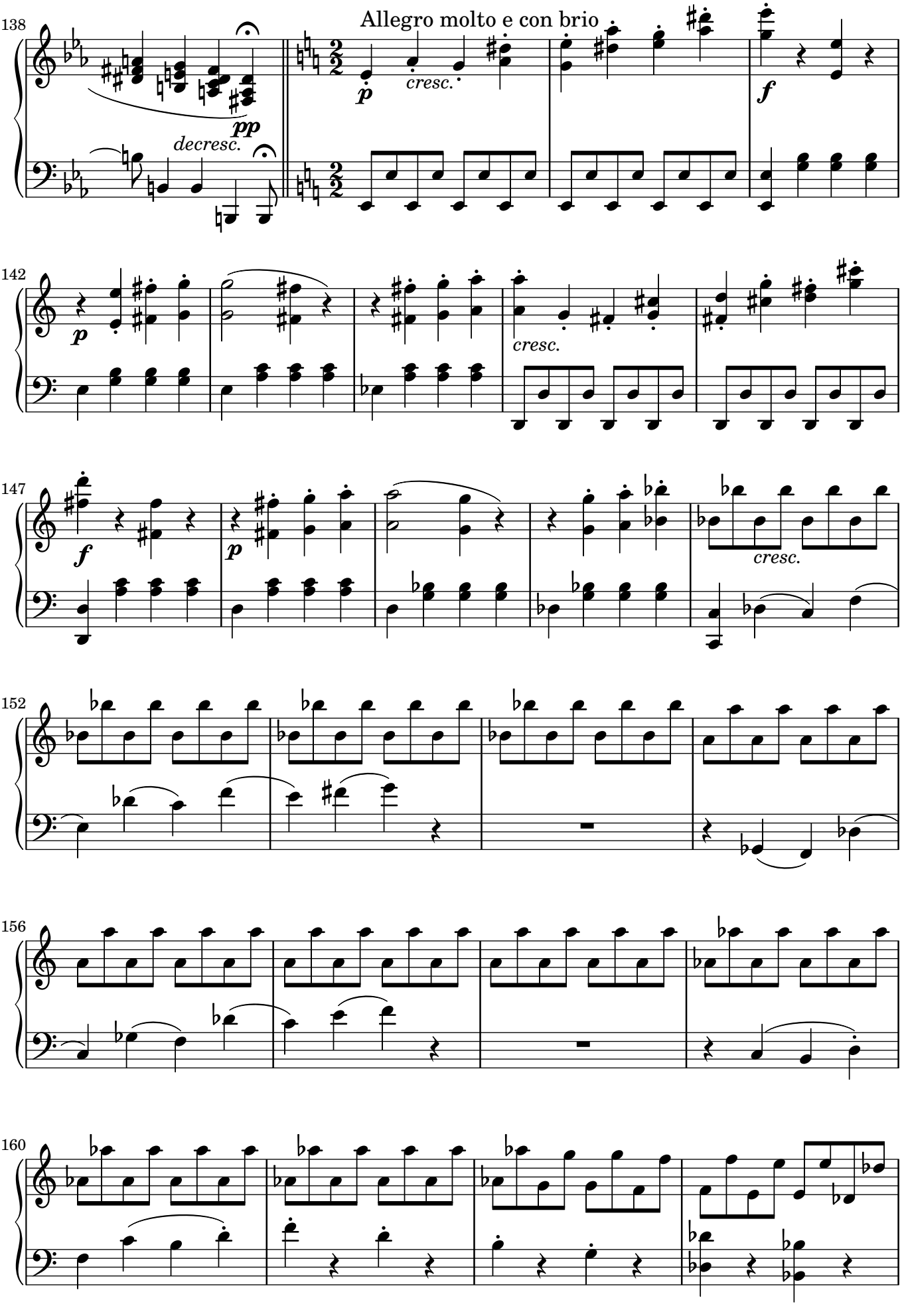

Allegro di molto e con brio
11
p
cresc.
18
p
cresc.
24
p
sf
sf
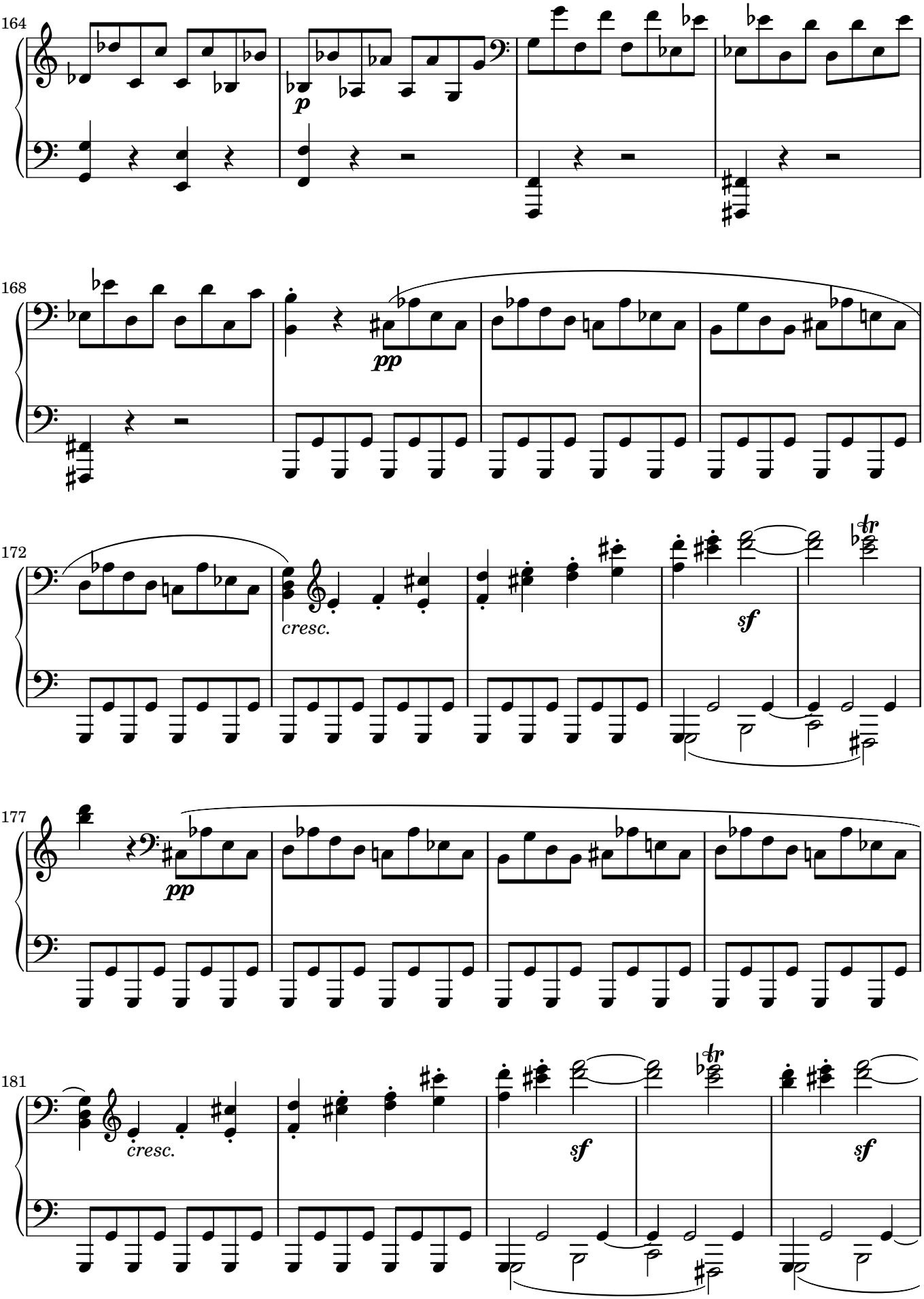

29
sf
sf
34
cresc.
38
sf
42
sf
sf
46
sf
sf
sf
p
50
sf
sf
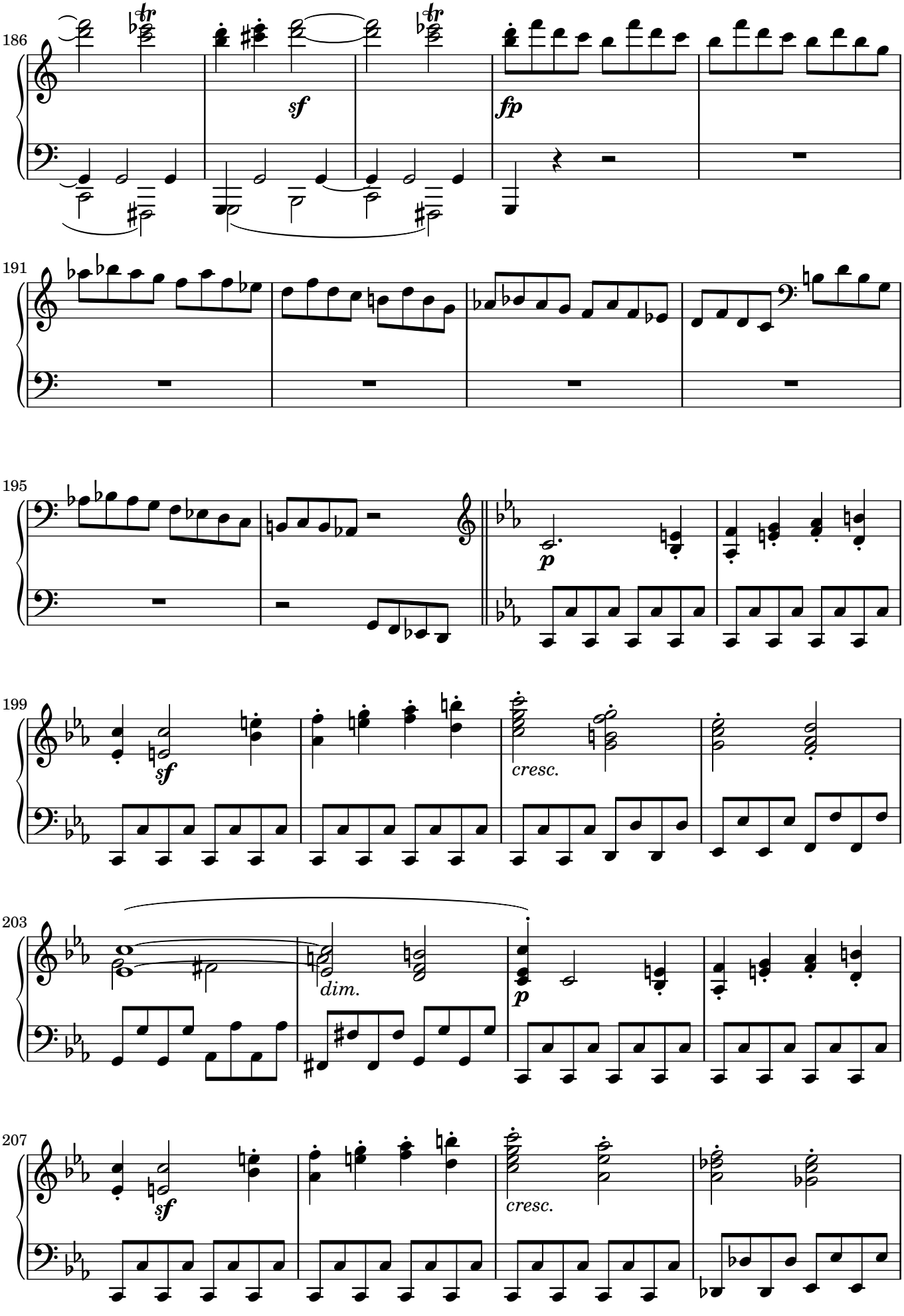

55
60
sf
sf
65
sf
70
sf
75
79
r f
84
cresc.
pp
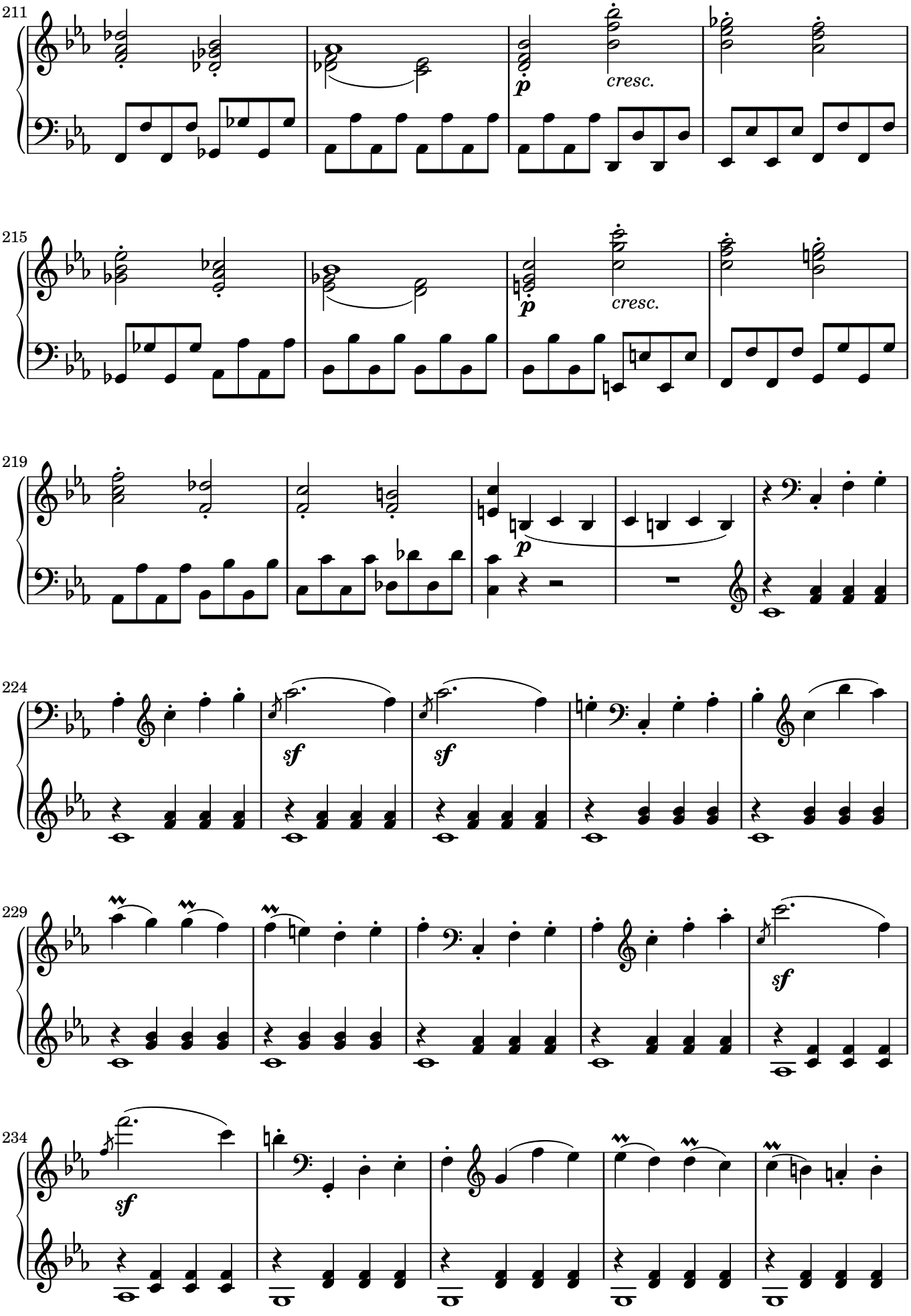

89
p
93
cresc.
97
f
101
p
105
cresc.
109
f
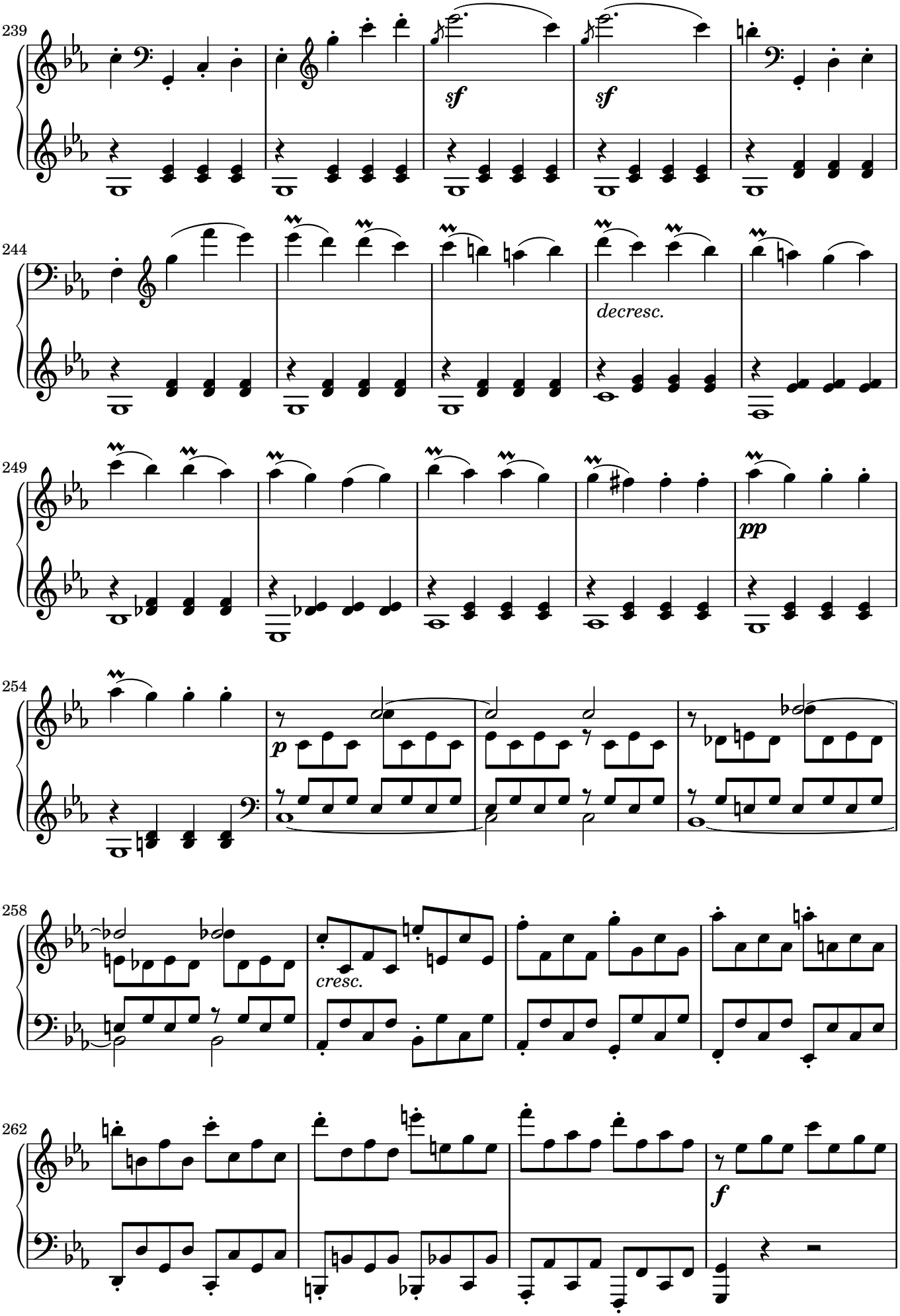

113
p
117
cresc.
121
f
125
f
129
f
f
1.
f
ff
2.
sf
ff
135
Tempo I
fp
fp
fp
p
attacca subito Allegro
molto e con brio
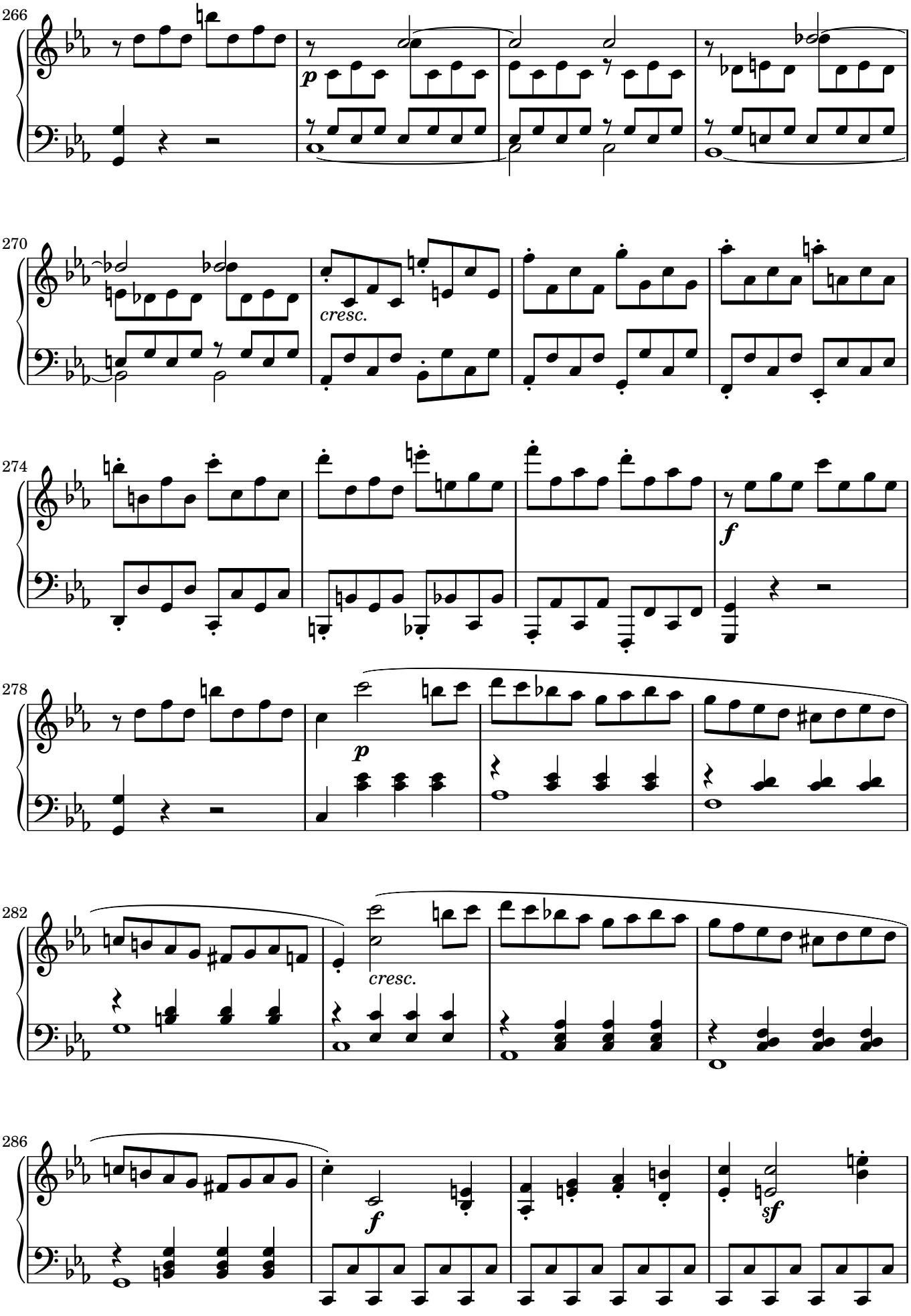

138
Allegro molto e con brio
pp
decresc.
p
cresc.
f
142
p
cresc.
147
f
p
cresc.
152
156
160
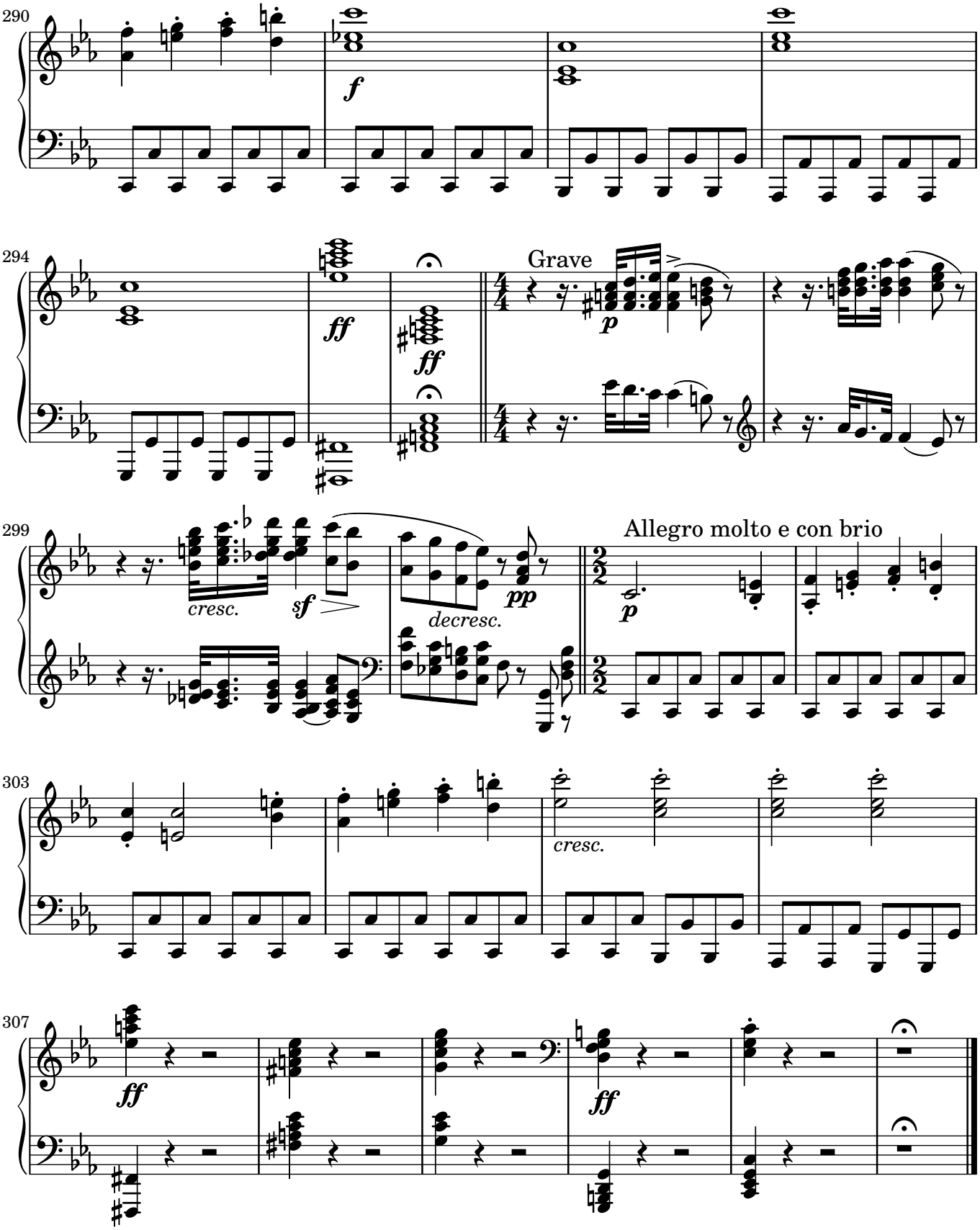

164
p
168
pp
172
cresc.
sf
tr
177
pp
181
cresc.
sf
sf
tr


186
sf
fp
191
195
p
199
sf
cresc.
203
dim.
p
207
sf
cresc.


211
cresc.
215
cresc.
219
224
229
234


239
sf
sf
244
decresc.
249
pp
254
p
258
cresc.
262
f


266
p
270
cresc.
274
f
278
p
282
cresc.
286
f
sf


290
f
294
ff
ff
Grave
p
299
cresc.
sf
decresc.
pp
Allegro molto e con brio
p
303
cresc.
307
ff
ff
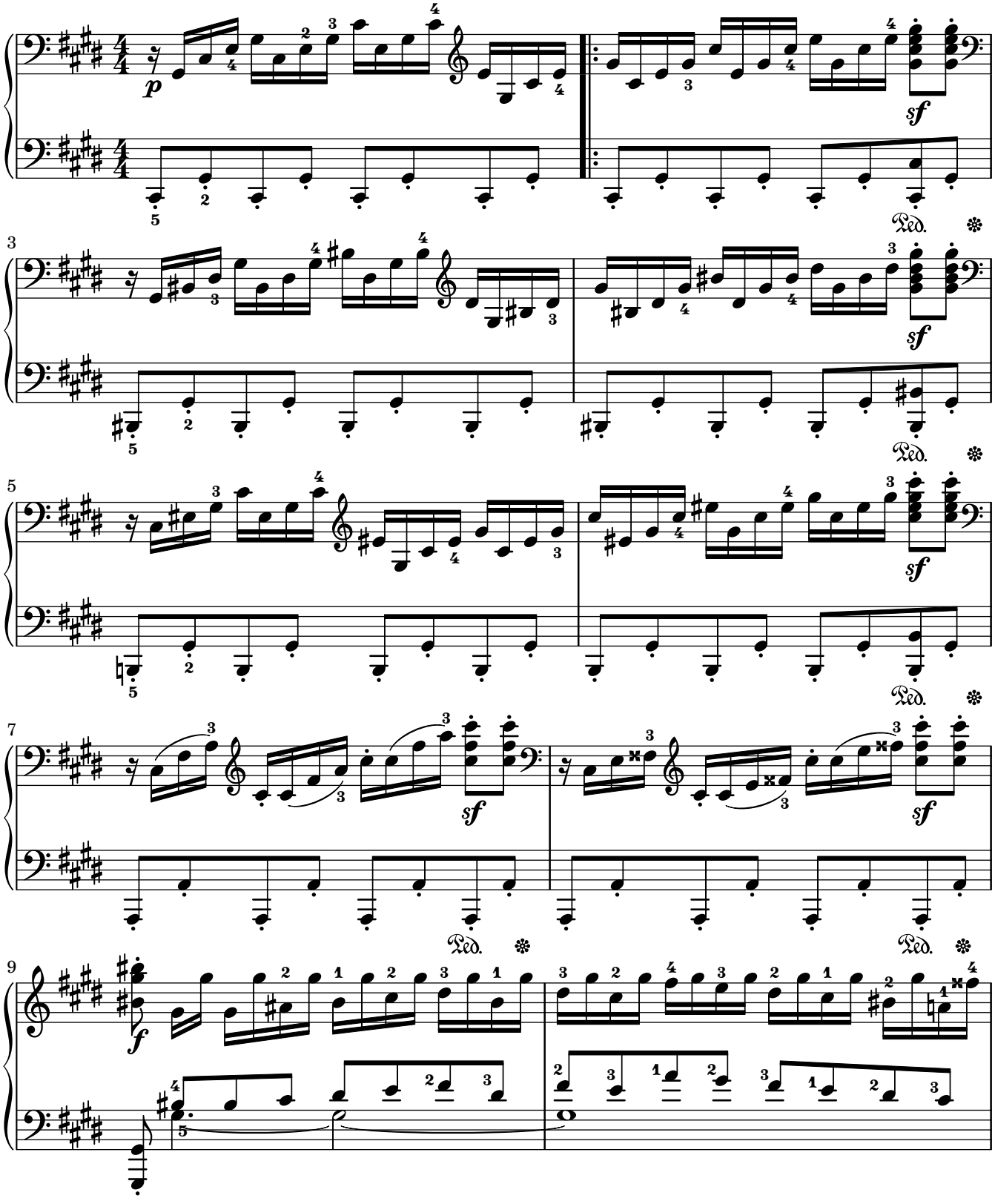
"Moonlight" Sonata, Op. 27 No. 2: III. Presto agitato
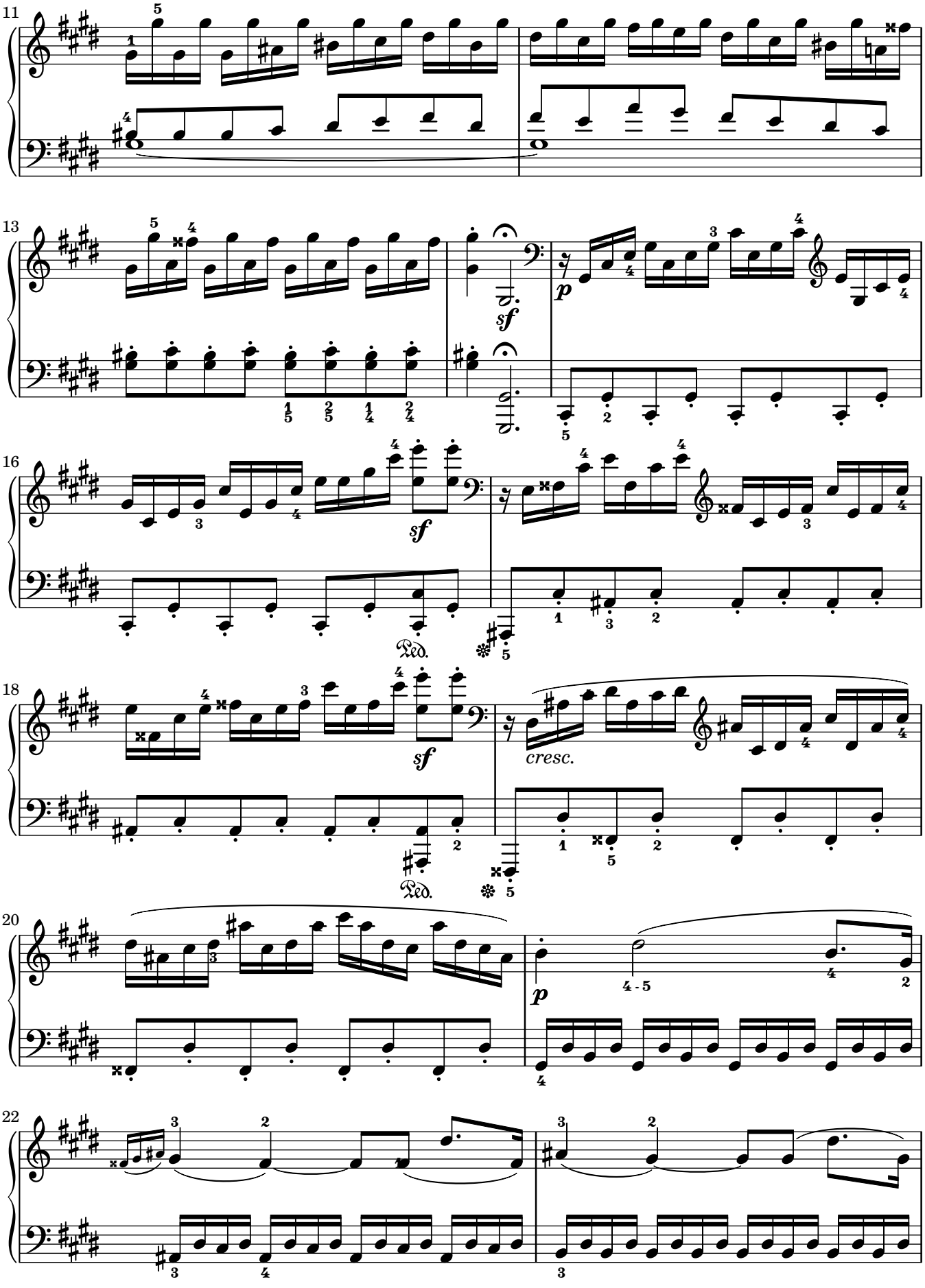
L. van Beethoven (1770-1827) - Sonata quasi una fantasia (1801)
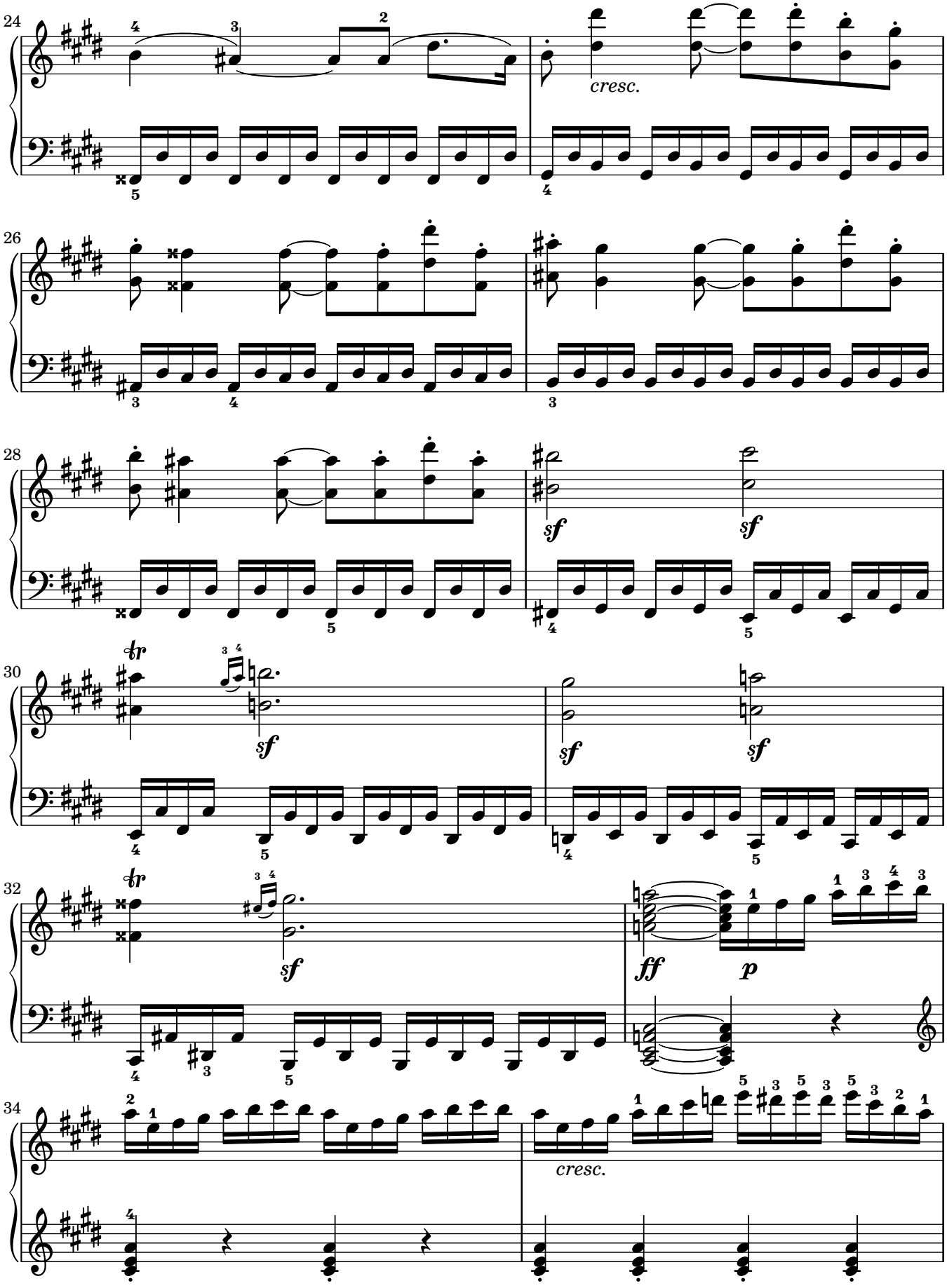
Level 10 · about 7 min
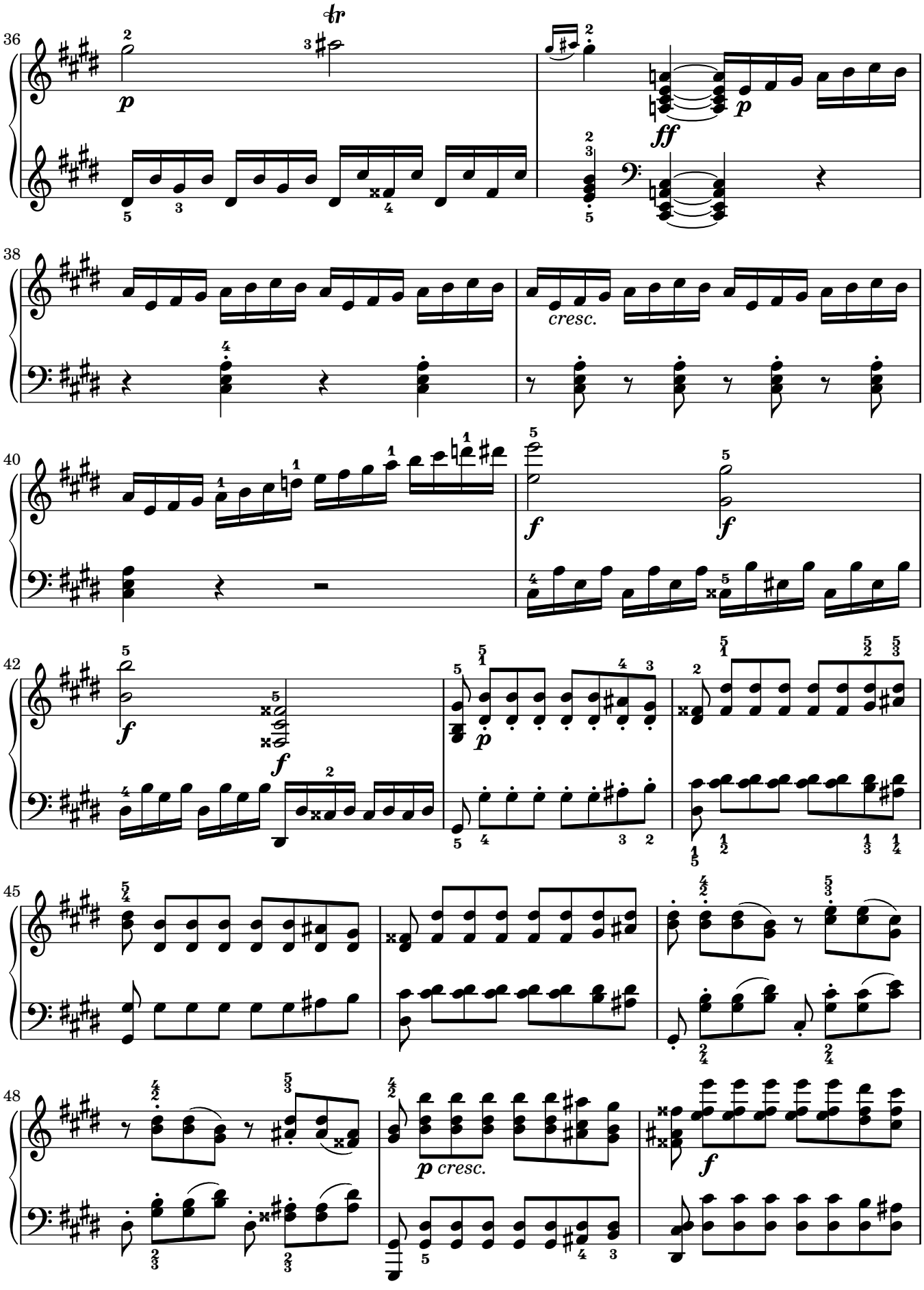
After the calm first movement (Book 7A), a storm: rising arpeggios that end in two loud chords, again and again, in a full sonata form. A real concert piece; learn it in small sections at half speed, keeping the arpeggios even and the hand relaxed between the chords.
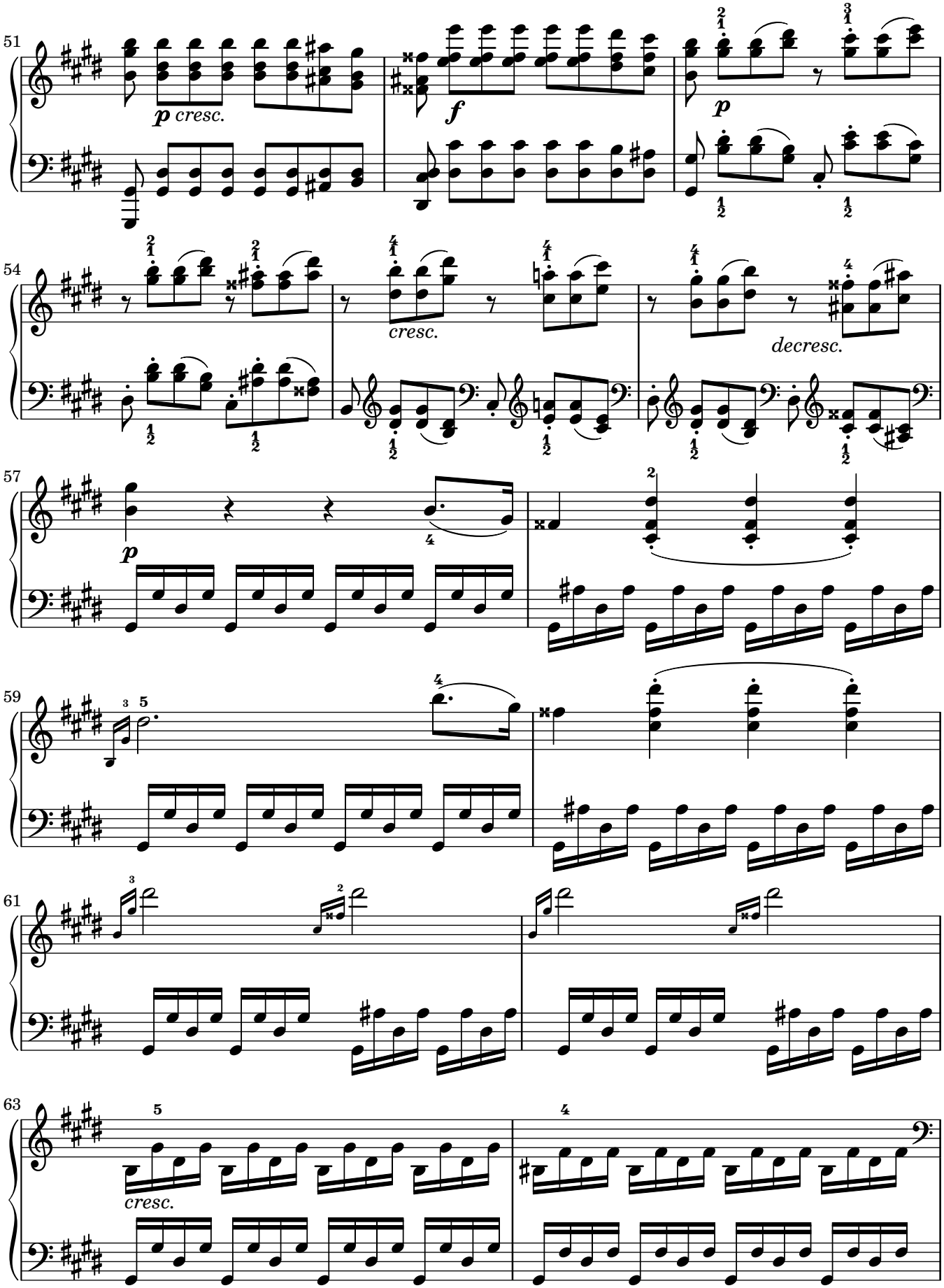
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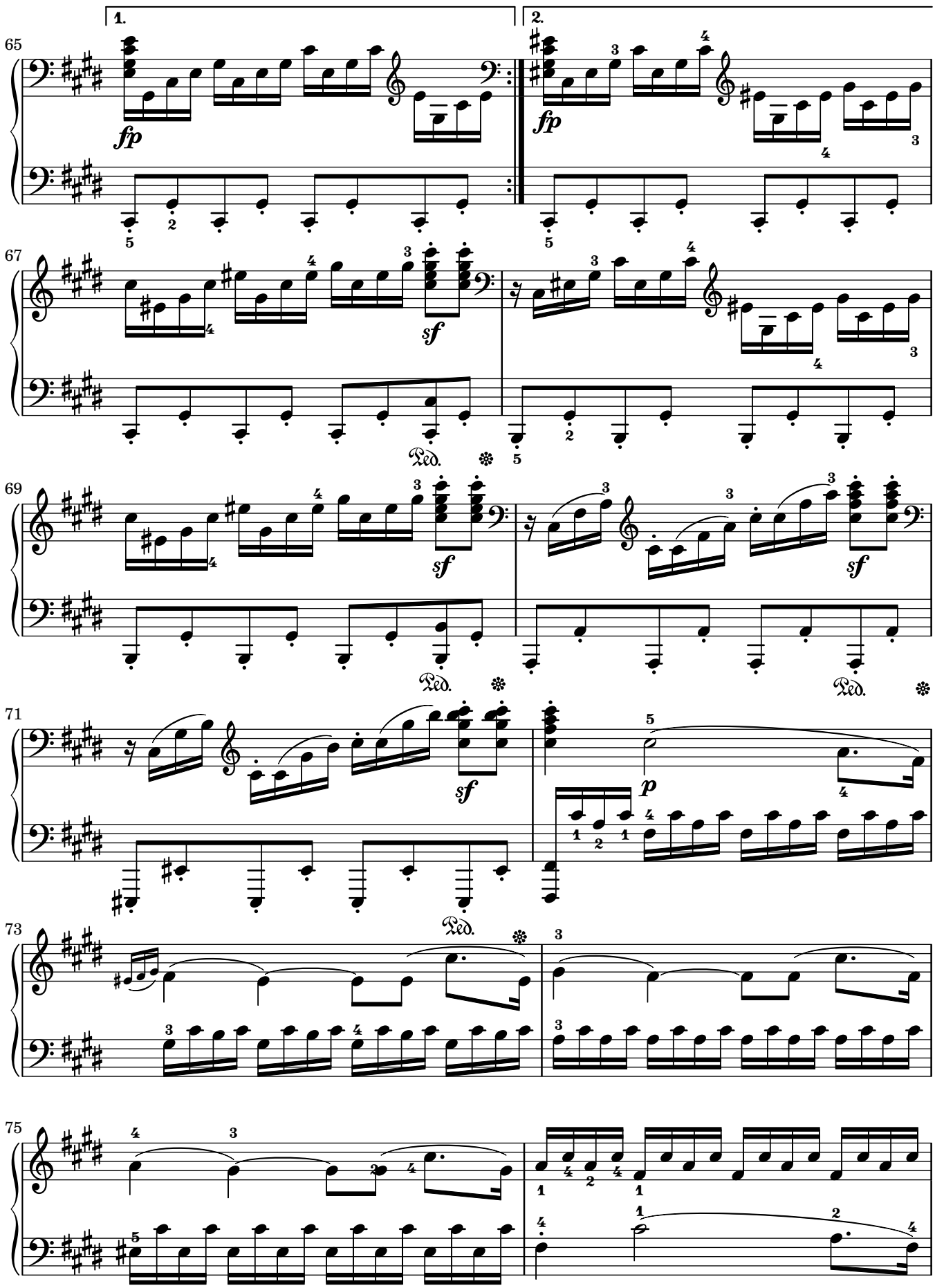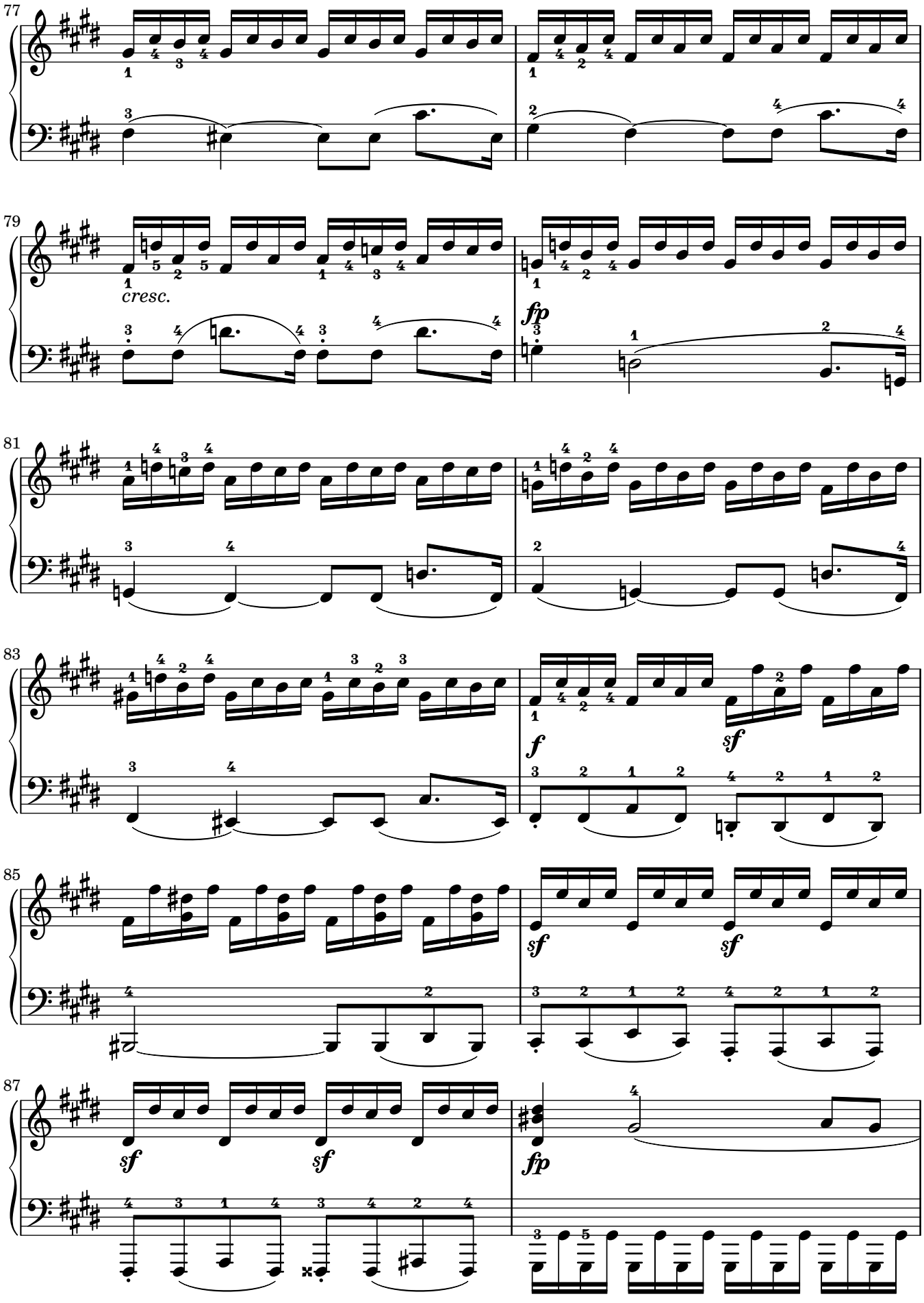



11
13
sf
p
16
sf
Ped.
18
sf
cresc.
Ped.
20
p
4 - 5
22
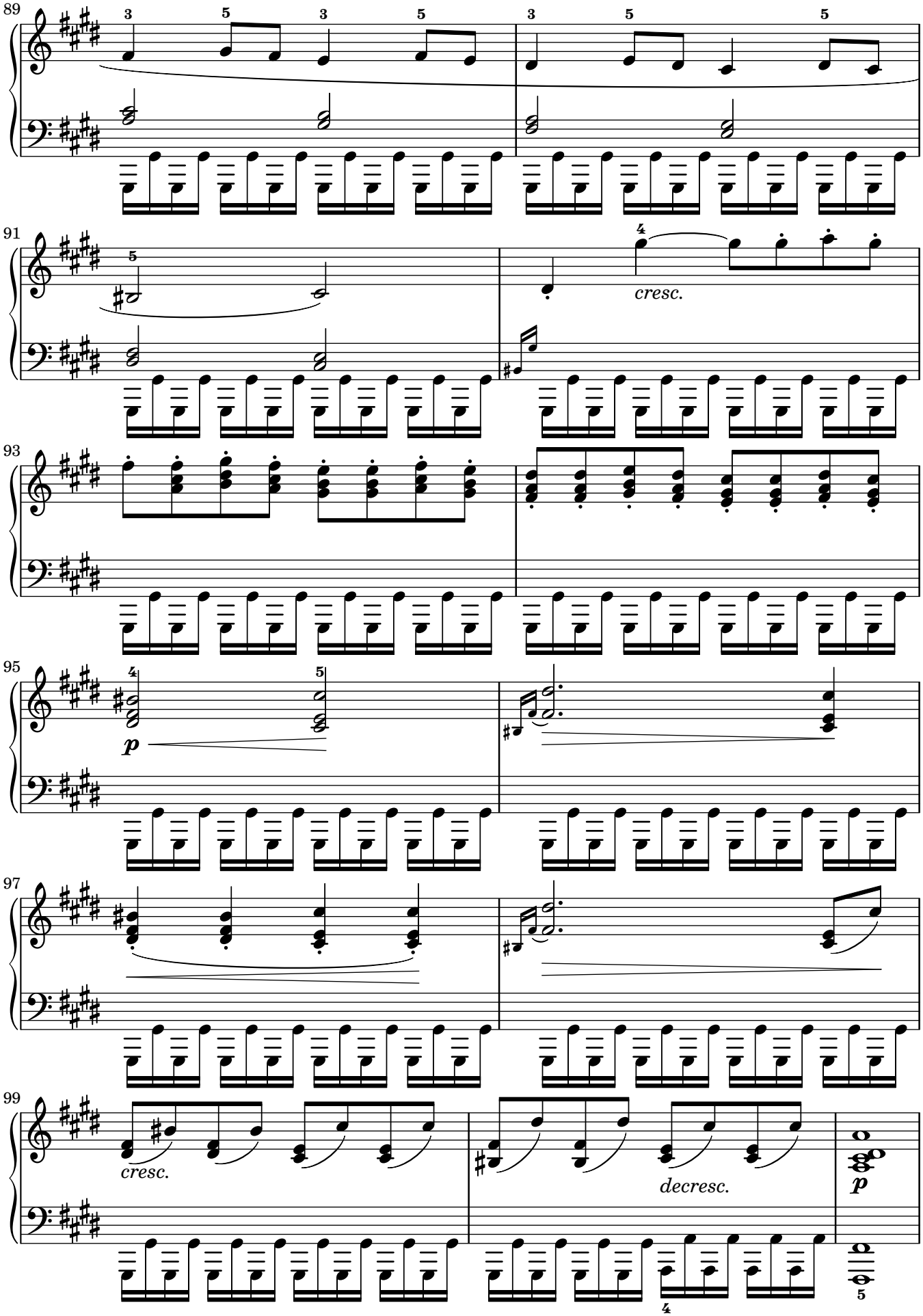

24
cresc.
26
28
sf
sf
30
tr
sf
sf
sf
32
tr
sf
ff
p
34
cresc.
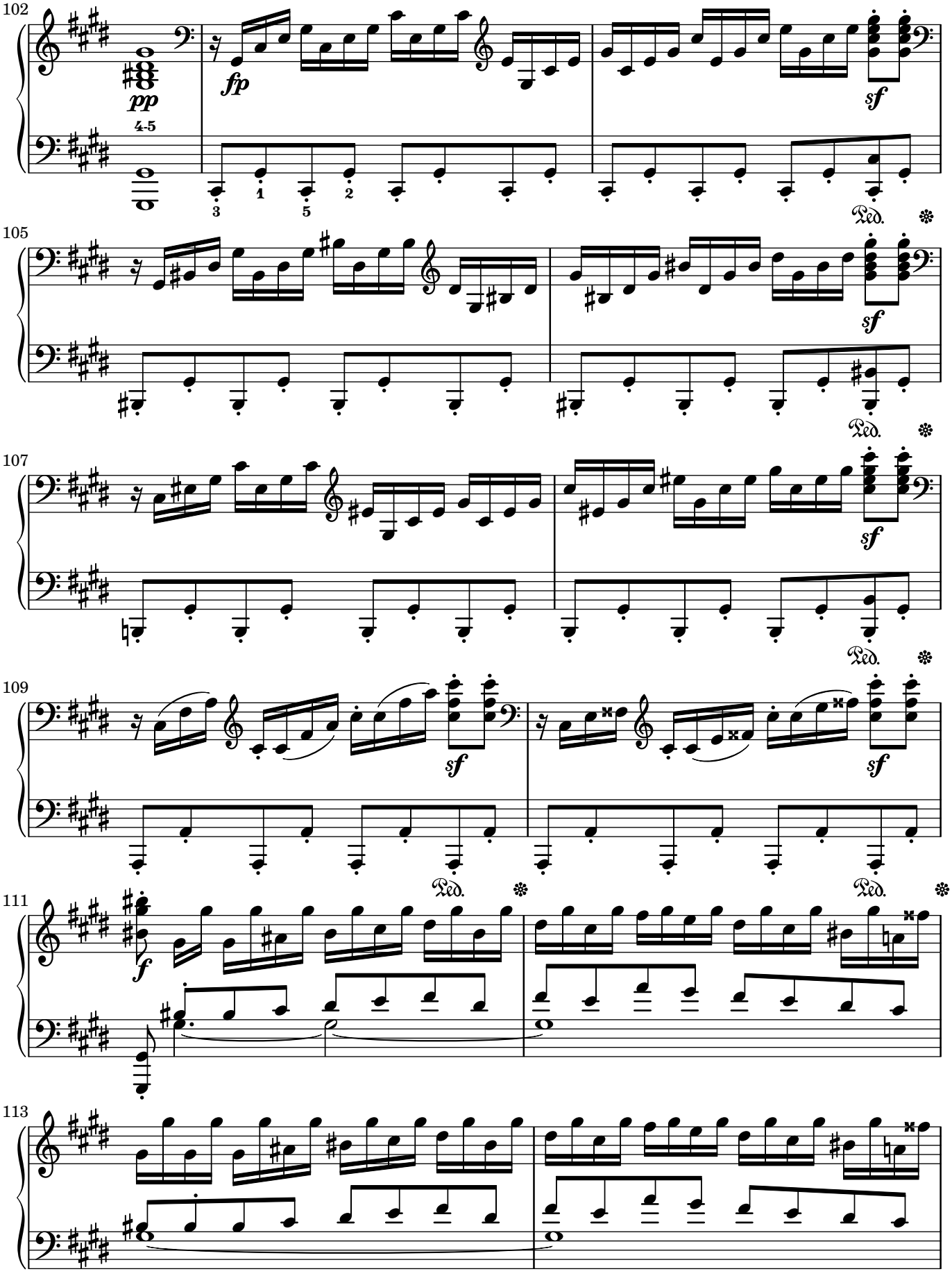

36
tr
p
ff
p
38
cresc.
40
f
f
42
f
f
p
45
48
p cresc.
f
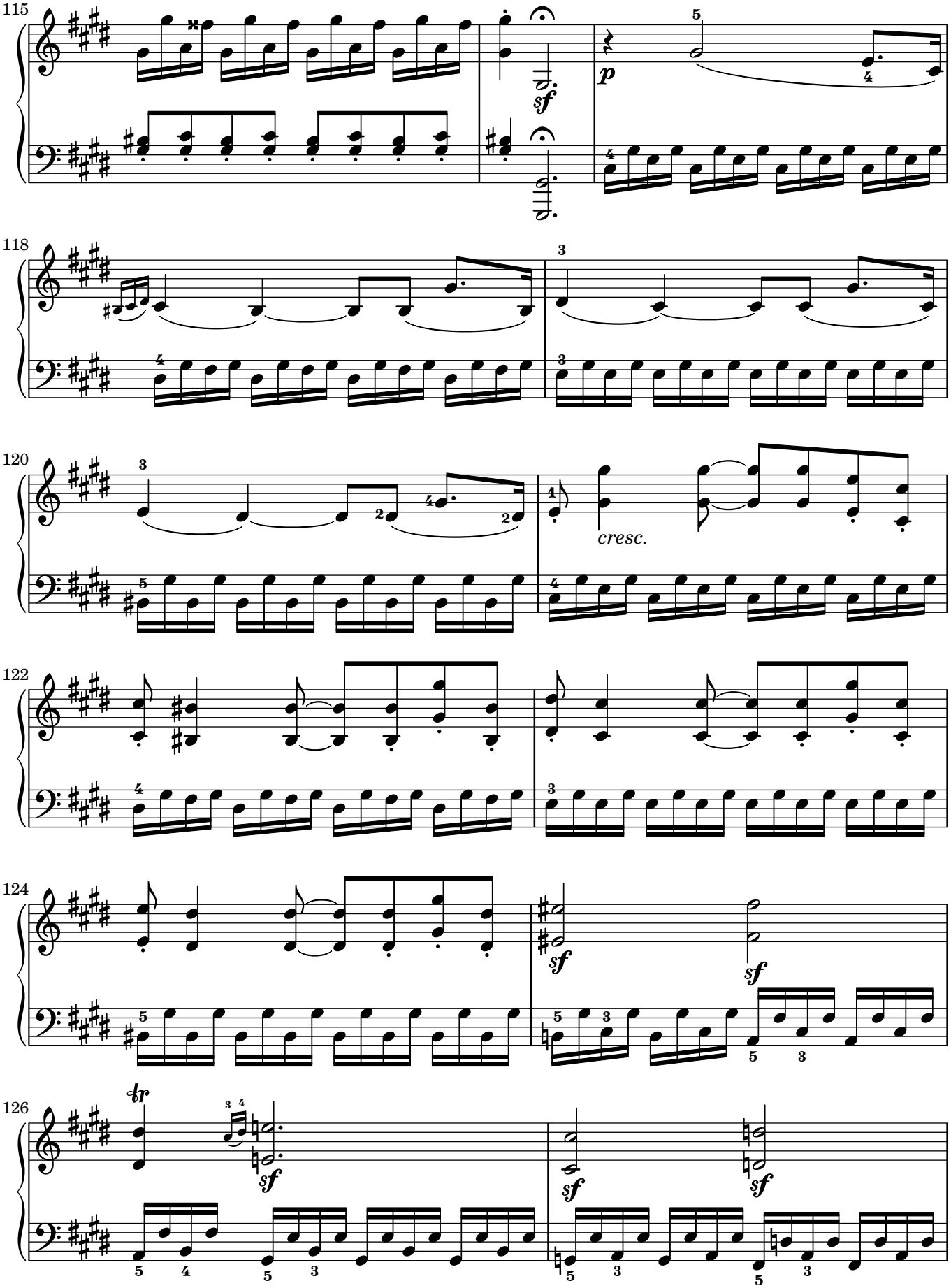

51
p cresc.
f
p
54
cresc.
decresc.
57
p
59
61
63
cresc.
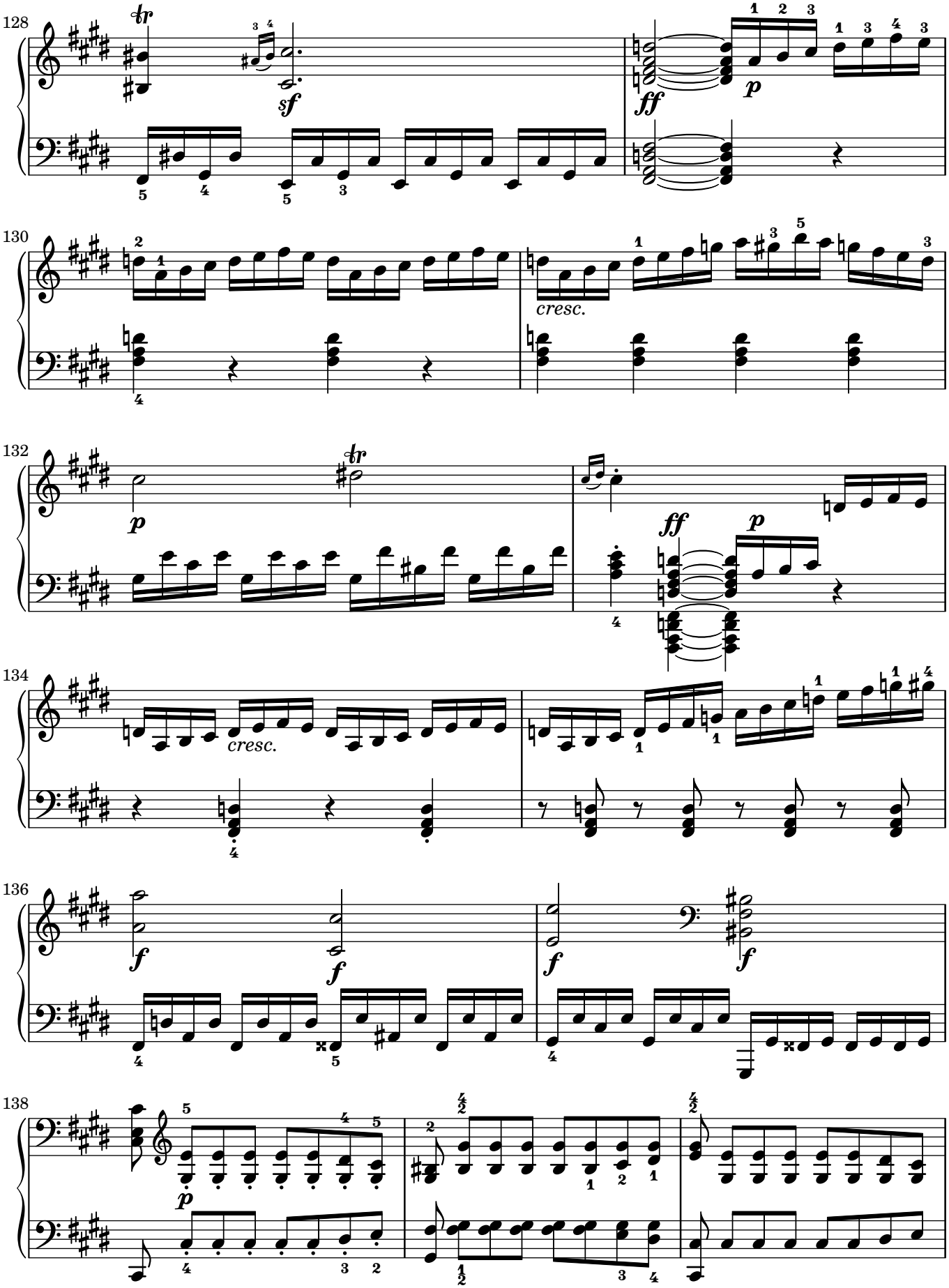

1.
2.
65
fp
fp
67
sf
Ped.
69
sf
sf
Ped.
Ped.
71
sf
p
Ped.
73
75
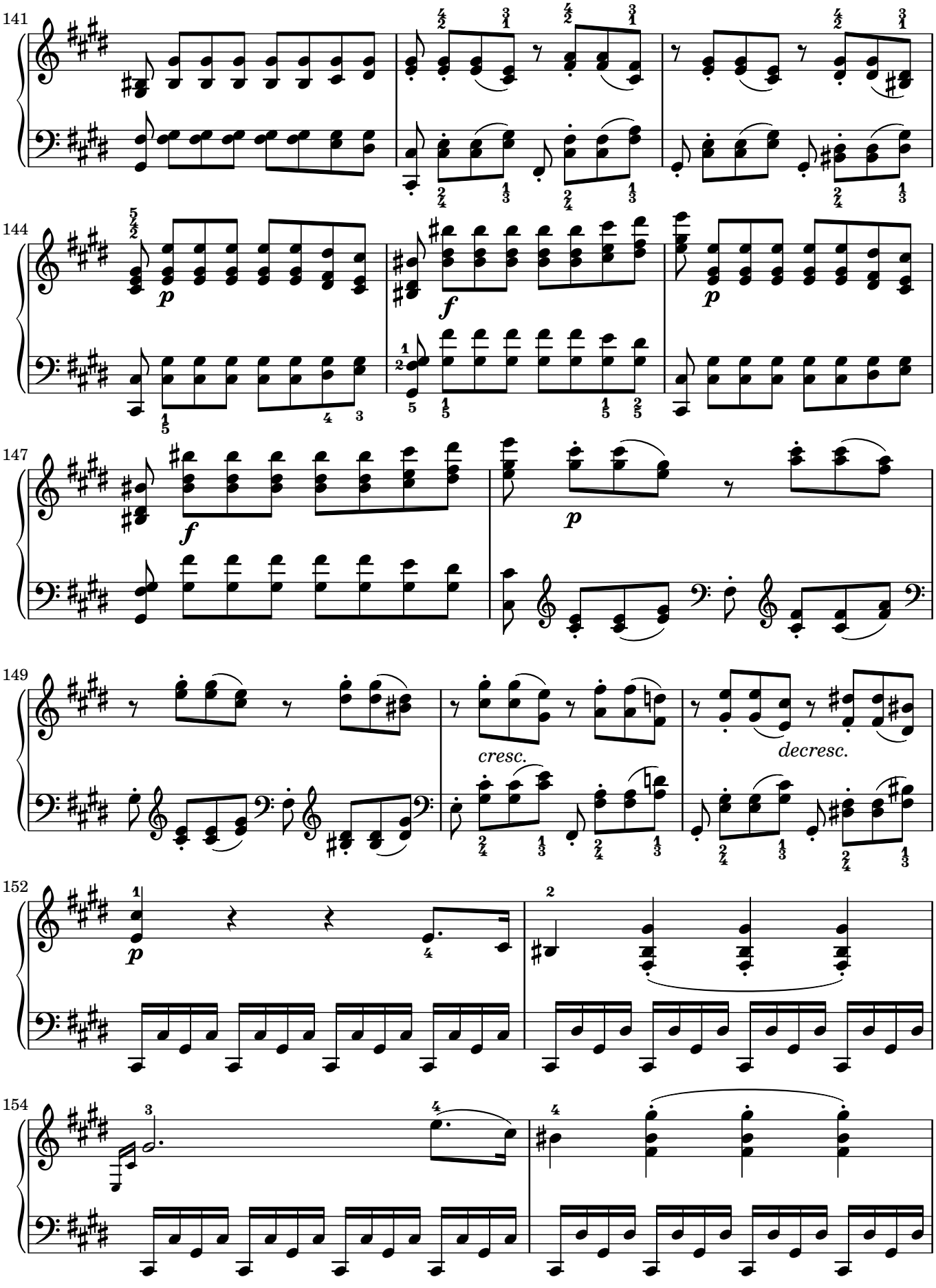

77
79
cresc.
fp
81
83
f
sf
85
sf
sf
87
sf
sf
fp
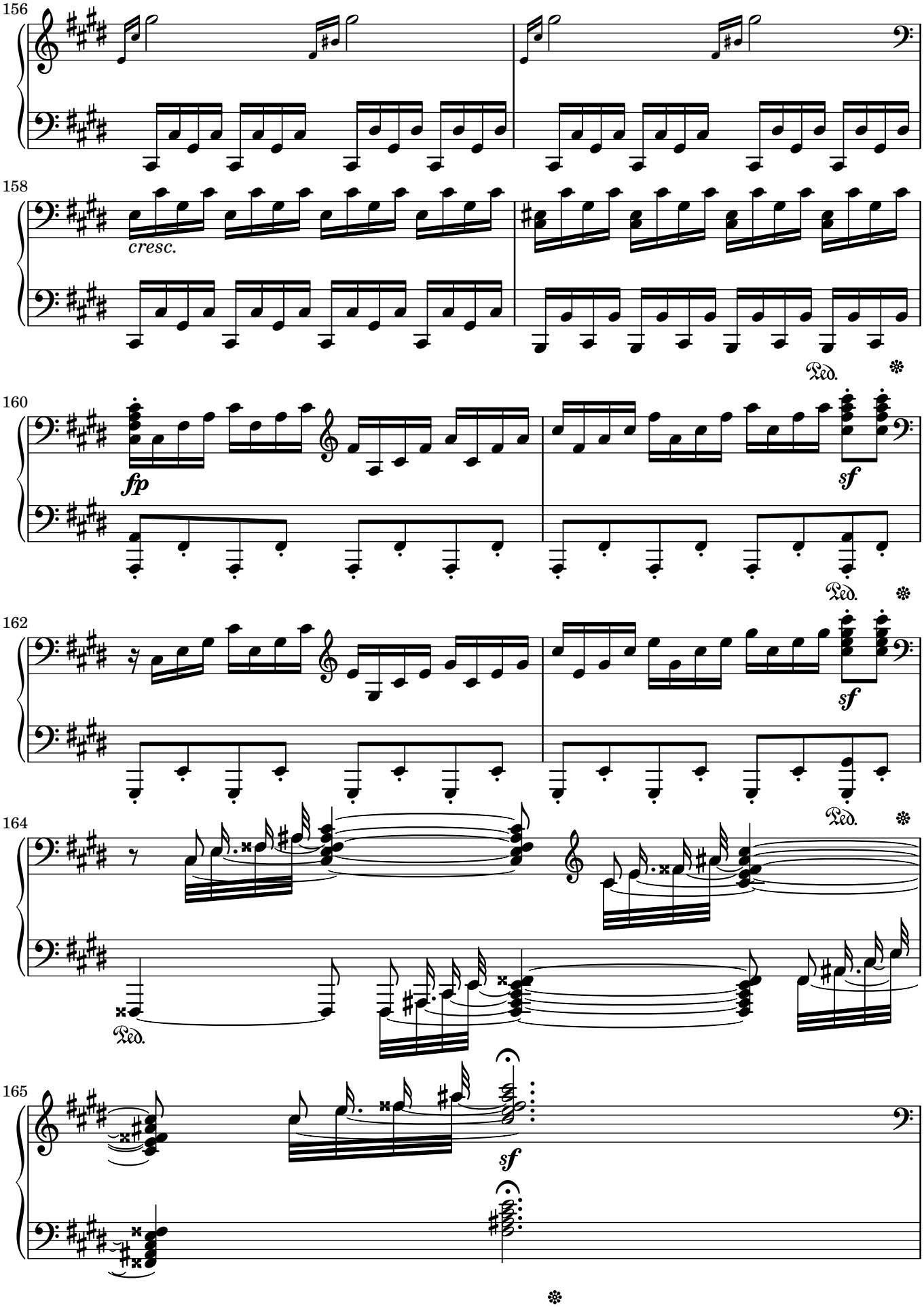

89
91
cresc.
93
95
p
97
99
cresc.
decresc.
p
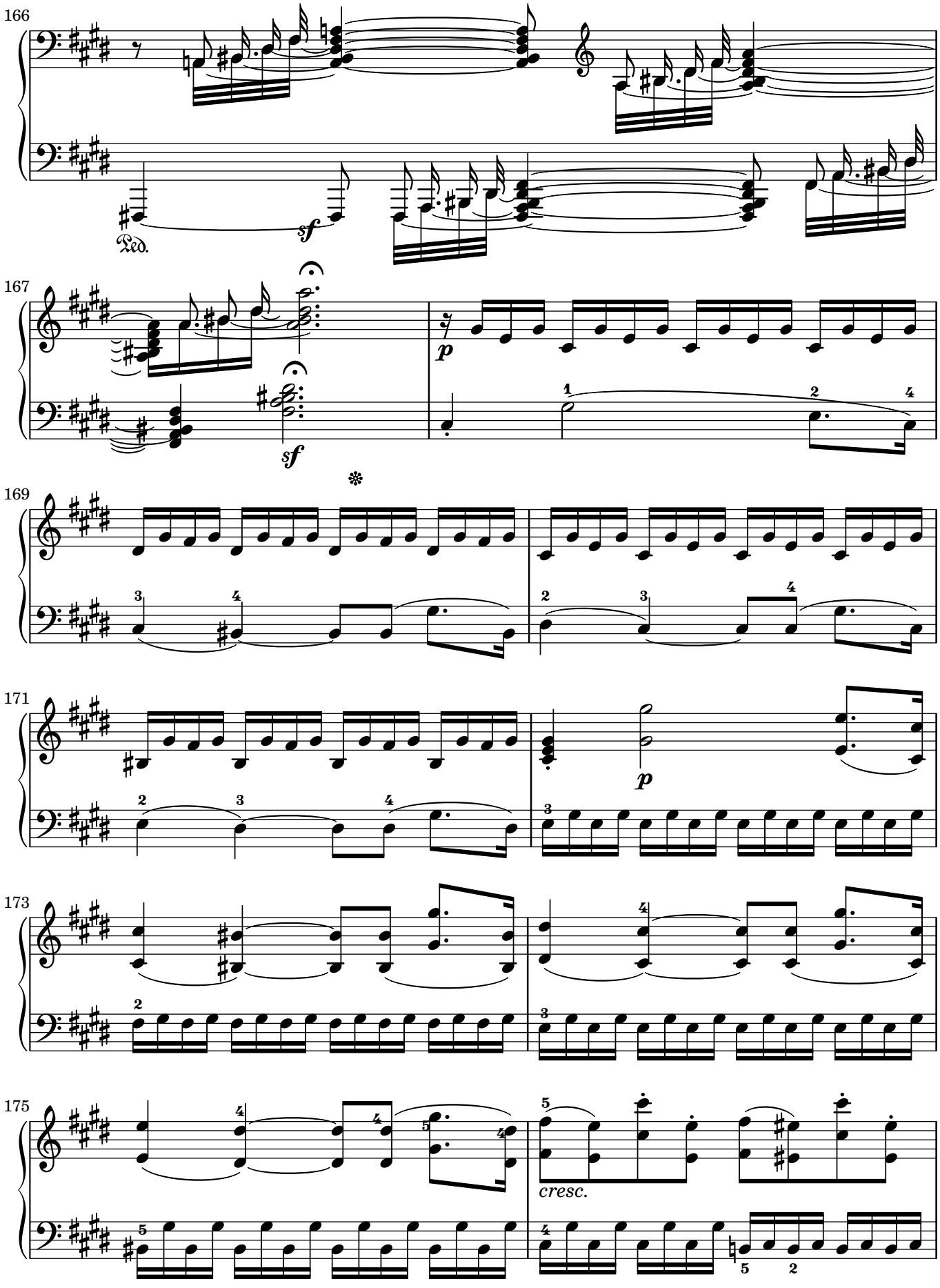

102
pp
4-5
fp
sf
Ped.
105
sf
Ped.
107
sf
Ped.
109
sf
sf
Ped.
Ped.
111
f
113
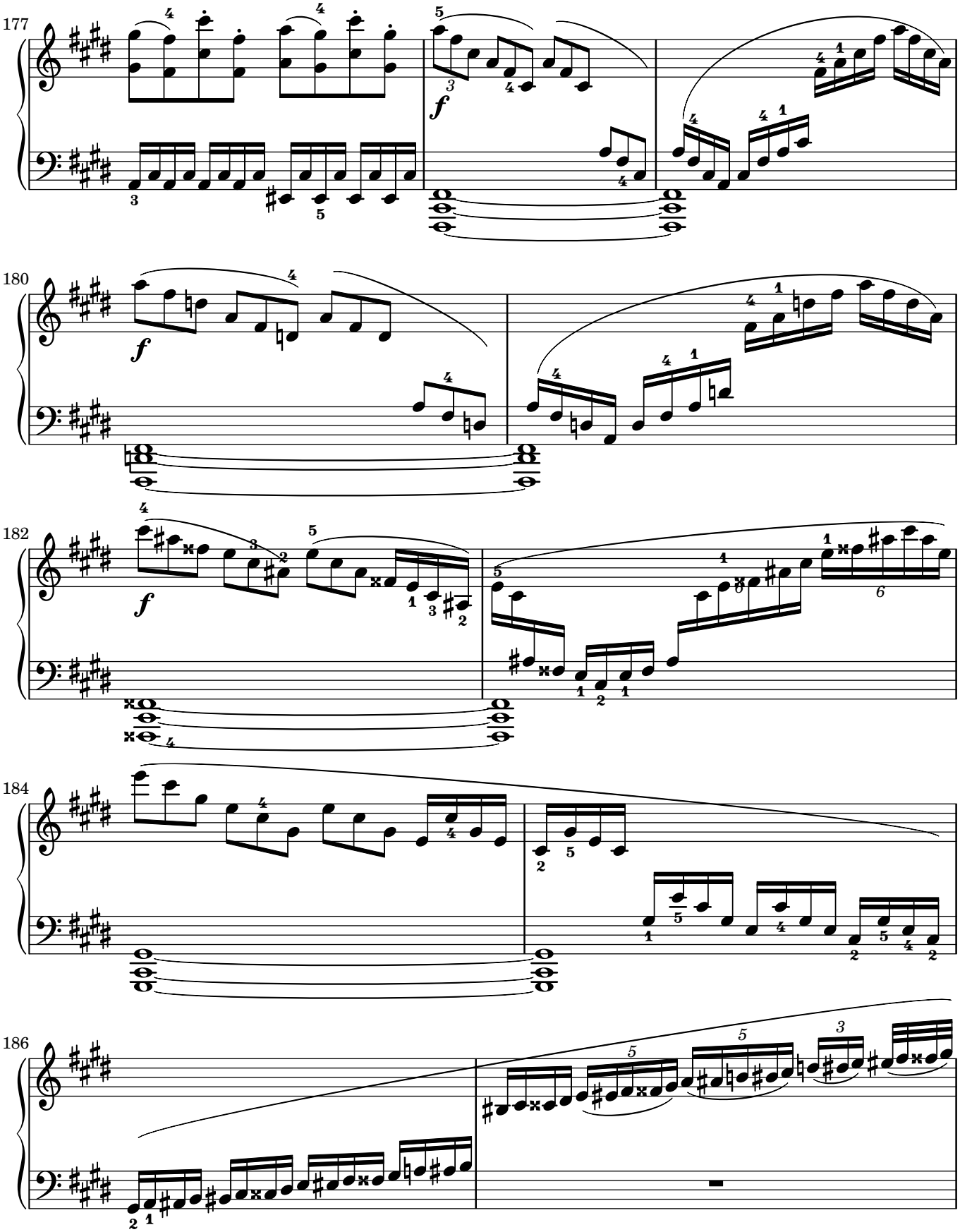

115
sf
p
118
120
cresc.
122
124
sf
sf
126
tr
sf
sf
sf
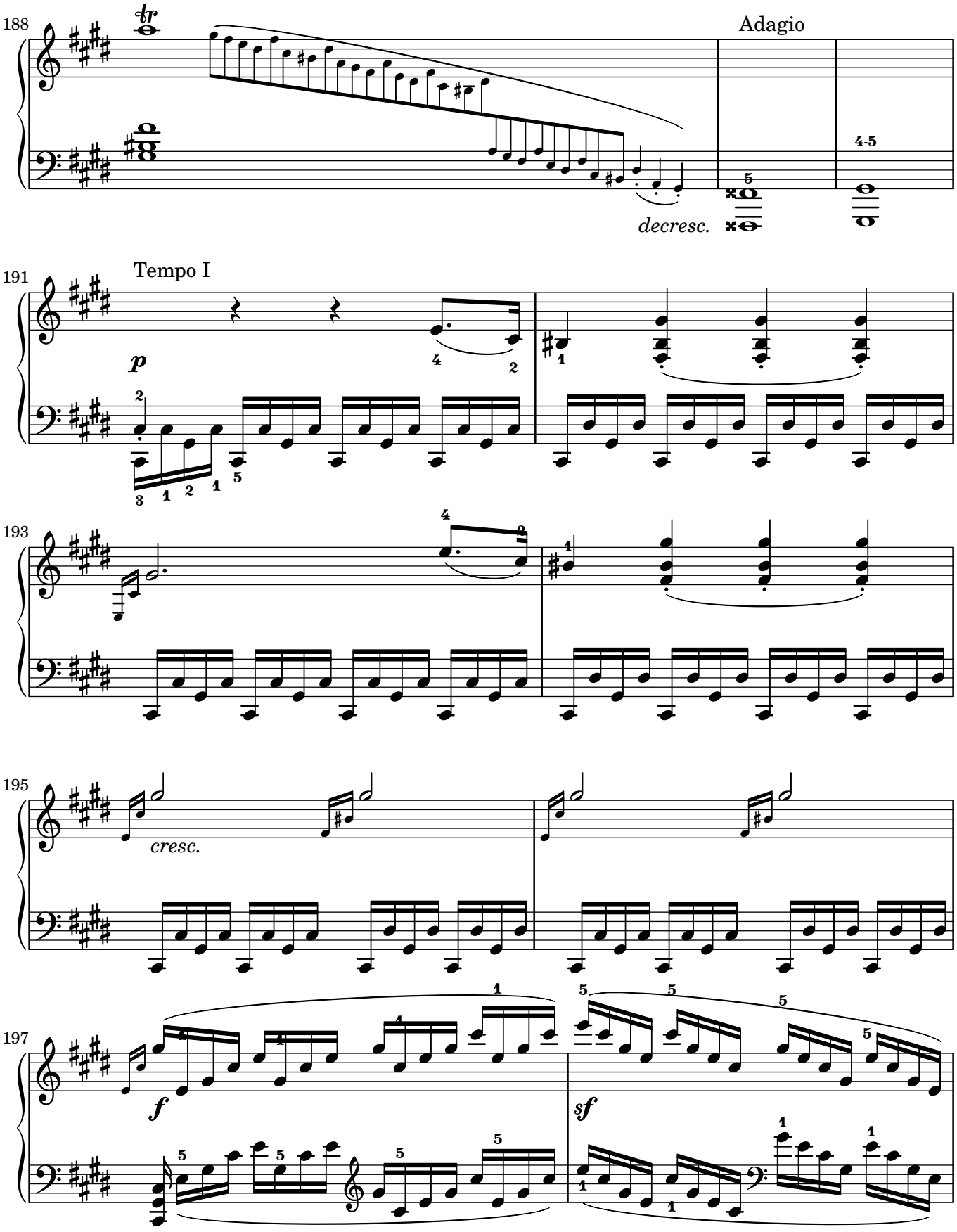

128
130
cresc.
132
cresc.
134
136
138

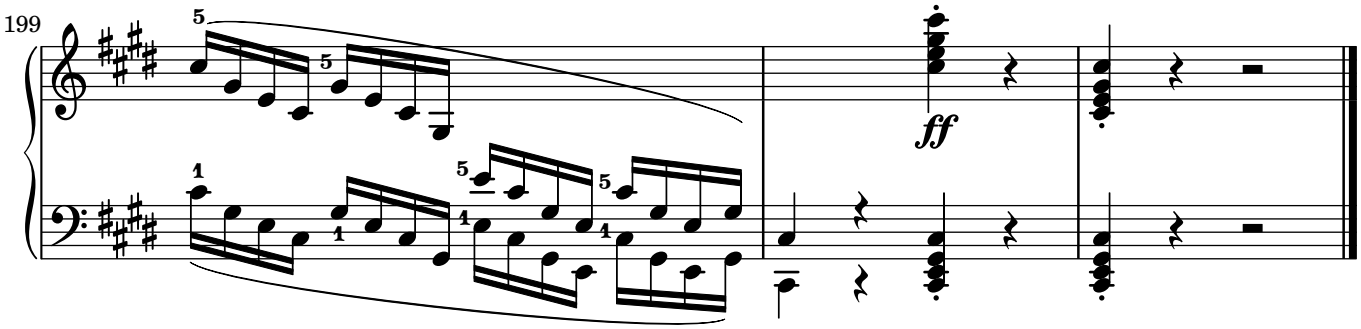

141
144
147
149
cresc.
decresc.
152
154


156
158
cresc.
Ped.
160
fp
sf
Ped.
162
sf
Ped.
164
Ped.
165
sf


166
Ped.
sf
167
sf
p
169
171
p
173
175
cresc.


177
180
182
184
186


188
Adagio
decresc.
4-5
191
Tempo I
p
193
195
cresc.
197
f
sf


199
ff

Section 3
Early Romantic

The first half of the nineteenth century: Schubert, Field, Mendelssohn, Schumann and Chopin. The piano becomes bigger and richer, and composers write short character pieces (nocturnes, songs without words, preludes, waltzes, impromptus) that express one mood. The melody sings like a voice over wide-spread accompaniment held together by the pedal.

What it asks of you

A singing tone: weight into the keys for the melody, a soft accompaniment. Pedal changed with each harmony (press it just after the new chord, not with it). Rubato that bends the time but keeps the left hand steady. Wide left-hand leaps, found by looking ahead, not at the hands.

In this section

F. Schubert: Impromptu in G-flat, D. 899 No. 3 *(Level 9)*

F. Schubert: Impromptu in E-flat, D. 899 No. 2 *(Level 10)*

F. Schubert: Impromptu in A-flat, D. 899 No. 4 *(Level 10)*

F. Mendelssohn: Folk Song in A minor, Op. 53 No. 5 *(Level 9)*

R. Schumann: Romance in F-sharp, Op. 28 No. 2 *(Level 9)*

F. Chopin: Nocturne in E minor, Op. 72 No. 1 *(Level 9)*

F. Chopin: Waltz in D-flat 'Minute', Op. 64 No. 1 *(Level 9)*

F. Chopin: Fantaisie-Impromptu, Op. 66 *(Level 10)*
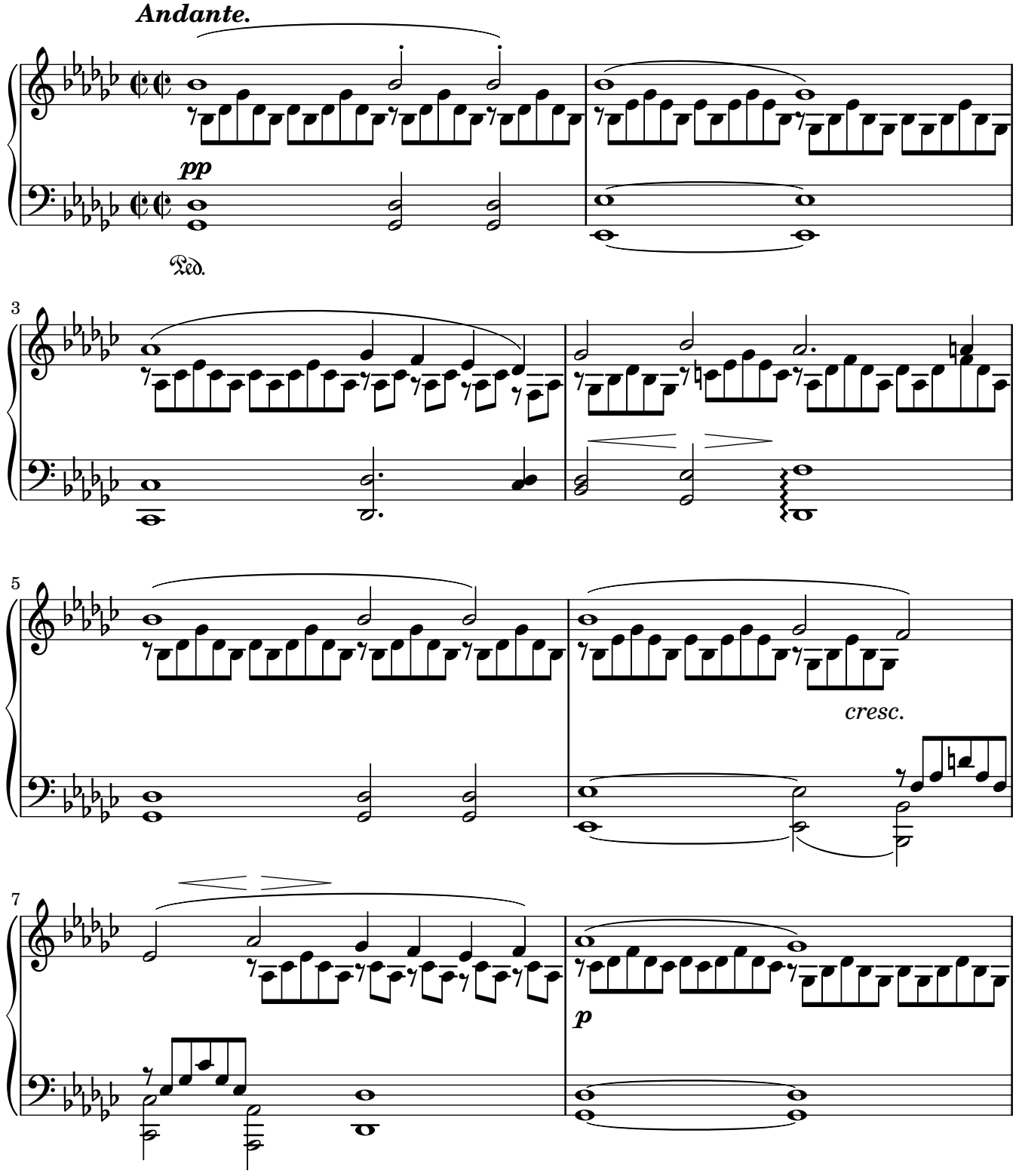
Impromptu in G-flat, D. 899 No. 3
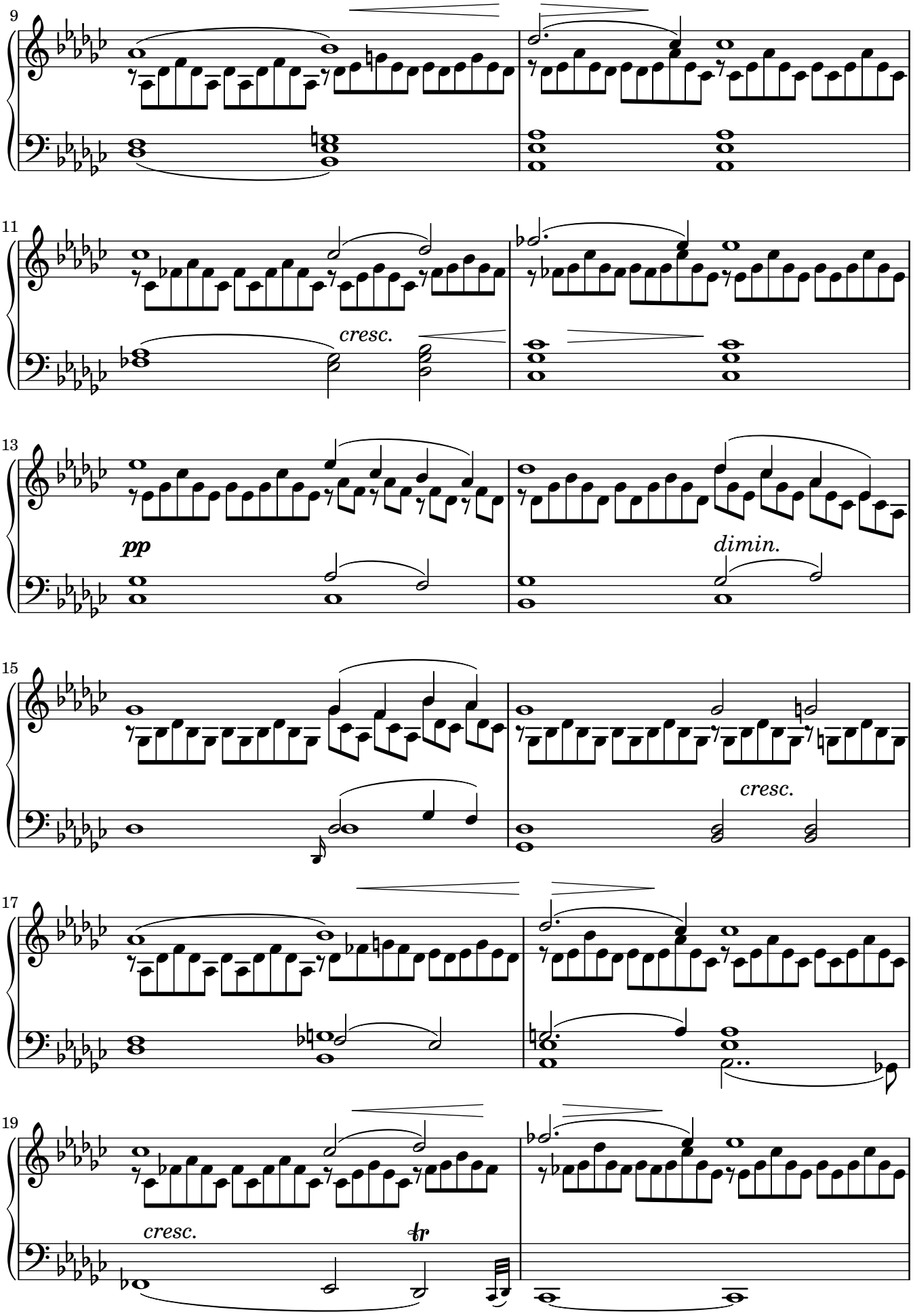
F. Schubert (1797-1828) - Four Impromptus, D. 899 (1827)
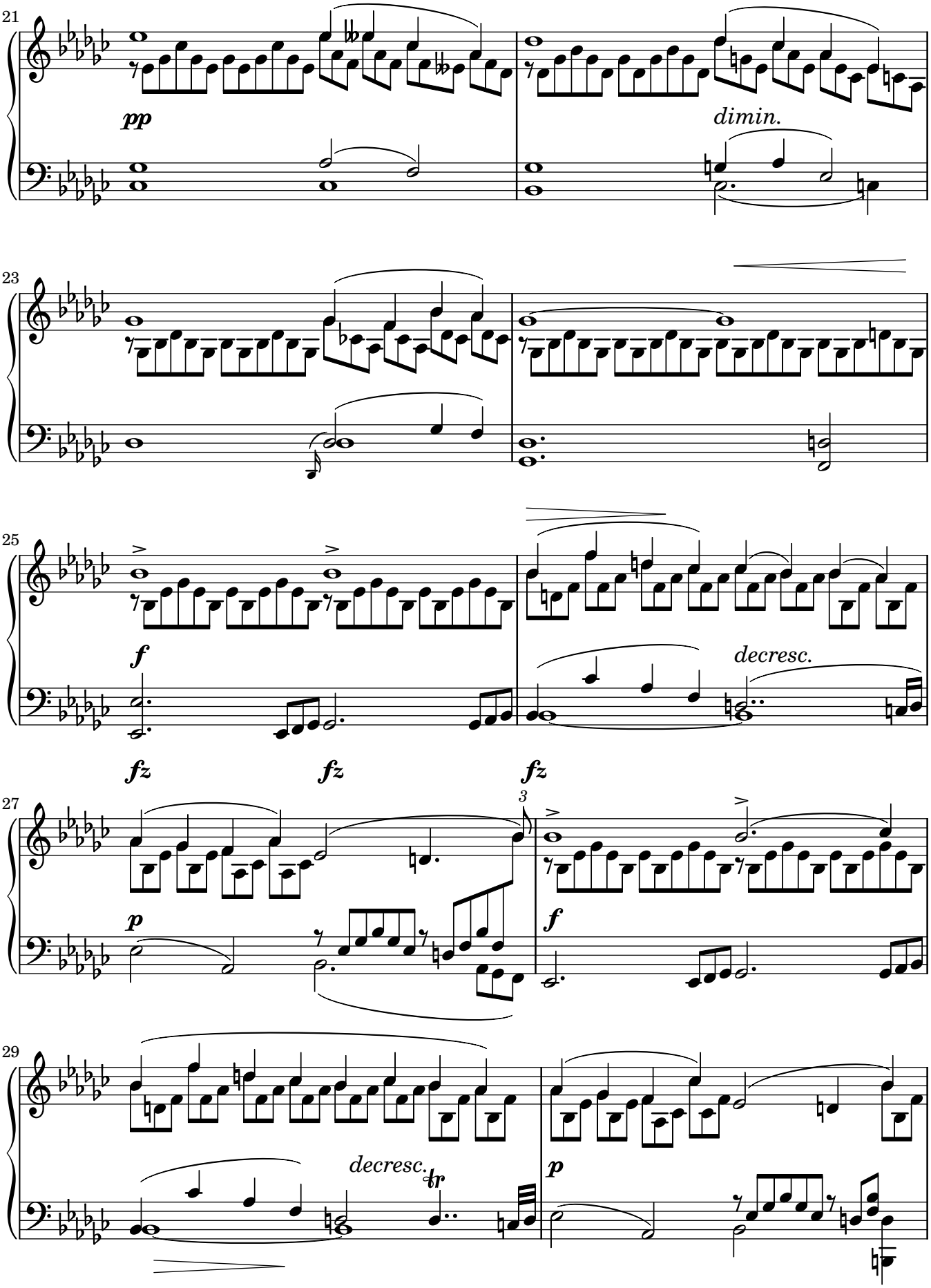
Level 9 · about 6 min
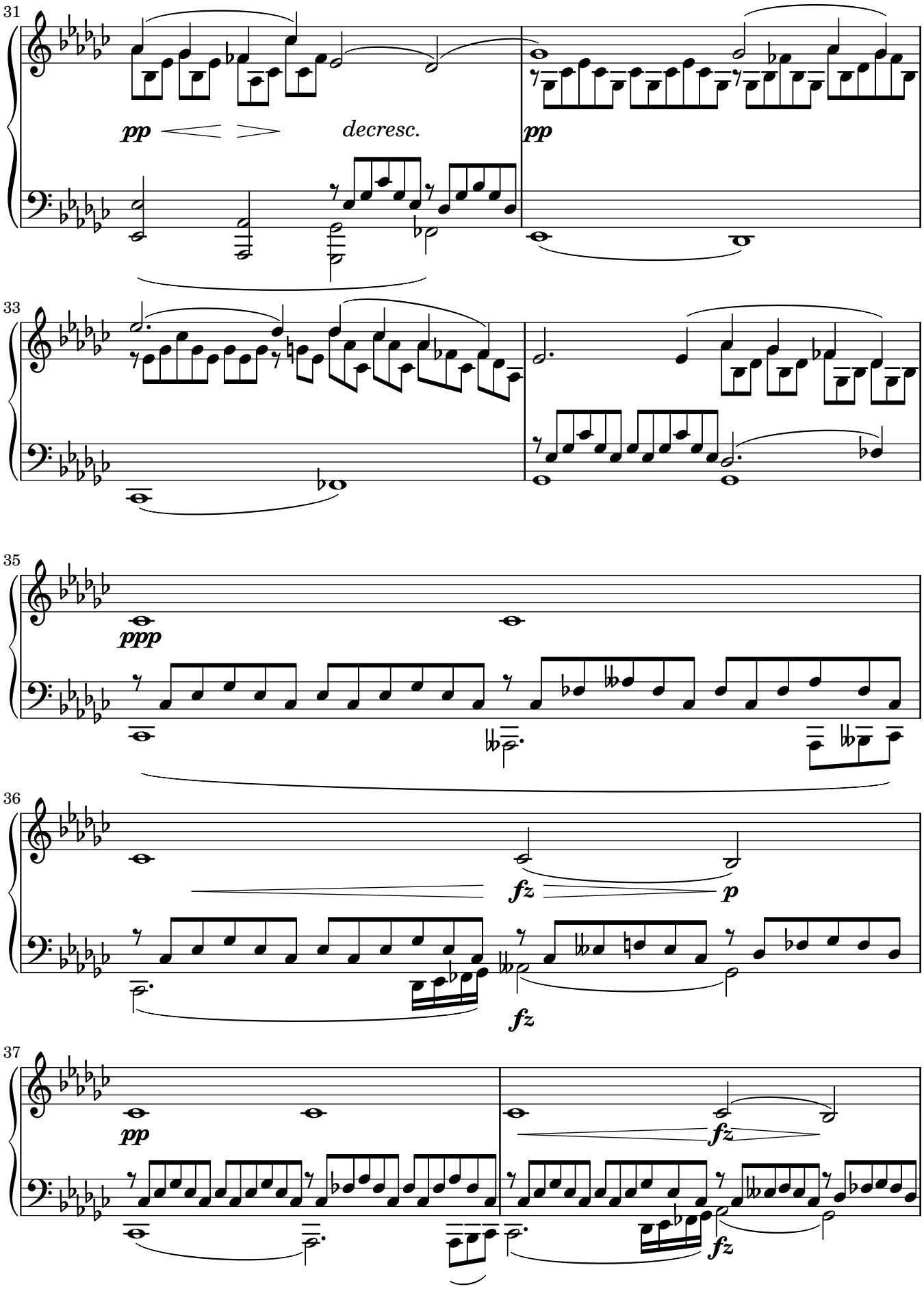
A long, calm song over a rippling accompaniment that never stops. The right hand plays both the melody, with its outer fingers, and the soft accompaniment, with its thumb and inner fingers; learn the melody alone first. Six flats: say the key signature before every practice.
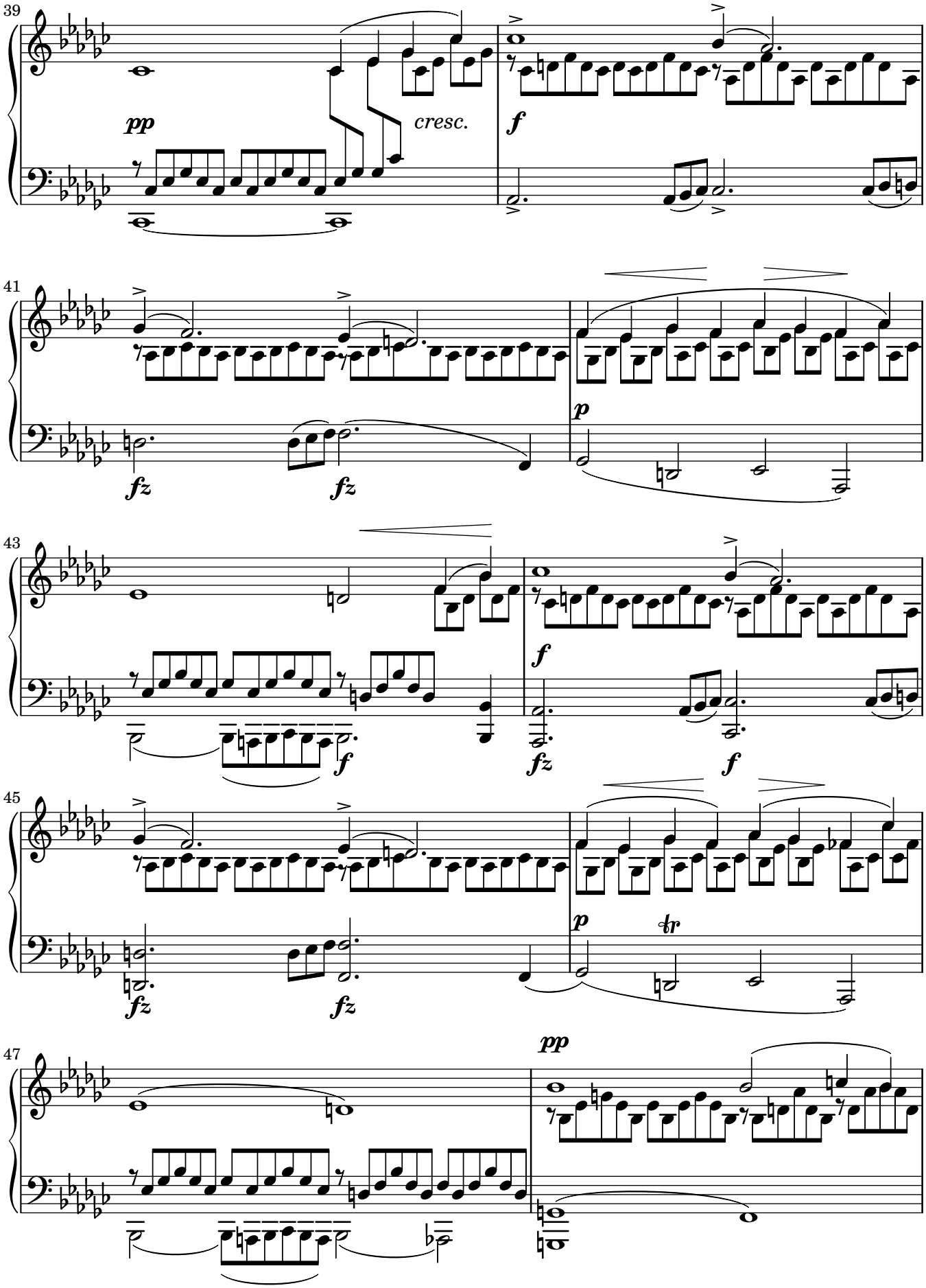
Source: Mutopia Project no. 1193, typeset by Ph. Raynaud (public domain).
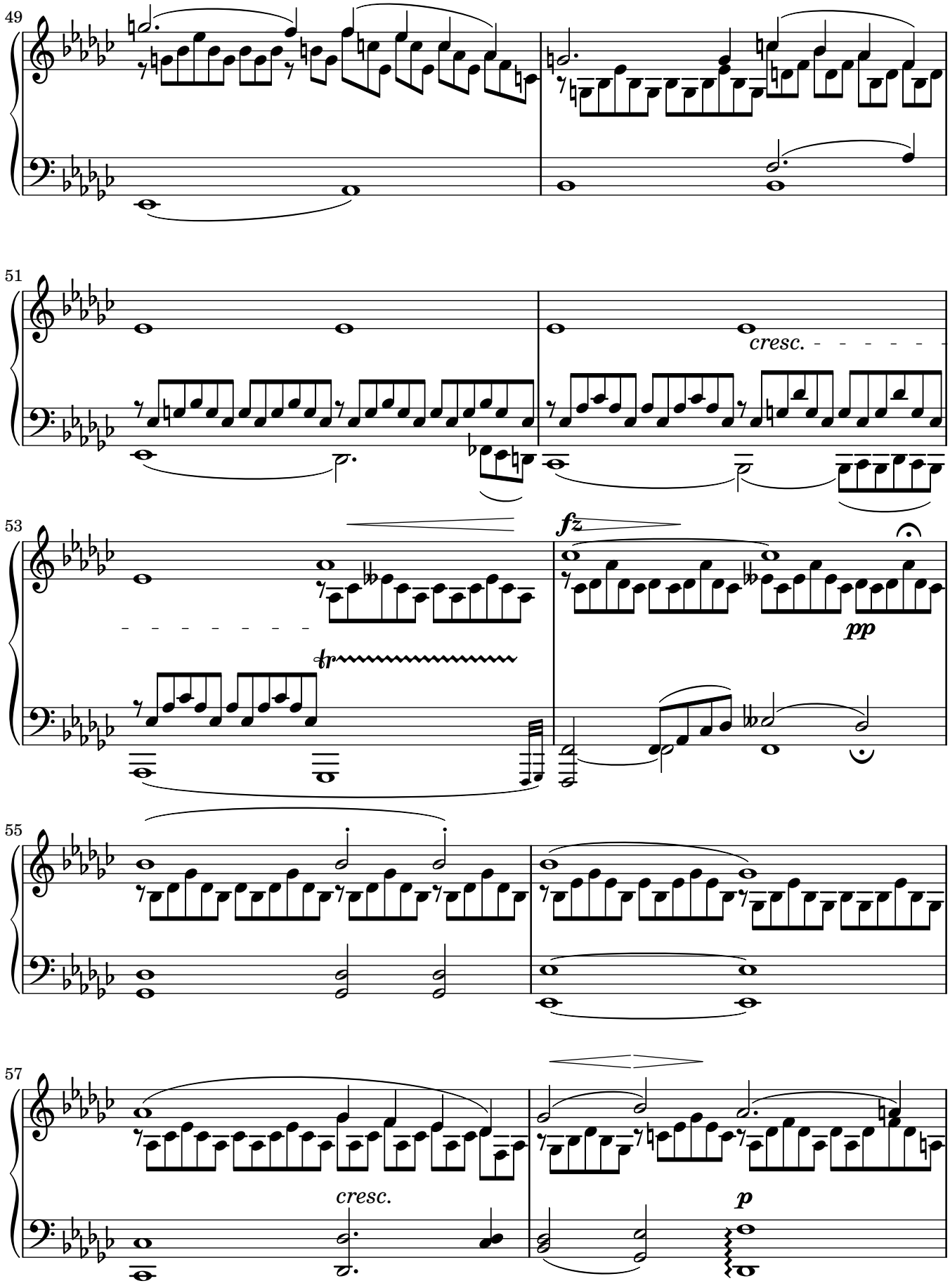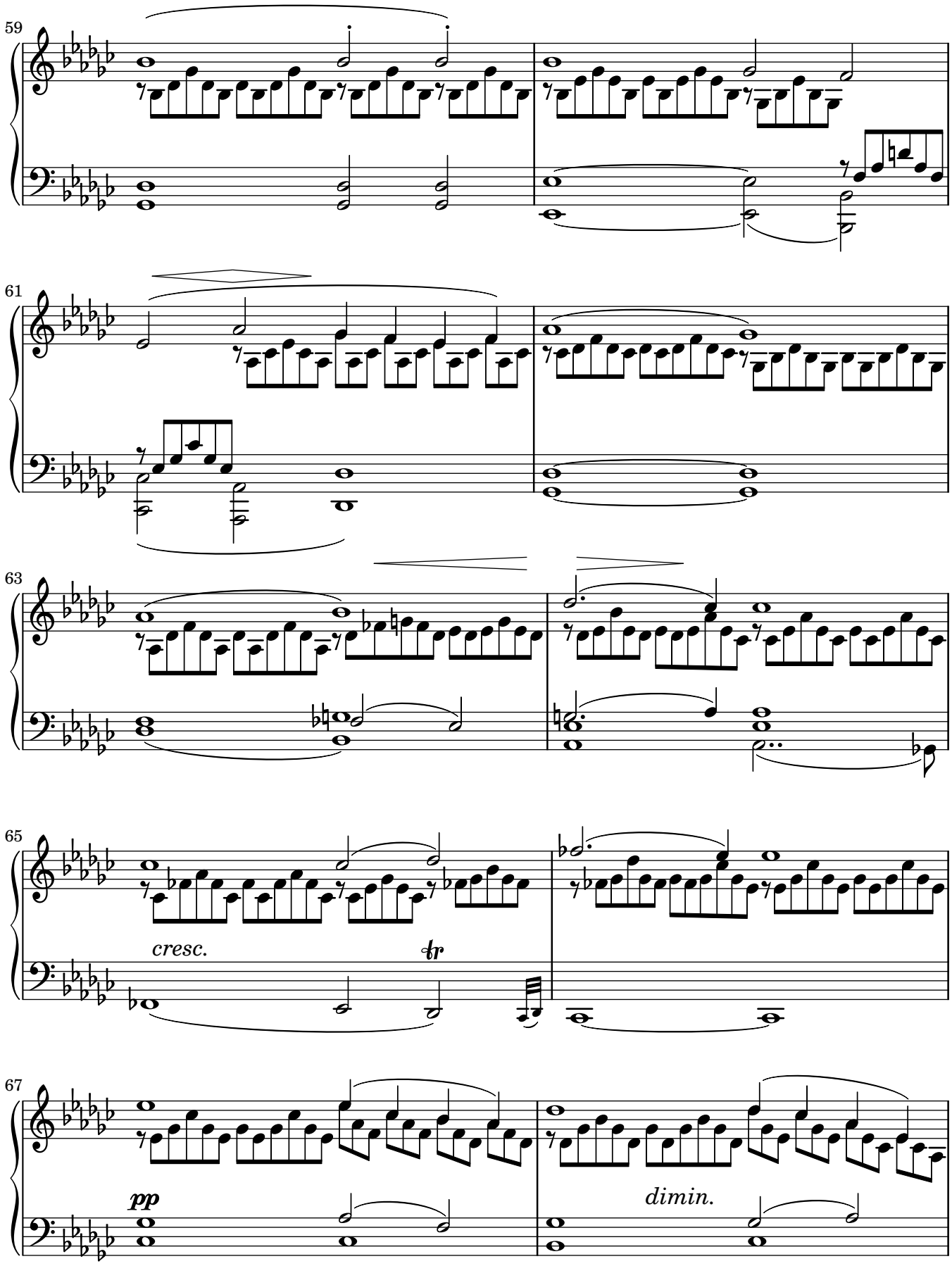



9
11
cresc.
13
pp
dimin.
15
cresc.
17
19
cresc.
tr
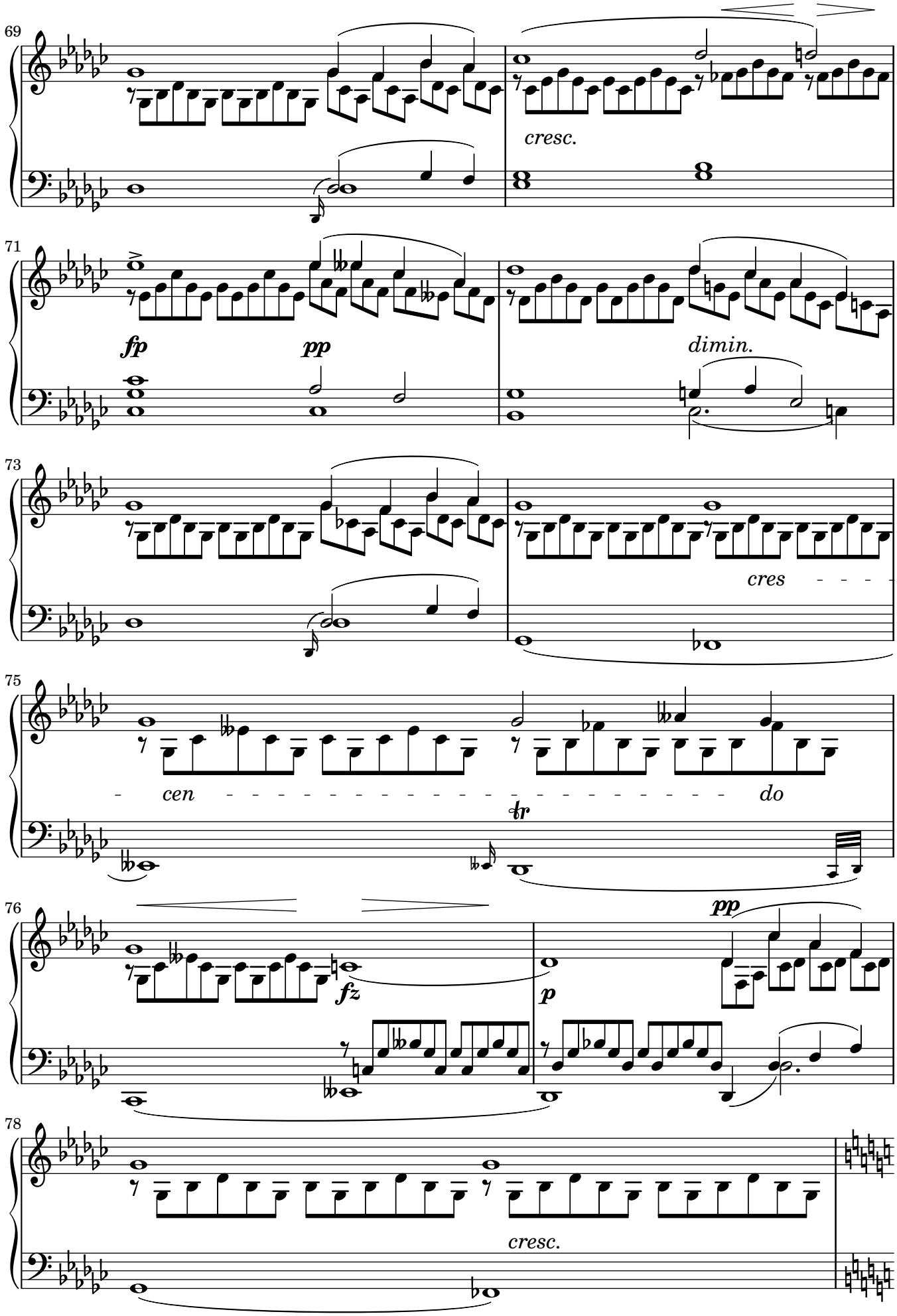

21
pp
dimin.
23
25
f
decresc.
fz
fz
fz
27
3
p
f
29
decresc.
tr
p
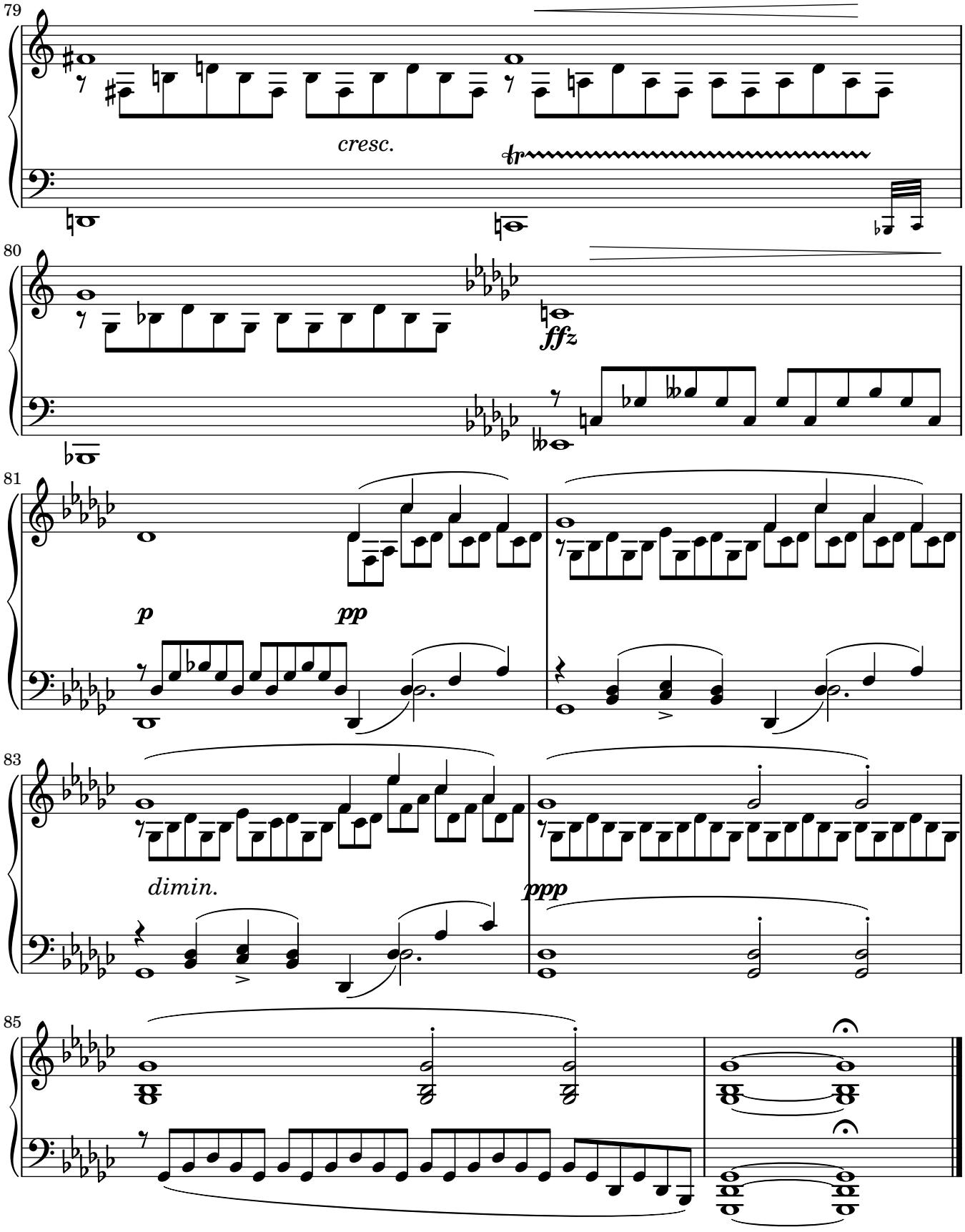

31
pp
decresc.
pp
33
35
ppp
36
fz
p
fz
37
pp
fz
fz


39
pp
cresc.
f
41
fz
fz
p
43
f
fz
f
45
fz
fz
p
47
pp


49
51
cresc.
53
fz
pp
55
57
cresc.
p


59
61
63
65
cresc.
tr
67
pp
dimin.


69
cresc.
71
fp
pp
dimin.
73
cres
75
cen
do
tr
76
fz
p
pp
78
cresc.


79
cresc.
tr
80
ffz
81
p
pp
83
dimin.
ppp
85
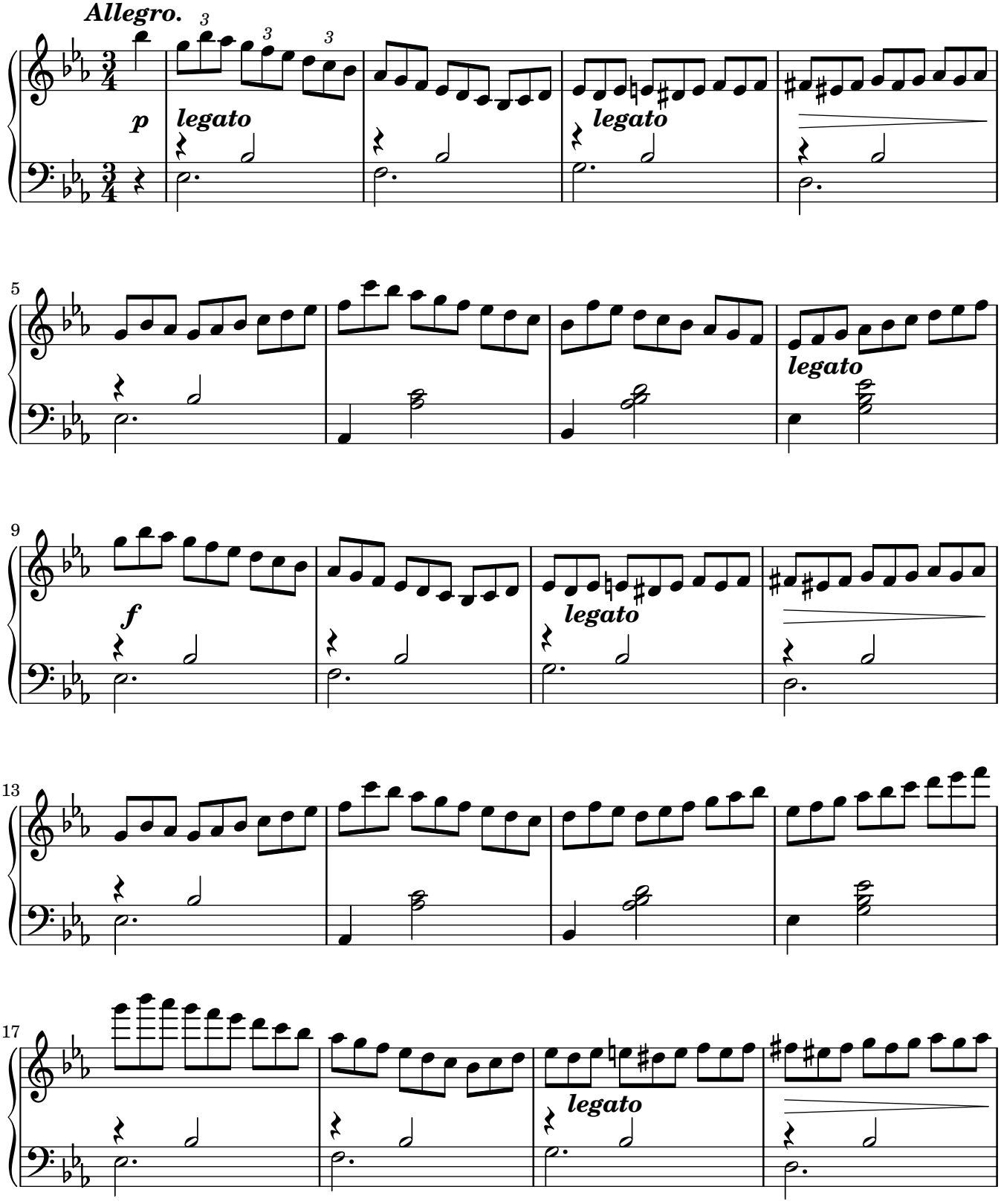
Impromptu in E-flat, D. 899 No. 2
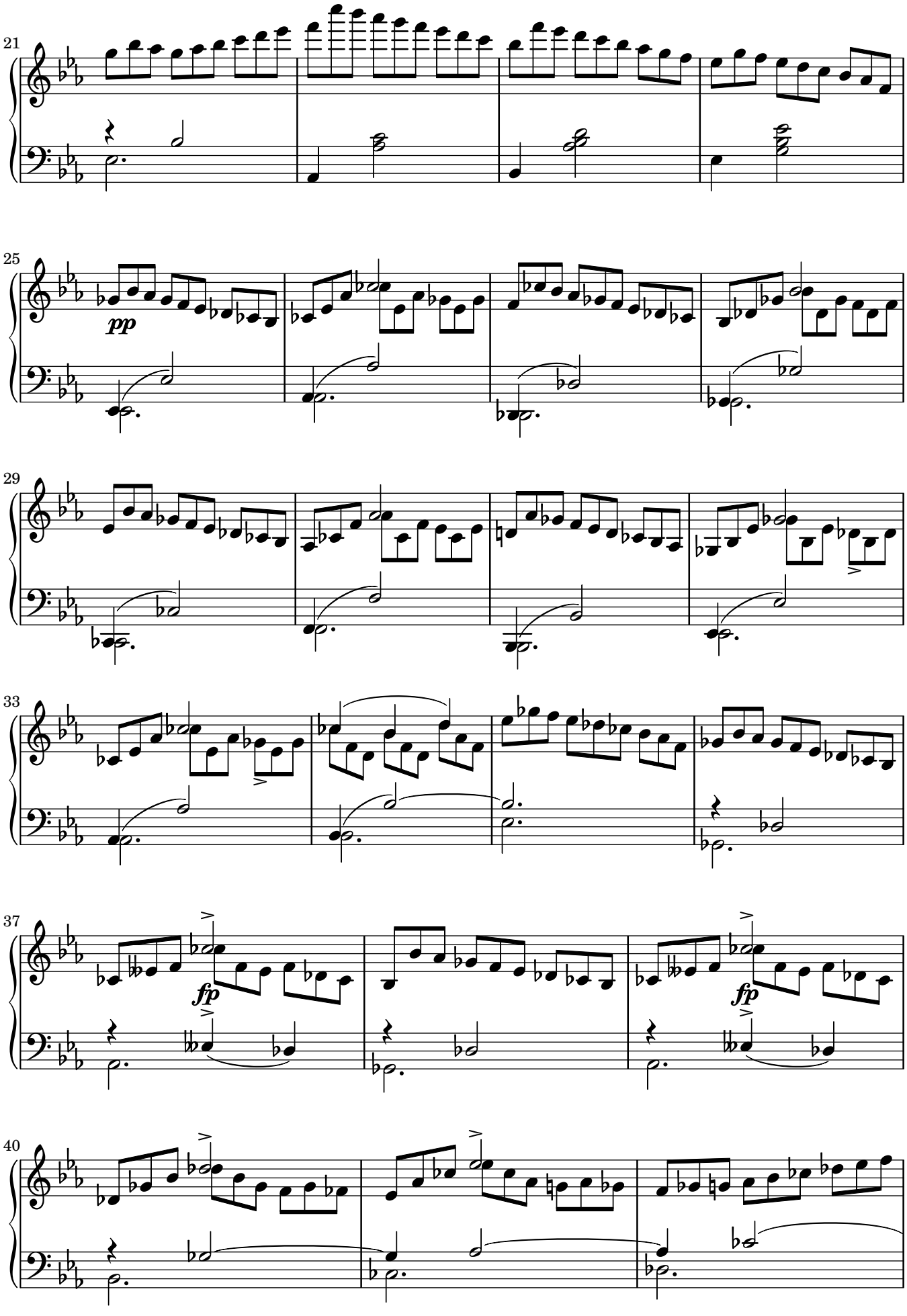
F. Schubert (1797-1828) - Four Impromptus, D. 899 (1827)
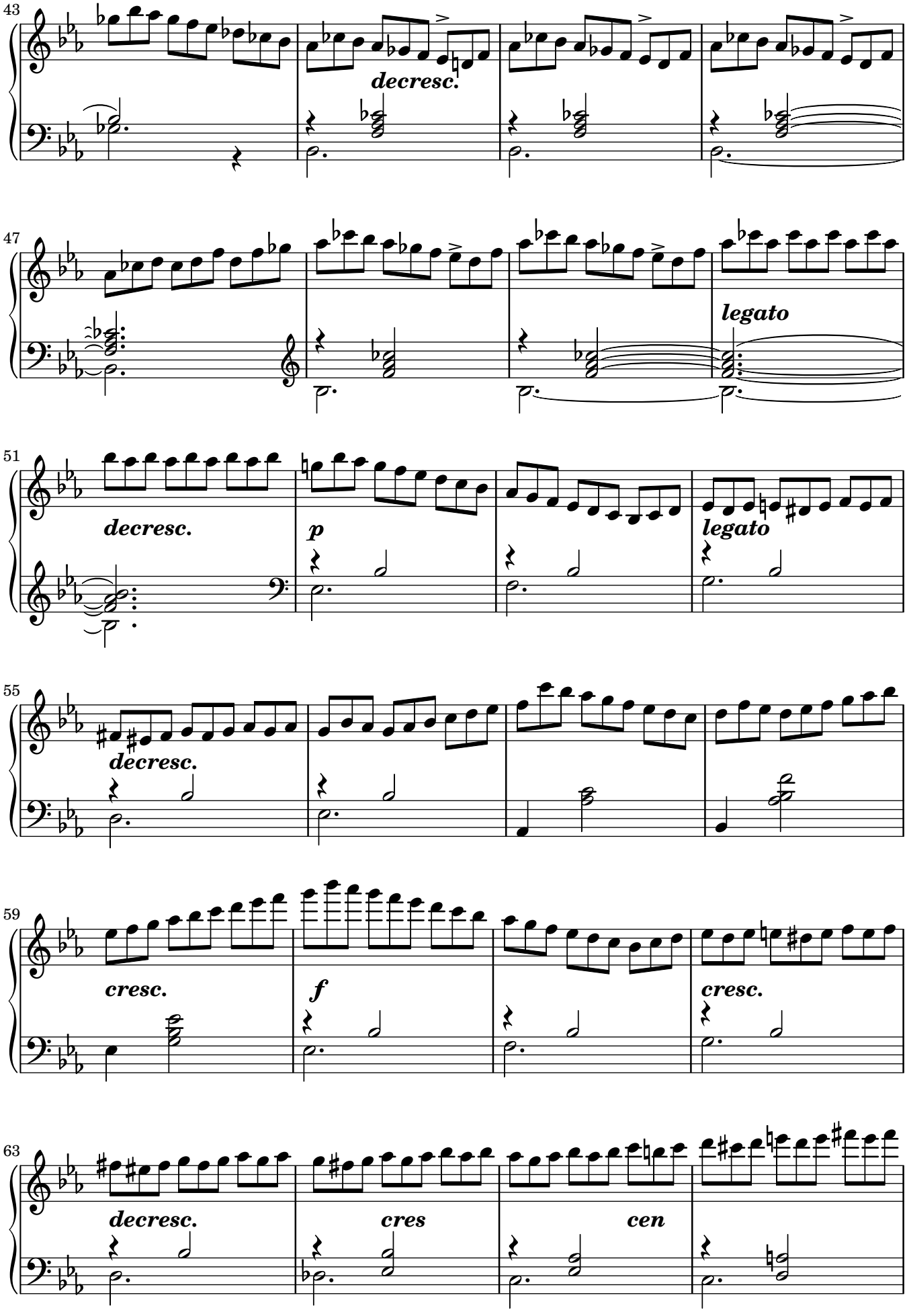
Level 10 · about 5 min

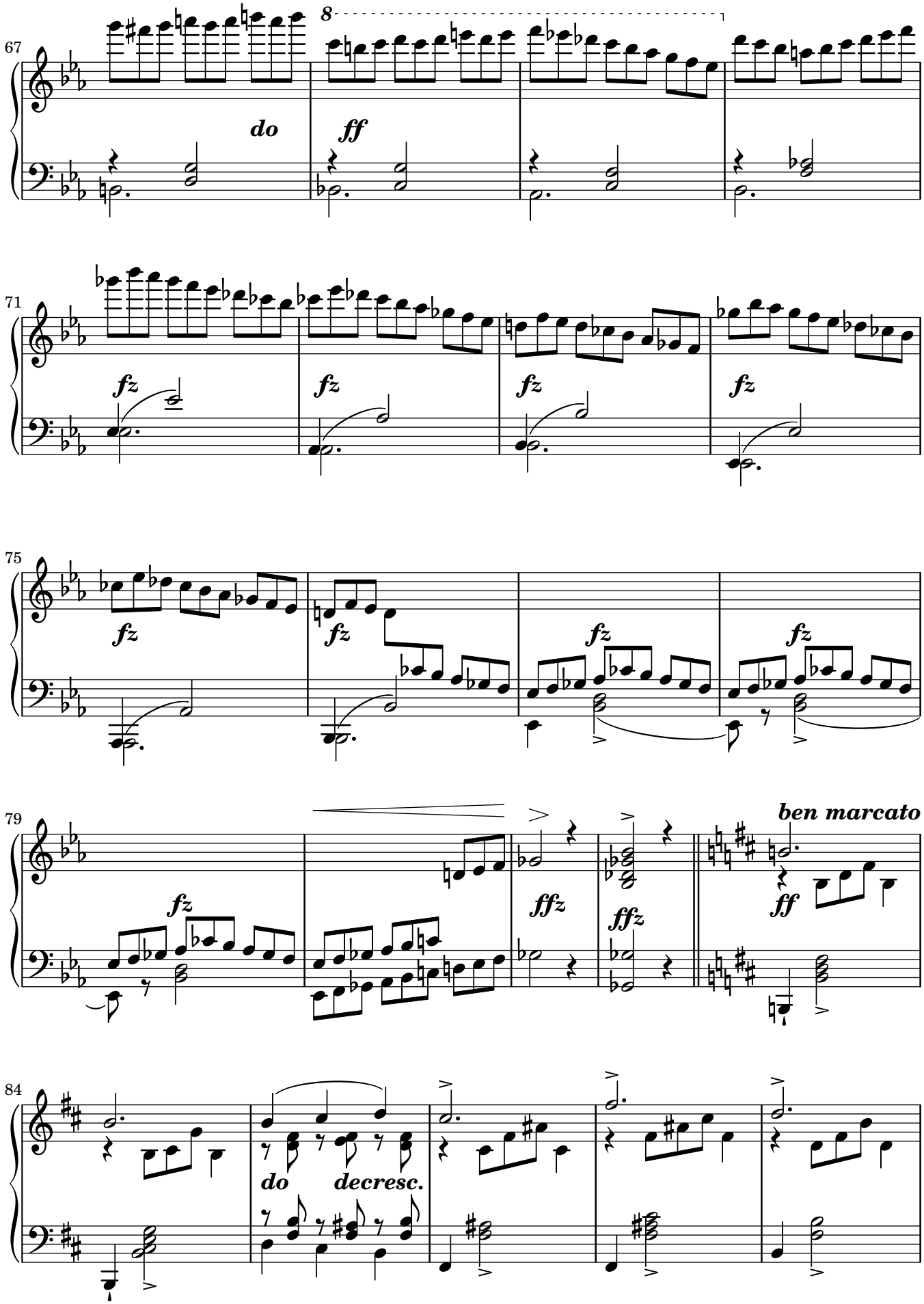
Running triplets in the right hand, perfectly even and quiet, over a light waltz-like left hand, with a fierce middle section in B minor. The triplet passages need careful fingering and slow practice in short groups.
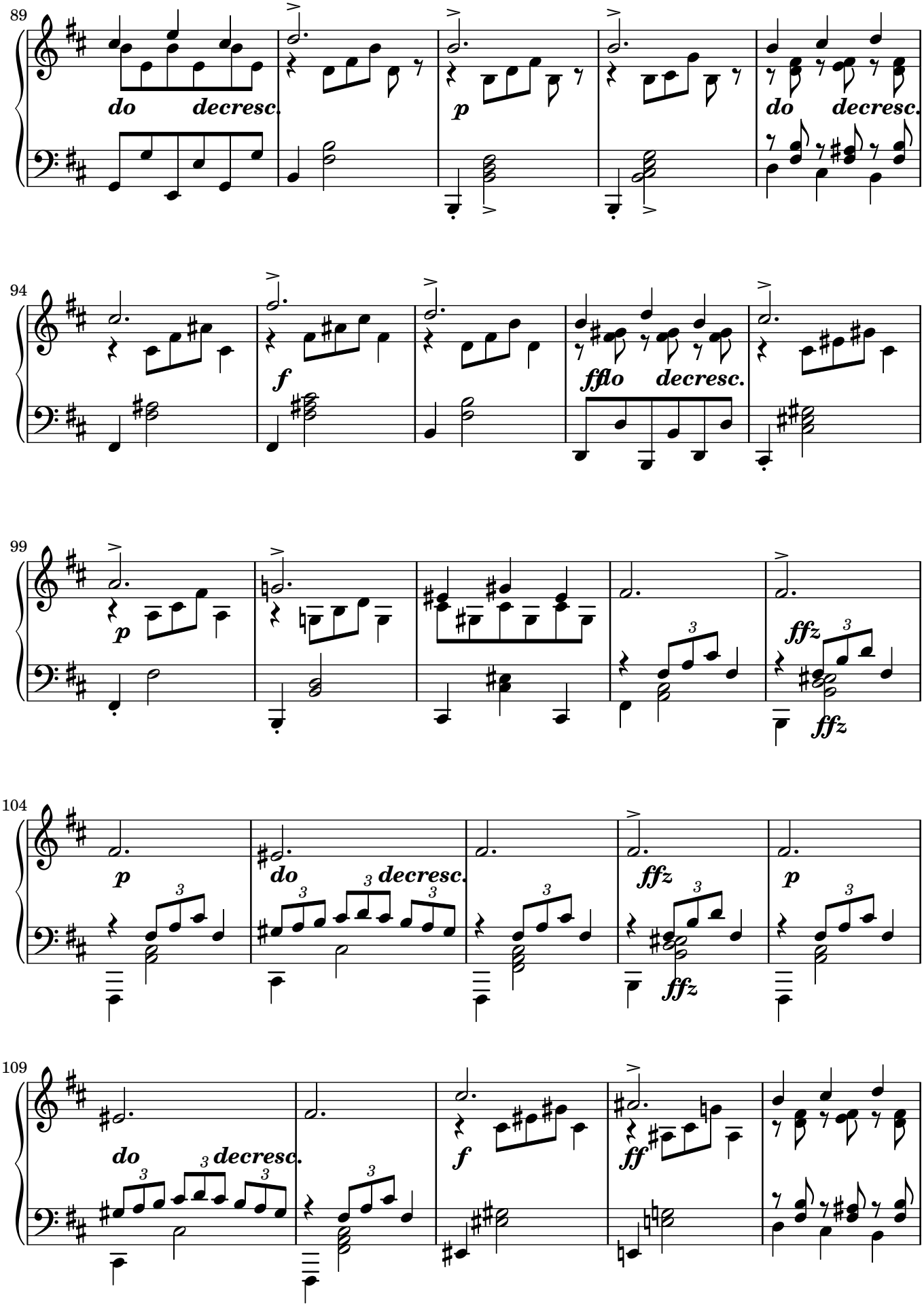
Source: Mutopia Project no. 1551, typeset by Ph. Raynaud (public domain).
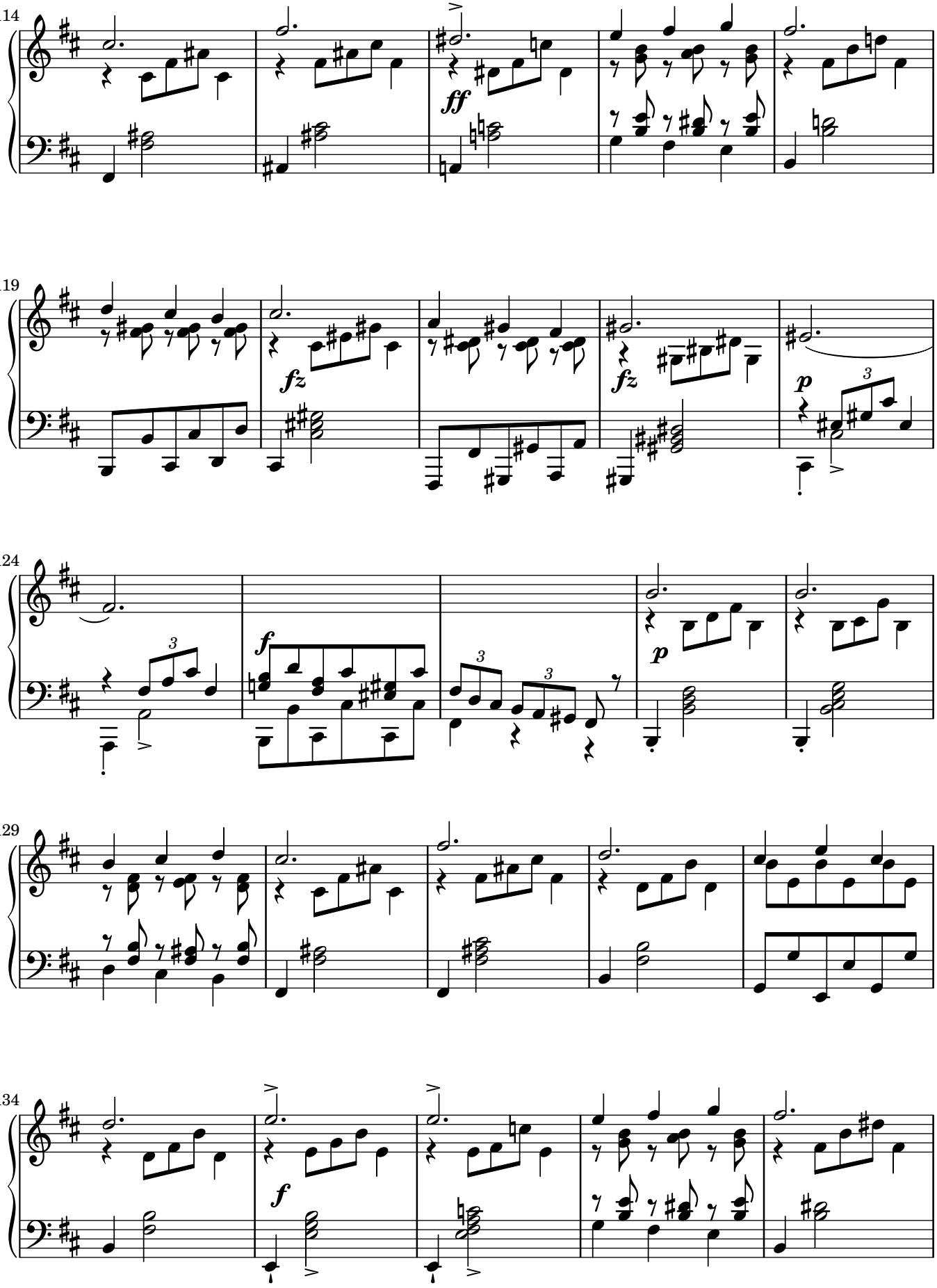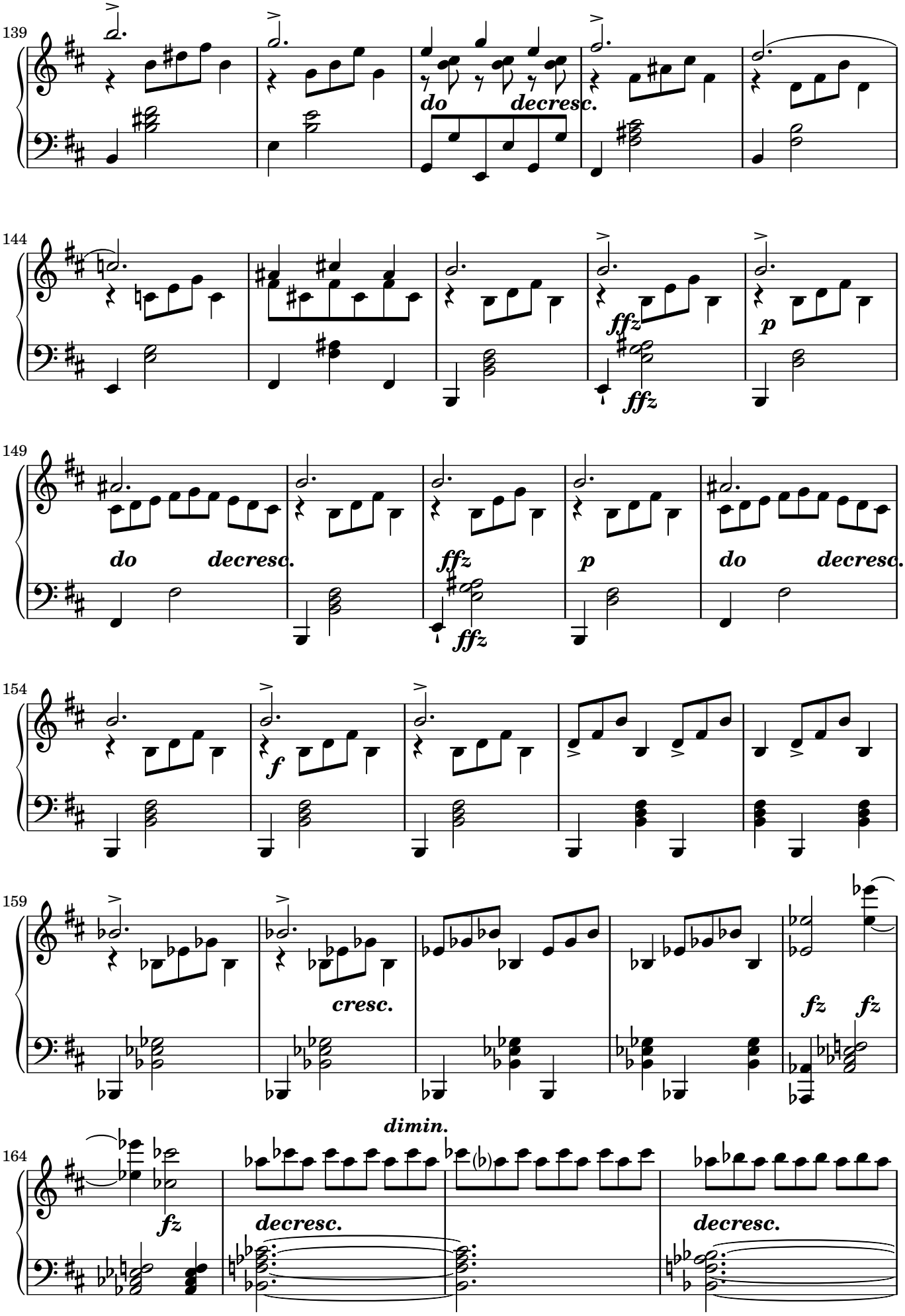



21
25
pp
29
33
37
fp
fp
40

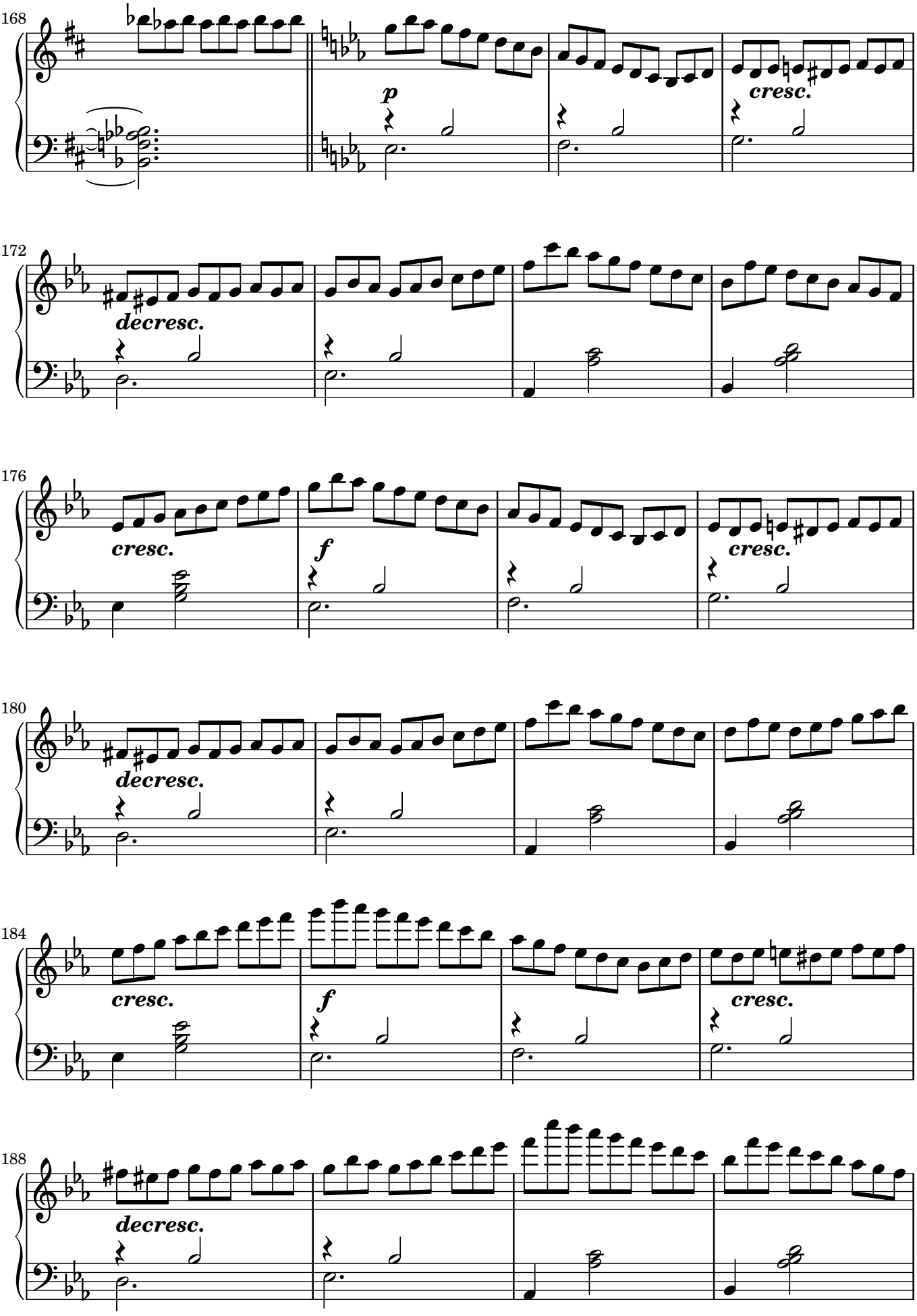

43
decresc.
47
legato
51
decresc.
p
legato
55
decresc.
59
cresc.
f
cresc.
63
decresc.
cres
cen

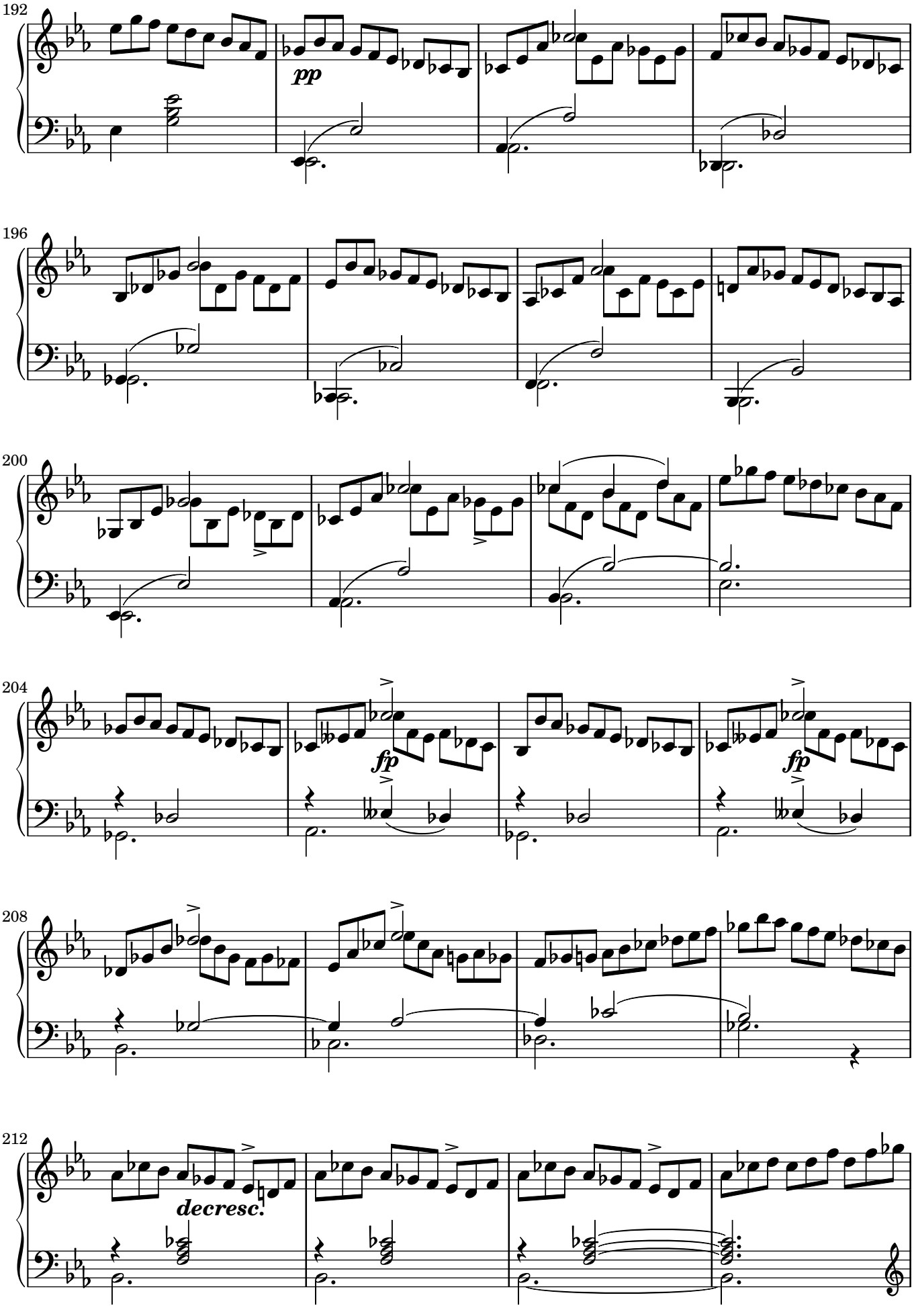

67
8
do
ff
71
fz
75
79
ffz
ben marcato
ff
84
do
decresc.

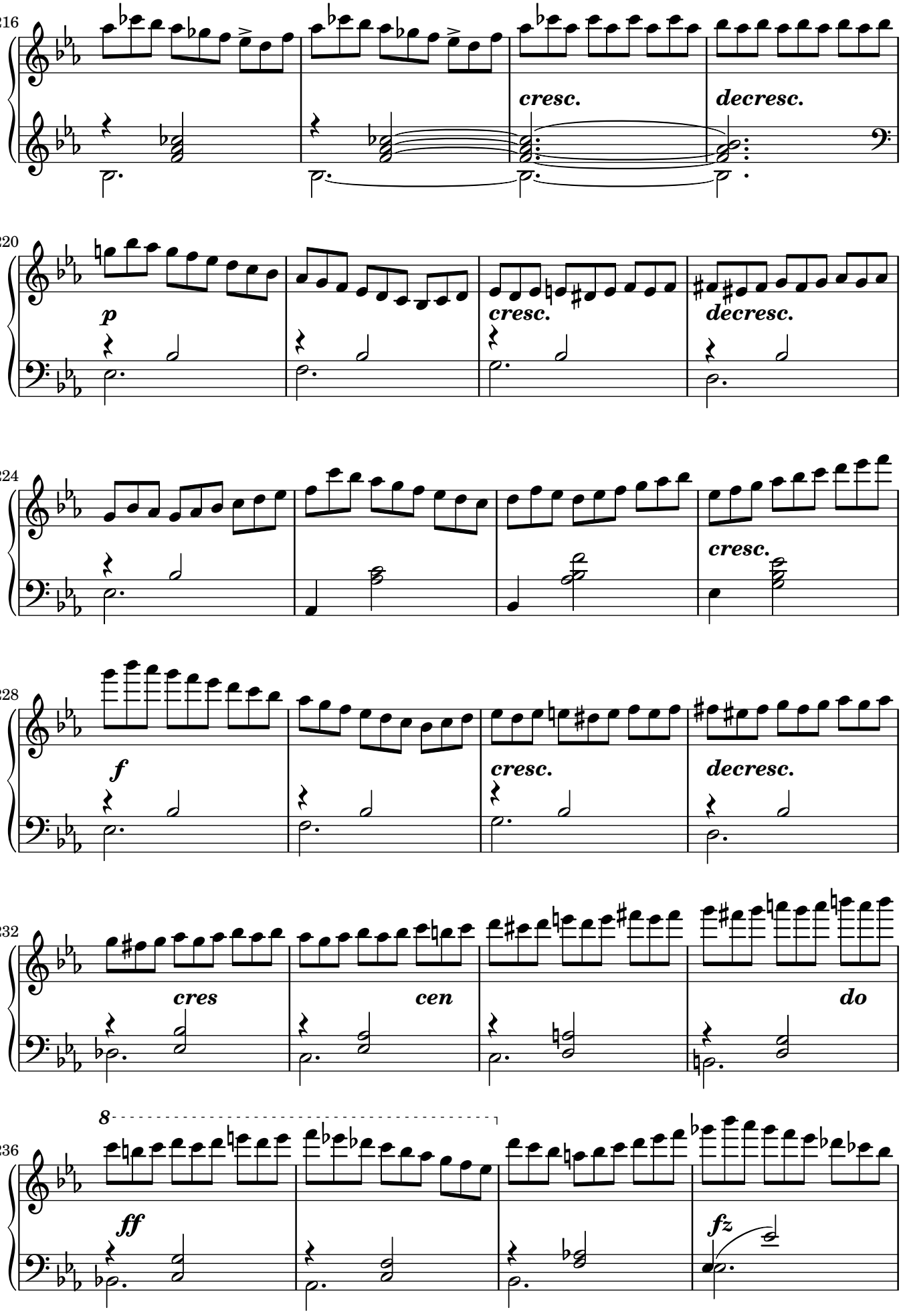

89
do decresc.
p
do decresc.
94
f
fflo decresc.
99
p
ffz
ffz
104
p
do decresc.
ffz
ffz
p
109
do decresc.
f
ff
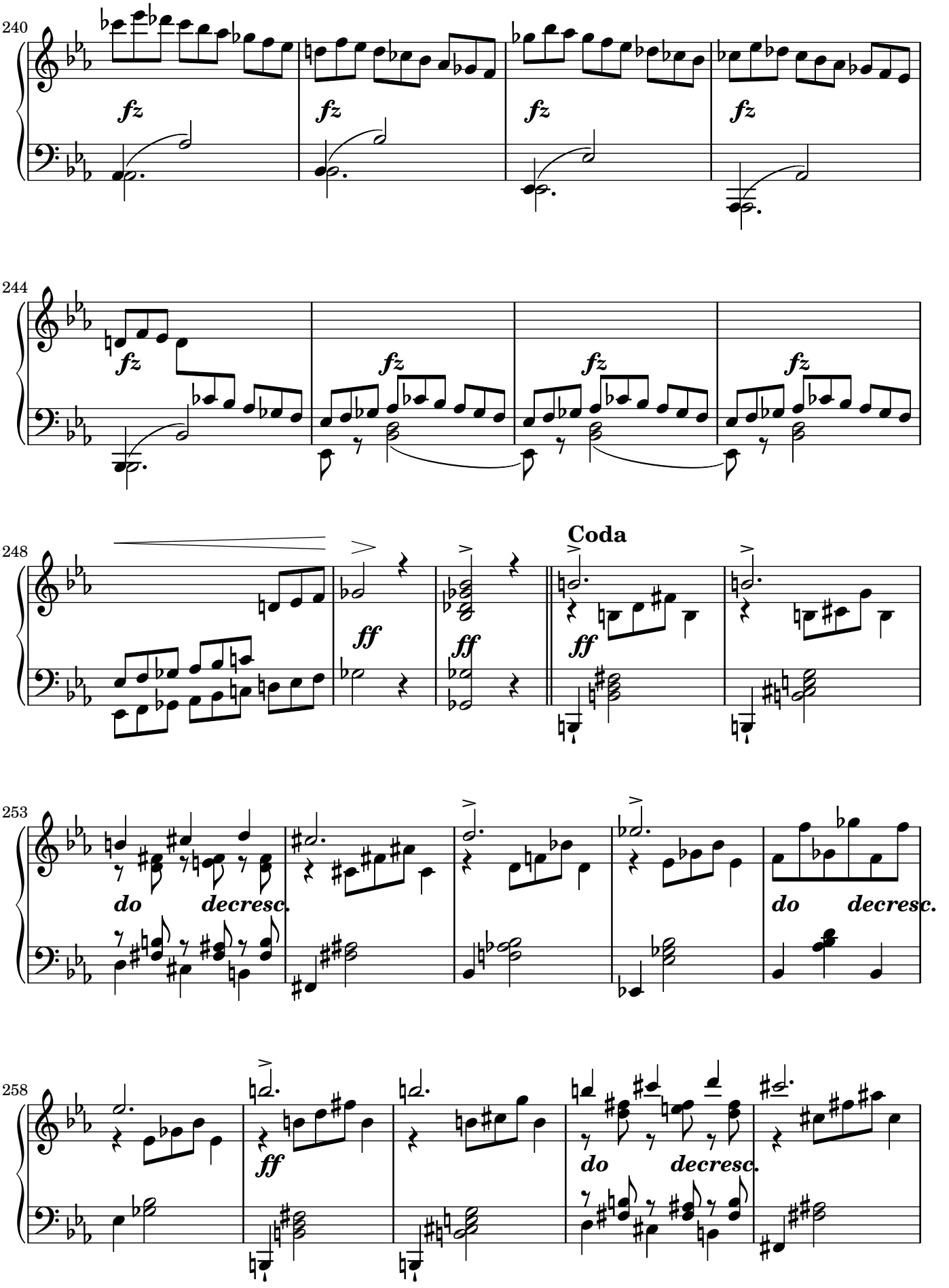

114
ff
119
fz
fz
p
124
f
p
129
134
f
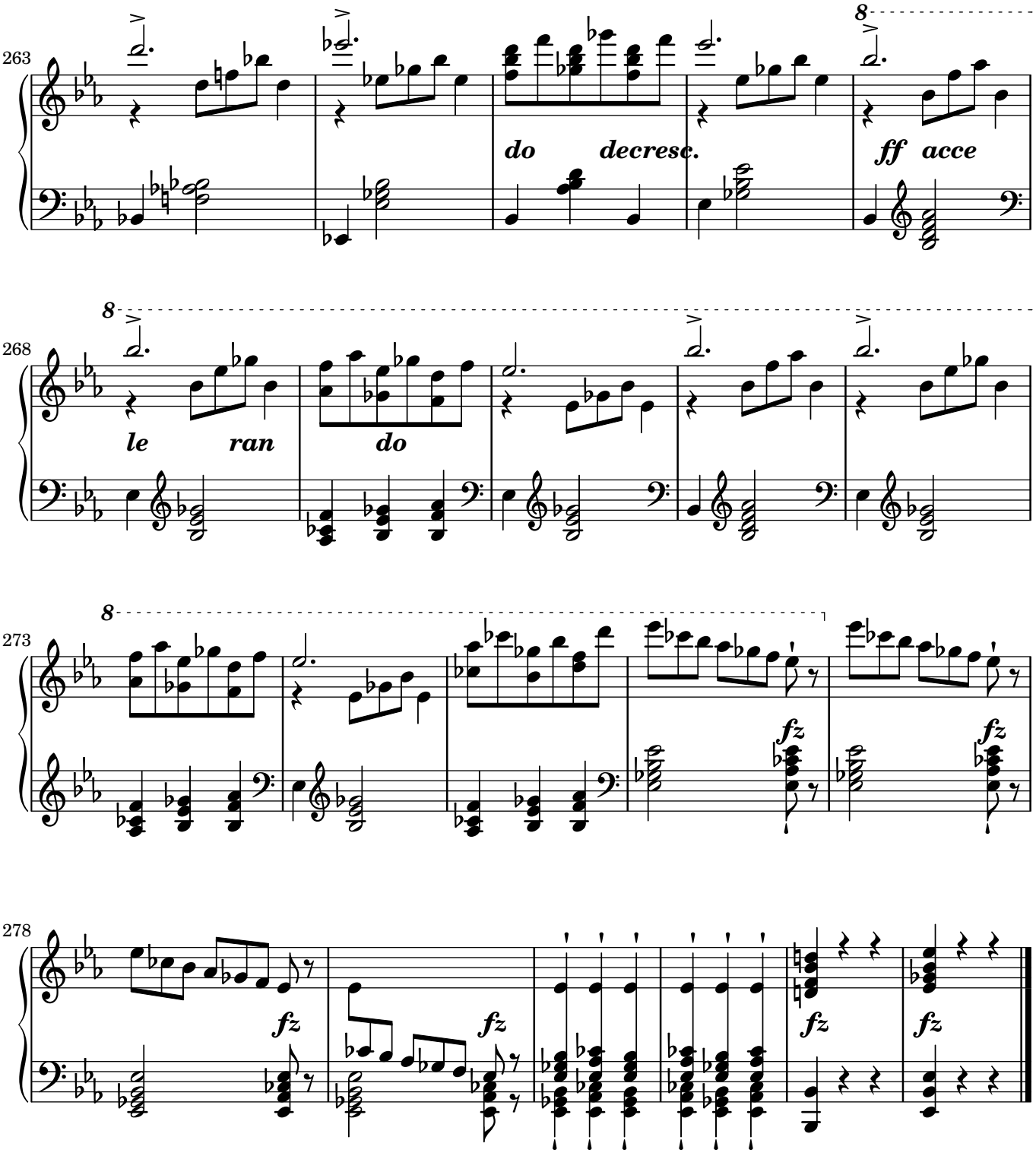

139
do decresc.
144
ffz
ffz
p
149
do decresc.
ffz
ffz
p
do decresc.
154
f
159
cresc.
fz fz
dimin.
164
fz
decresc.
decresc.


168
p
cresc.
172
decresc.
176
cresc.
f
cresc.
180
decresc.
184
cresc.
f
cresc.
188
decresc.


192
pp
196
200
204
fp
fp
208
212
decresc.


216
cresc.
decresc.
220
p
cresc.
decresc.
224
cresc.
228
f
cresc.
decresc.
232
cres
cen
do
236
8
ff
fz


240
fz
fz
fz
fz
244
fz
fz
fz
fz
248
Coda
ff
ff
ff
253
do
decresc.
do
decresc.
258
ff
do
decresc.


263
8
do decresc.
ff acce
268
8
le ran
do
273
8
fz
fz
278
fz
fz
fz
fz
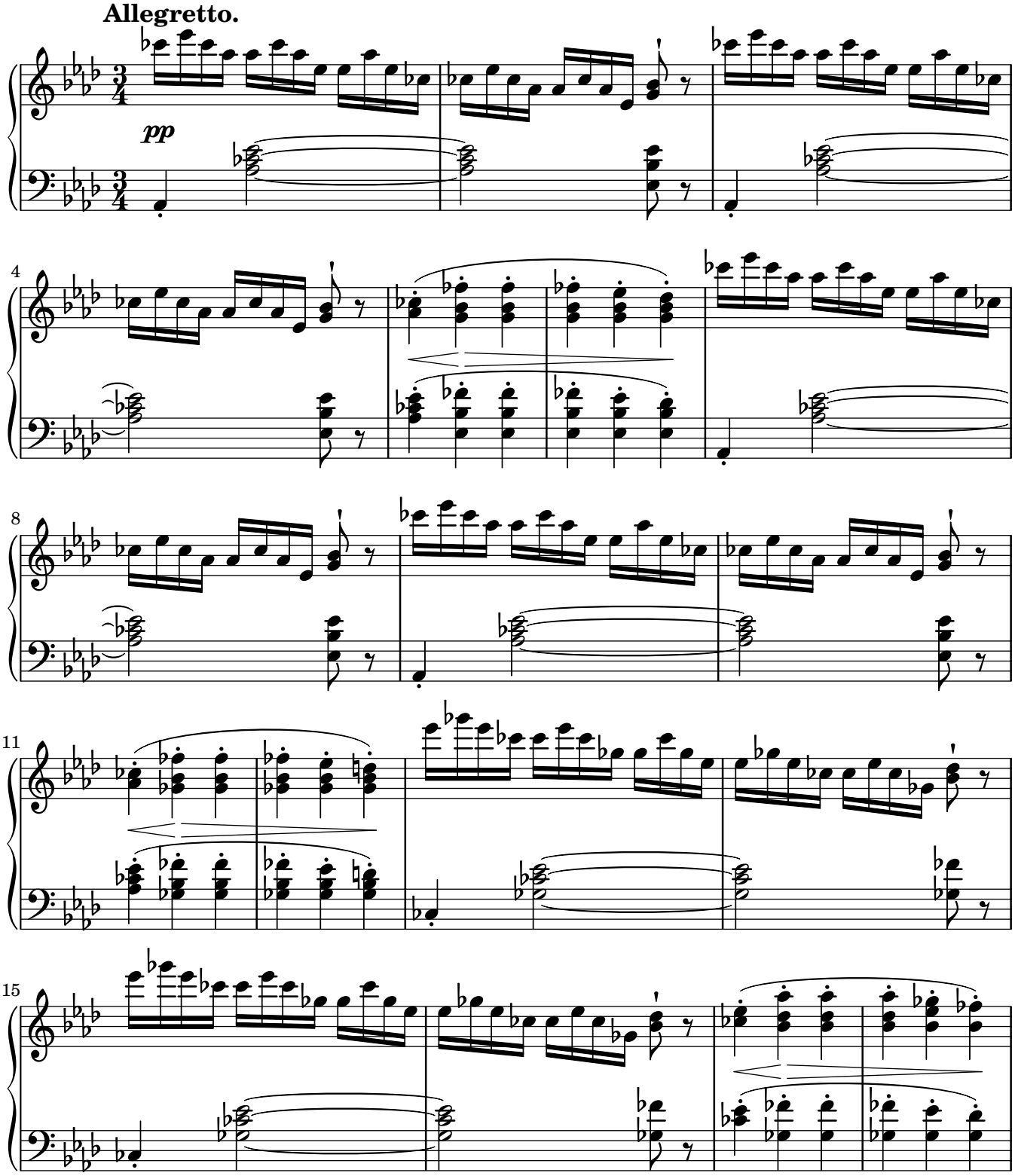
Impromptu in A-flat, D. 899 No. 4
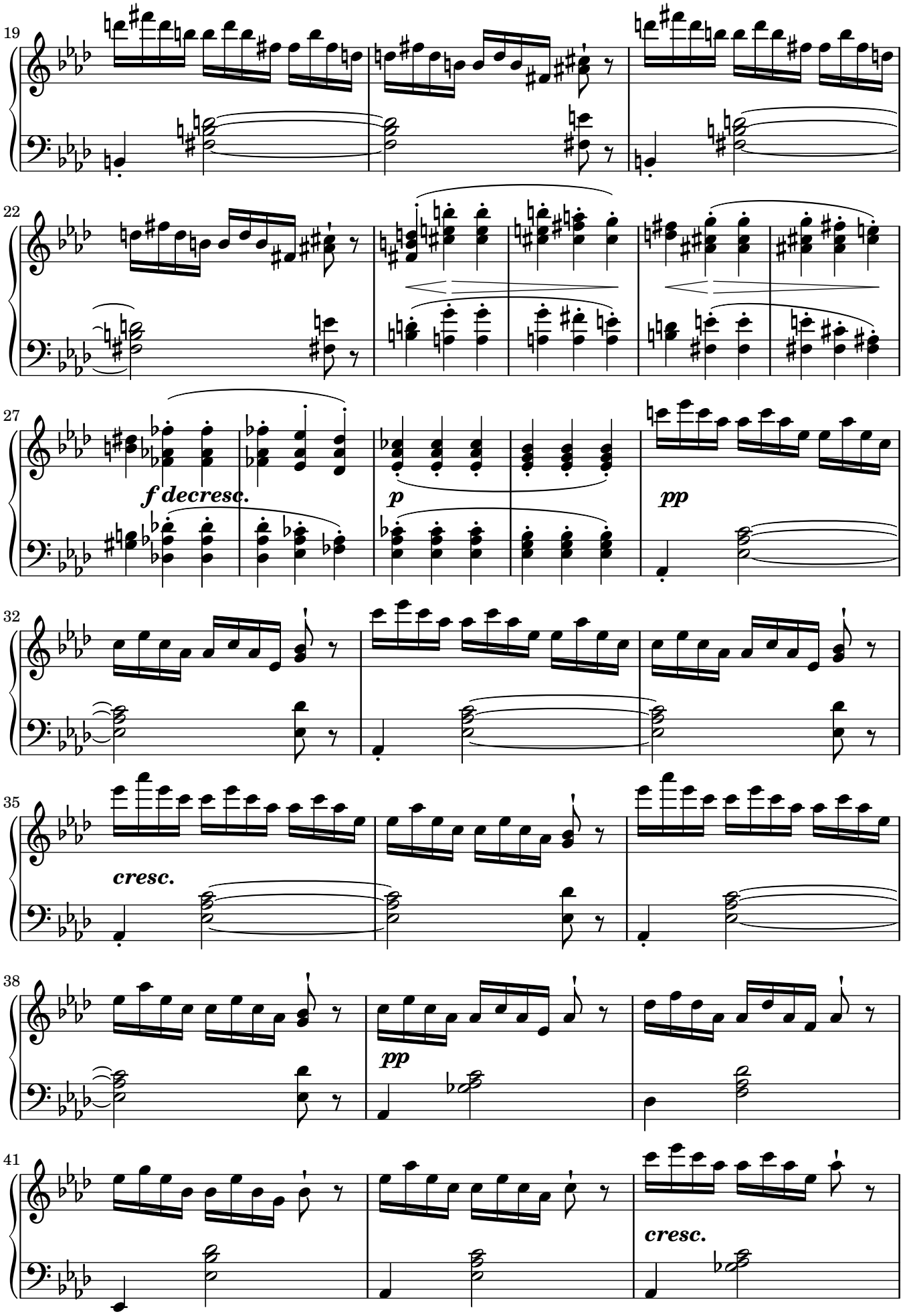
F. Schubert (1797-1828) - Four Impromptus, D. 899 (1827)
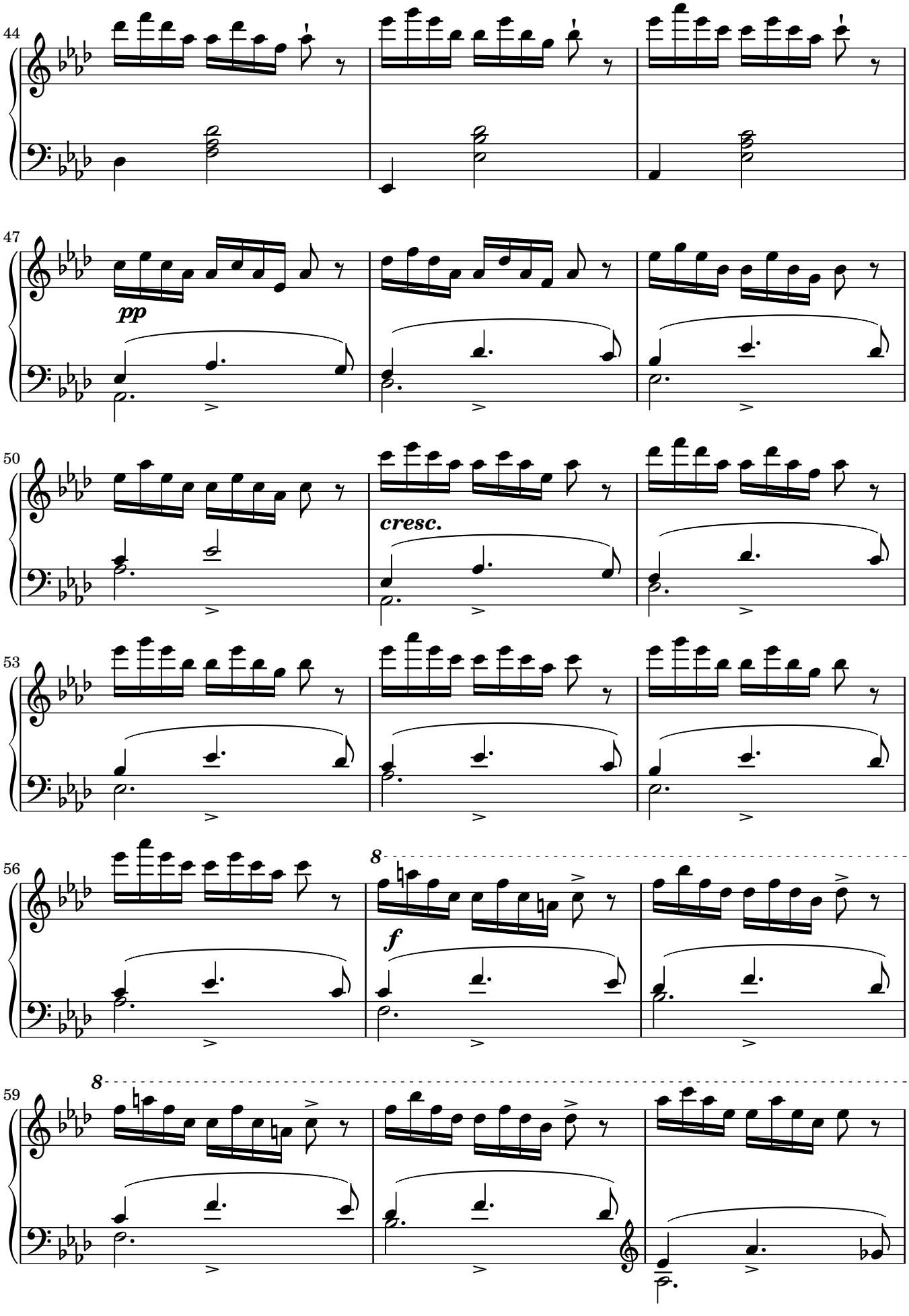
Level 10 · about 8 min
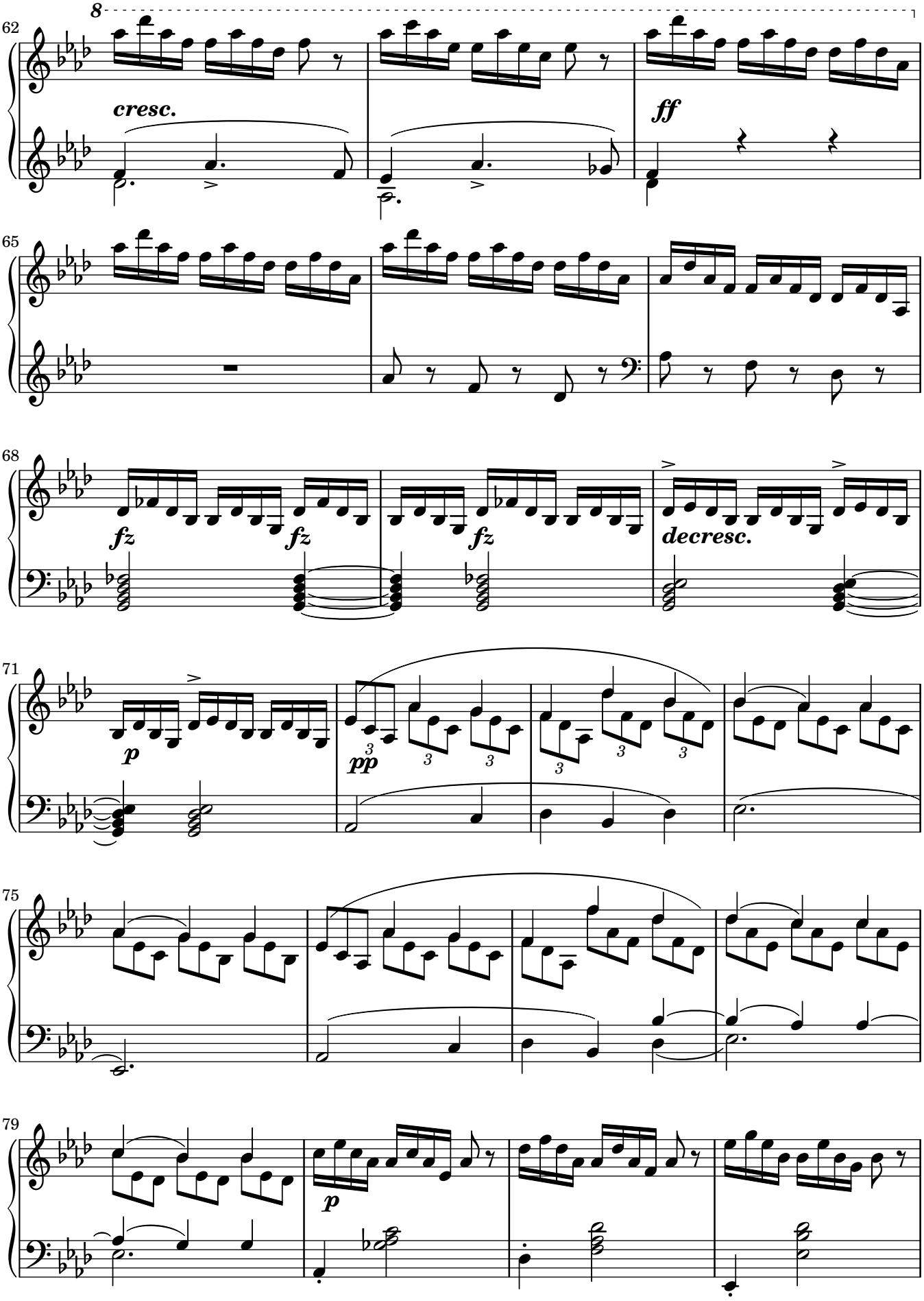
Cascades of broken chords falling down the keyboard, with the melody in the left hand beneath them; then a passionate middle section in C-sharp minor. Keep the cascades light and let the left-hand tune sing.
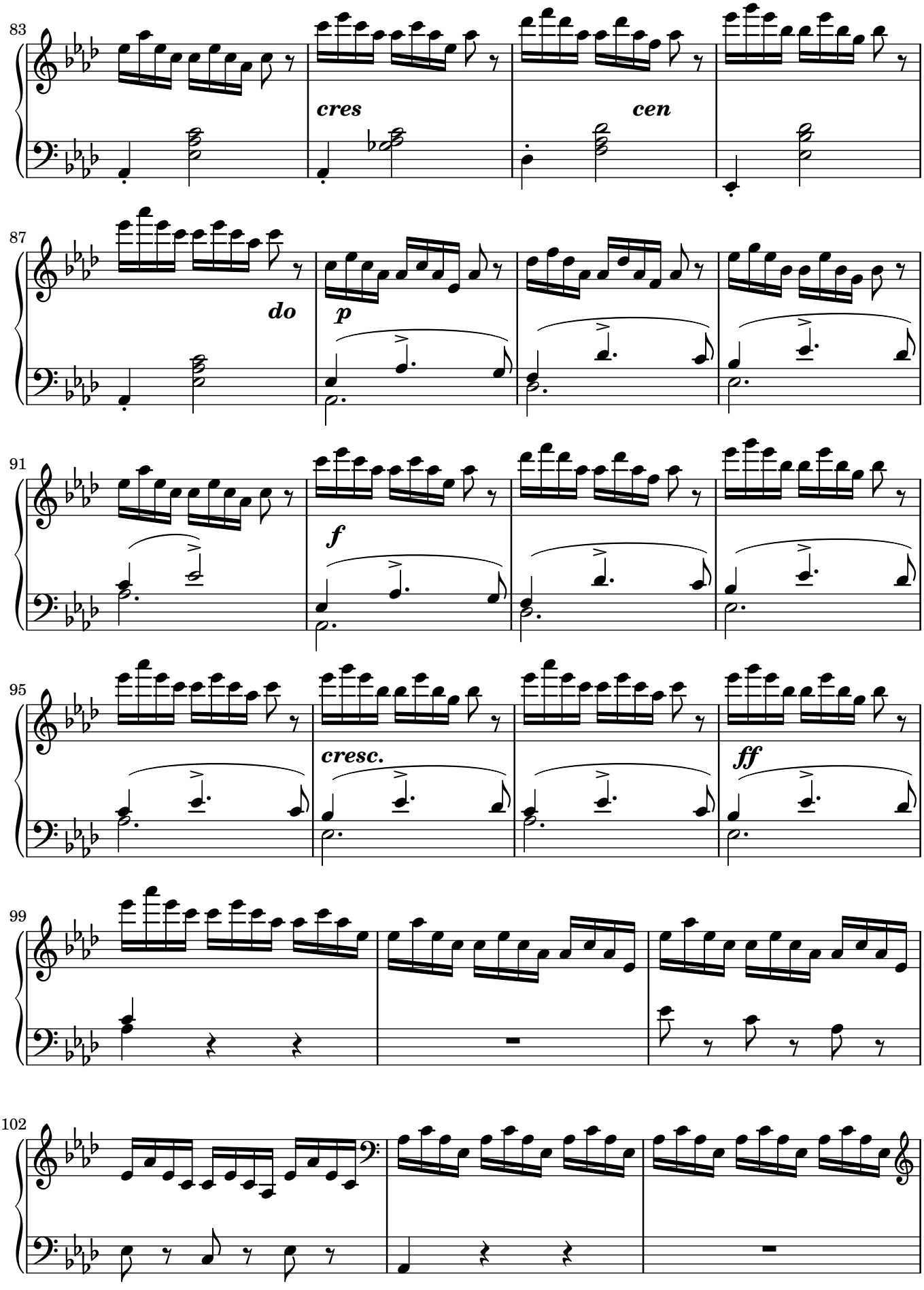
Source: Mutopia Project no. 1552, typeset by Ph. Raynaud (public domain).
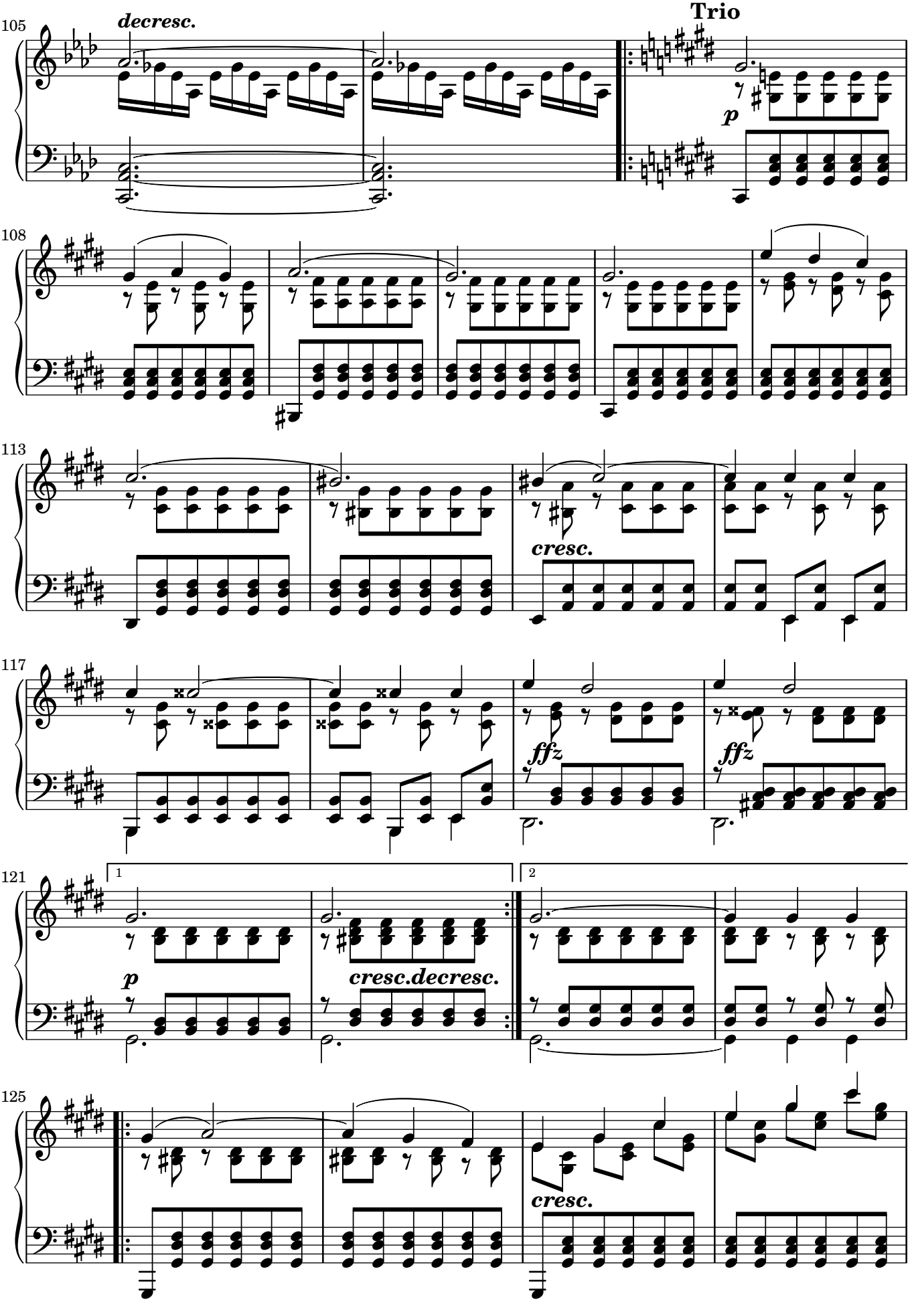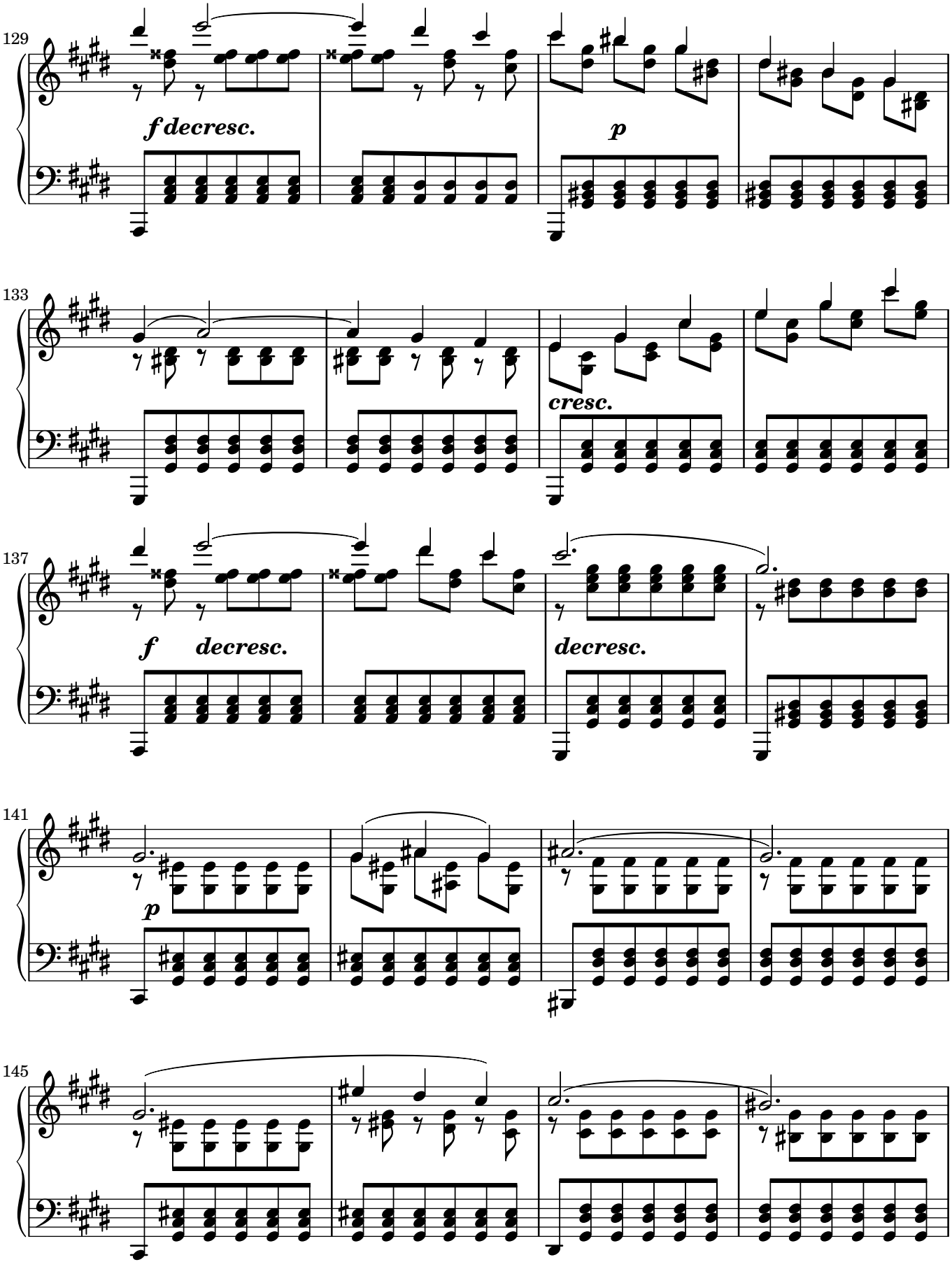



19
22
27
f decresc.
p
pp
32
35
cresc.
38
pp
41
cresc.
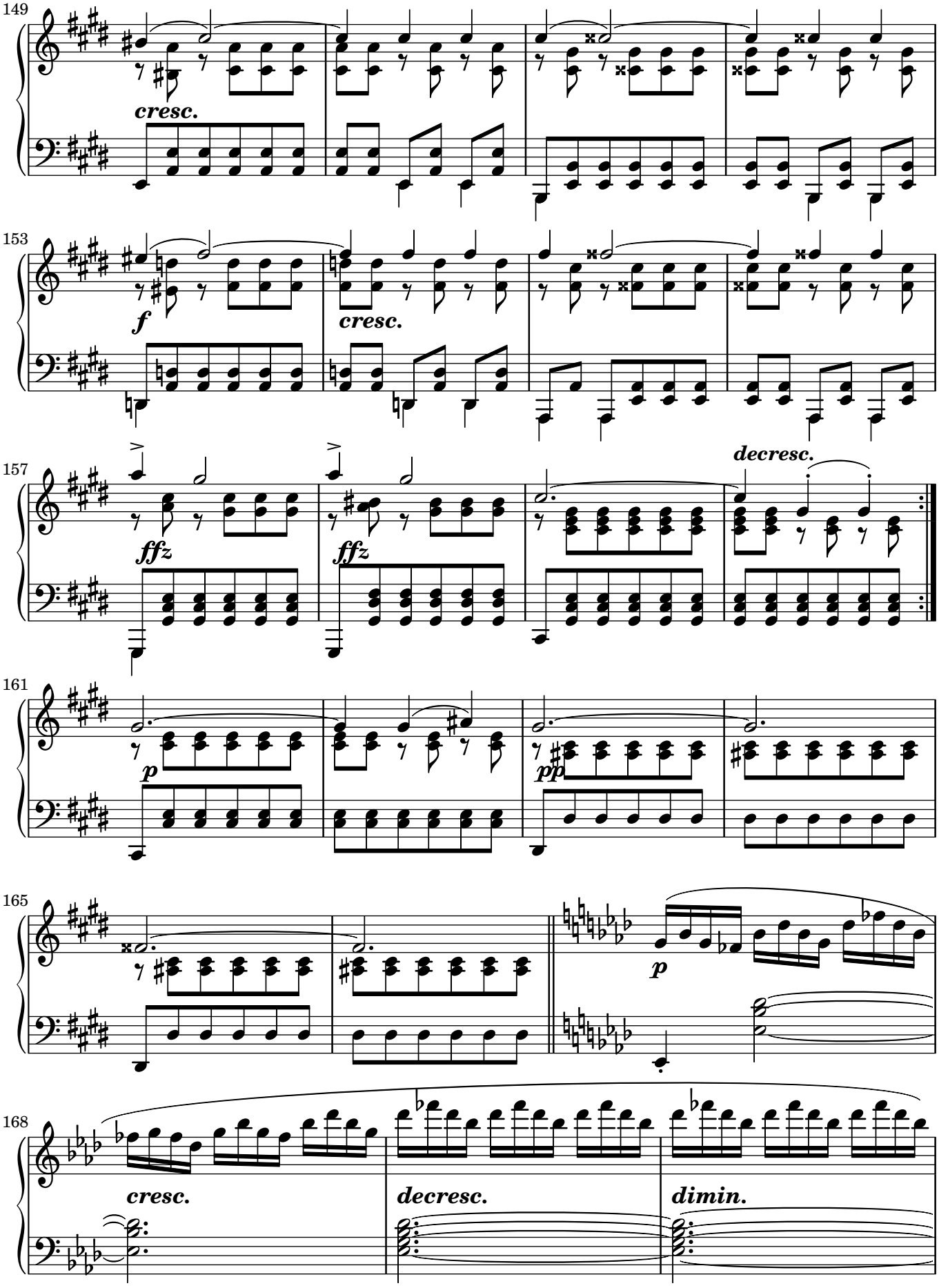

44
47
pp
50
cresc.
53
56
8
f
59
8
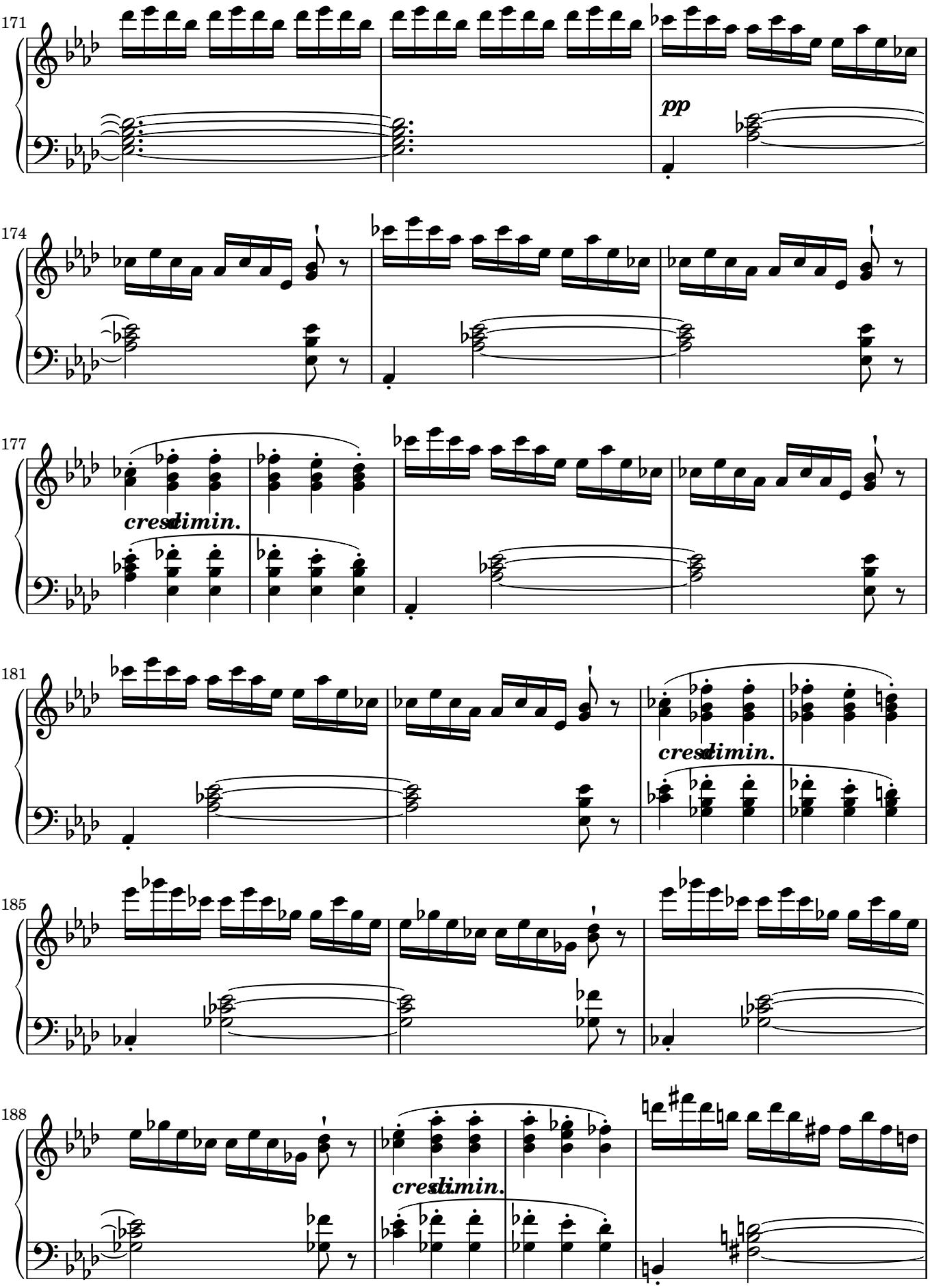

8
62
cresc.
ff
65
68
fz
fz
fz
decresc.
71
p
pp
75
79
p
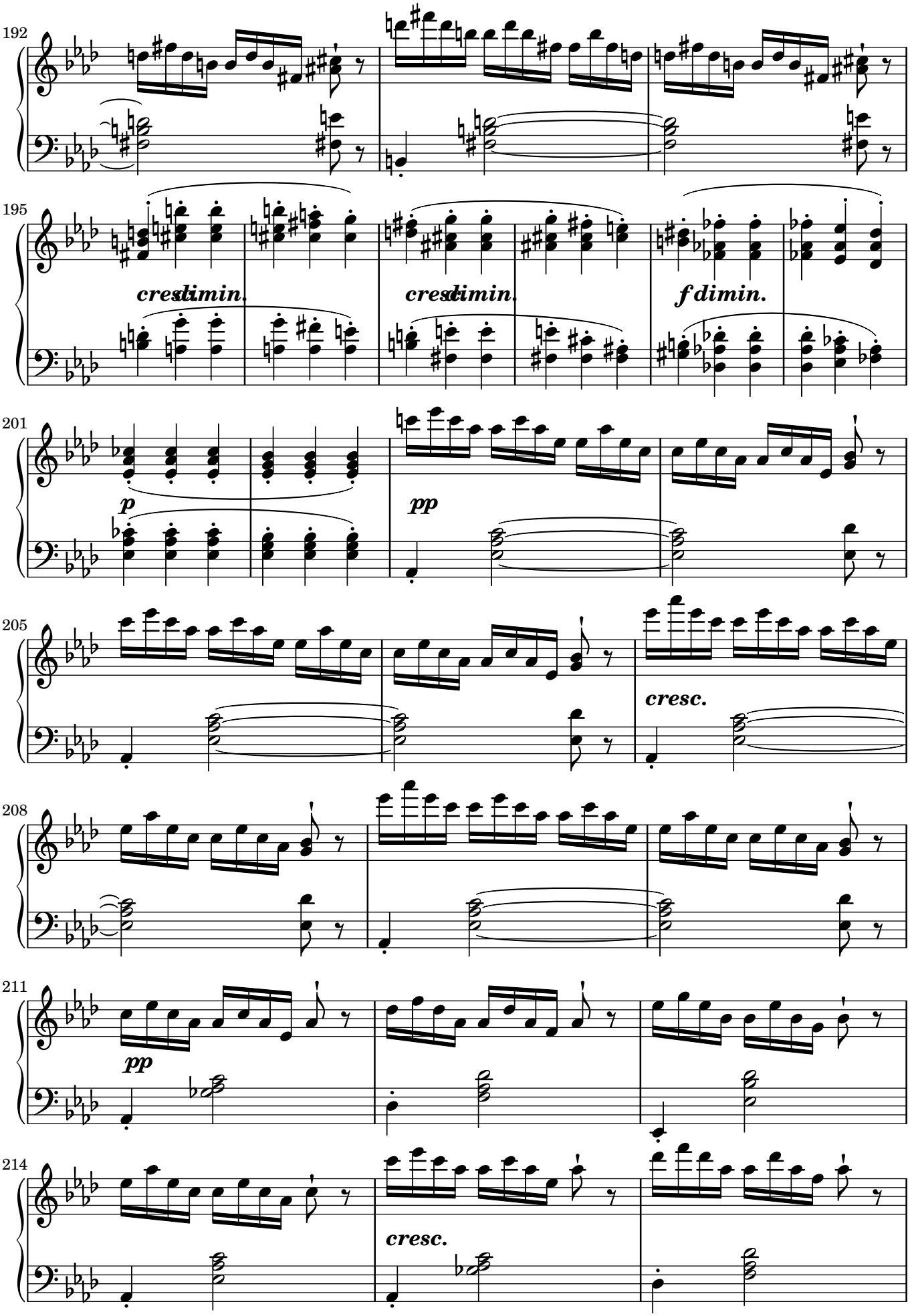

83
cres
cen
87
do
p
91
f
95
cresc.
ff
99
102
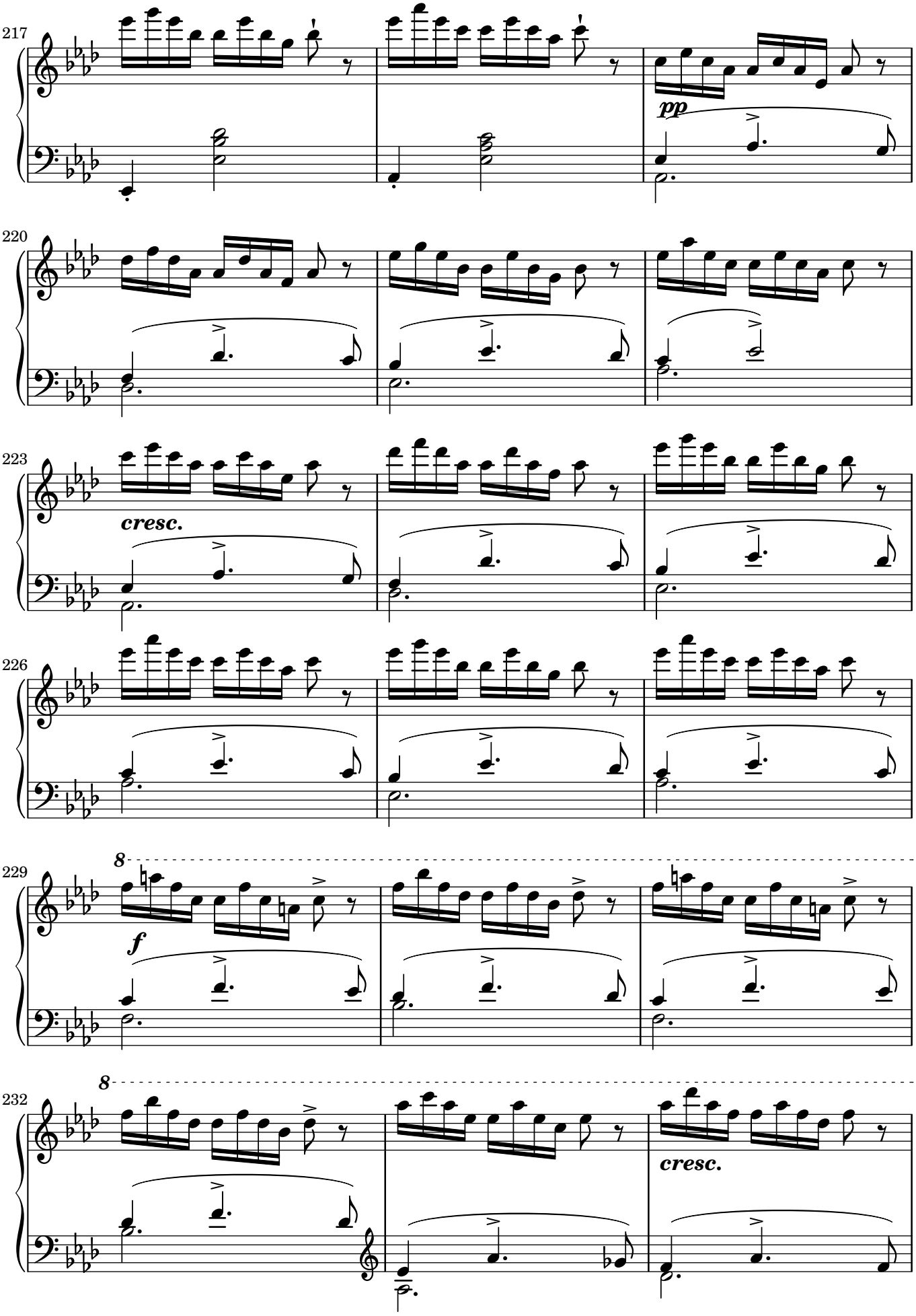

105
decresc.
Trio
p
108
113
cresc.
117
ffz
ffz
121
1
2
p
cresc.decresc.
125
cresc.
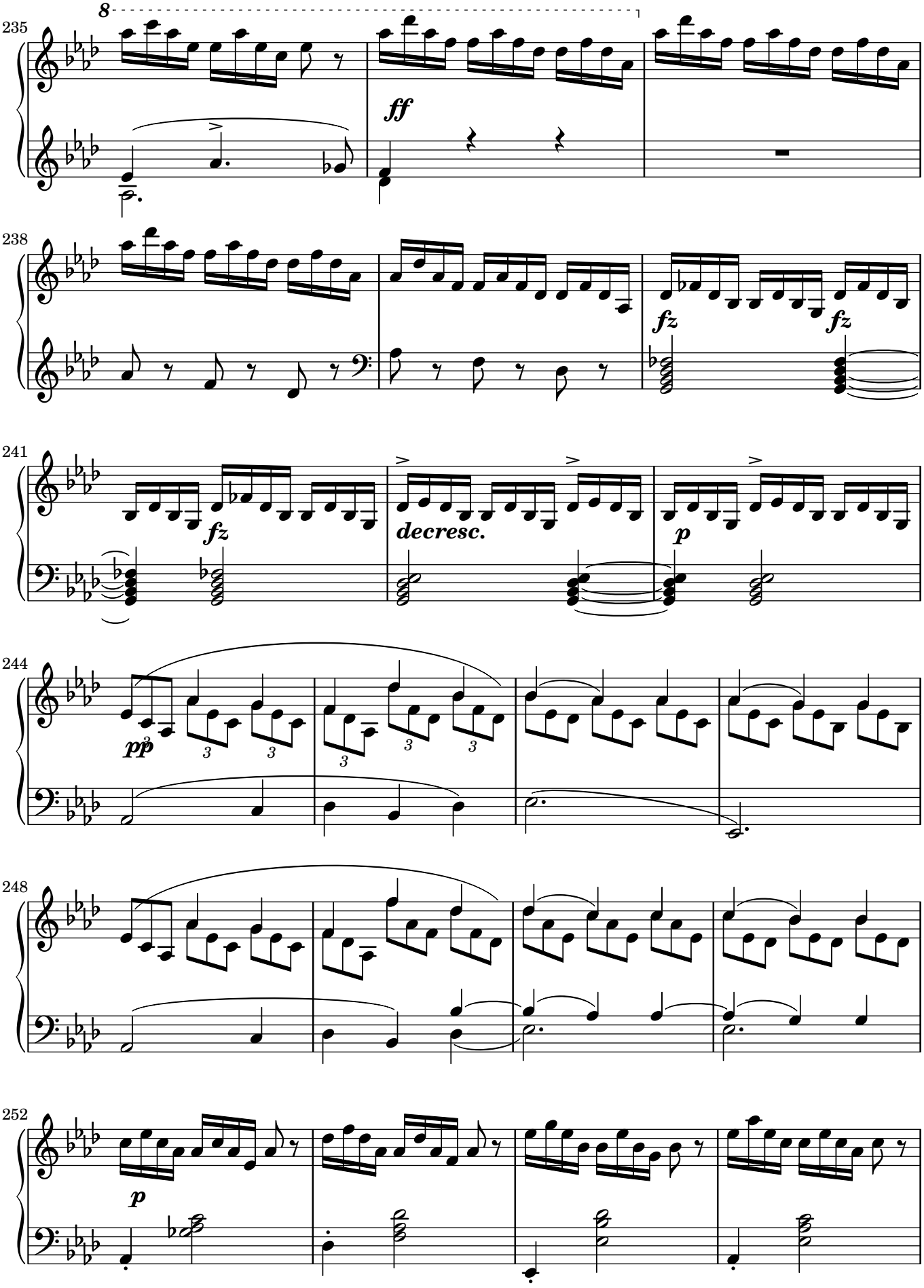

129
f decresc.
p
133
cresc.
137
f decresc.
decresc.
141
p
145
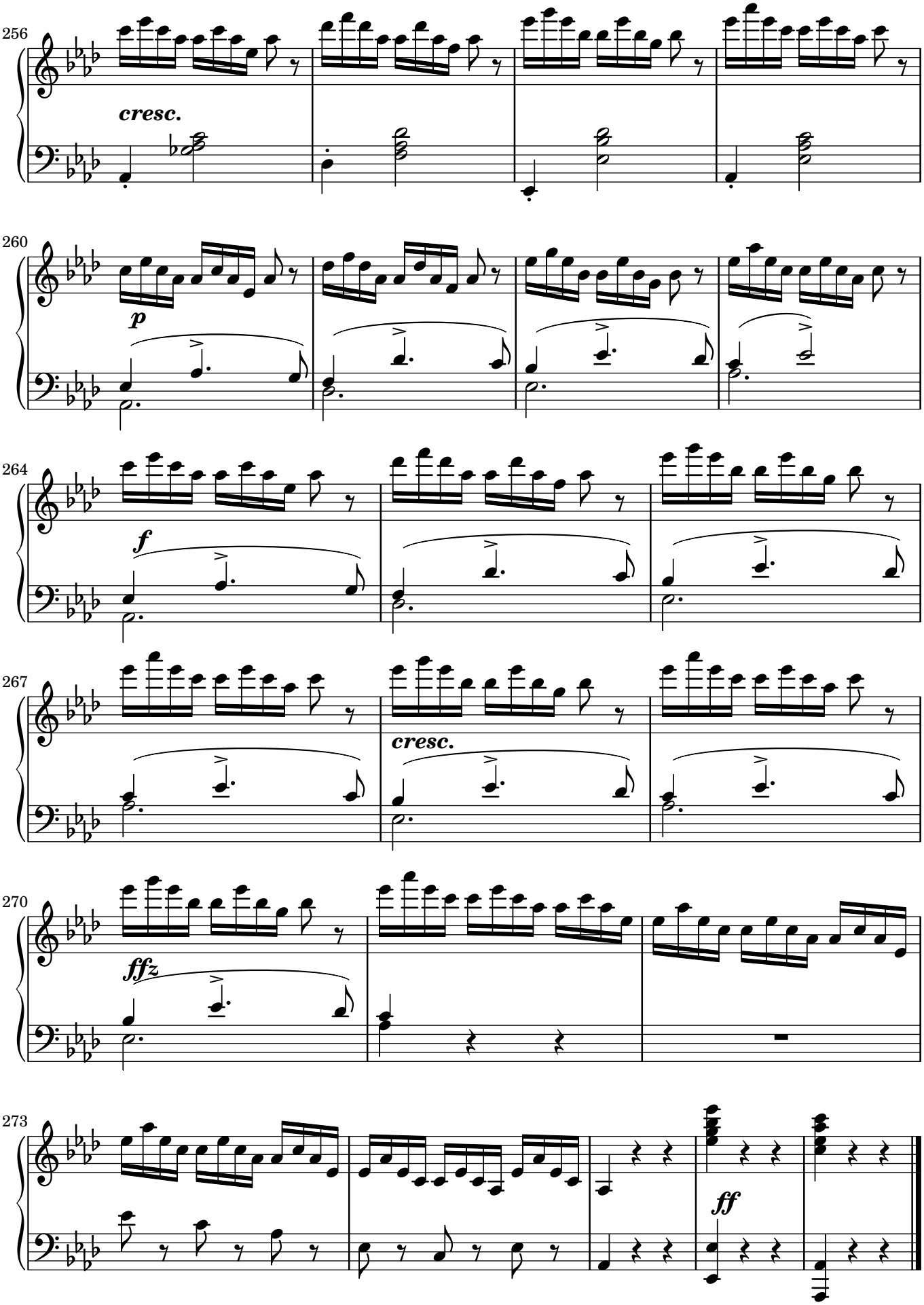

149
cresc.
153
f
cresc.
157
ffz
ffz
decresc.
161
p
pp
165
p
168
cresc.
decresc.
dimin.


171
pp
174
177
cresc.
dimin.
181
cresc.
dimin.
185
188
cresc.
dimin.


192
195
cresc.
dimin.
cresc.
dimin.
f dimin.
201
p
pp
205
cresc.
208
211
pp
214
cresc.


217
pp
220
223
cresc.
226
229
8
f
232
8
cresc.


235
8
ff
238
fz
fz
241
fz
decresc.
p
244
pp
248
252
p


256
cresc.
260
p
264
f
267
cresc.
270
ffz
273
ff
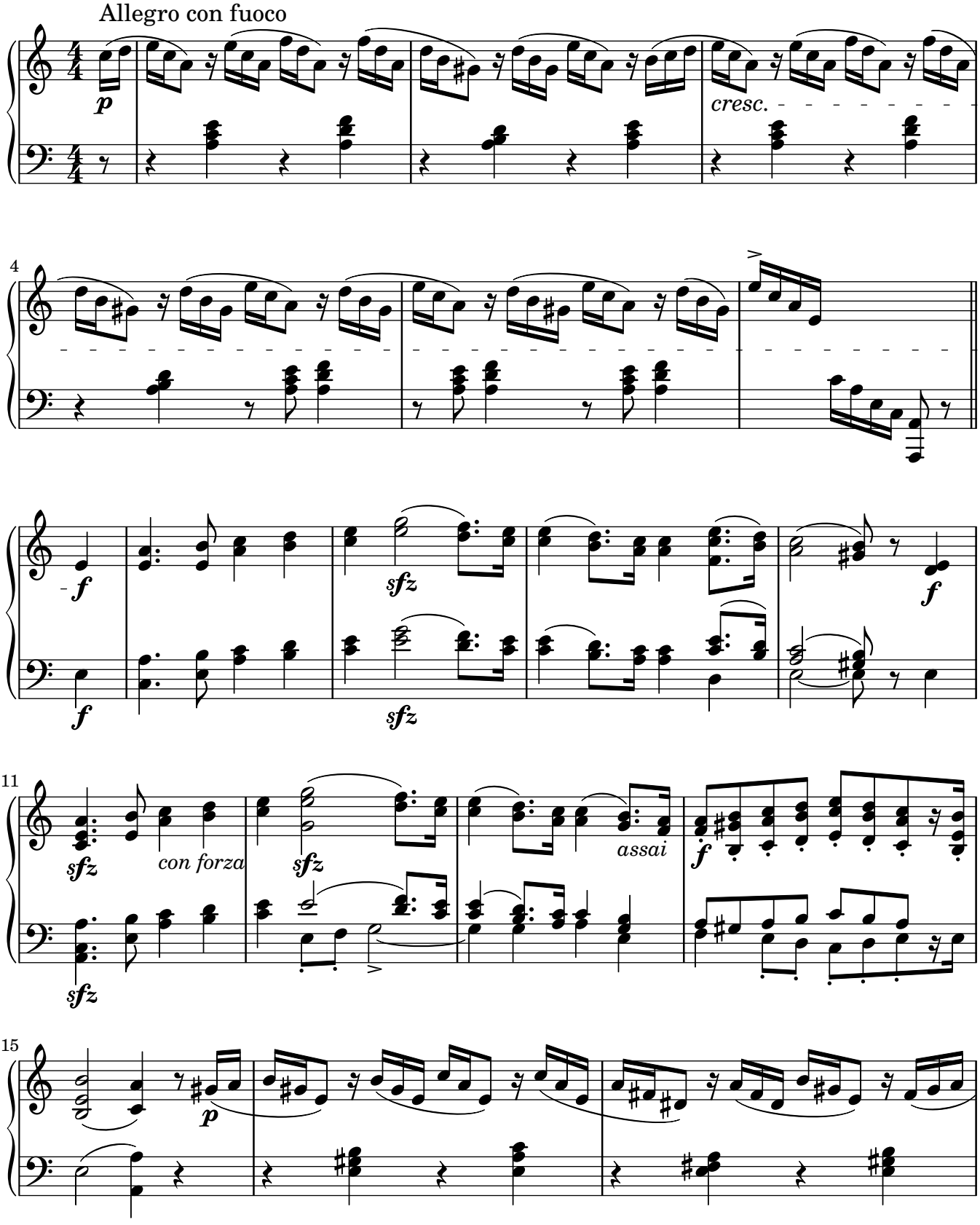
Folk Song in A minor, Op. 53 No. 5
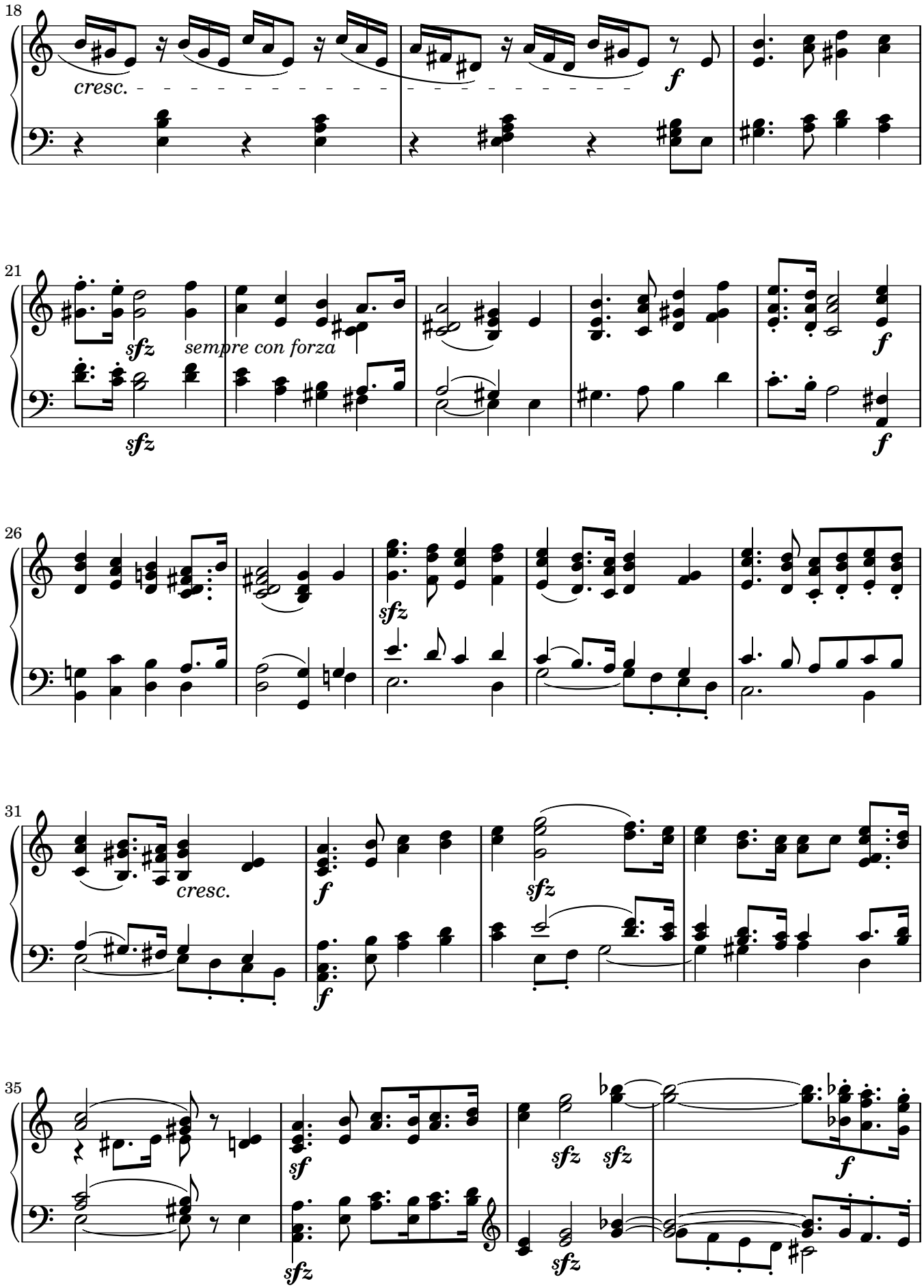
F. Mendelssohn (1809-1847) - Songs without Words, Book 5 (1841)
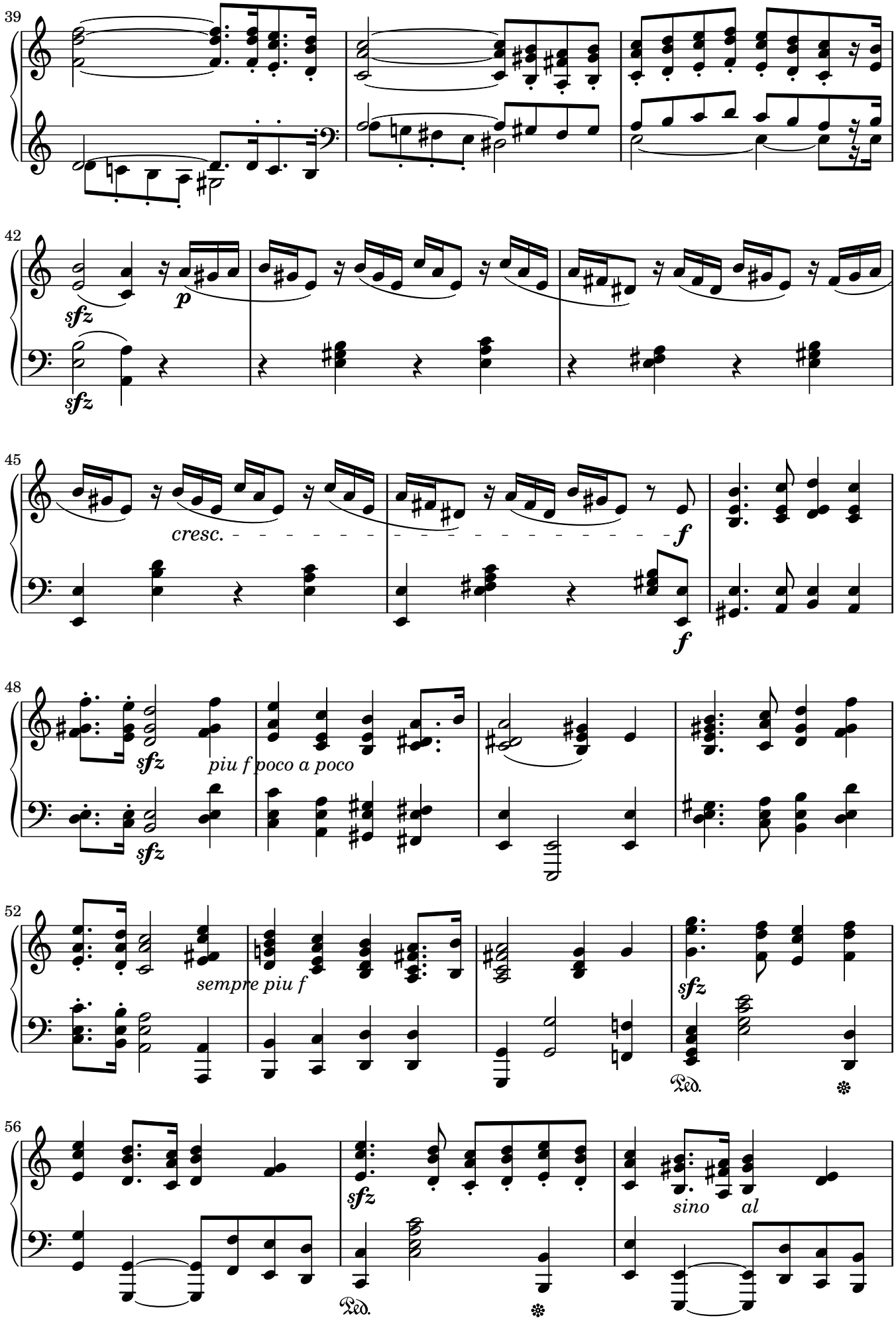
Level 9 · about 3 min
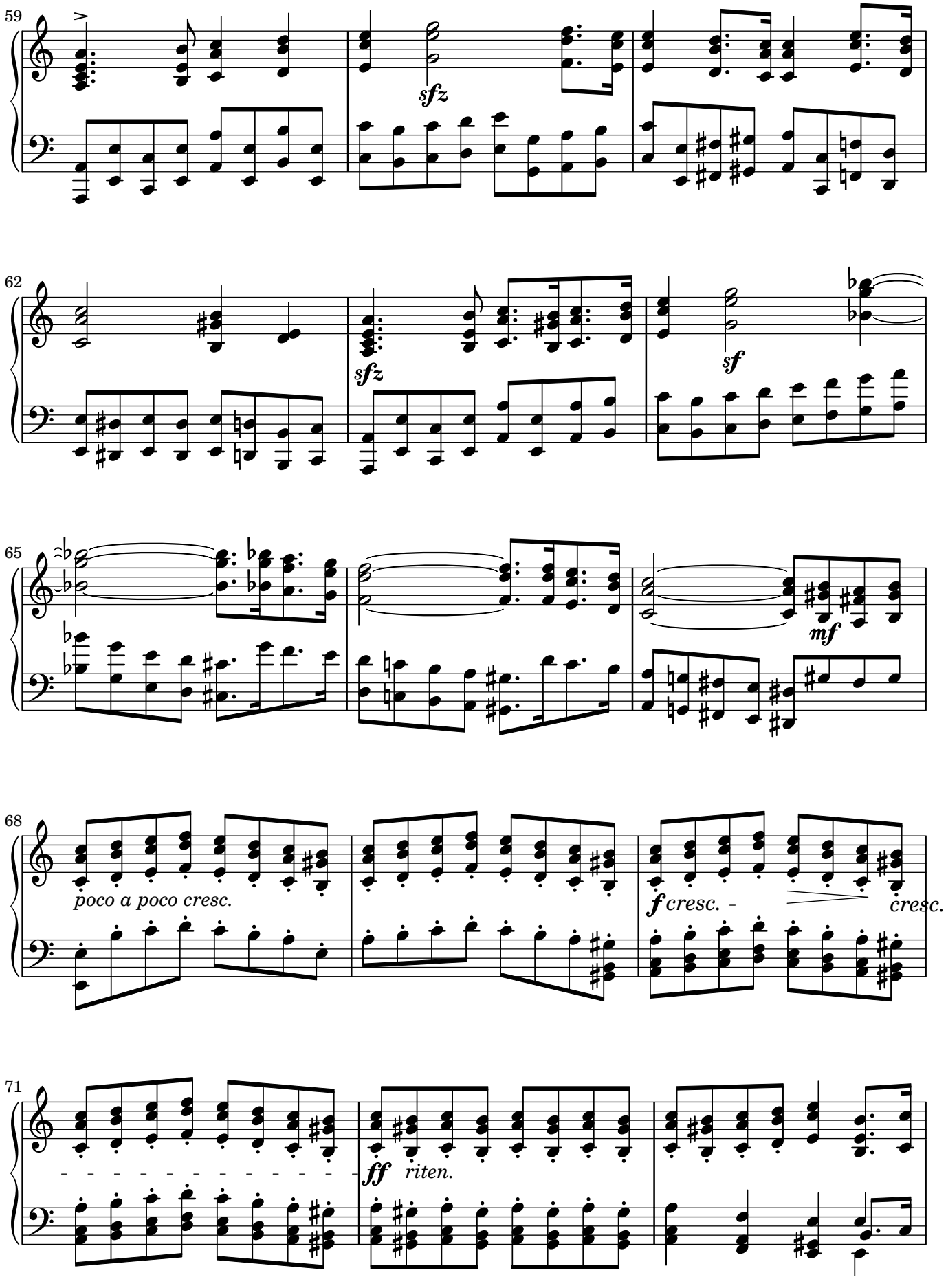
A song like a folk melody in octaves and full chords over a marching bass. Voice the chords to the top and keep the march steady as the music grows louder.
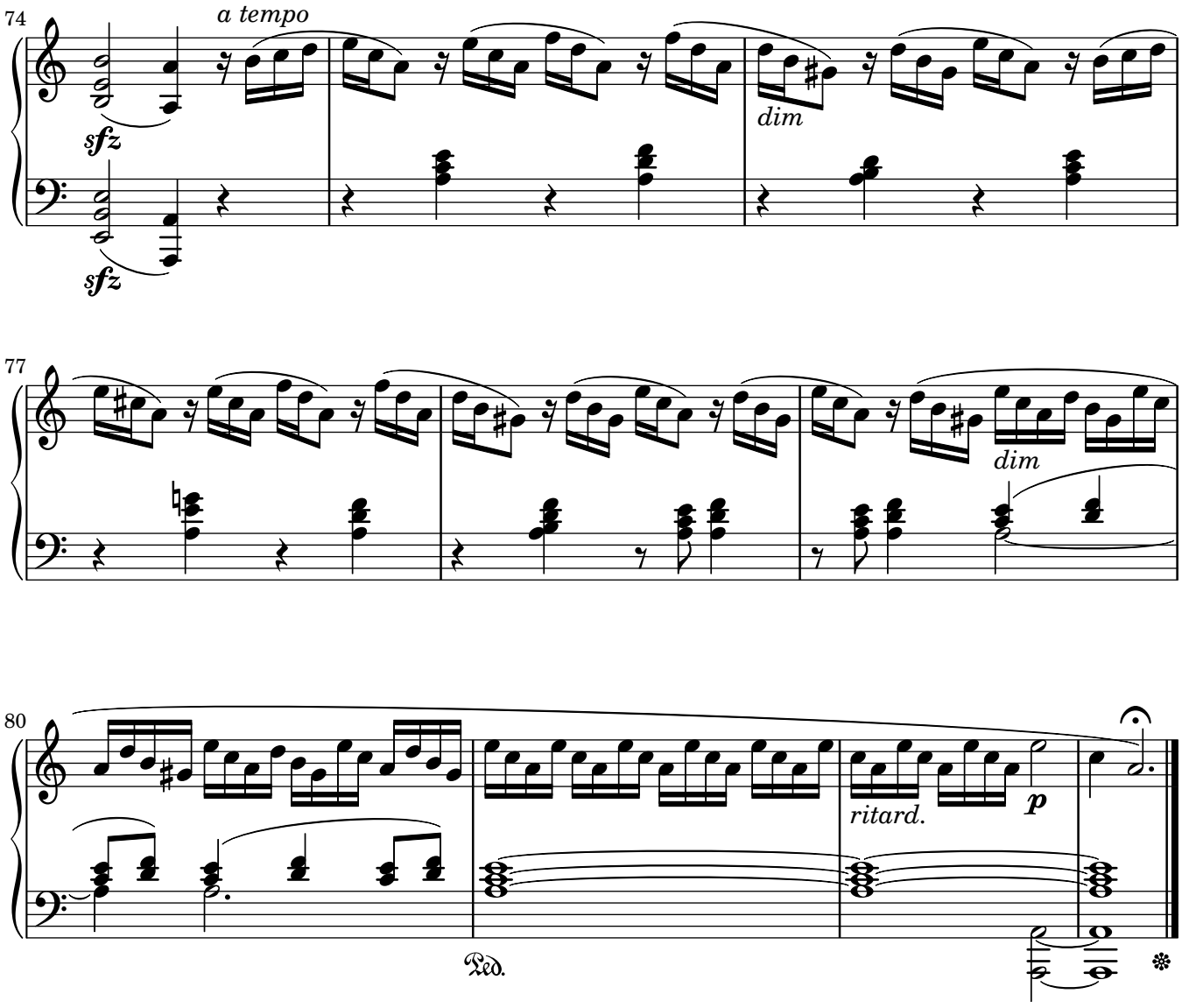
Source: Mutopia Project no. 592, typeset by Stelios Samelis (public domain).




18
cresc.
f
21
sfz
sempre con forza
sfz
f
f
26
sfz
31
cresc.
f
f
sfz
35
sf
sfz
sfz
sfz
f
sfz


39
42
sfz
p
sfz
45
cresc.
f
f
48
sfz
piu f poco a poco
sfz
52
sempre piu f
sfz
Ped.
56
sfz
sino al
Ped.


59
sfz
62
sfz
sf
65
mf
68
poco a poco cresc.
f cresc.
cresc.
71
ff
riten.


74
a tempo
sfz
sfz
dim
77
dim
80
ritard.
p
Ped.
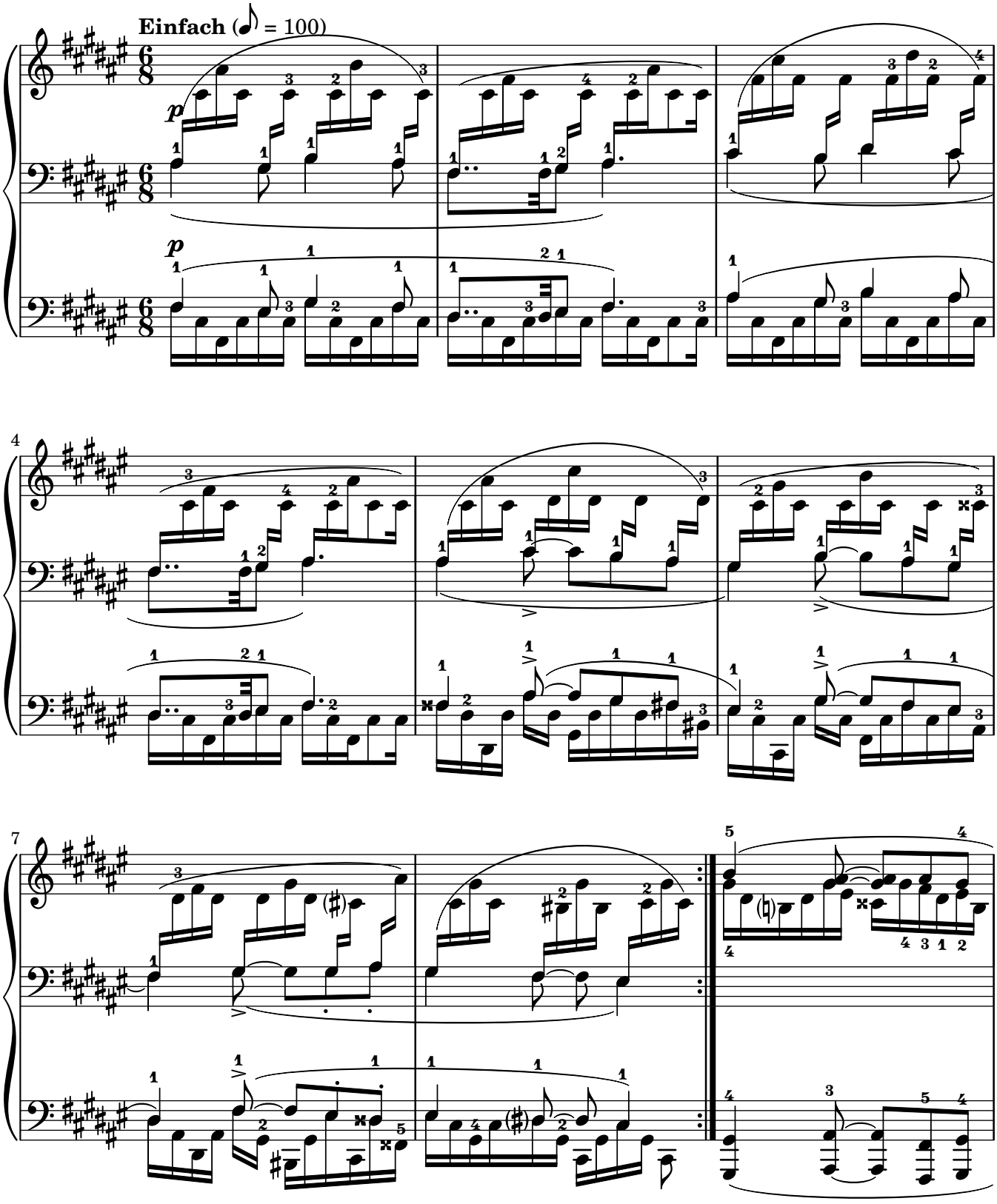
Romance in F-sharp, Op. 28 No. 2
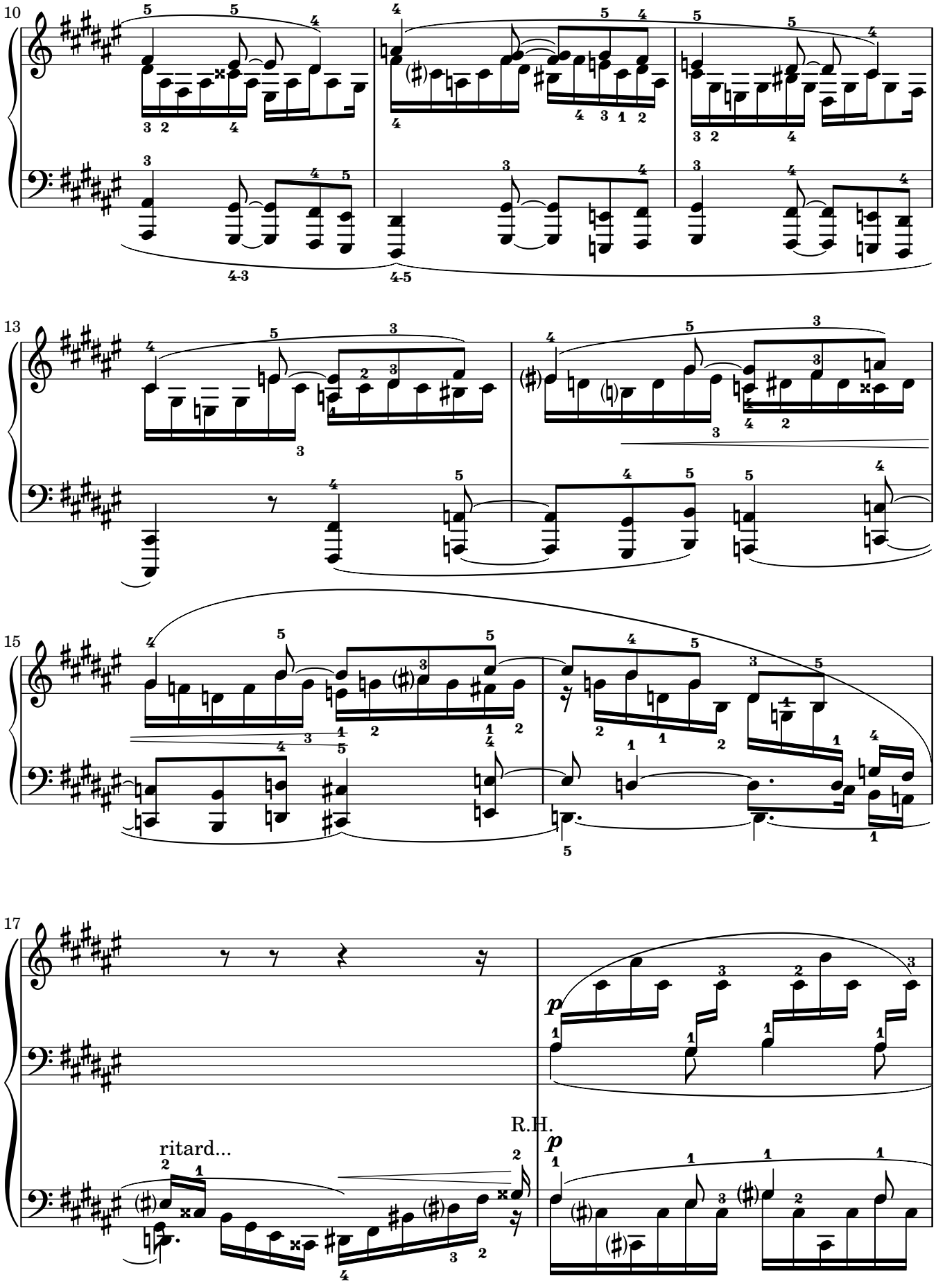
R. Schumann (1810-1856) - Three Romances (1839)
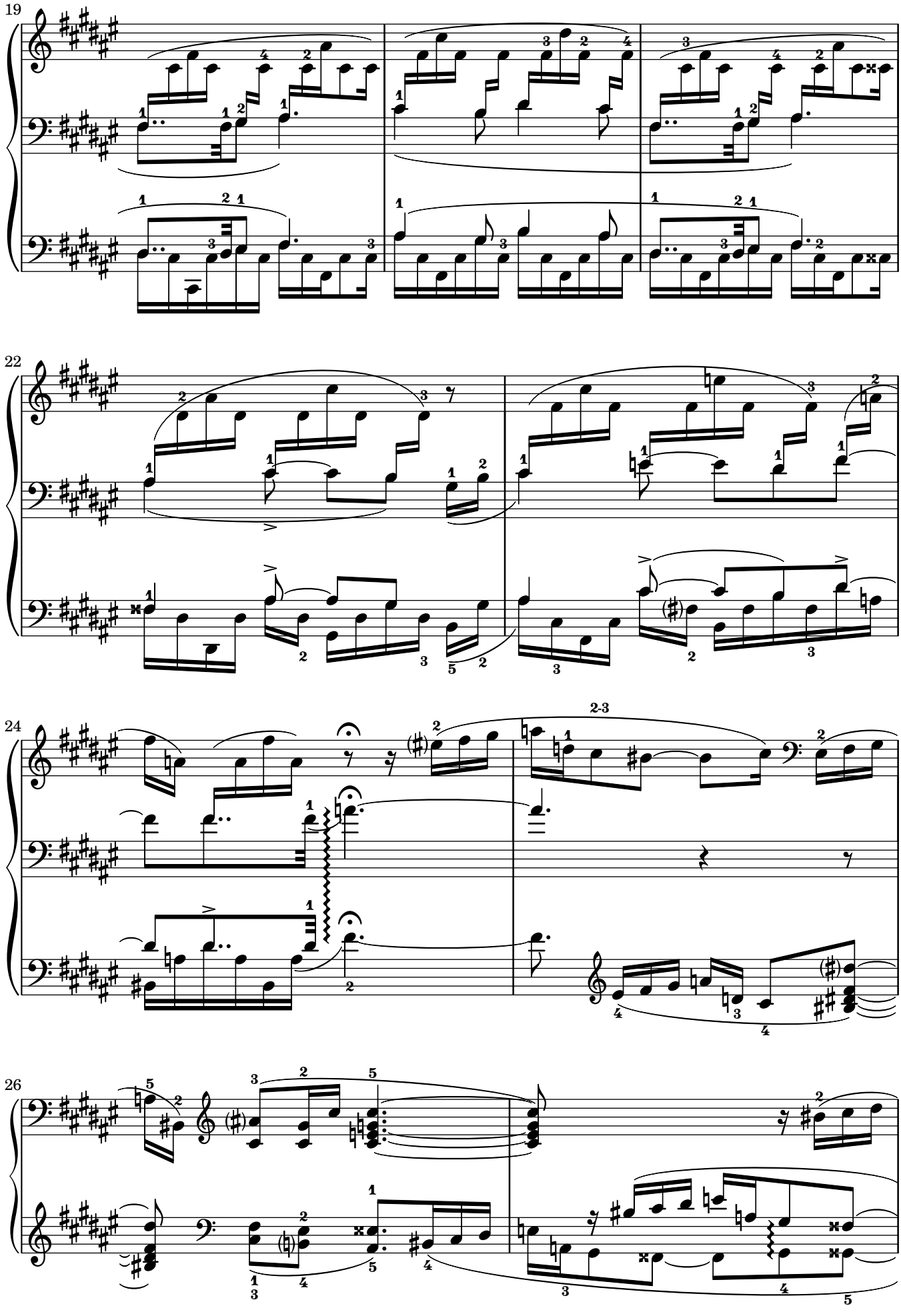
Level 9 · about 4 min
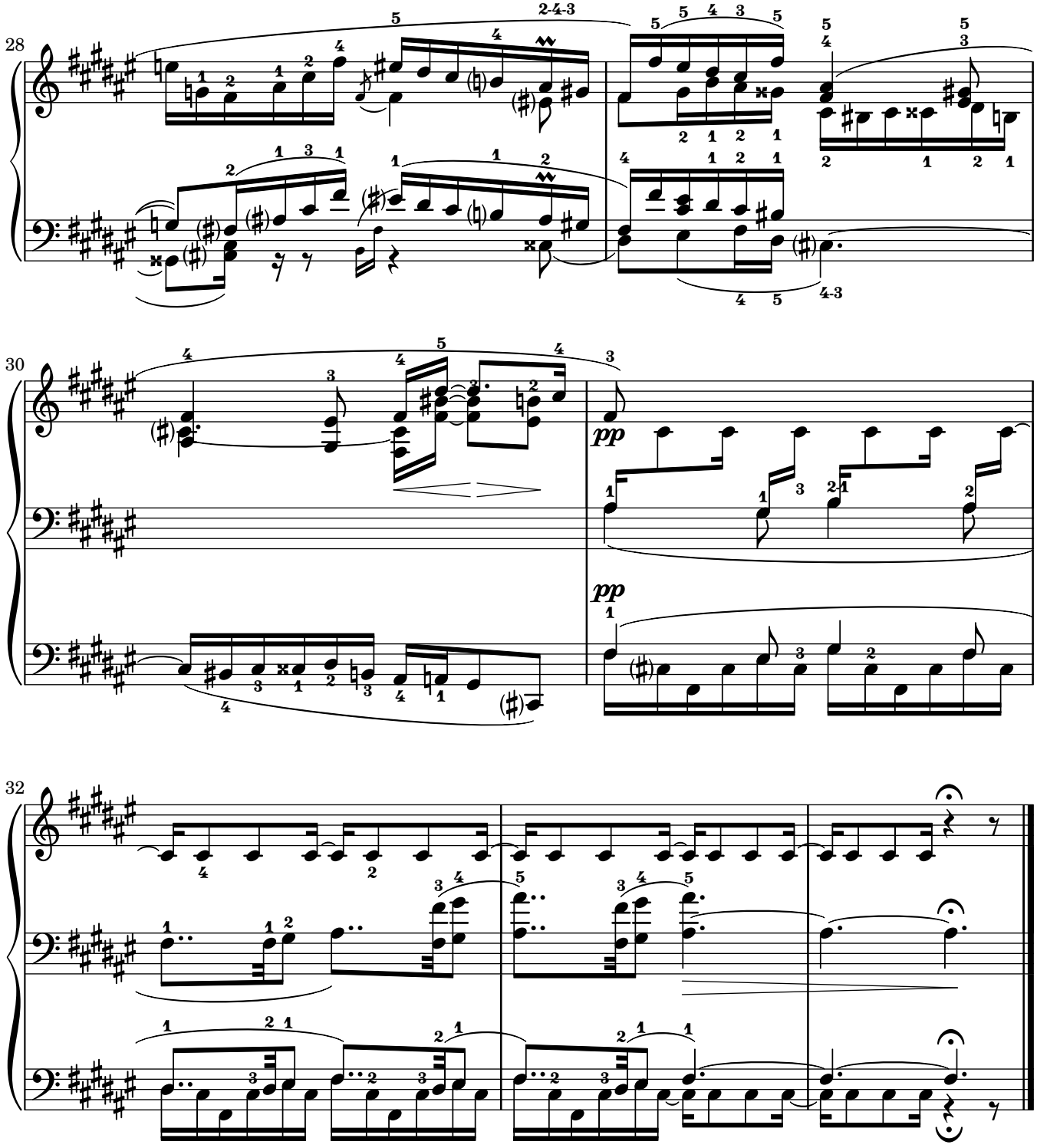
A duet: the melody in thirds and sixths is shared between the thumbs of both hands in the middle of the keyboard, surrounded by soft broken chords. Find which notes are melody before anything else, and bring them out.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 314, typeset by rune@zedeler.dk (public domain).




10
13
15
17
ritard...
R.H.
p
p


19
22
24
2-3
26


28
30
32
pp
pp
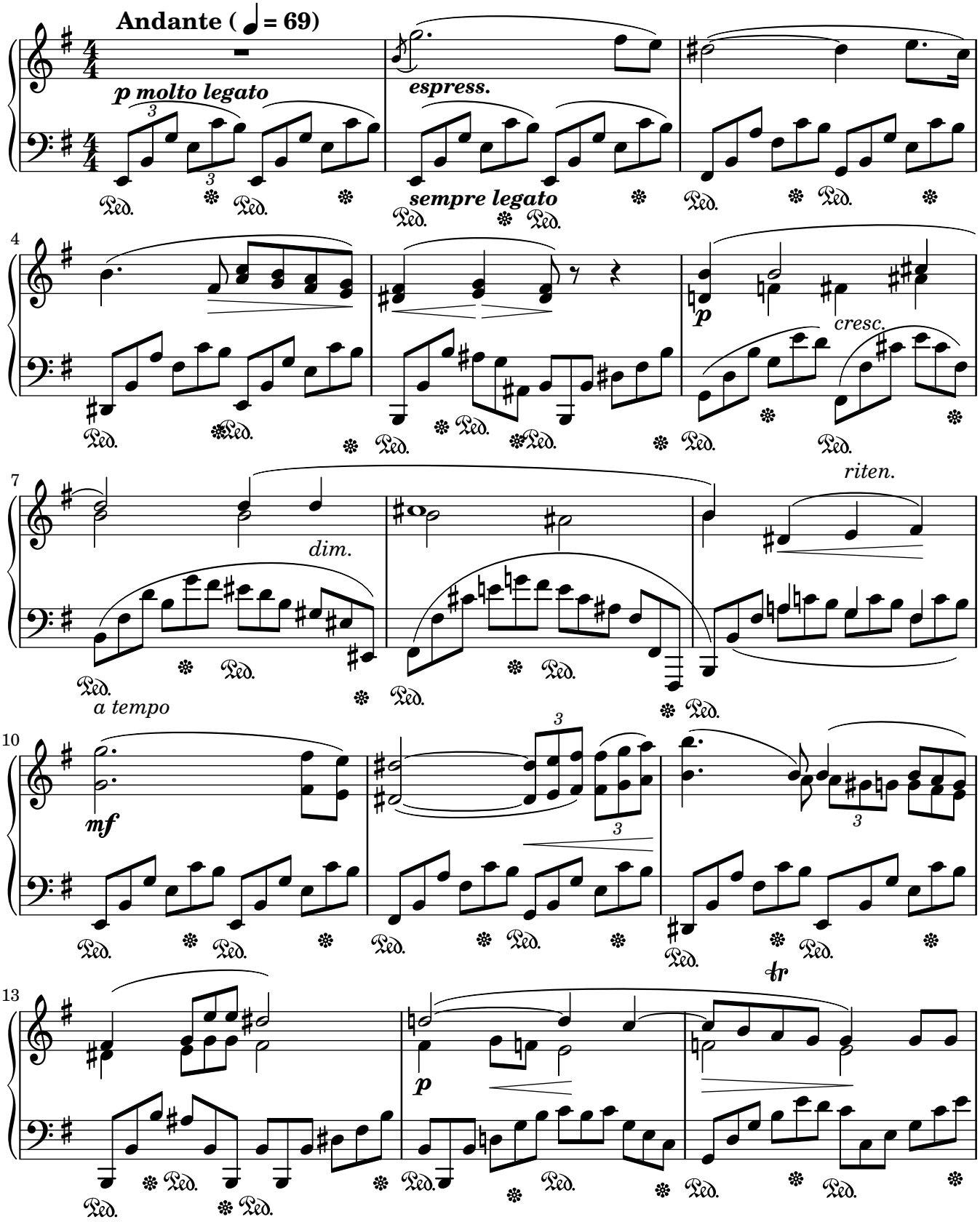
Nocturne in E minor, Op. 72 No. 1
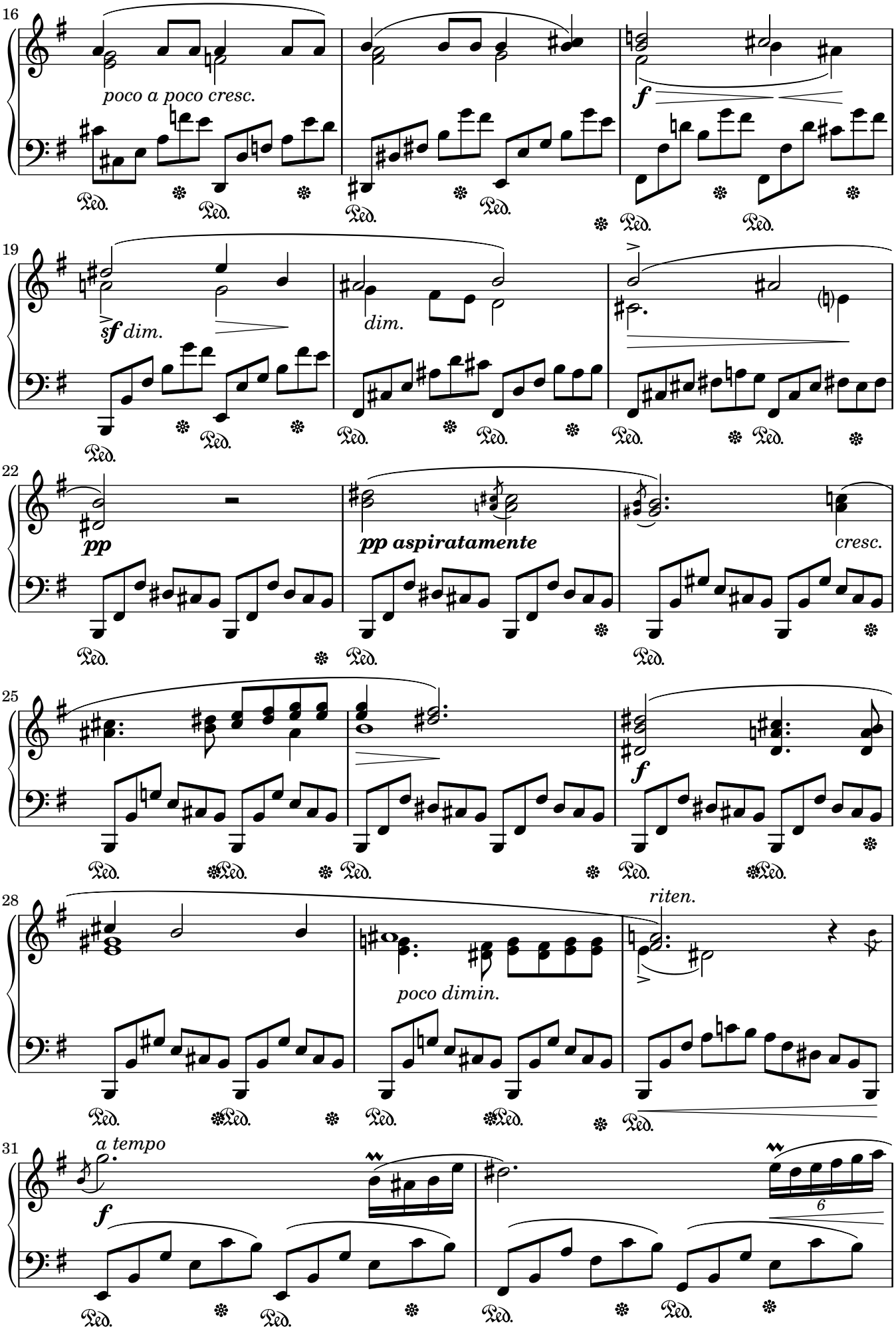
F. Chopin (1810-1849) - Published posthumously (1855)
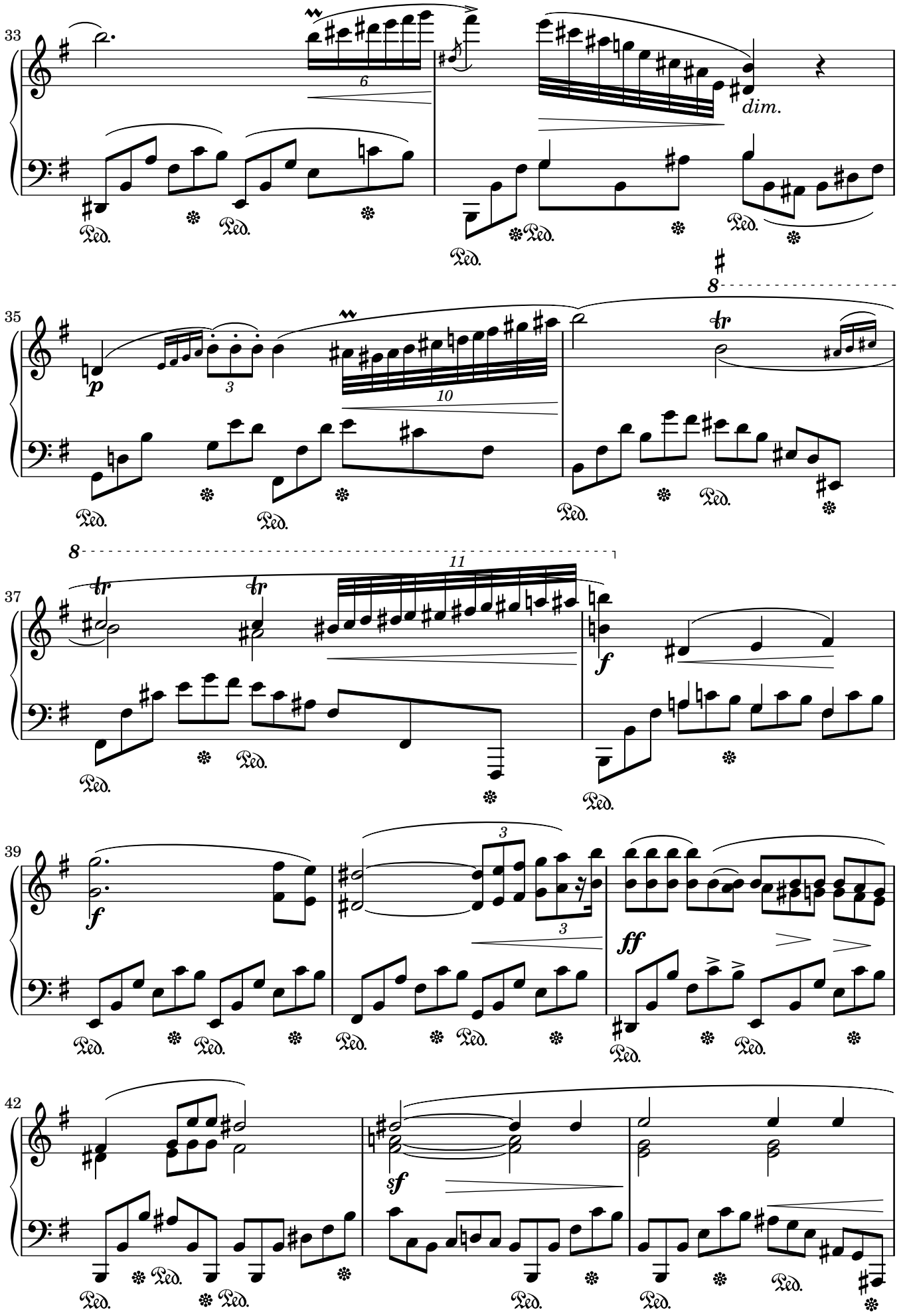
Level 9 · about 4 min
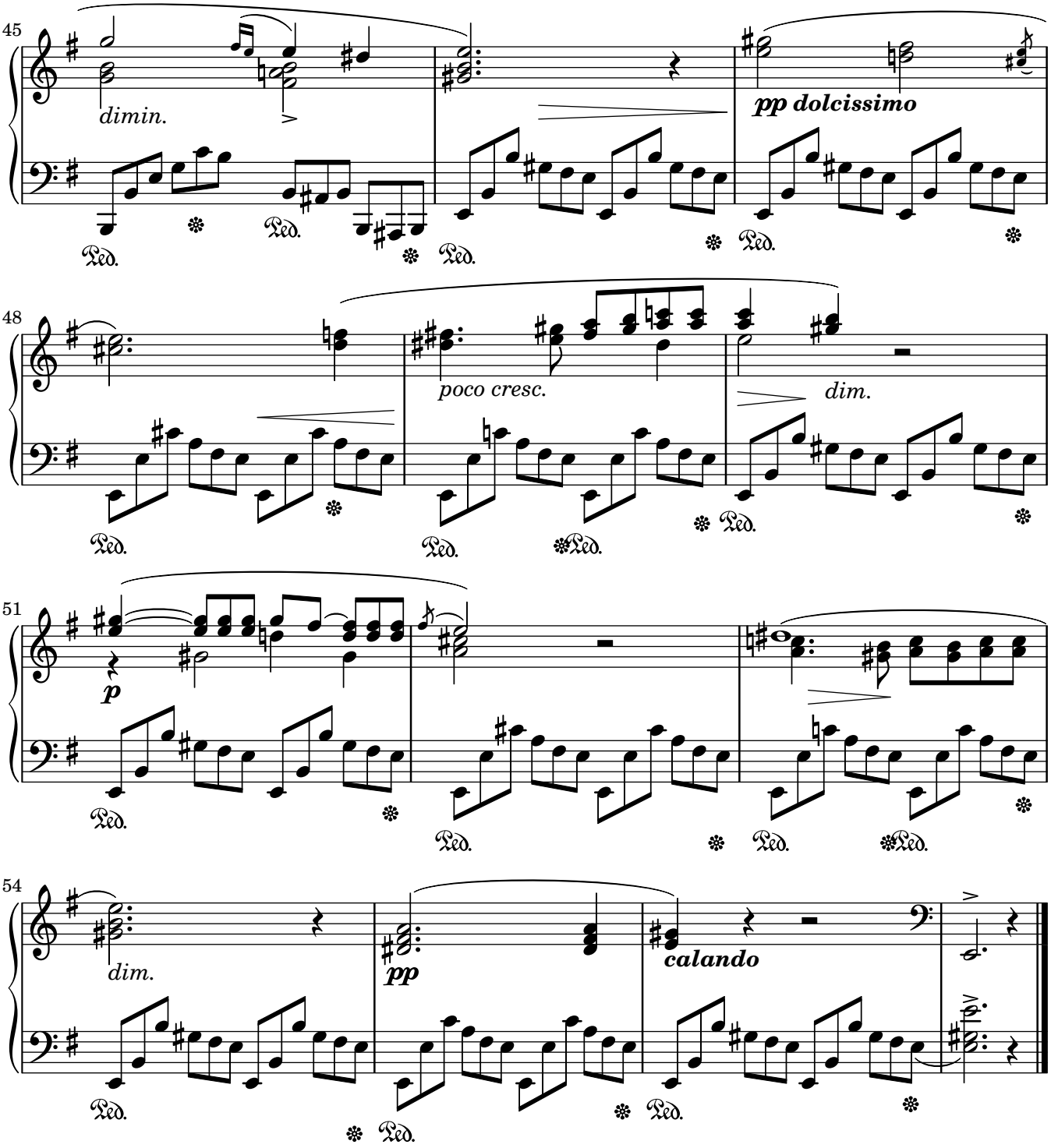
One of Chopin's earliest nocturnes, published after his death. The left hand's wide arpeggios, spanning more than an octave, carry the whole piece; practise them alone with the pedal until they are smooth, then add the singing melody, including its later two-voice passages.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 509, typeset by Benjamin D. Esham (CC BY-SA 4.0).




16
poco a poco cresc.
f
19
sf dim.
dim.
22
pp
pp aspiratamente
cresc.
25
f
28
poco dimin.
riten.
31
a tempo
f
6


33
6
dim.
Ped.
35
p
3
10
8
tr
37
11
f
39
ff
42
sf


45
dimin.
pp dolcissimo
48
poco cresc.
dim.
51
p
54
dim.
pp
calando
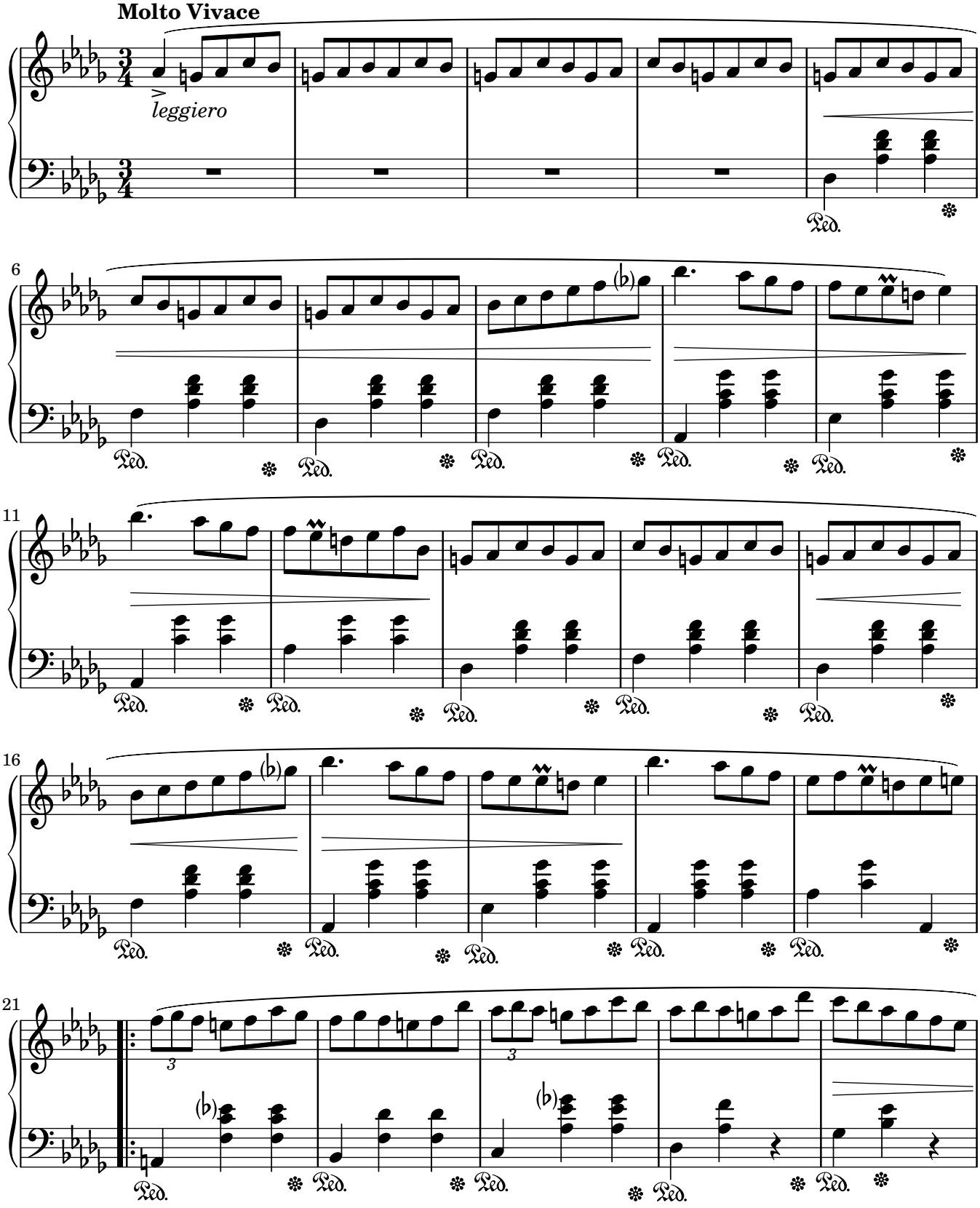
Waltz in D-flat 'Minute', Op. 64 No. 1
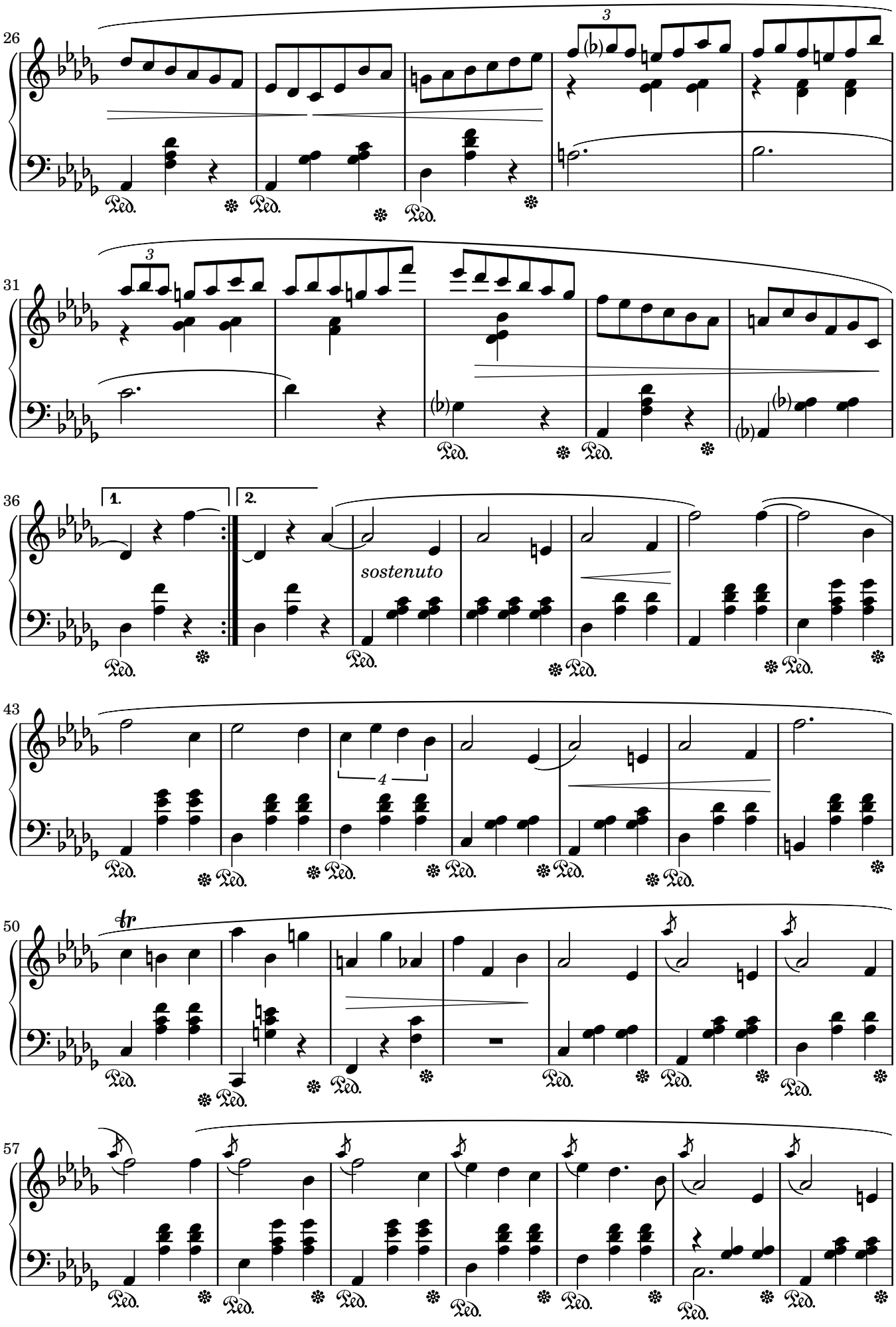
F. Chopin (1810-1849) - Three Waltzes, Op. 64 (1847)
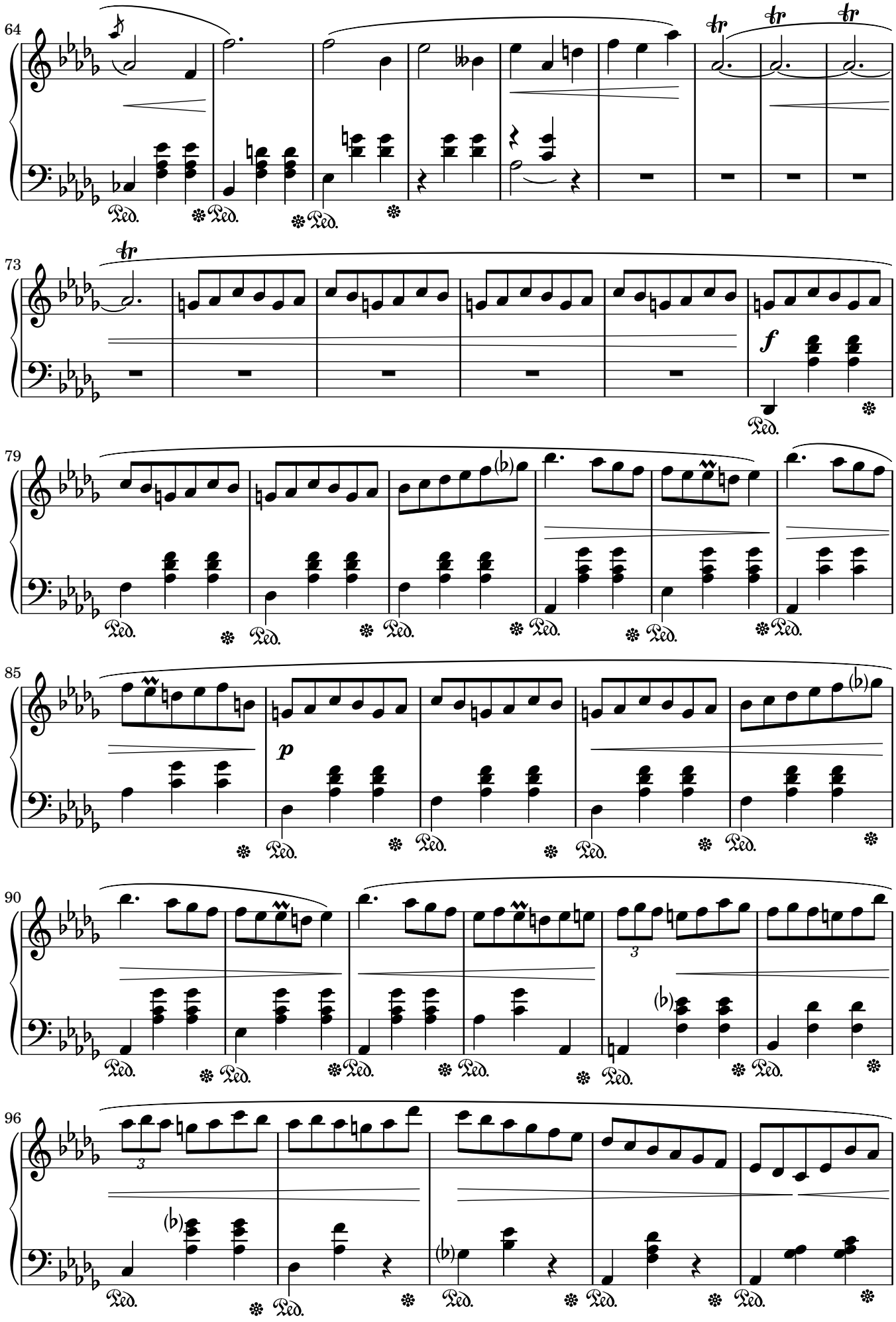
Level 9 · about 2 min
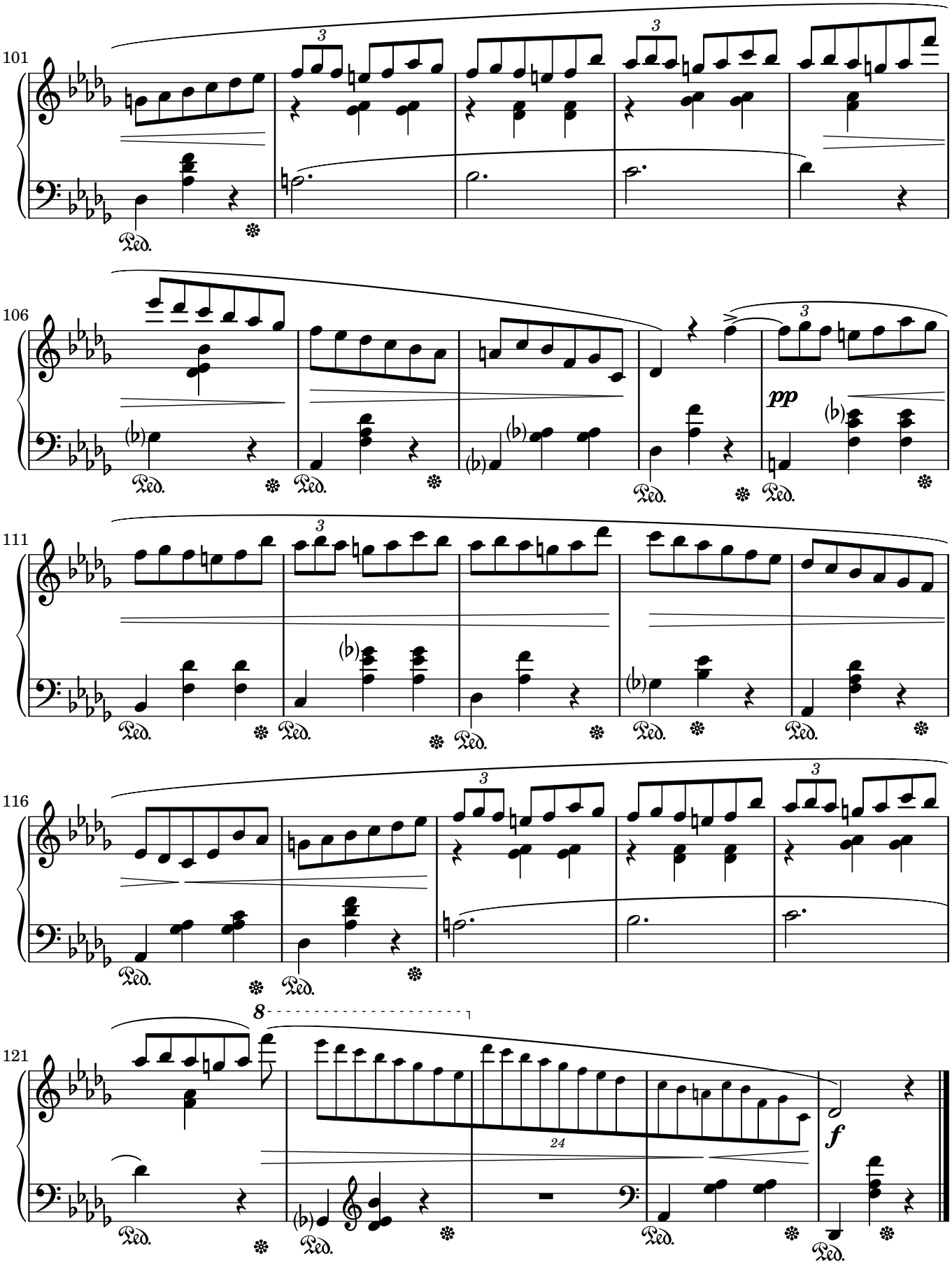
The 'Little Dog' waltz (Chopin's companion George Sand said it showed her dog chasing its tail); 'Minute' means small, not sixty seconds. Light, even right-hand runs over a steady waltz bass; the middle section is slower and singing.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 483, typeset by Magnus Lewis-Smith (public domain).




26
31
36
1.
2.
sostenuto
43
50
tr
57


64
73
79
85
90
96
Ped.
f
p


101
106
111
116
121
pp
f
8
24
Ped.
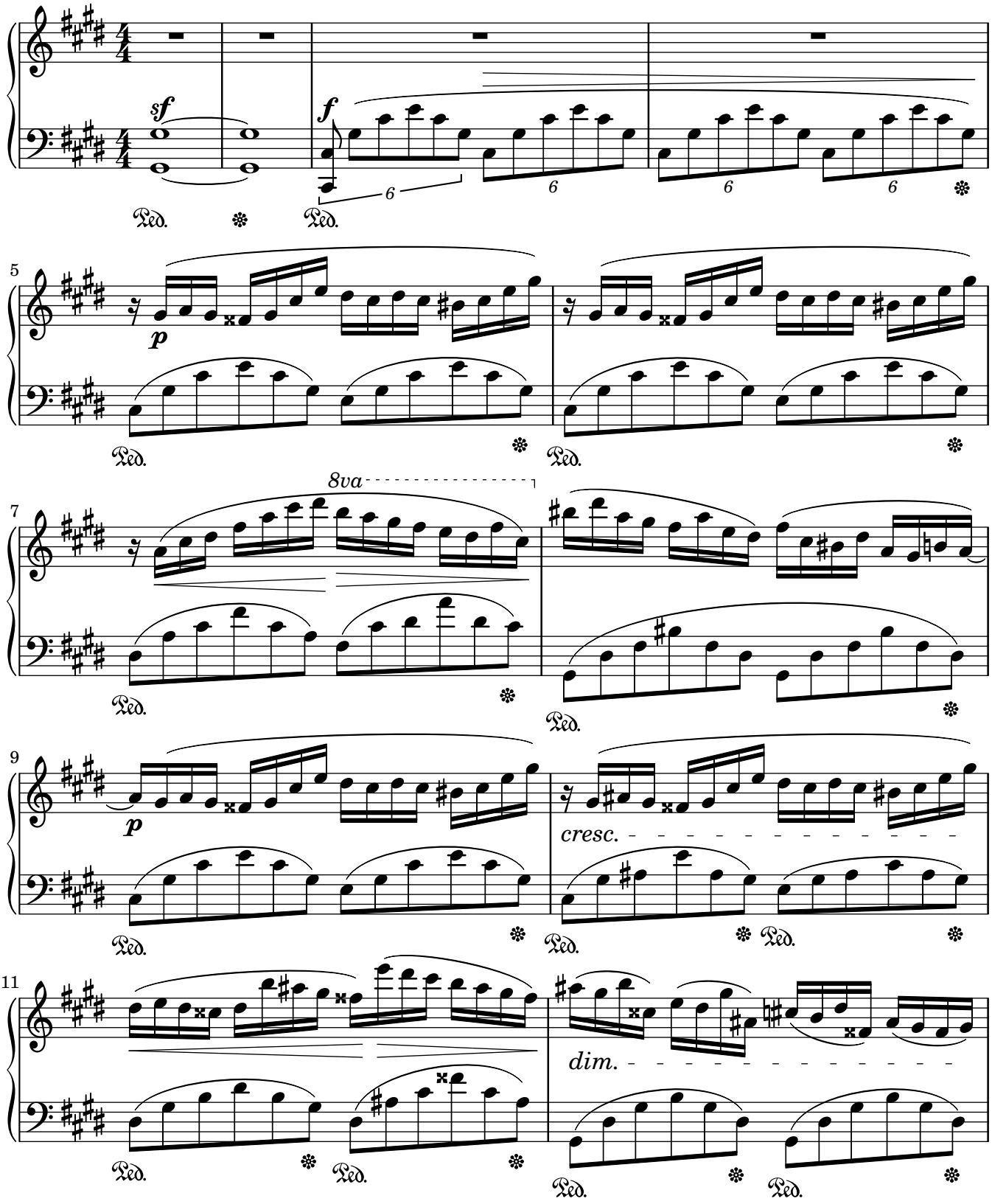
Fantaisie-Impromptu, Op. 66
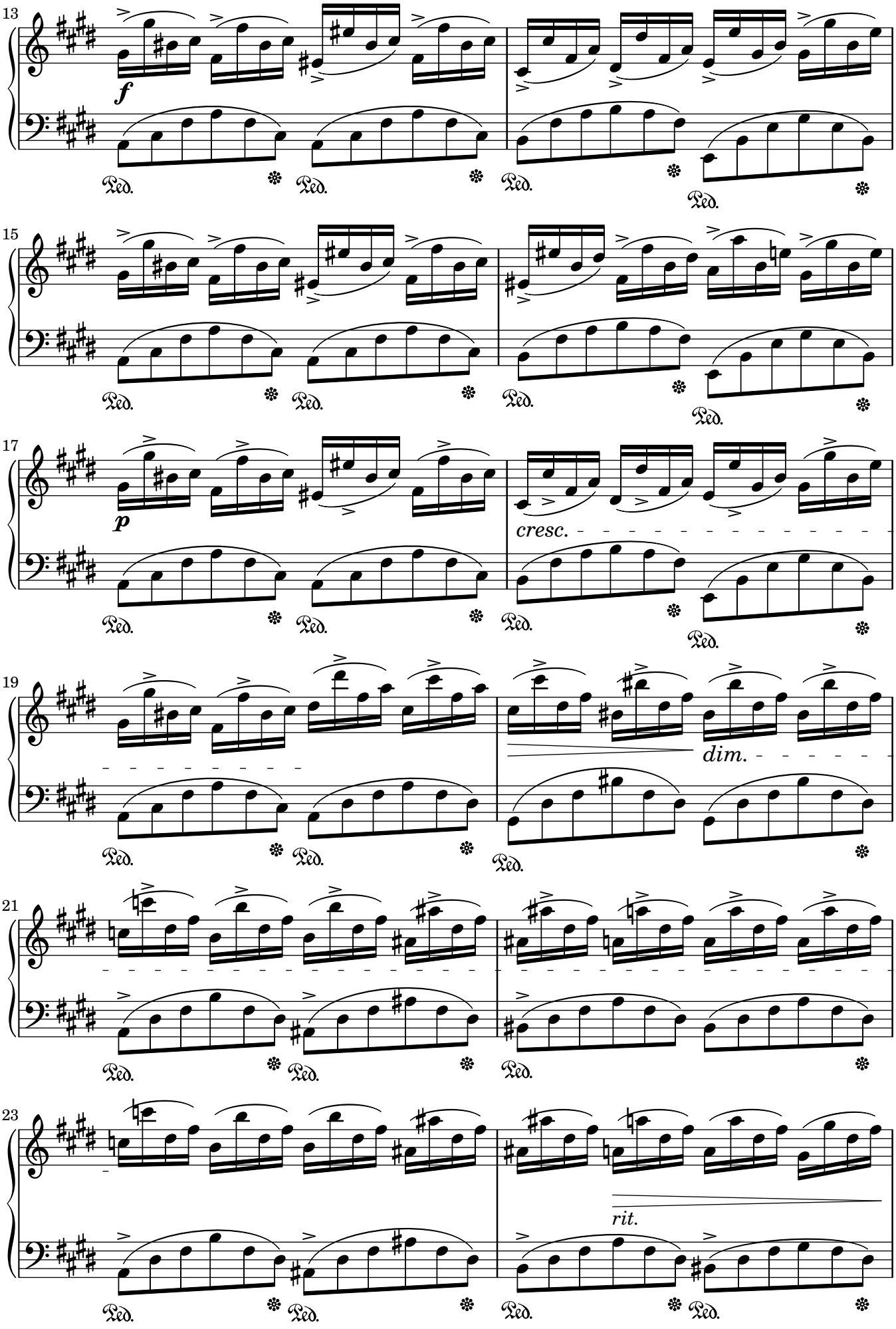
F. Chopin (1810-1849) - Published posthumously (1855)
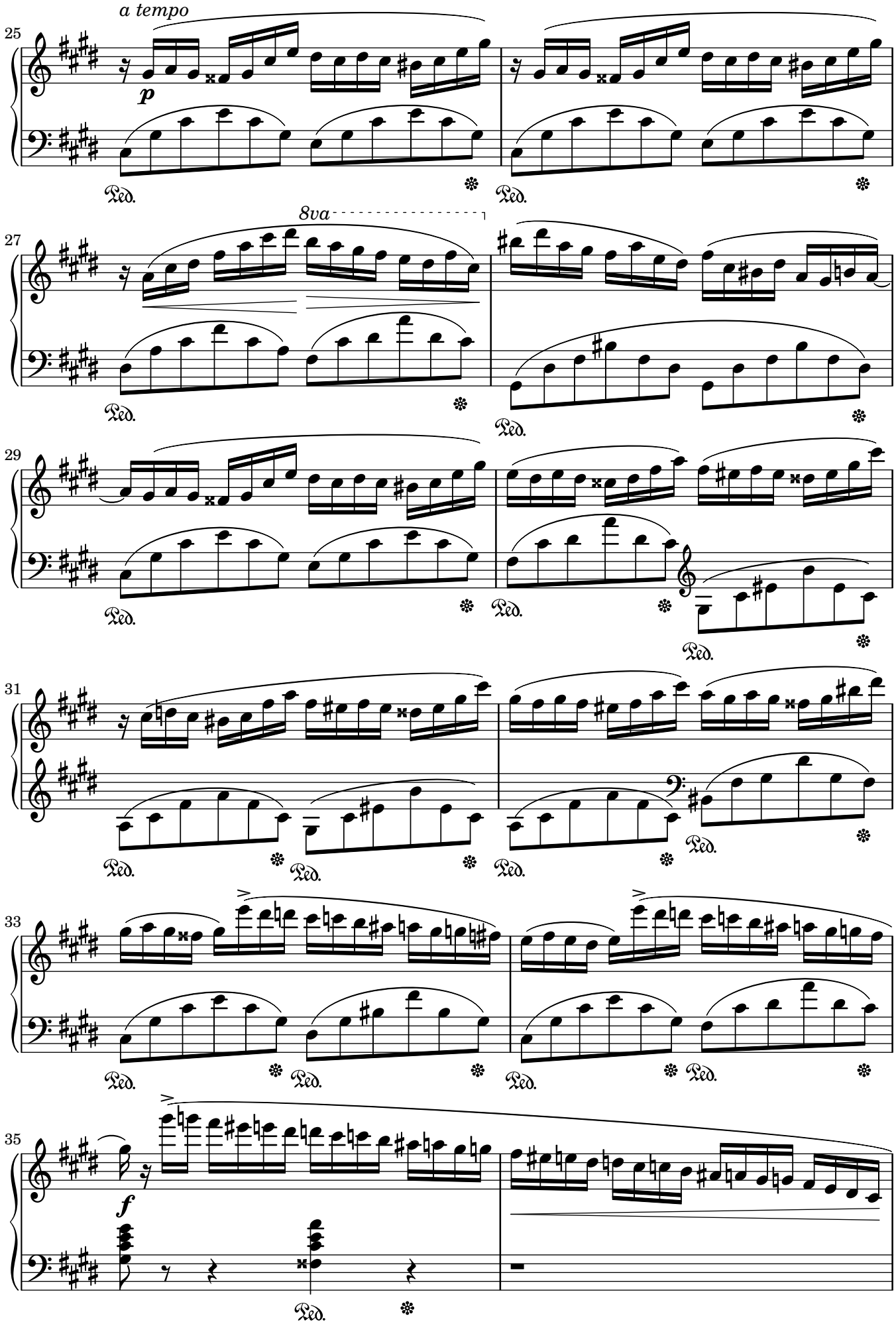
Level 10 · about 5 min

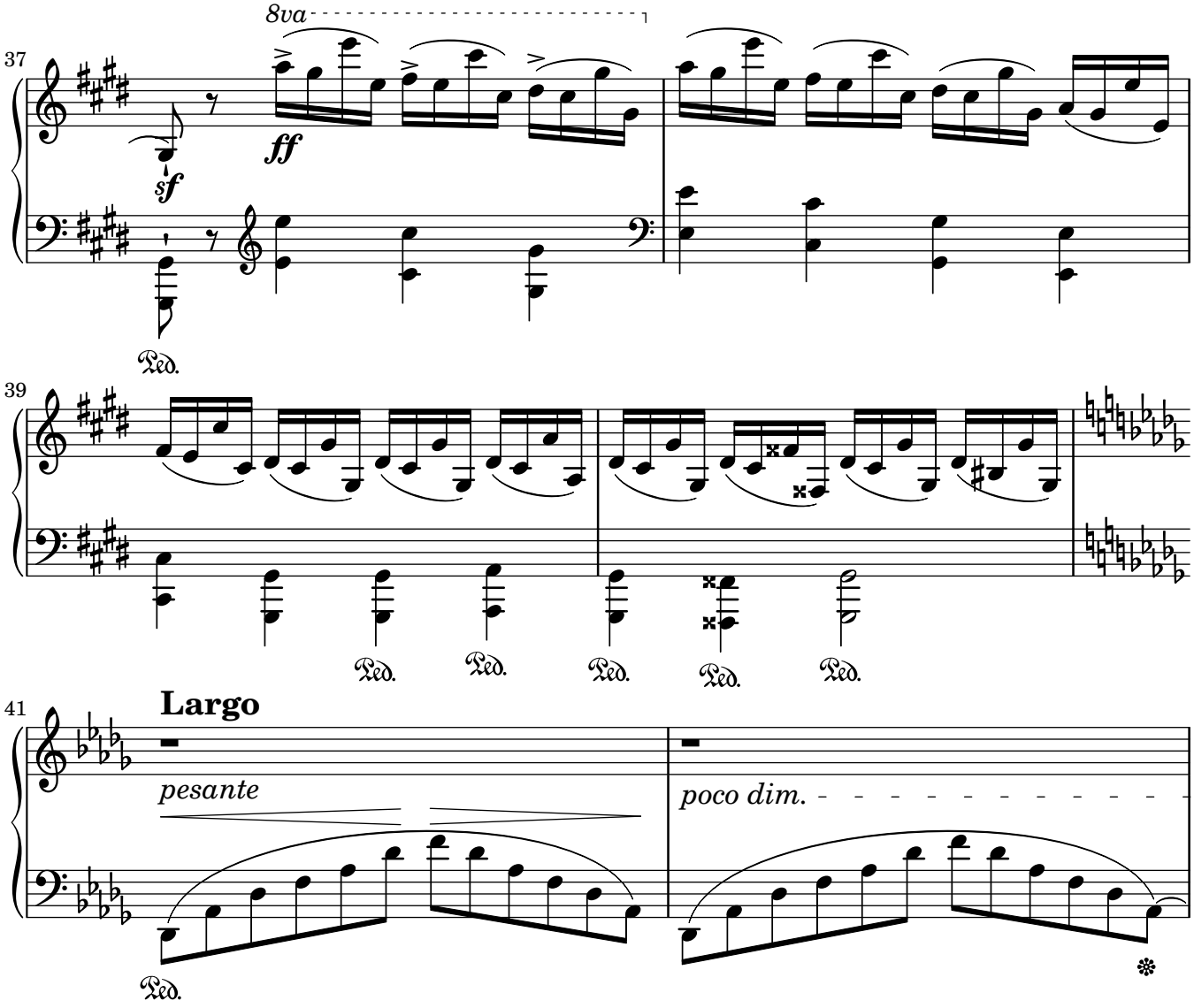
Four sixteenths in the right hand against six eighth-note triplets in the left, at speed: the polyrhythm from Volume 6, Unit 2, as a concert piece. Practise the hands separately until each is automatic, then together very slowly, lining up the first note of each beat. The middle section is a famous slow melody.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1693, typeset by Guy D. Lederfein (public domain).

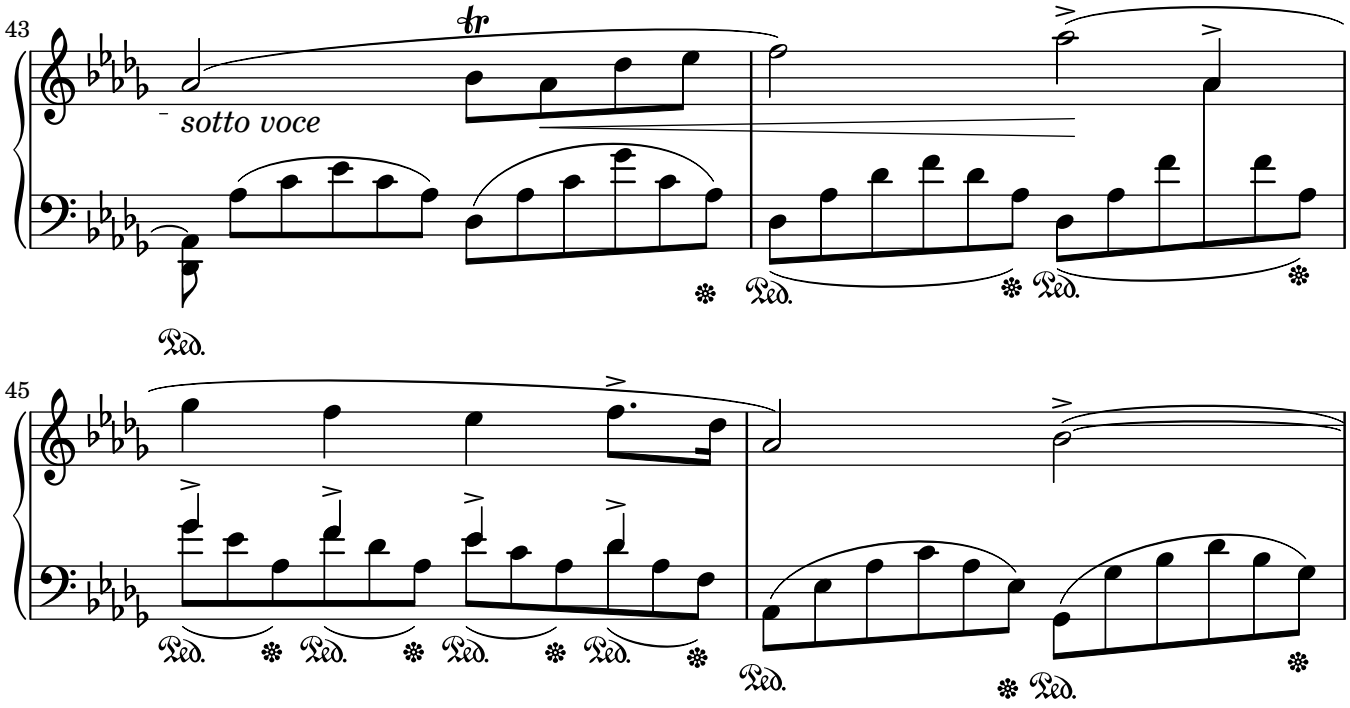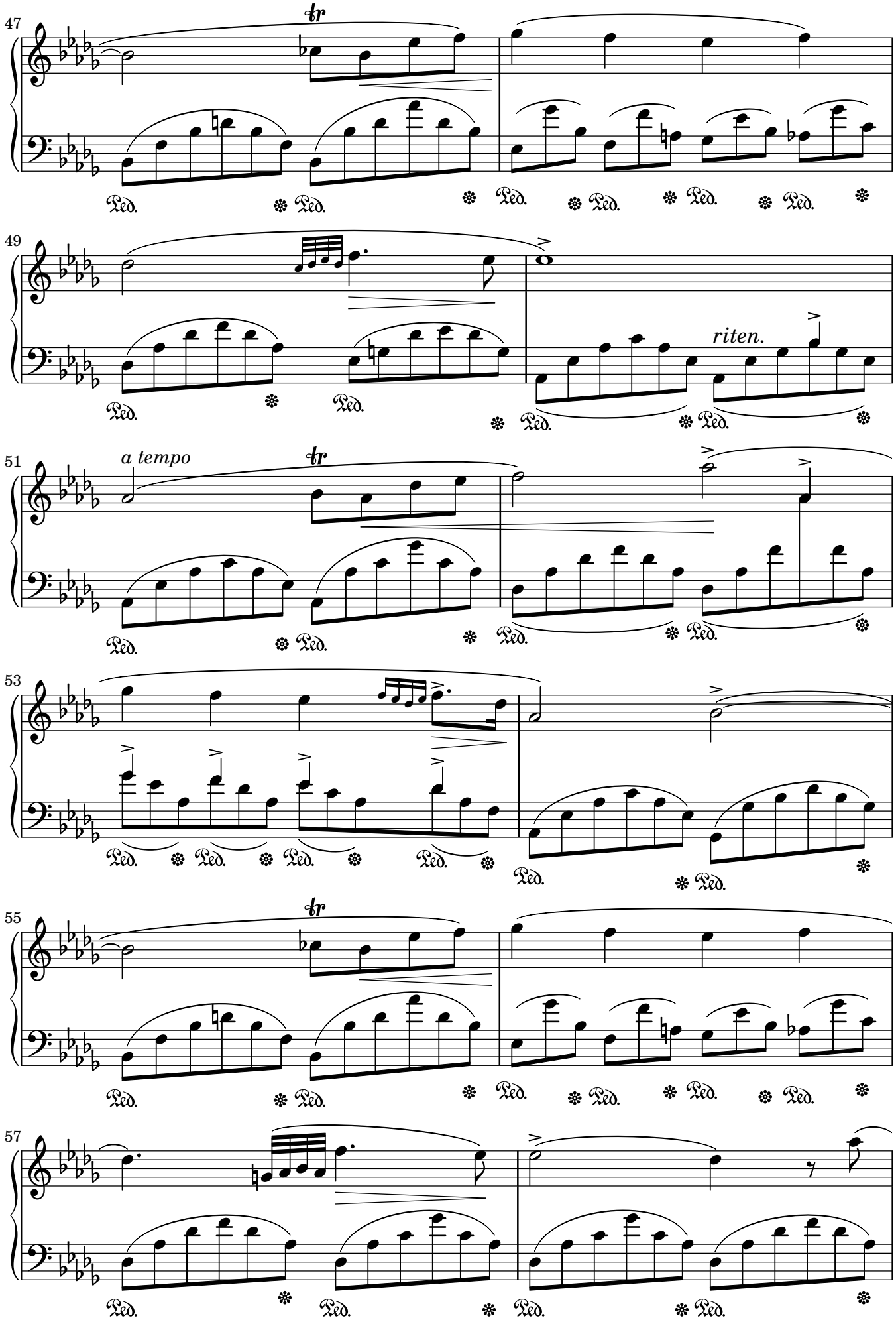



13
f
Ped.
15
Ped.
17
p
cresc.
19
dim.
21
23
rit.
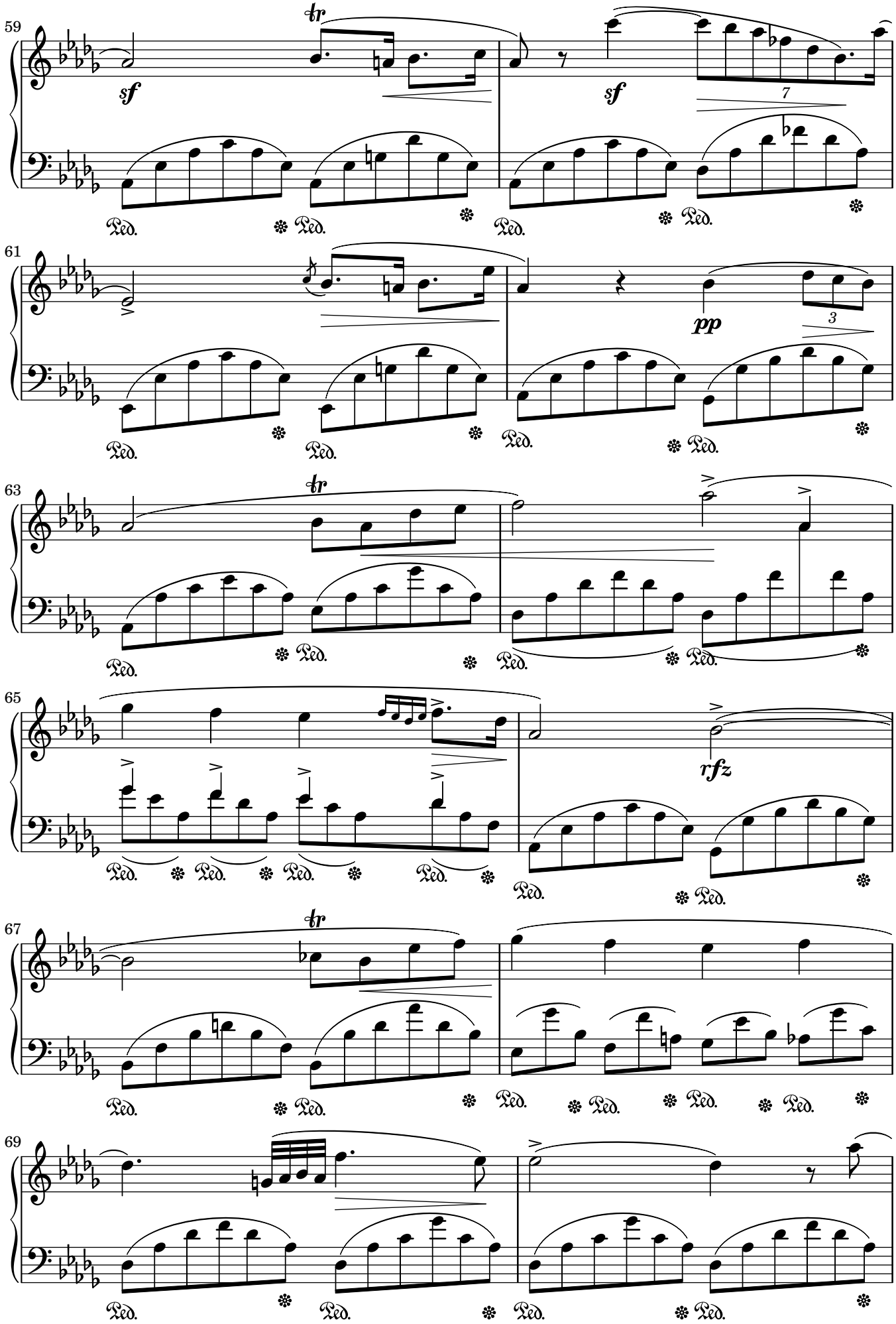

a tempo
25
p
Ped.
8va
27
29
31
33
35
f

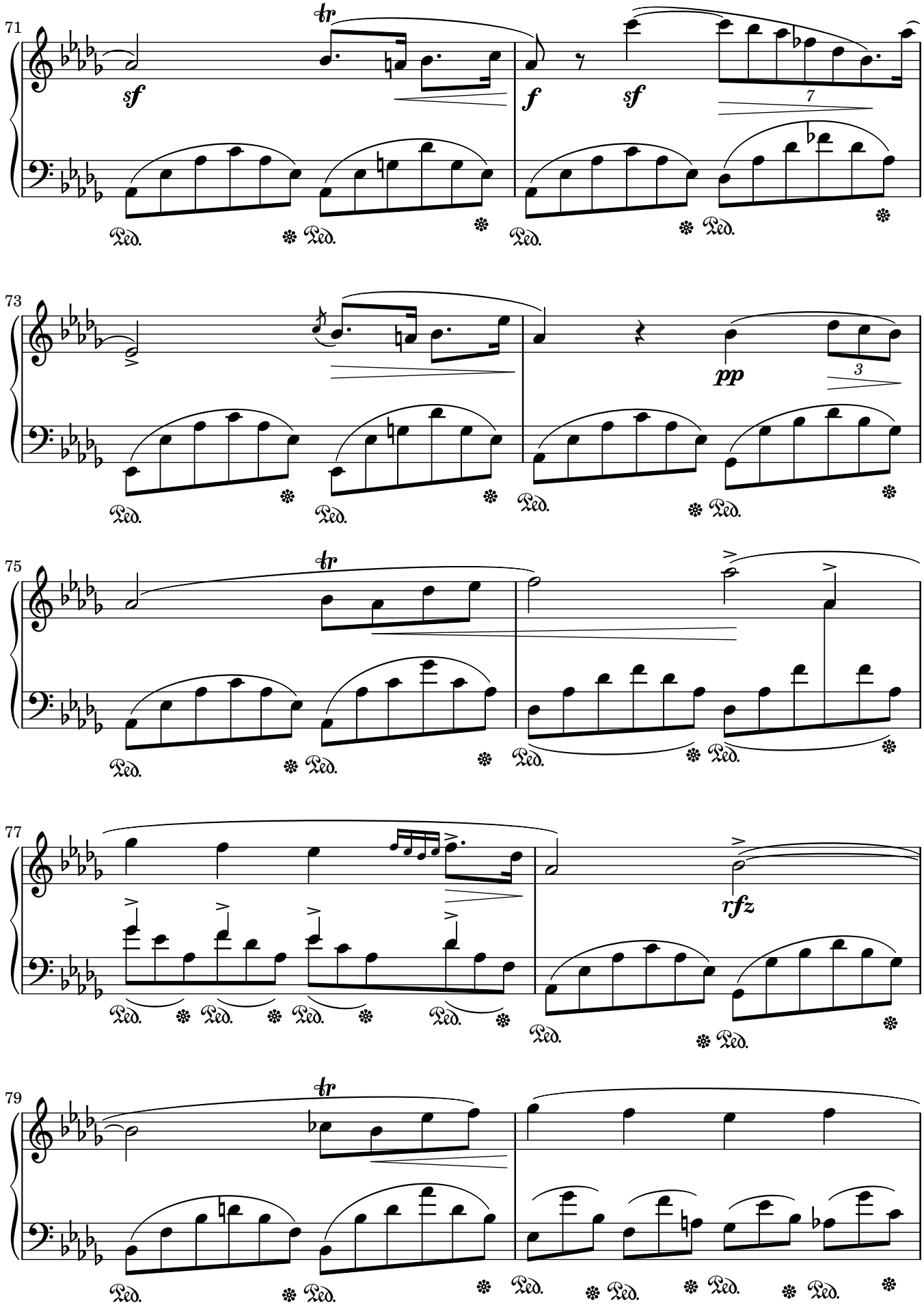


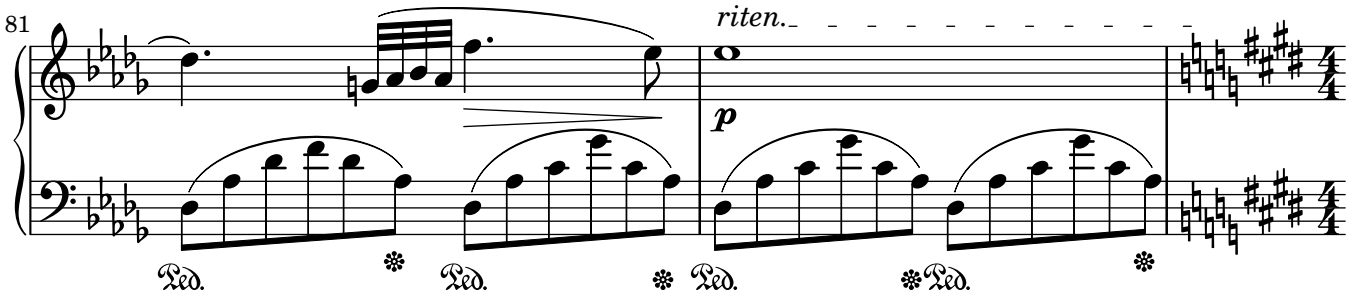
Moderato cantabile
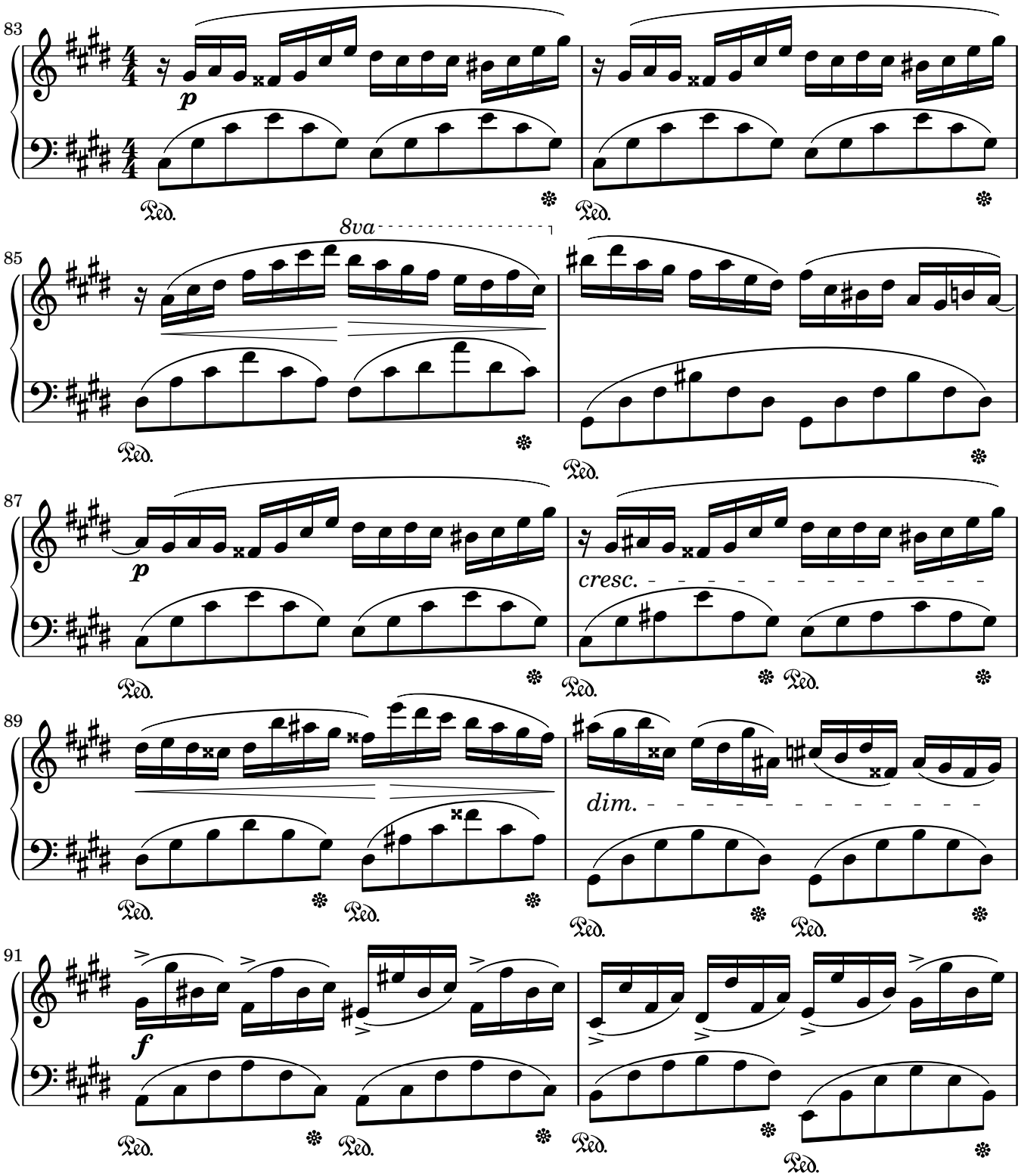



47
49
riten.
51
a tempo
53
55
57
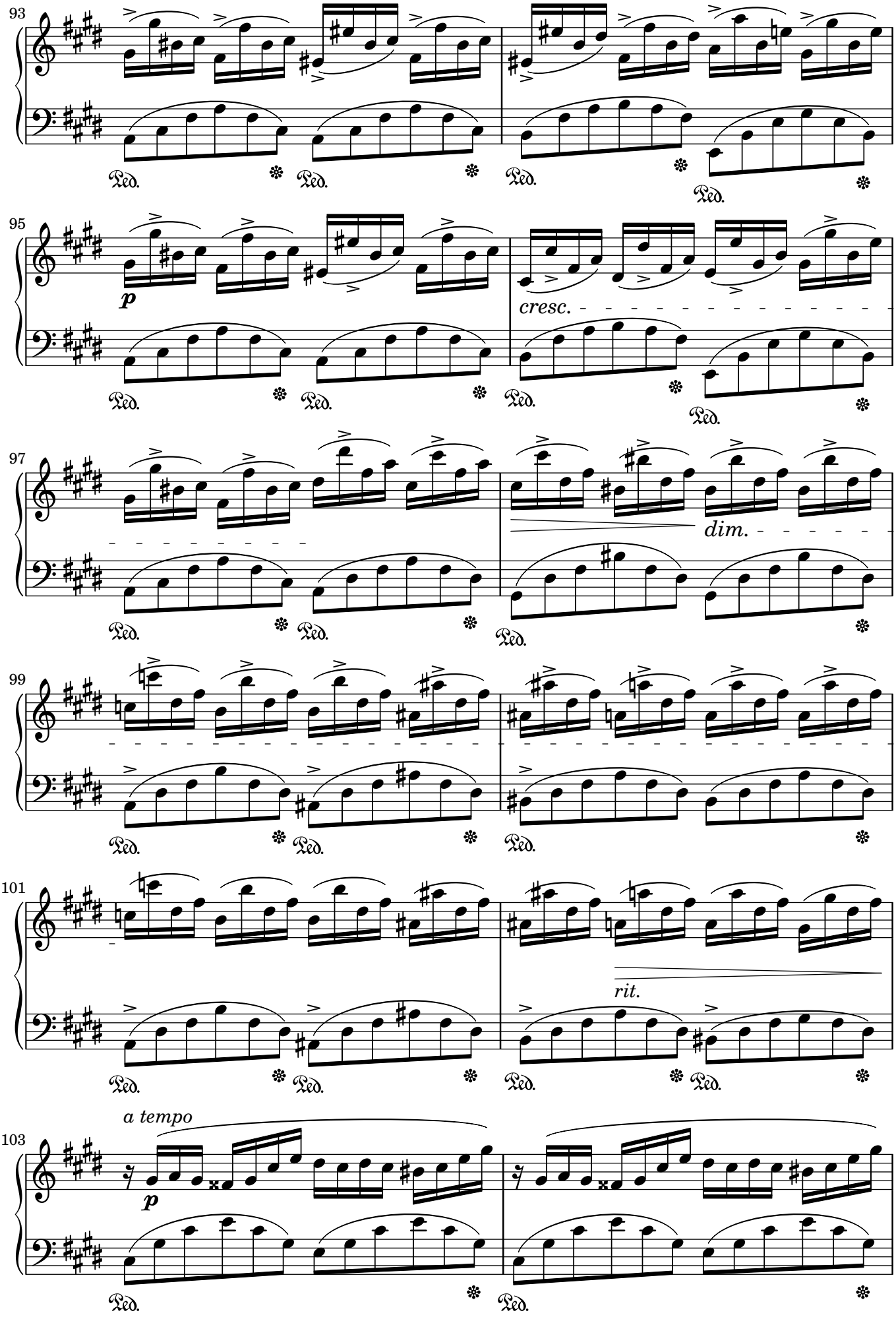

59
tr
sf
sf
7
Ped.
61
pp
3
63
tr
65
rfz
67
tr
69
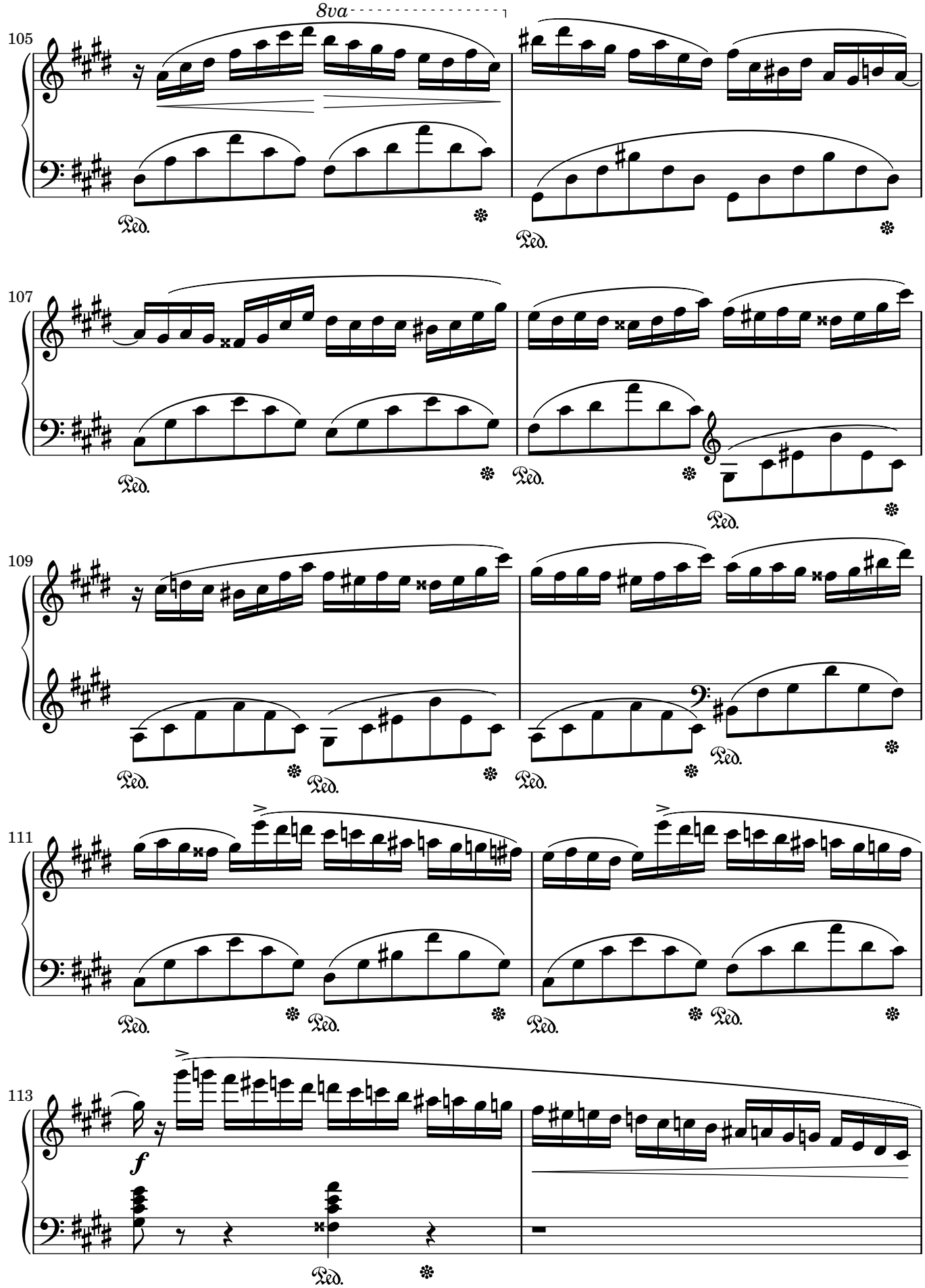

71
sf
f
sf
7
Ped.
73
pp
3
75
rfz
77
79
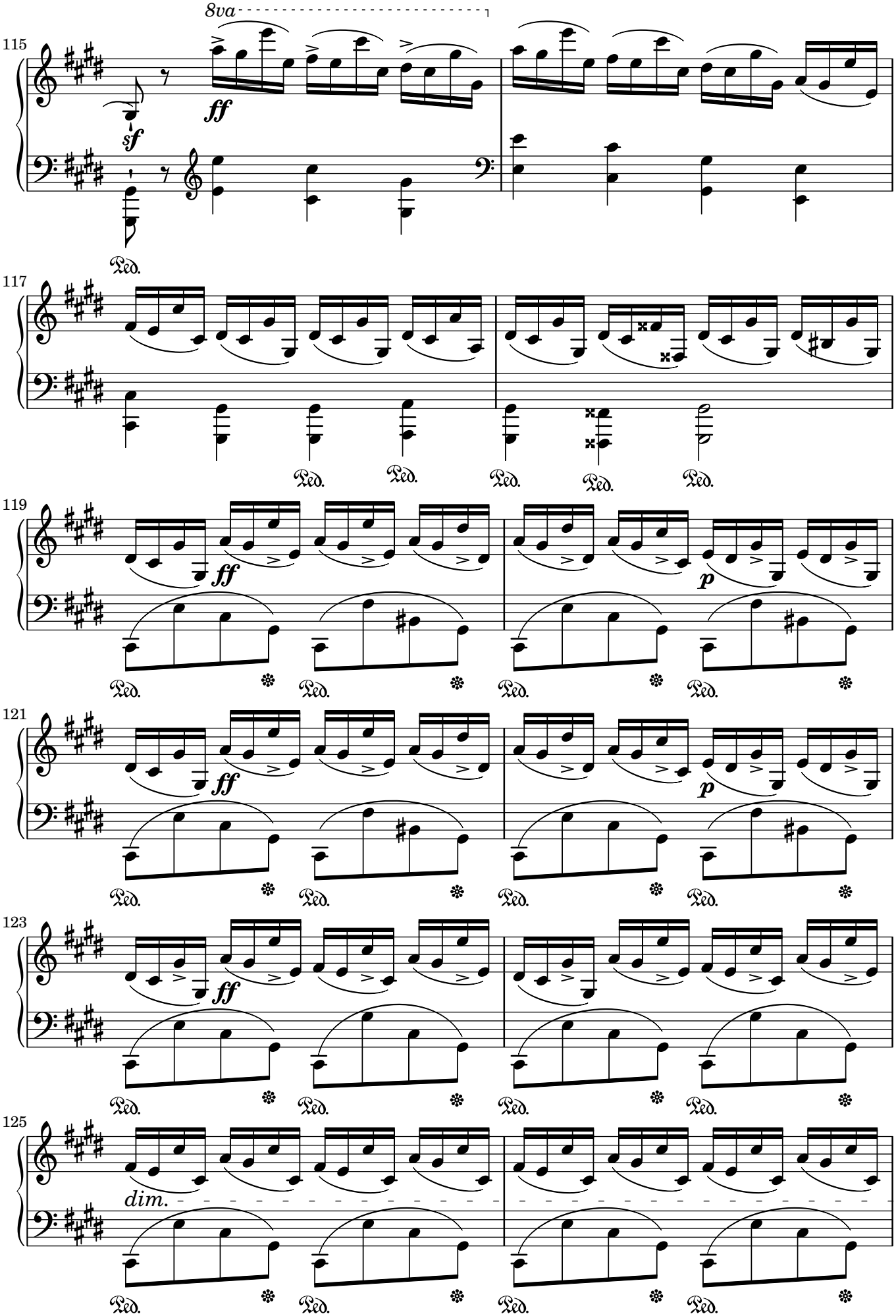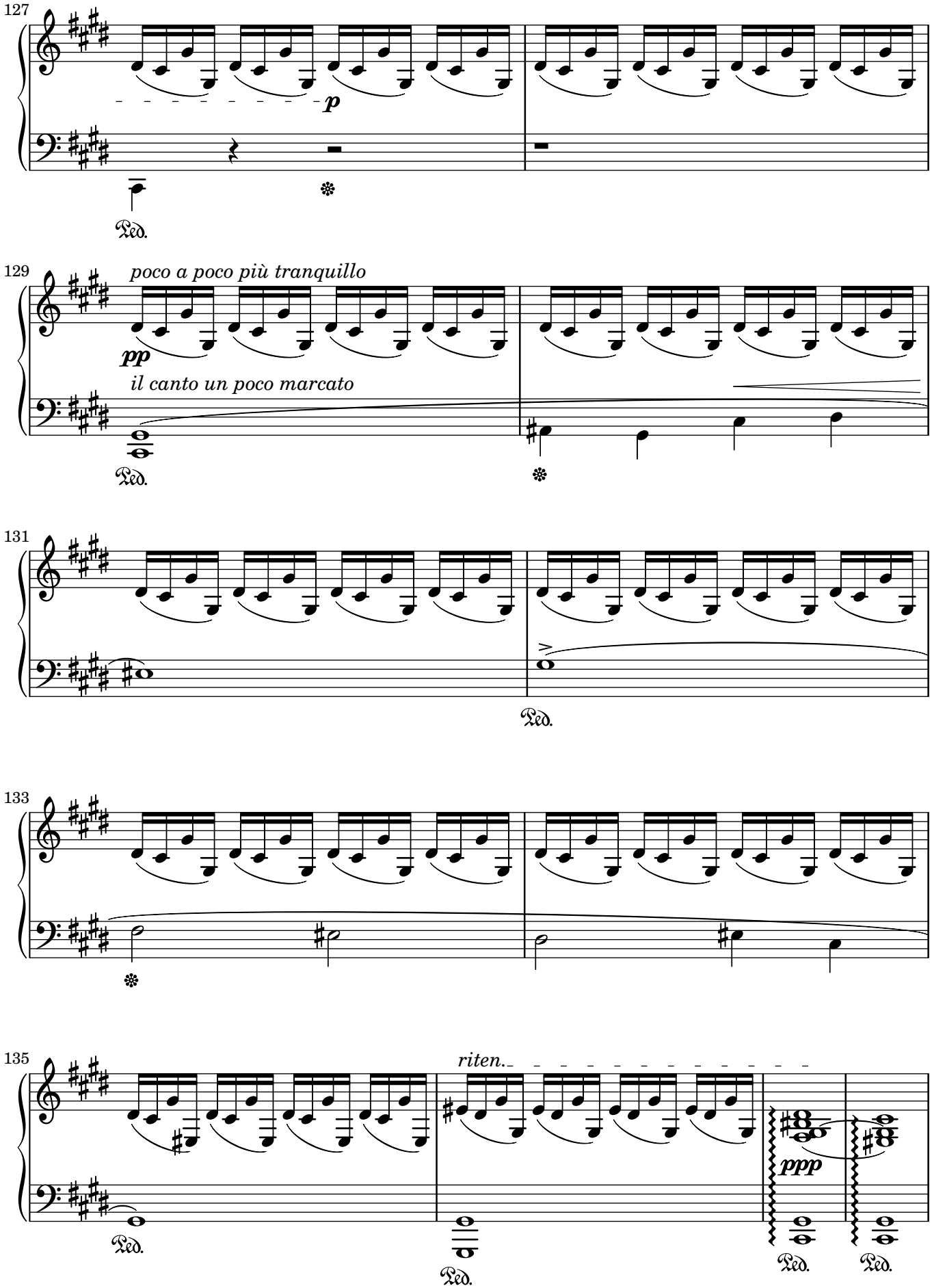


Presto




93
95
p
cresc.
97
dim.
99
101
rit.
a tempo
103
p
Ped.


8va
105
Ped.
107
109
111
113
f


8va
115
ff
sf
Ped.
117
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
119
ff
p
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
121
ff
p
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
123
ff
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
125
dim.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.


127
p
Ped.
129
poco a poco più tranquillo
pp
il canto un poco marcato
Ped.
131
Ped.
133
135
riten.
ppp
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.

Section 4
Late Romantic

The second half of the nineteenth century: Brahms, Liszt, Grieg, Tchaikovsky, and at its end Scriabin and Rachmaninoff. The textures grow fuller and the harmony richer, and national styles (Grieg's Norwegian music, Tchaikovsky's Russian) join the German and French traditions.

What it asks of you

Full chords voiced to the top, longer phrases held together by the pedal, and steady control of building to a climax: a crescendo planned over many bars, not one.

In this section

J. Brahms: Intermezzo in A, Op. 118 No. 2 *(Level 9)*

F. Liszt: Consolation No. 3 in D-flat, S. 172 *(Level 9)*

E. Grieg: Wedding Day at Troldhaugen, Op. 65 No. 6 *(Level 9)*

P. I. Tchaikovsky: January: By the Hearth, Op. 37a No. 1 *(Level 9)*

A. Scriabin: Prelude in C, Op. 11 No. 1 *(Level 9)*

S. Rachmaninoff: Prelude in C-sharp minor, Op. 3 No. 2 *(Level 10)*
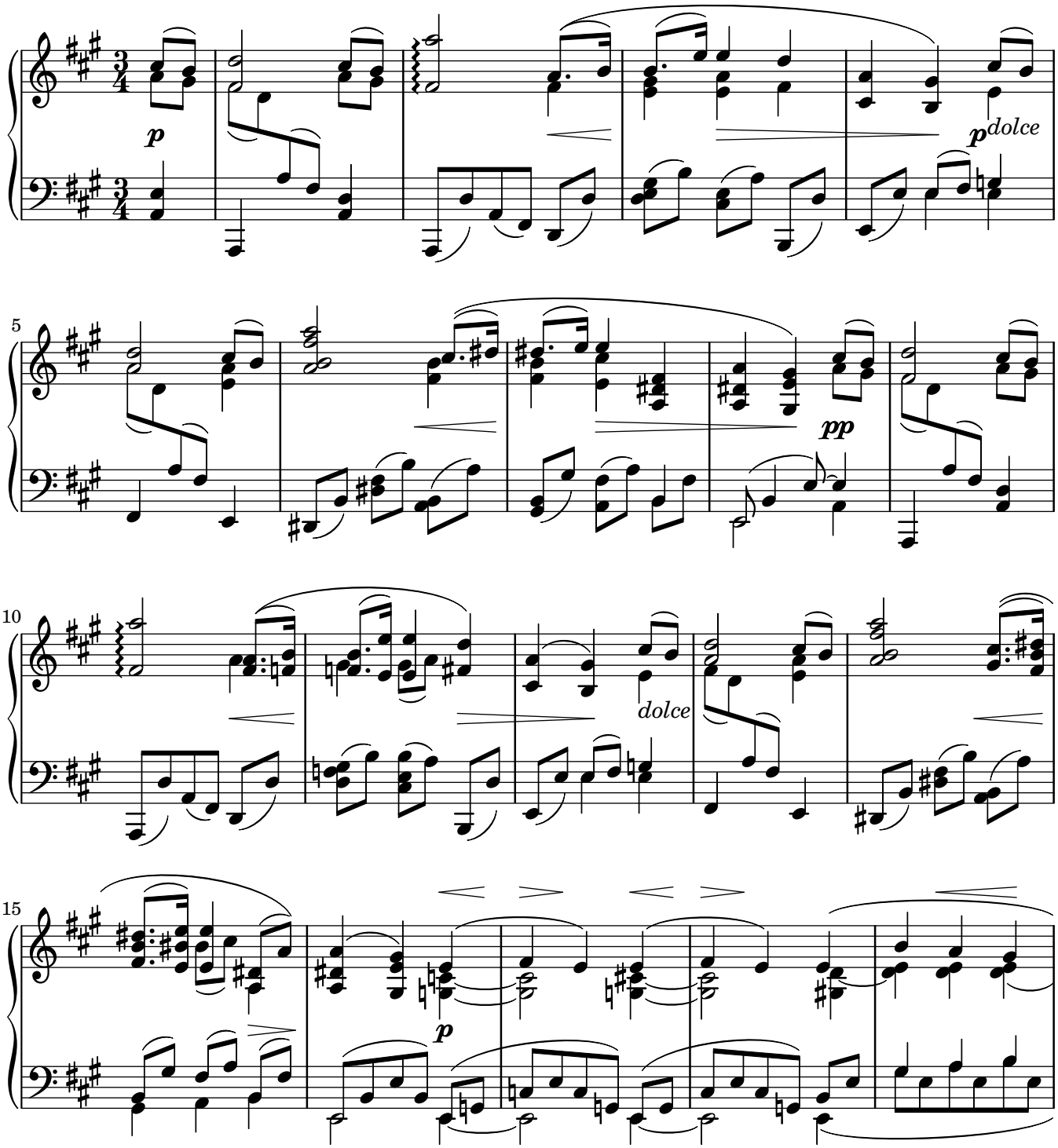
Intermezzo in A, Op. 118 No. 2
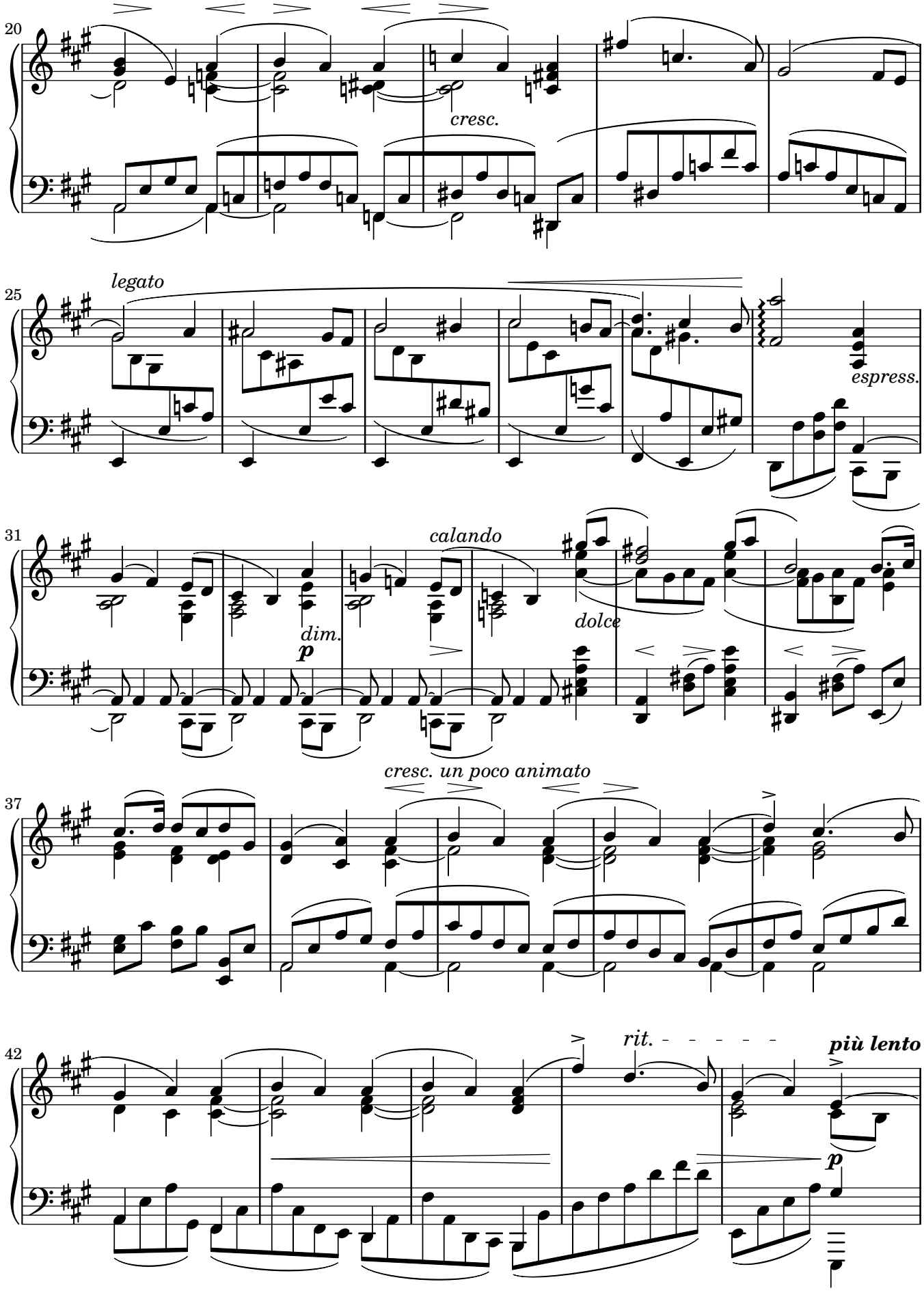
J. Brahms (1833-1897) - Six Pieces, Op. 118 (1893)
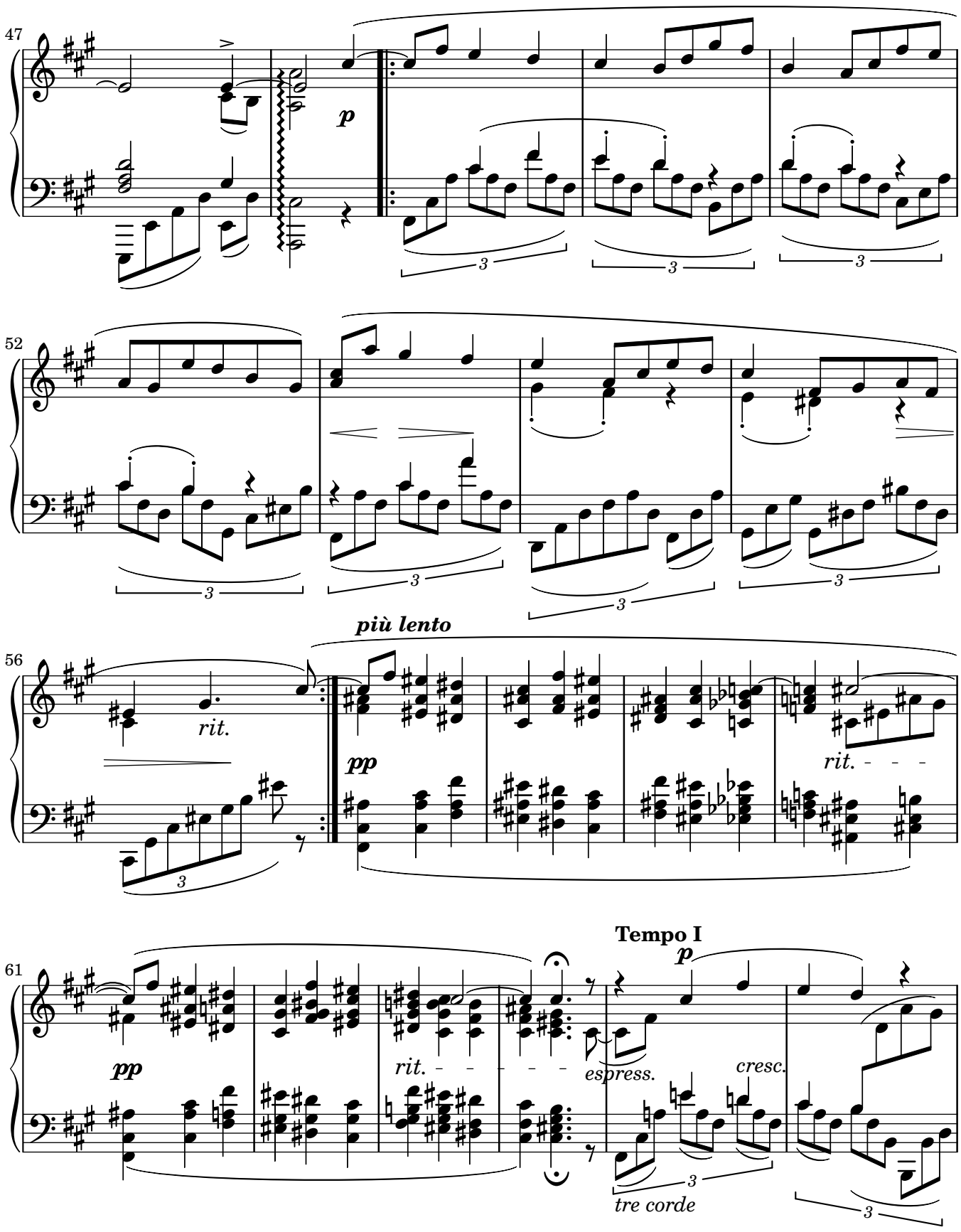
Level 9 · about 6 min
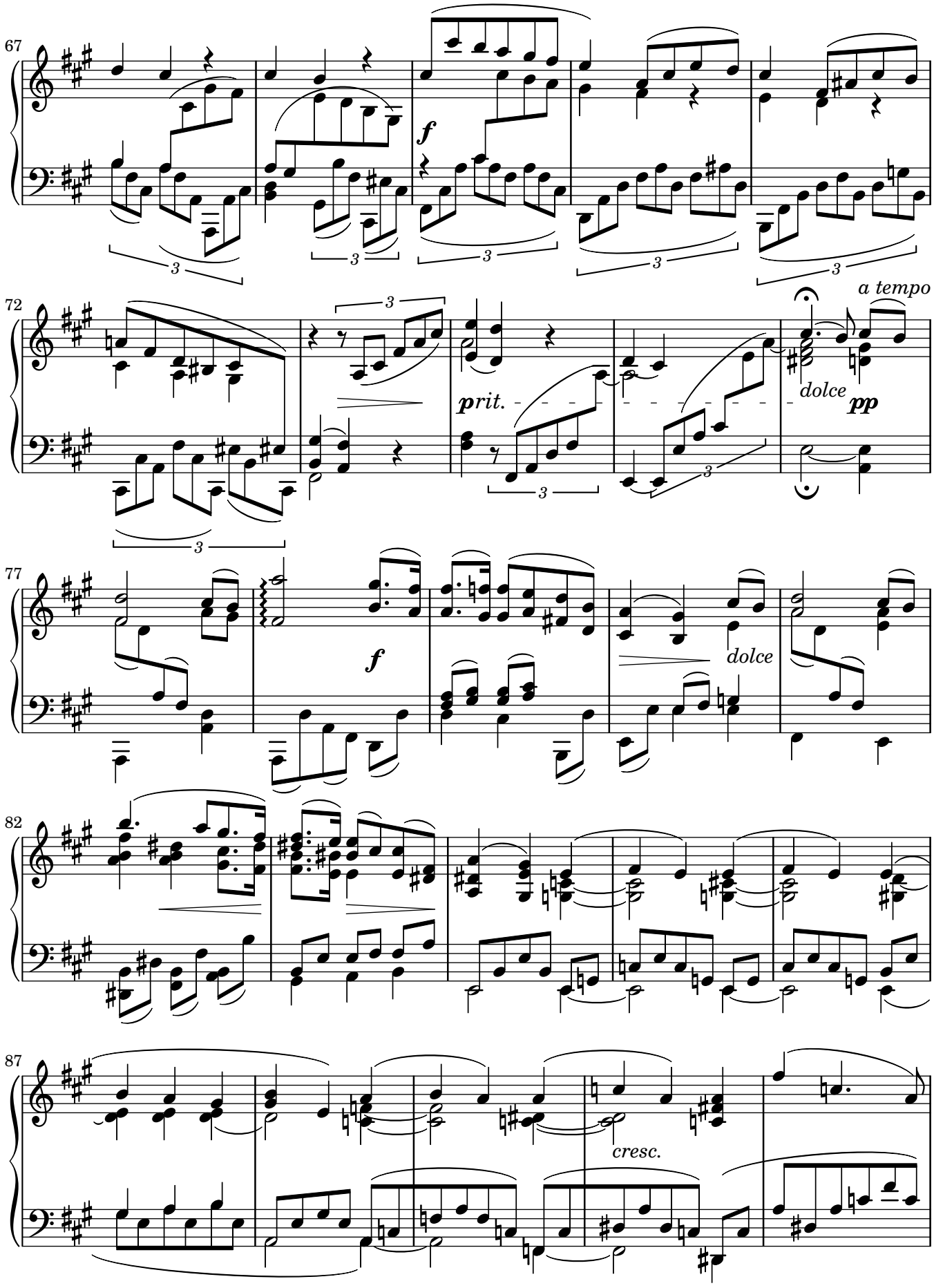
One of Brahms's last piano pieces, written for Clara Schumann: a tender melody in thick, close chords, with a middle section in F-sharp minor where the hands imitate each other in canon. Voice the top line of every chord and keep the inner voices soft.
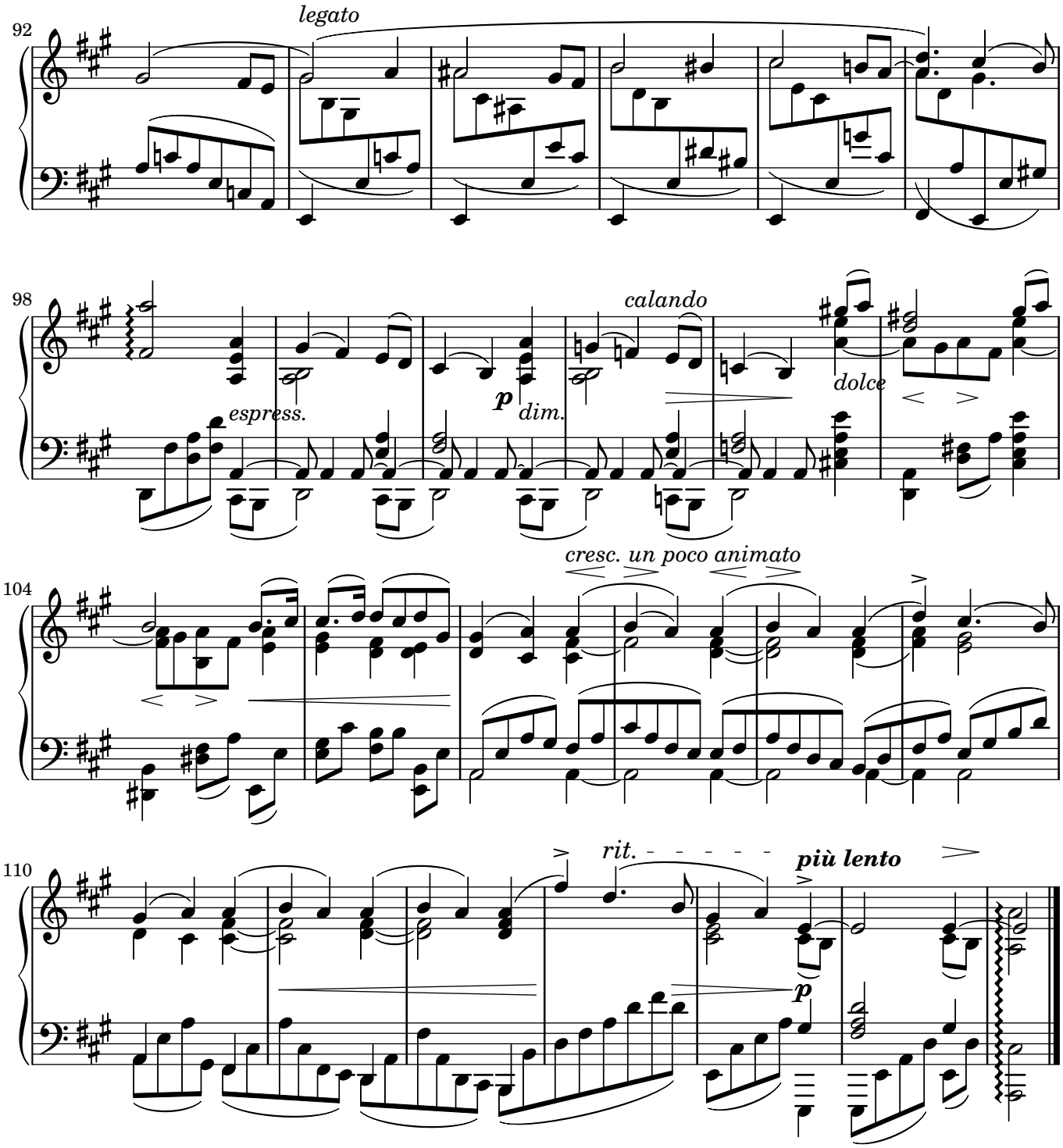
Source: Mutopia Project no. 535, typeset by Aron Fay (public domain).




20
cresc.
25
legato
espress.
31
calando
dim.
p
dolce
37
cresc. un poco animato
42
rit.
più lento
p


47
p
52
3
56
più lento
rit.
pp
rit.
61
Tempo I
p
pp
rit.
espress.
cresc.
tre corde


67
f
72
prit.
a tempo
dolce
pp
77
f
dolce
82
87
cresc.


92
legato
98
espress.
p
dim.
calando
dolce
104
cresc. un poco animato
110
rit.
più lento
p
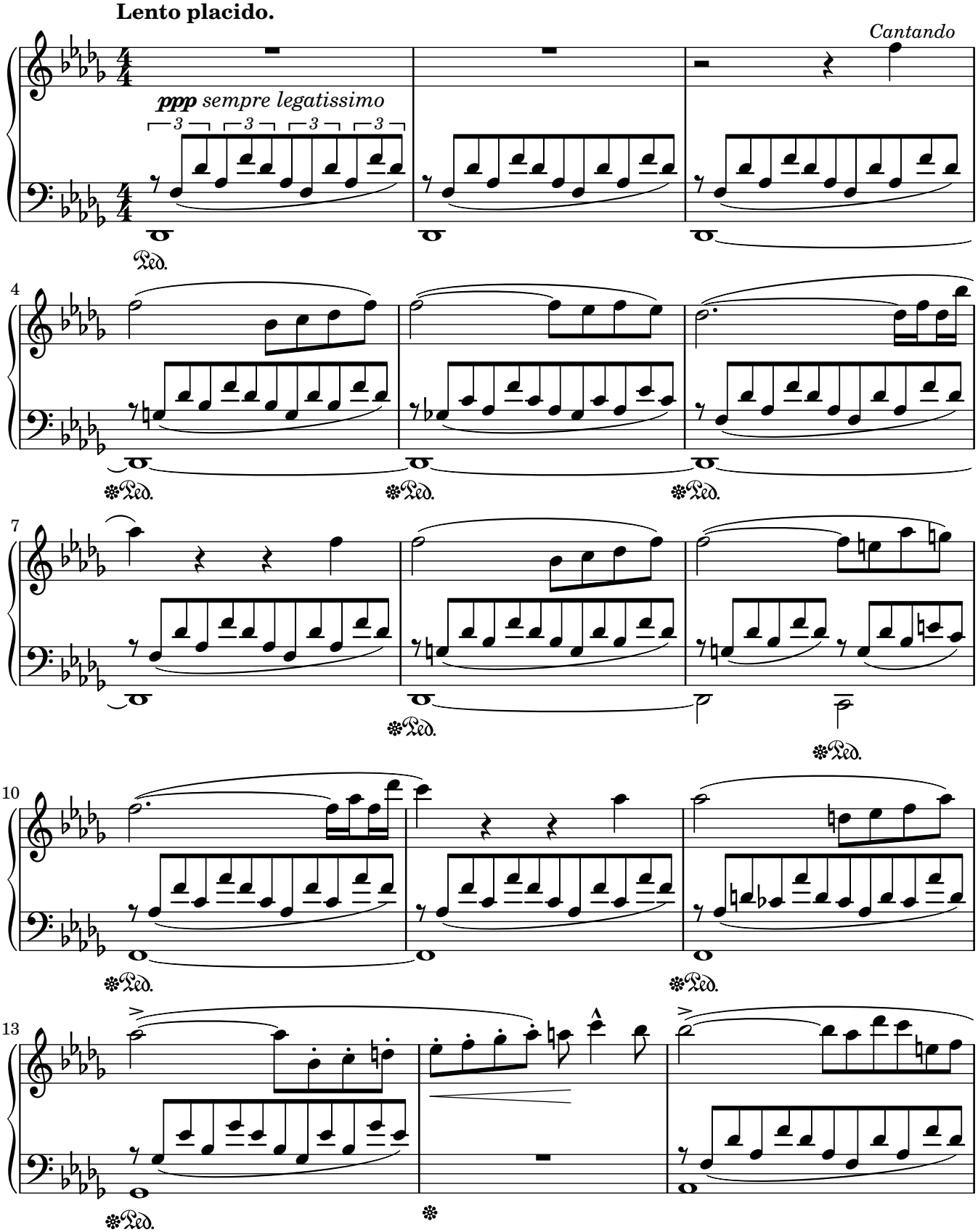
Consolation No. 3 in D-flat, S. 172
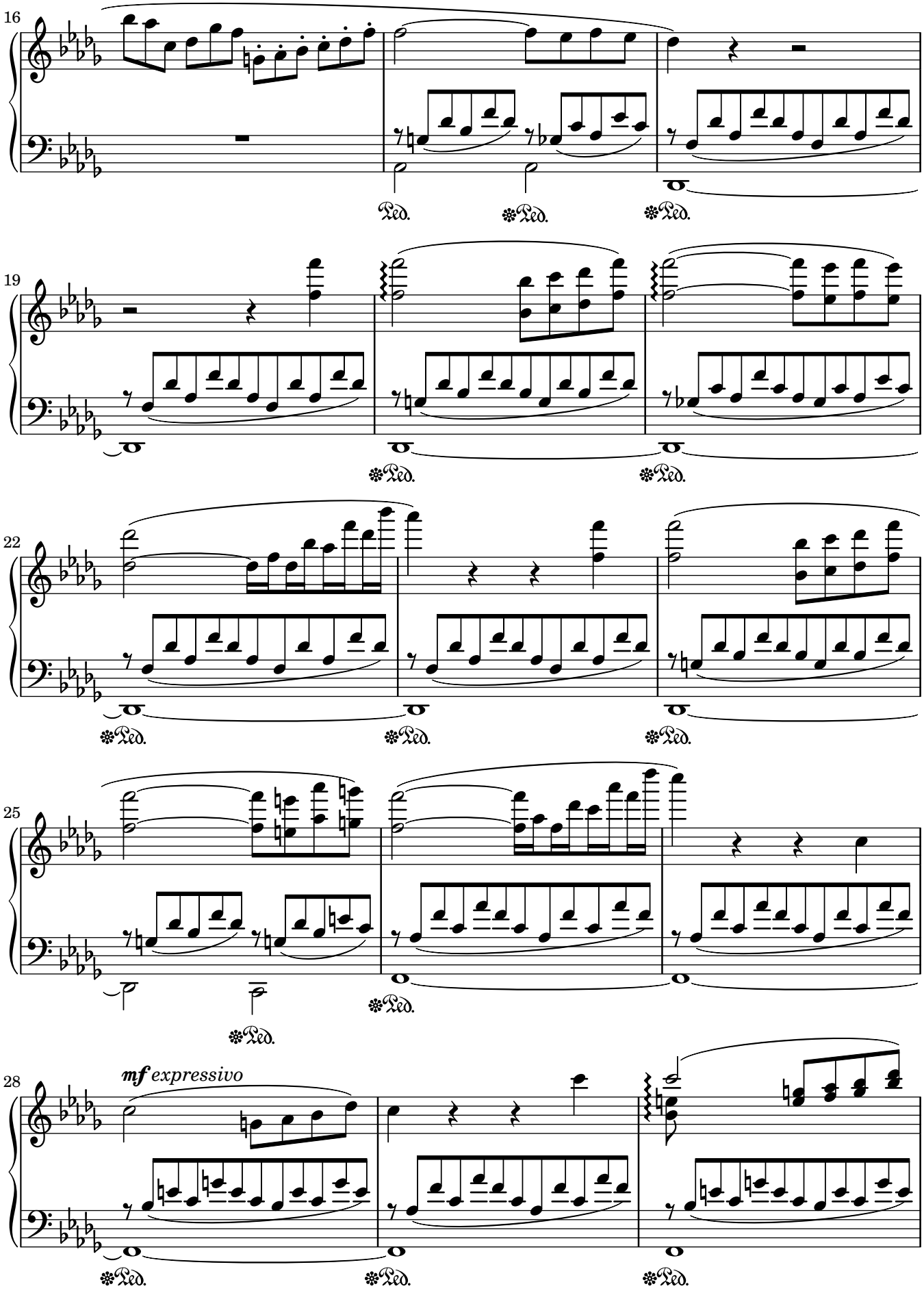
F. Liszt (1811-1886) - Six Consolations (1849-1850)
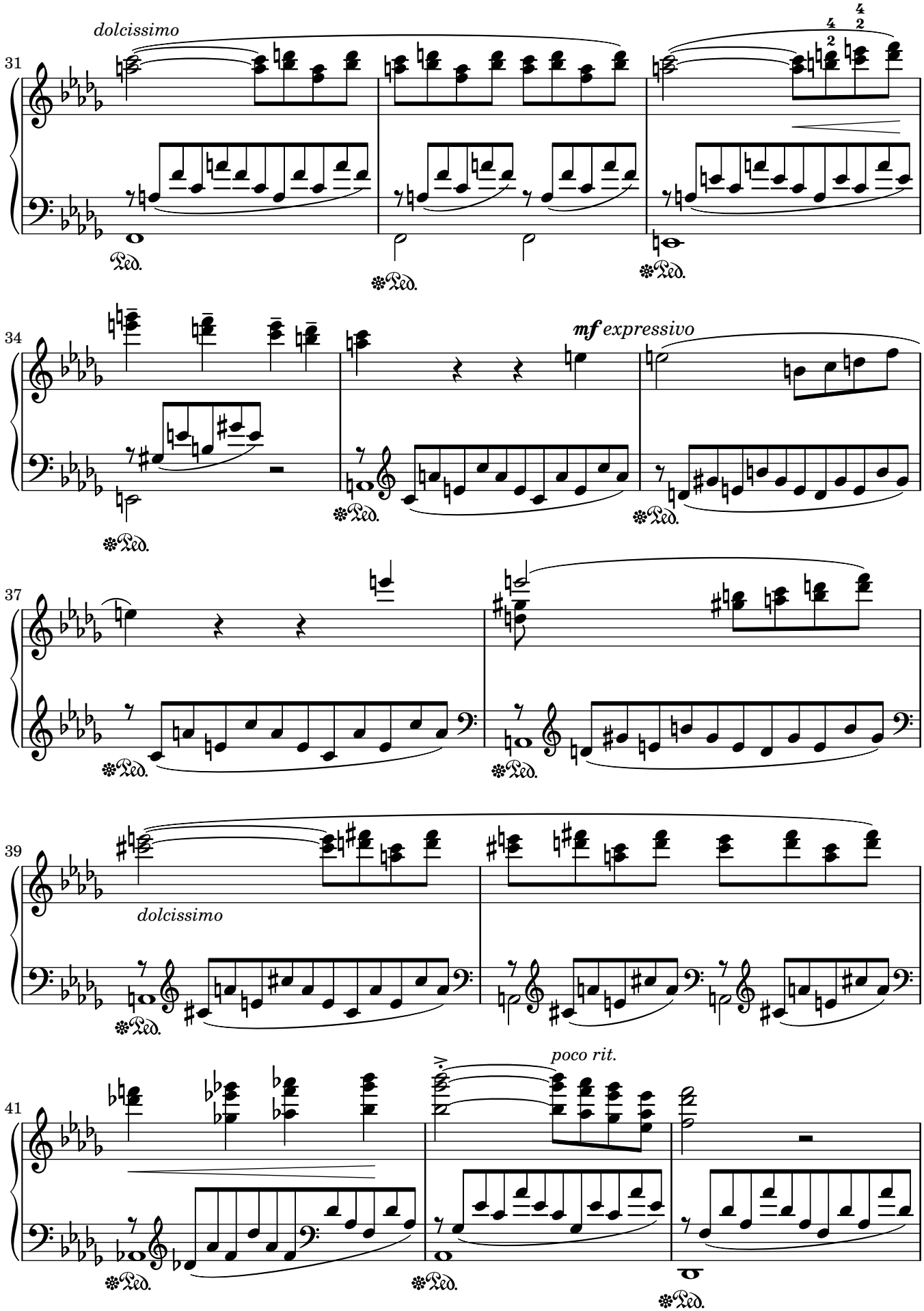
Level 9 · about 4 min

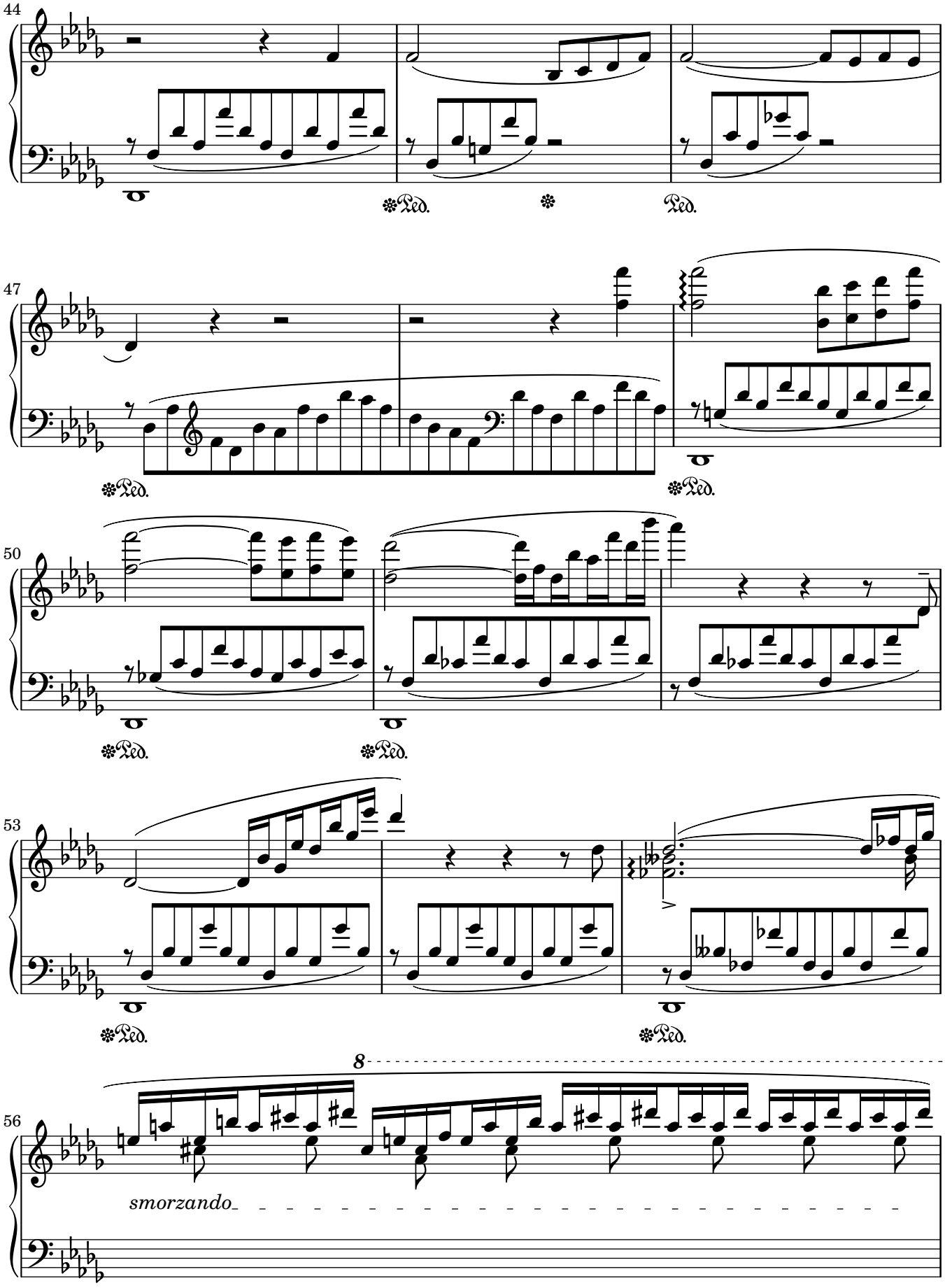
Liszt's best-known gentle piece: a long melody over a slow, wide left-hand accompaniment held together by the pedal. Practise the left hand alone until its leaps are smooth, and keep the melody singing above it.

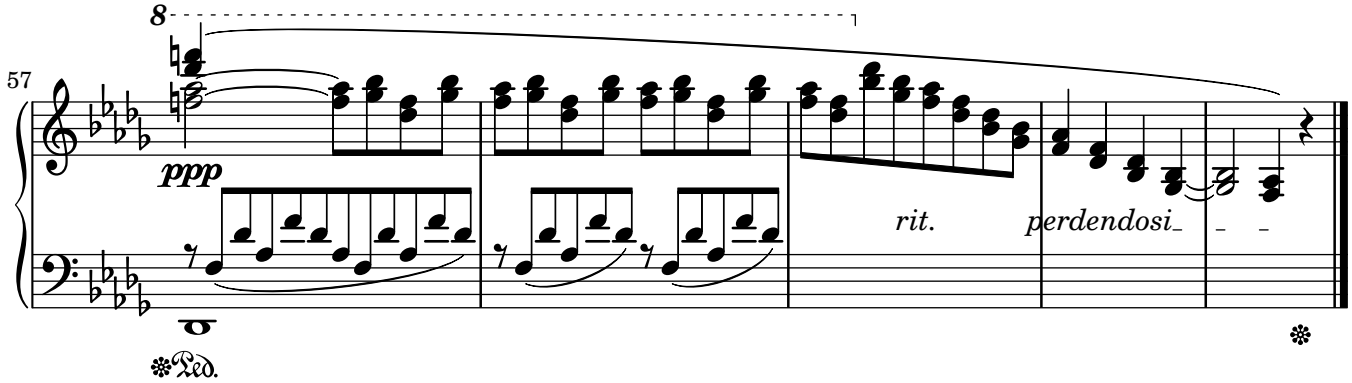
Source: Mutopia Project no. 1647, typeset by Ryan Prince (CC BY 3.0).




16
Ped.
19
22
25
28
mf expressive


dolcissimo
31
4
2
4
2
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
34
mf expressivo
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
37
Ped.
Ped.
39
dolcissimo
Ped.
poco rit.
41
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.


44
Ped.
Ped.
47
Ped.
Ped.
50
Ped.
Ped.
53
Ped.
Ped.
8
56
smorzando


8
57
ppp
rit.
perdendosi
Ped.
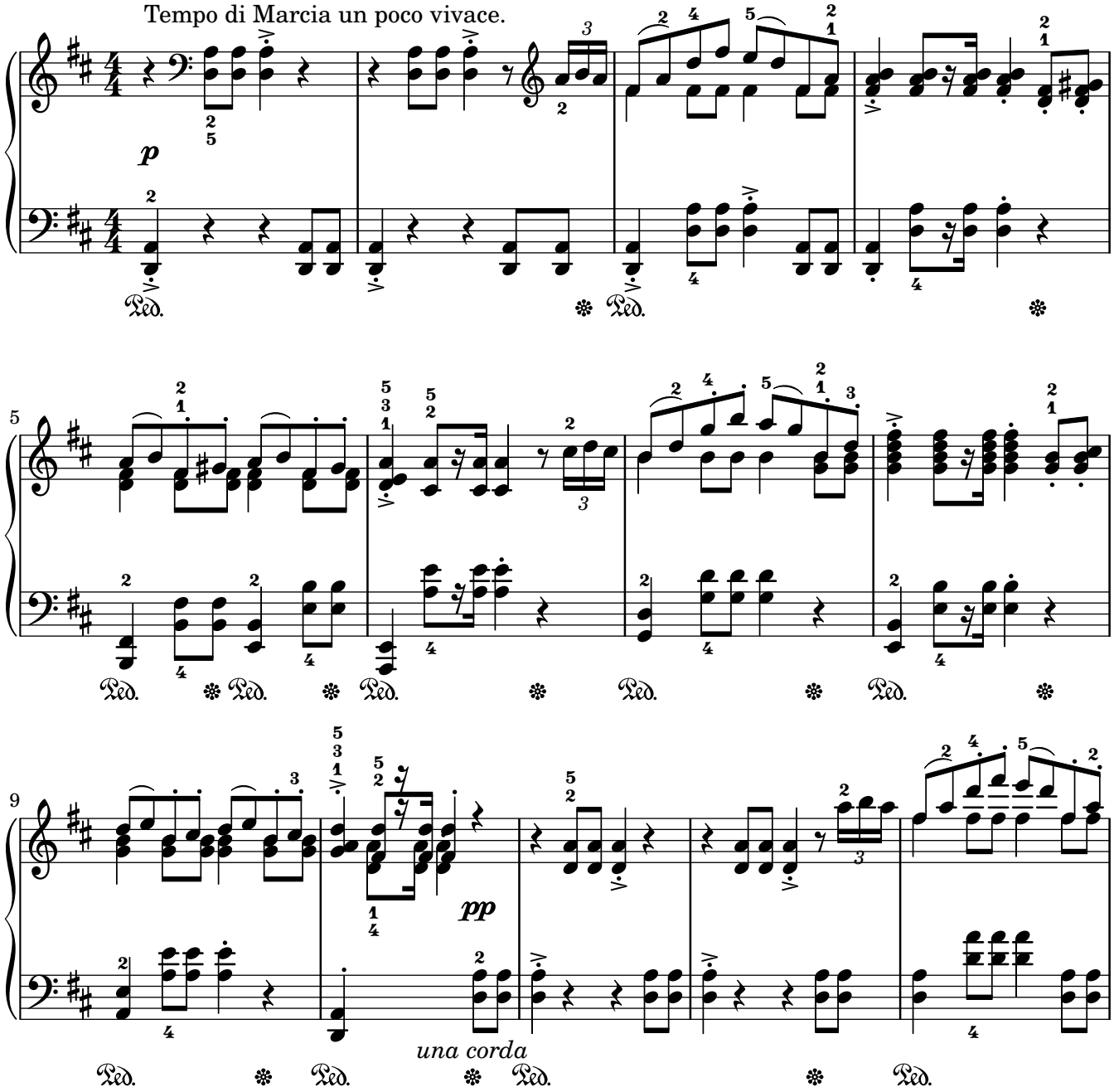
Wedding Day at Troldhaugen, Op. 65 No. 6
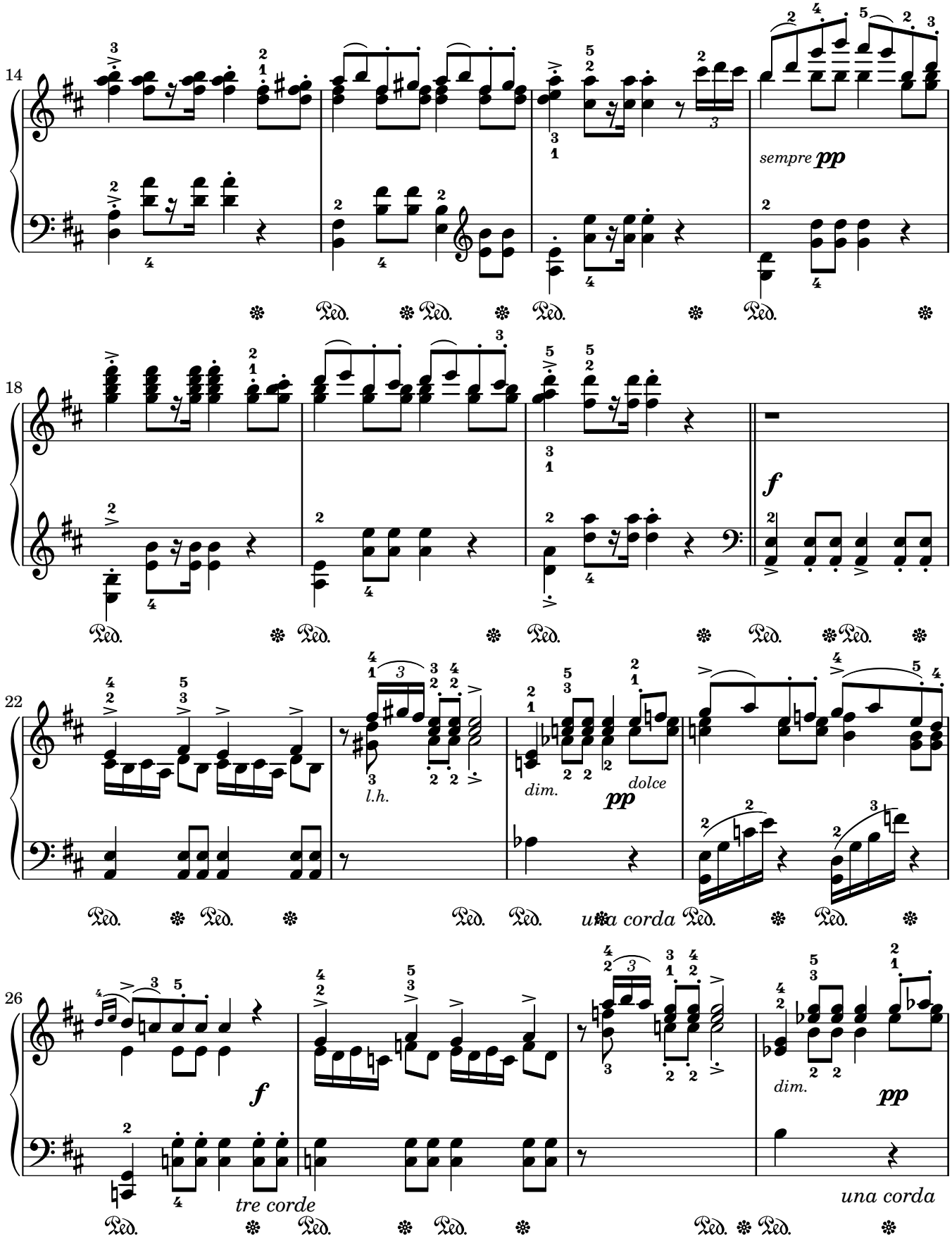
E. Grieg (1843-1907) - Lyric Pieces, Book 8 (1896)
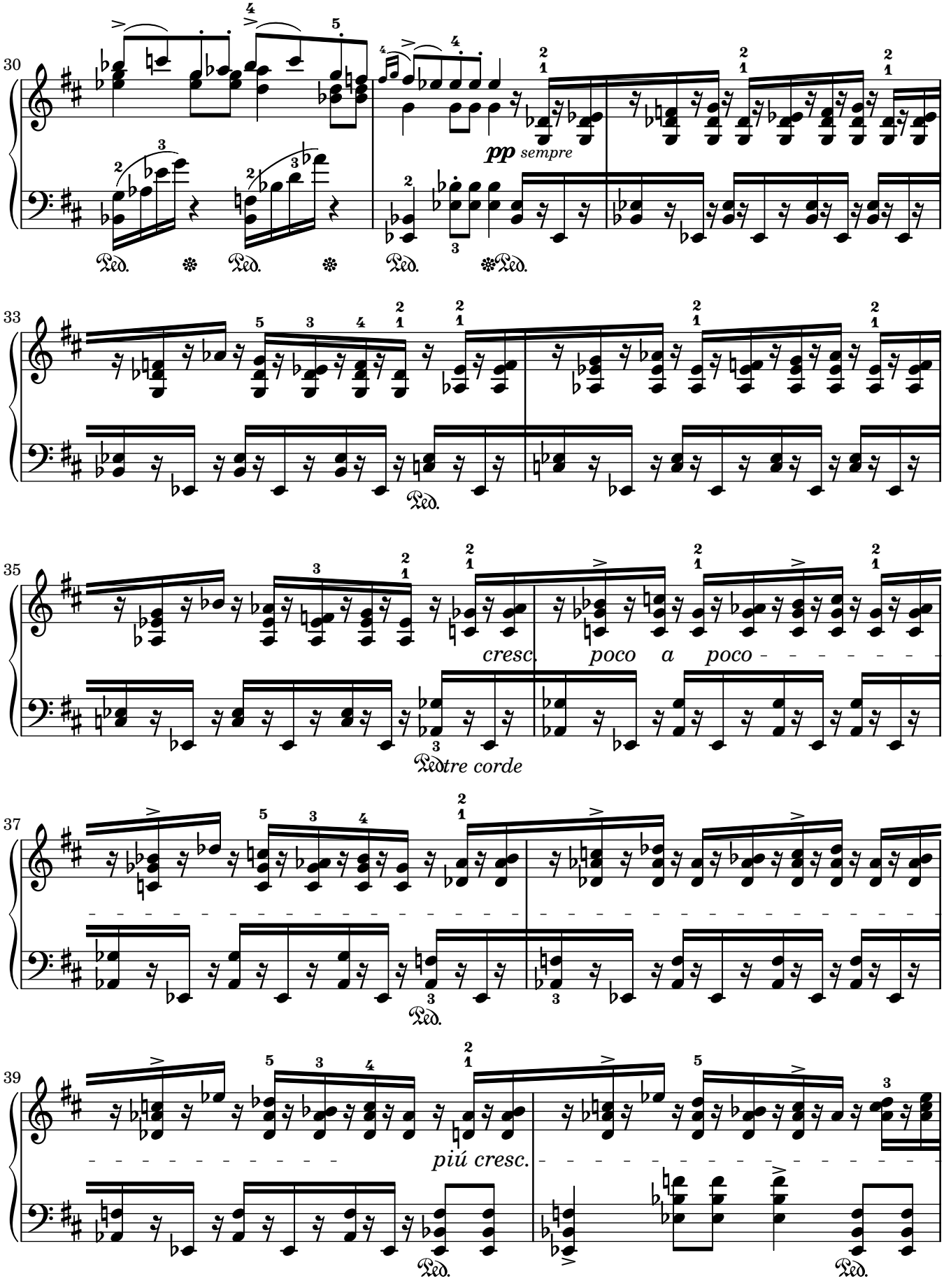
Level 9 · about 7 min
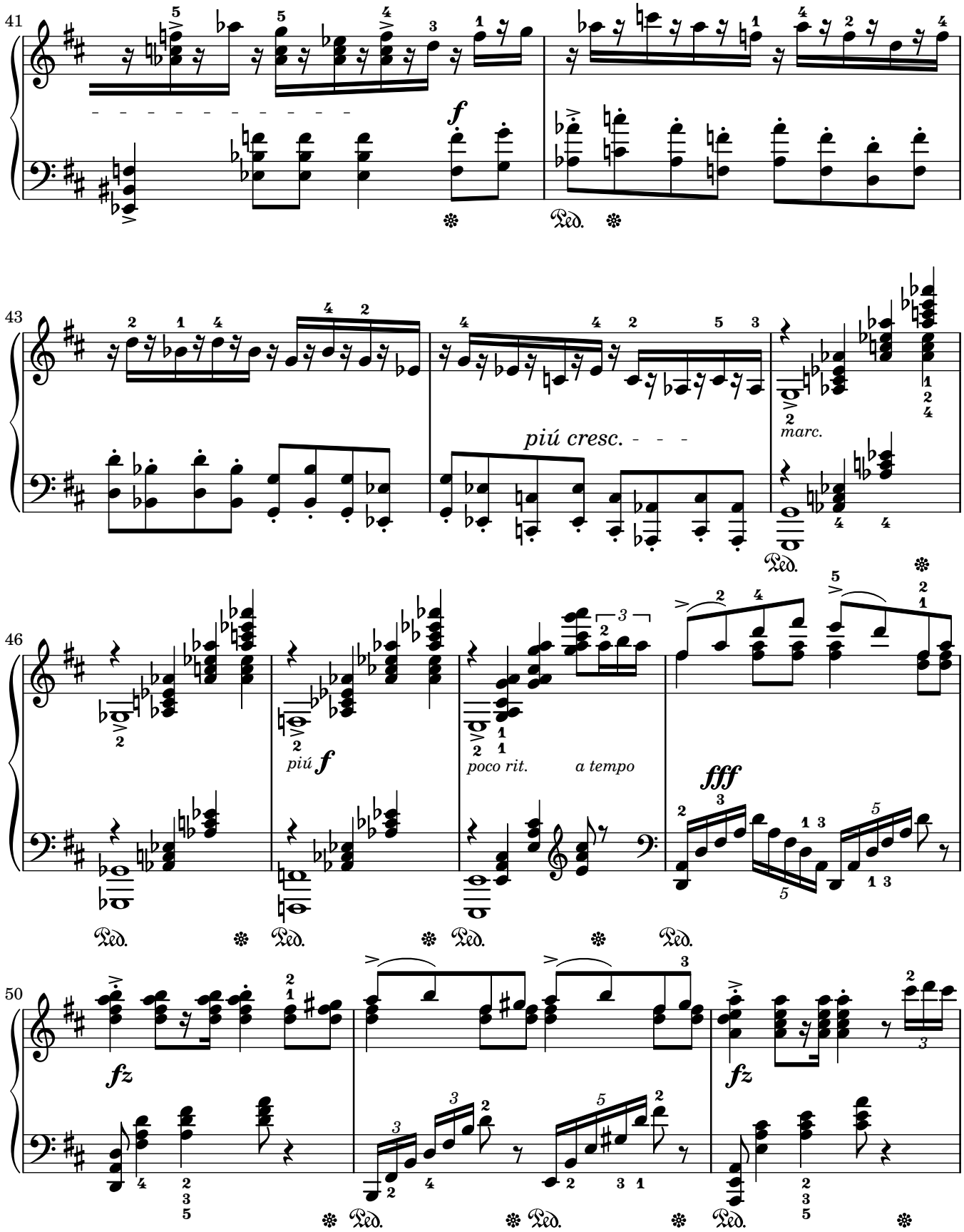
Grieg wrote it for his silver wedding anniversary at Troldhaugen, his home near Bergen (the opening was an excerpt in Volume 6). A festive march with octaves and full chords, and a gentle middle section. Keep the march rhythm crisp and the octaves light.
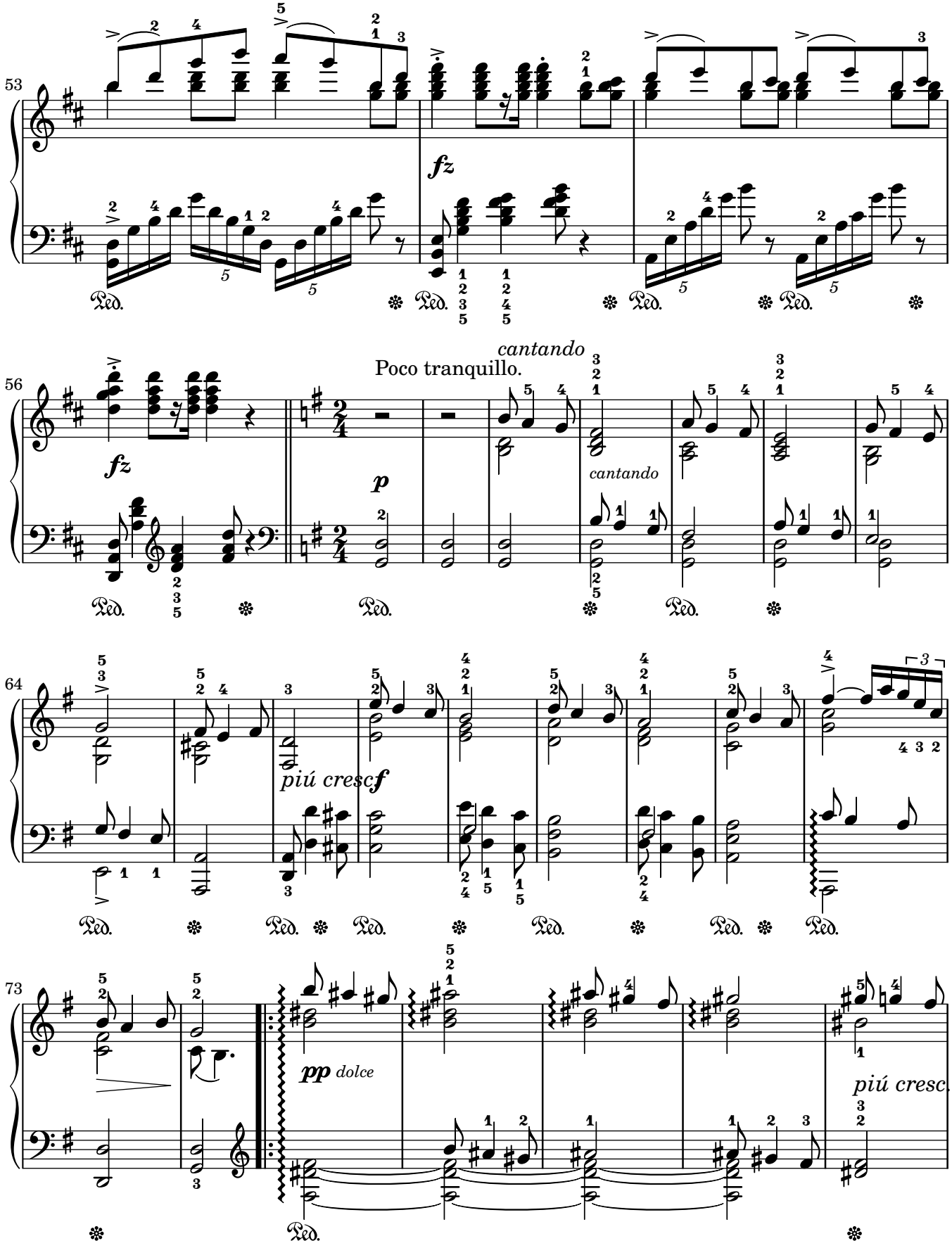
Source: Mutopia Project no. 781, typeset by David Whipple (public domain).
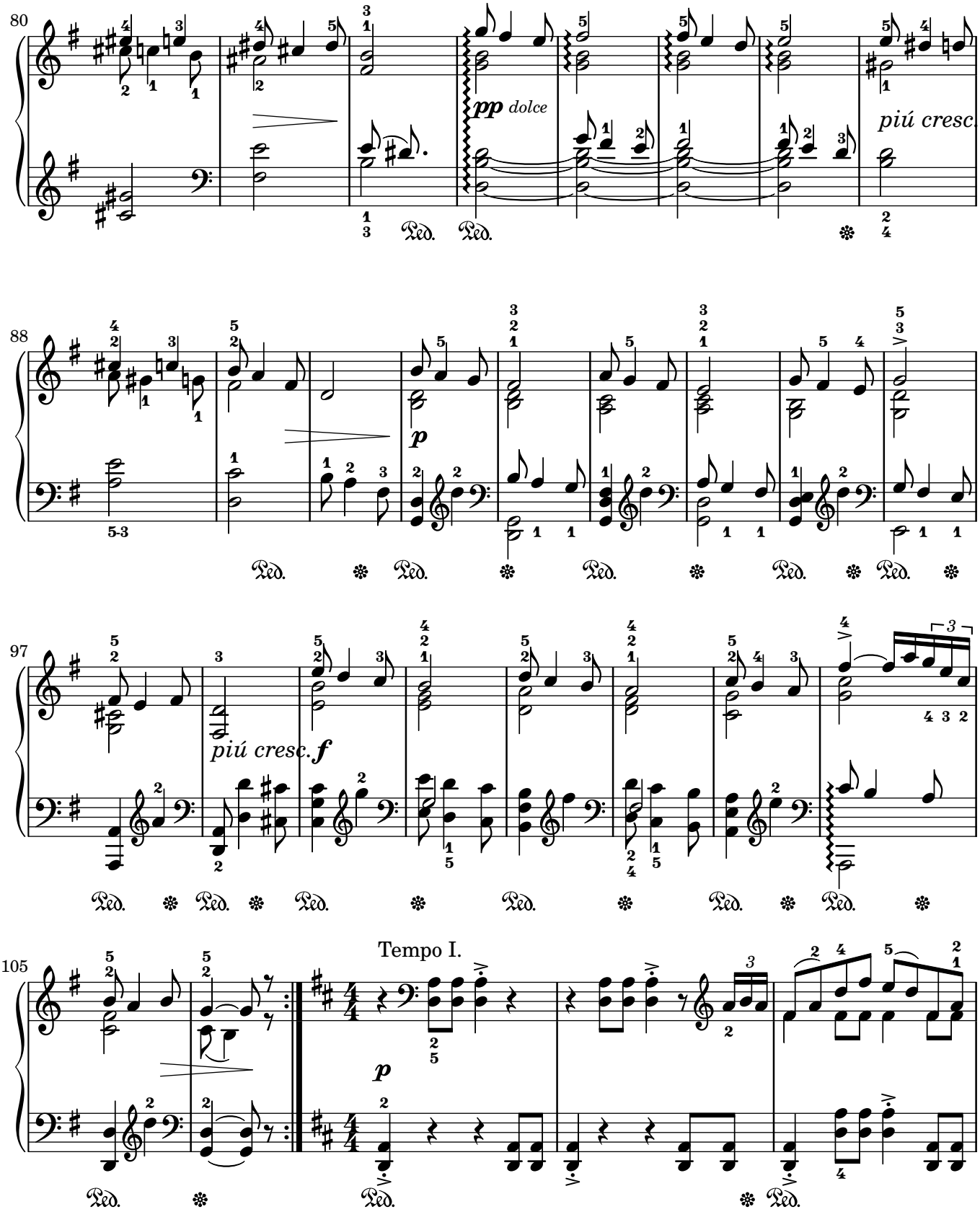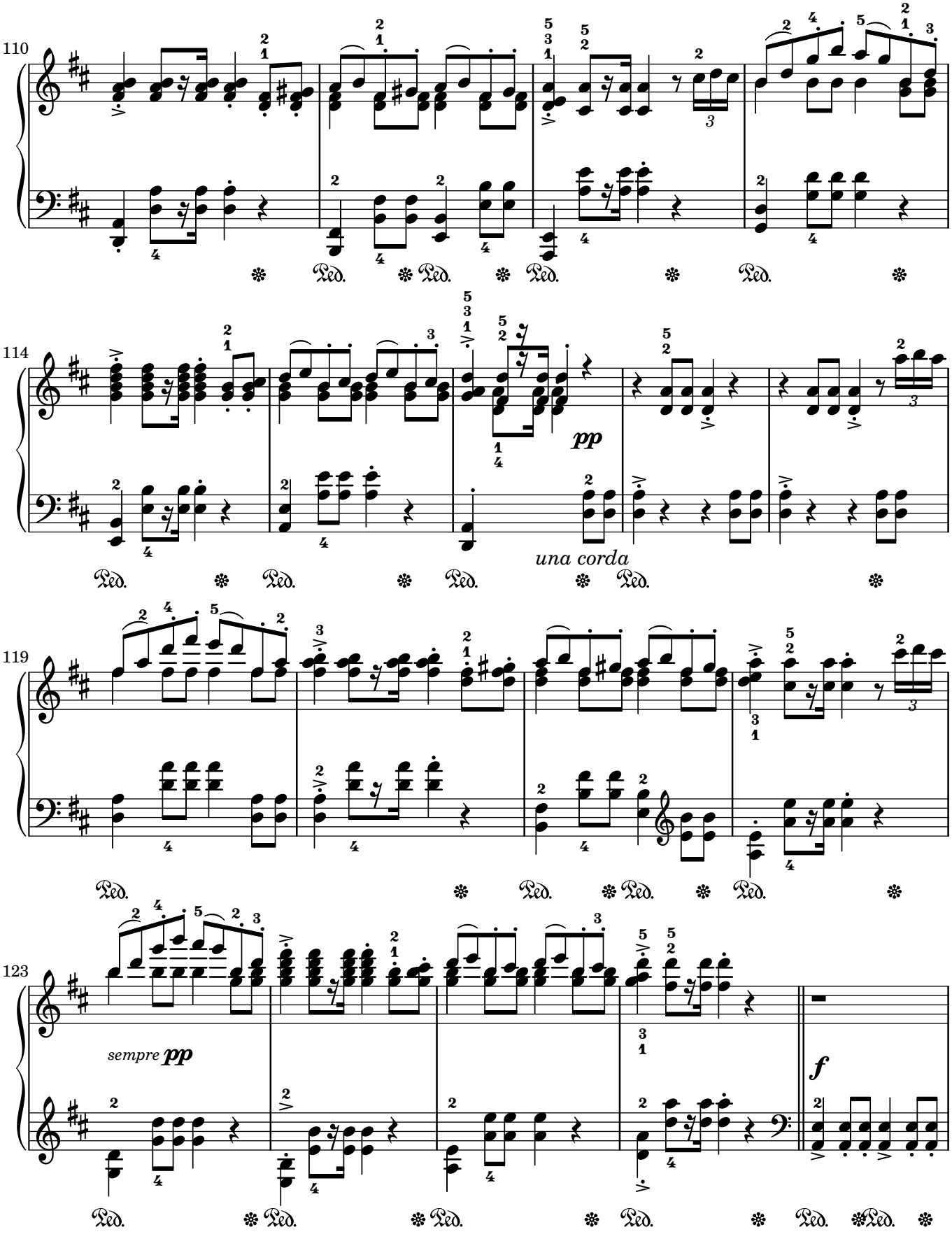



14
sempre pp
18
f
22
l.h.
dim.
pp
dolce
una corda
26
f
tre corde
dim.
pp
una corda
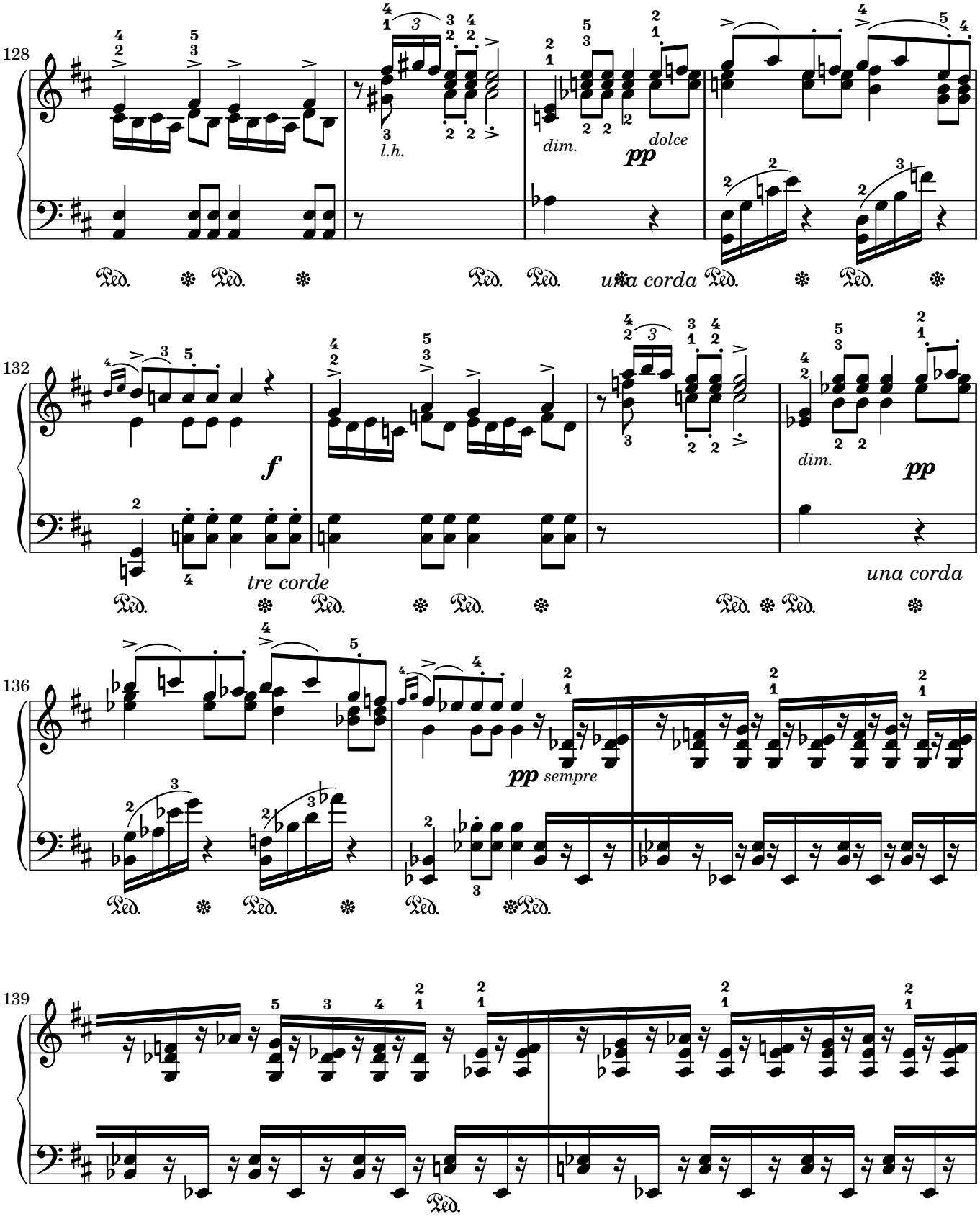

30
pp sempre
Ped.
33
Ped.
35
cresc. poco a poco
Ped
tre corde
37
Ped.
39
piú cresc.
Ped.
Ped.
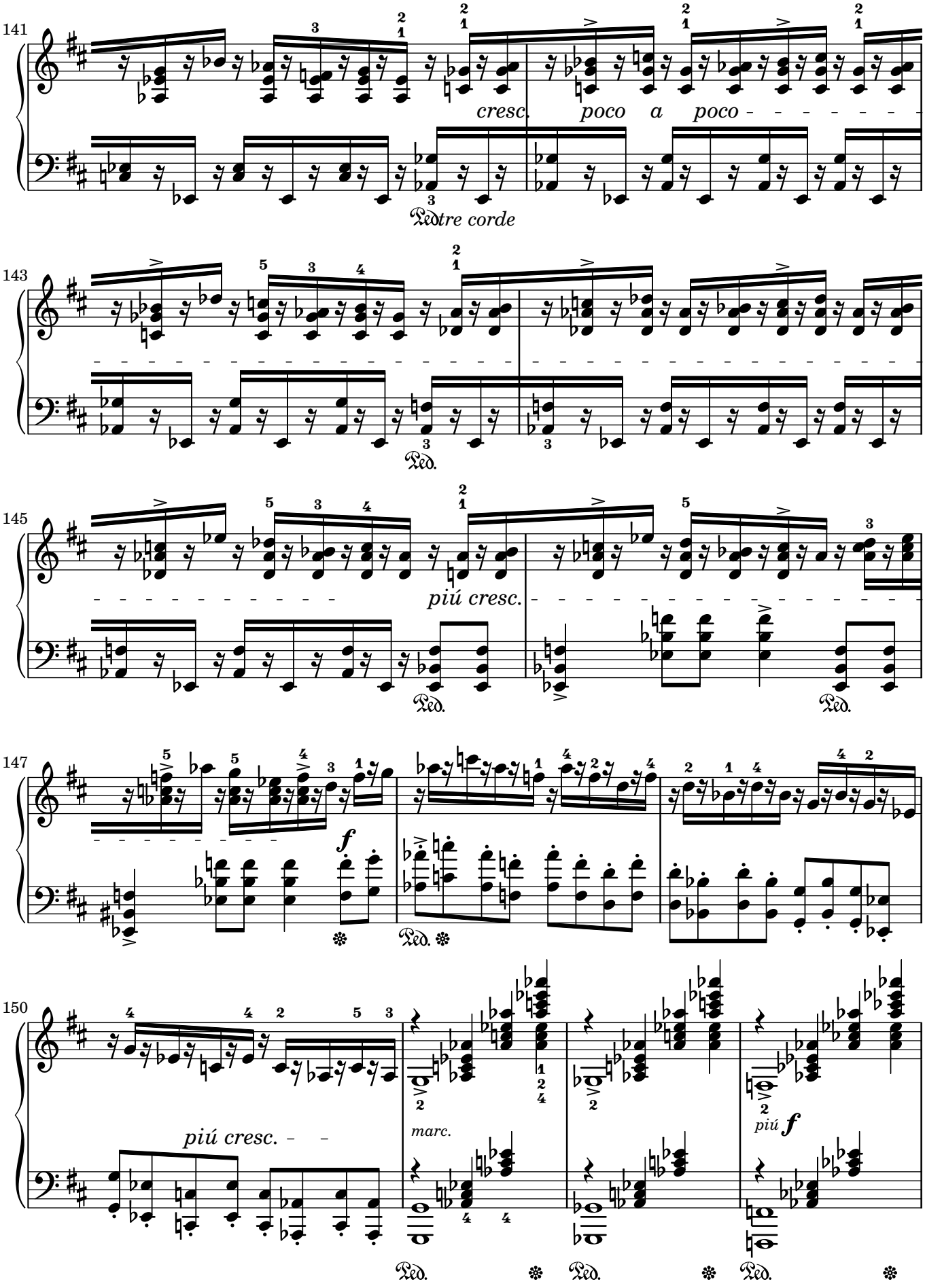

41
f
Ped.
43
piú cresc.
marc.
Ped.
46
piú f
poco rit.
a tempo
fff
Ped.
50
fz
fz
Ped.
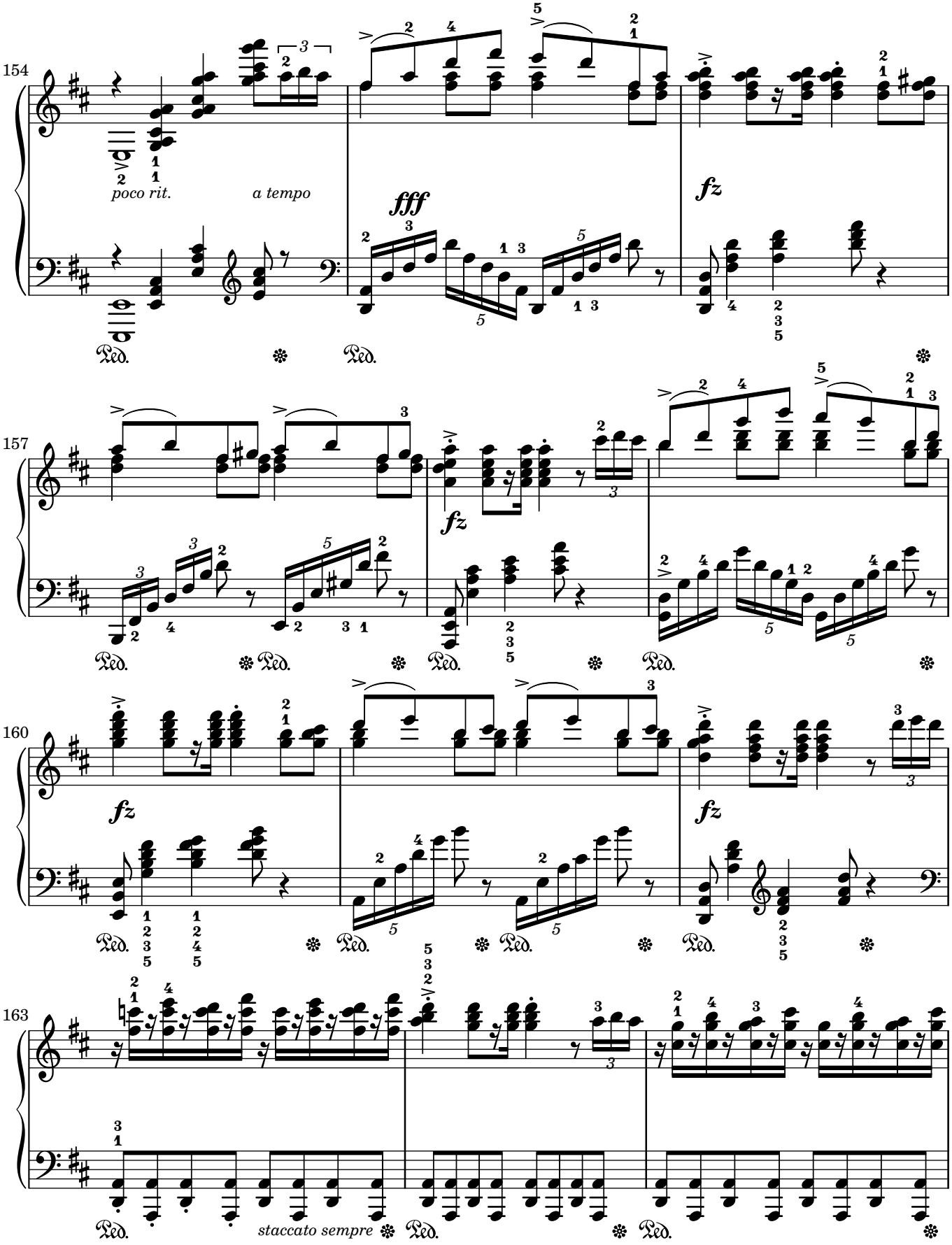

53
fz
56
fz
Poco tranquillo.
cantando
p
cantando
64
piú cresc
f
73
pp dolce
piú cresc.
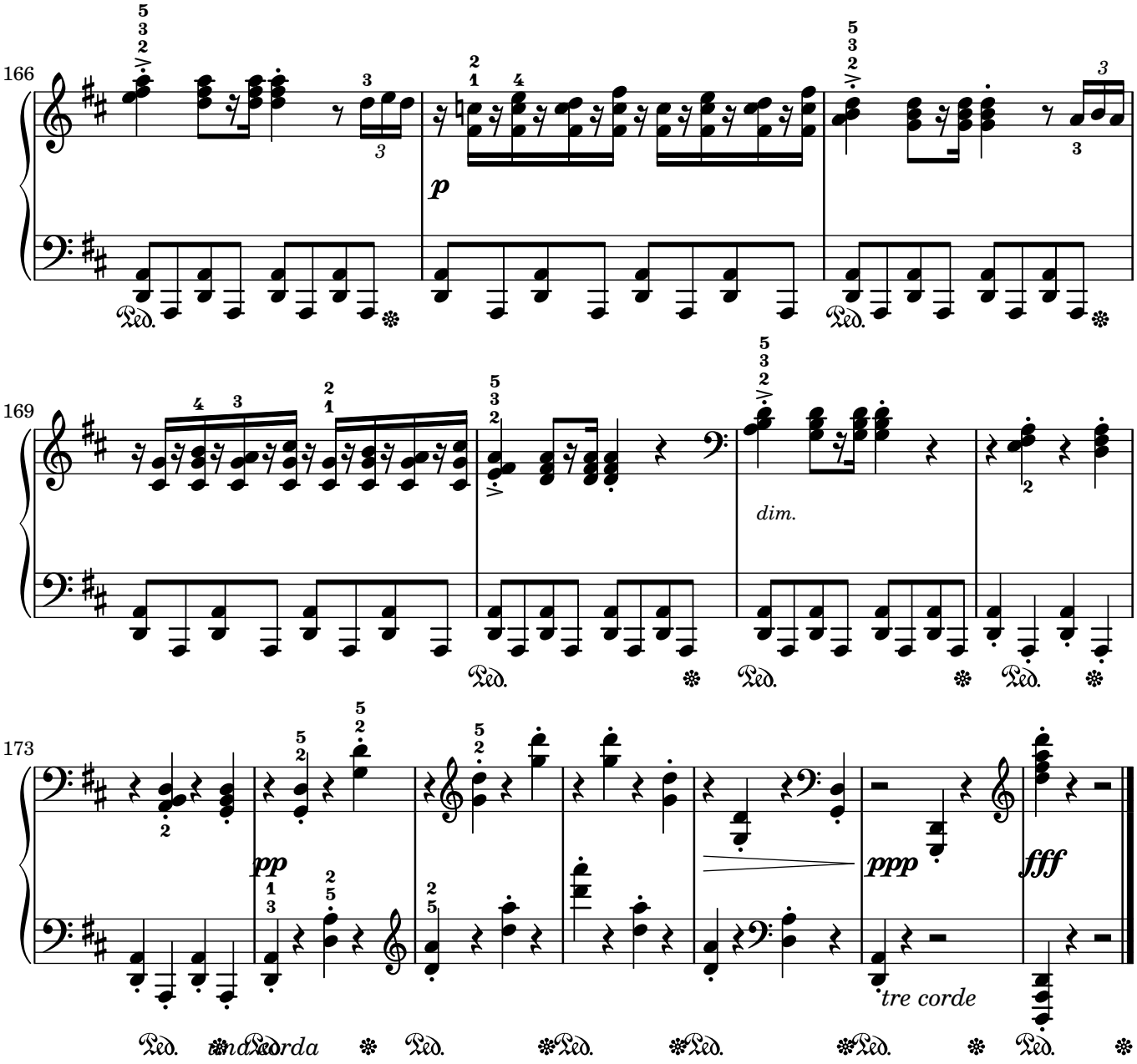

80
pp dolce
piú cresc.
88
p
97
piú cresc.
f
3
4 3 2
105
Tempo I.
p


110
114
pp
una corda
119
123
sempre pp
f


128
l.h.
dim.
dolce
pp
una corda
132
f
tre corde
dim.
pp
una corda
136
pp sempre
139


141
cresc. poco a poco
Tre corde
143
Ped.
145
piú cresc.
Ped.
Ped.
147
f
Ped.
150
piú cresc.
marc.
piú f
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.


154
poco rit.
a tempo
fff
fz
157
fz
160
fz
fz
163
staccato sempre


166
p
169
dim.
173
pp
ppp
fff
una corda
tre corde

January: By the Hearth, Op. 37a No. 1
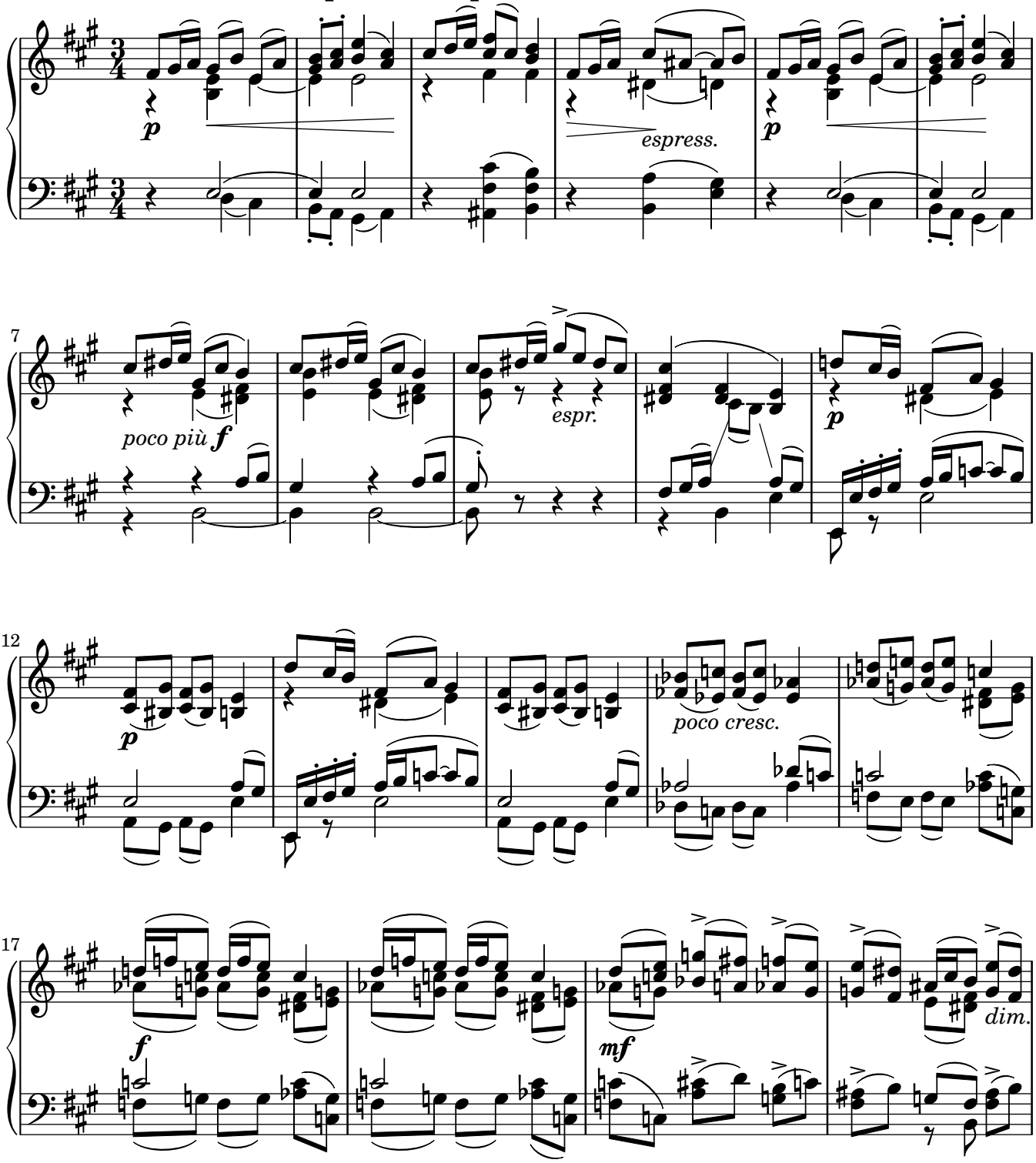
P. I. Tchaikovsky (1840-1893) - The Seasons (1876)
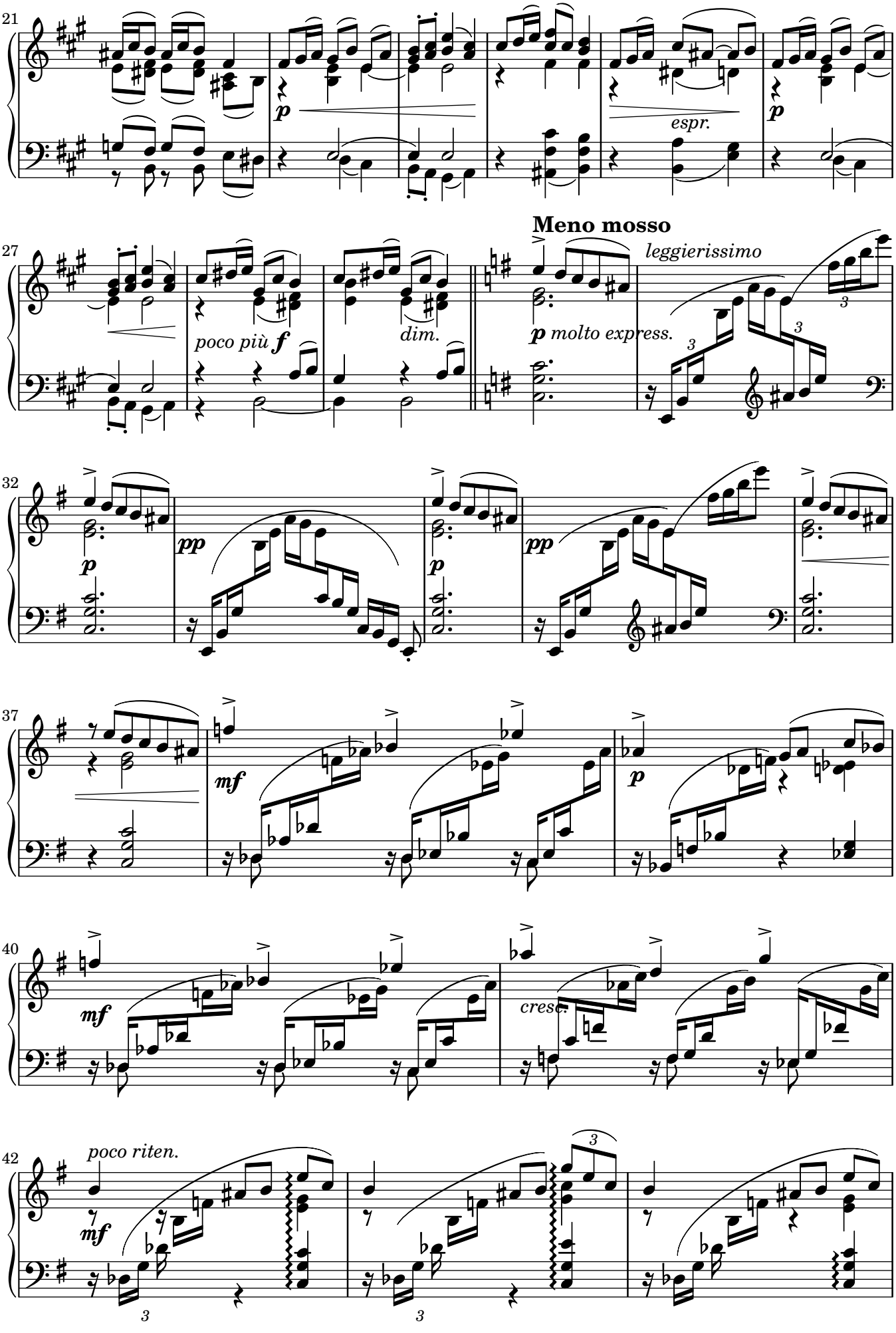
Level 9 · about 5 min
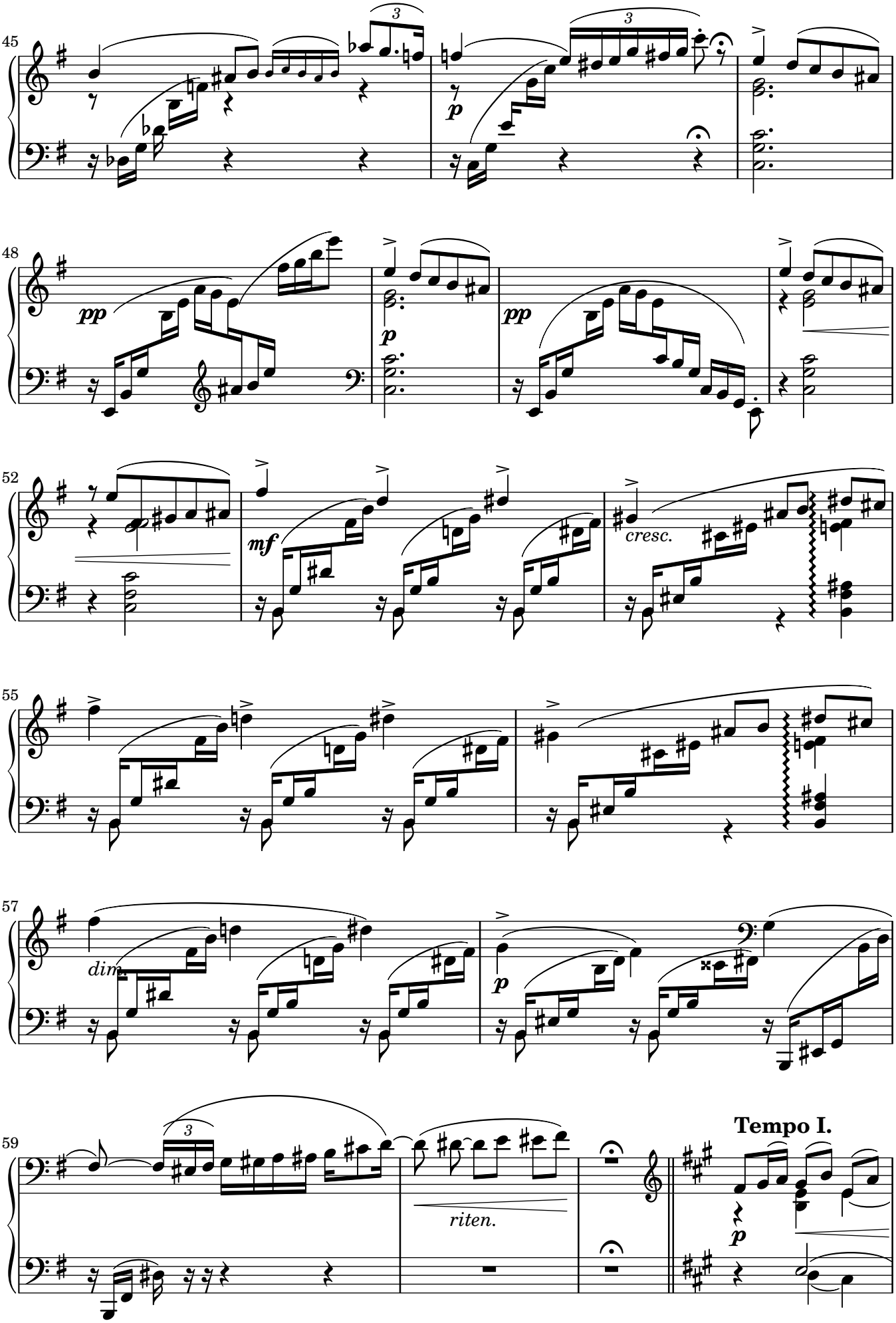
The first of Tchaikovsky's twelve pieces for the months of the year: a quiet, dreamy evening by the fire, with a livelier middle section. The melody passes between the hands and inner voices; mark which hand has it before learning the notes.
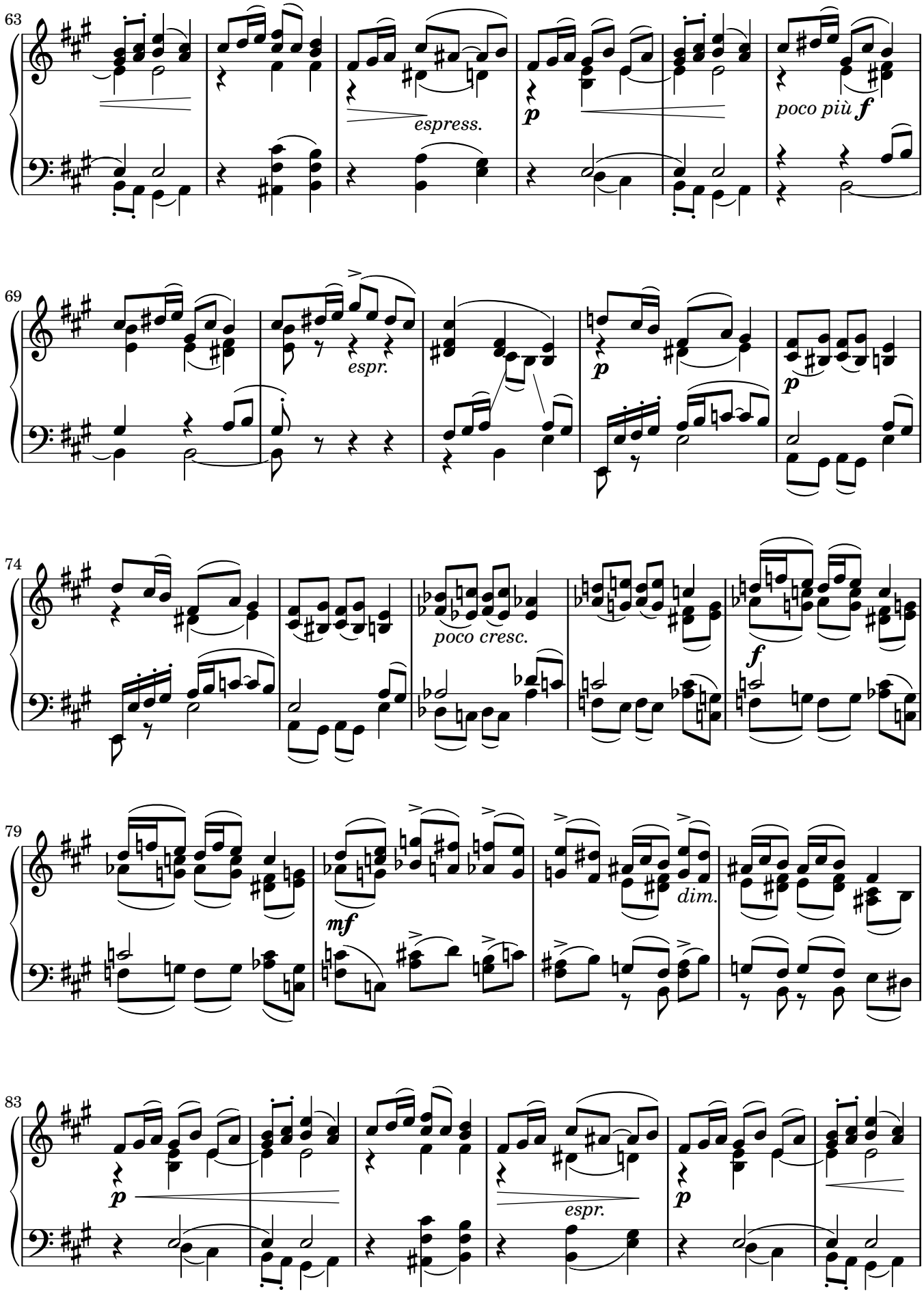
Source: Mutopia Project no. 1171, typeset by Till Rettig (public domain).
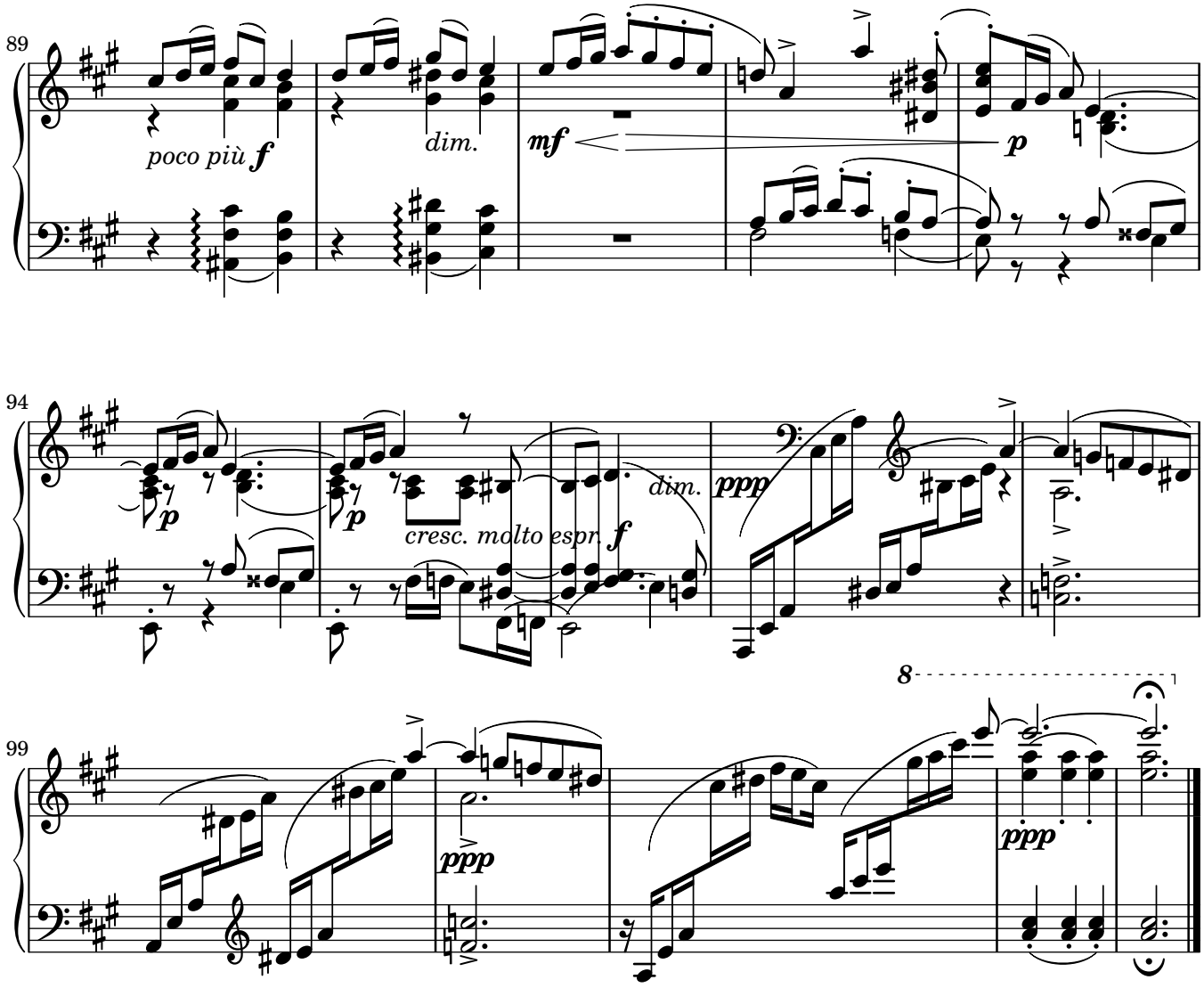
Moderato simplice ma espressivo




21
p
espr.
p
27
Meno mosso
poco più f
dim.
p molto express.
leggierissimo
32
p
pp
p
pp
37
mf
p
40
mf
cresc.
42
poco riten.
mf


45
48
52
55
57
59
pp
p
mf
cresc.
dim.
riten.
Tempo I.


63
espress.
p
poco più f
69
espr.
p
p
74
poco cresc.
f
79
mf
dim.
83
p
espr.
p


89
poco più f
dim.
mf
p
94
p
p
cresc. molto espr.
f
dim.
ppp
8
99
ppp
ppp
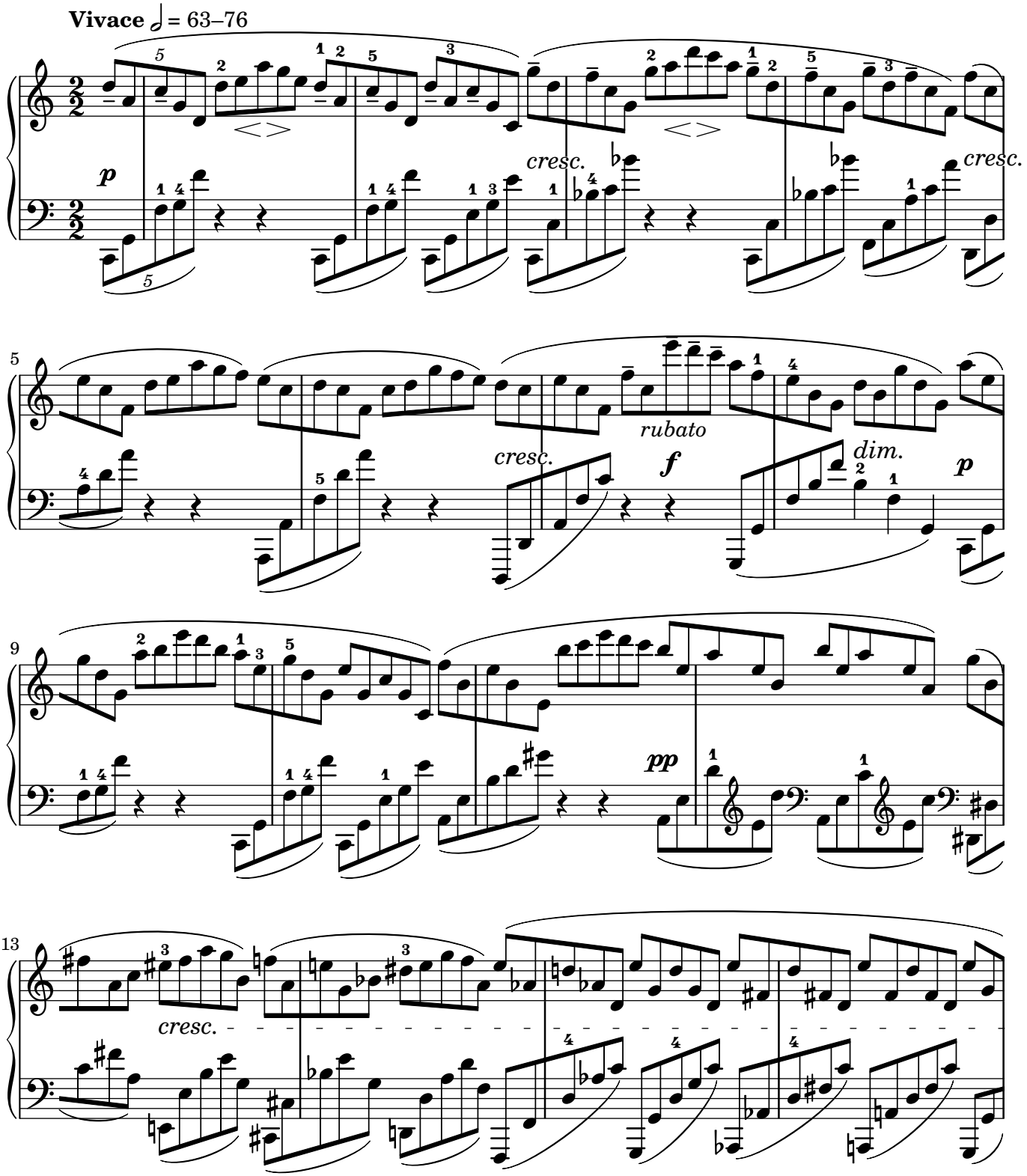
Prelude in C, Op. 11 No. 1

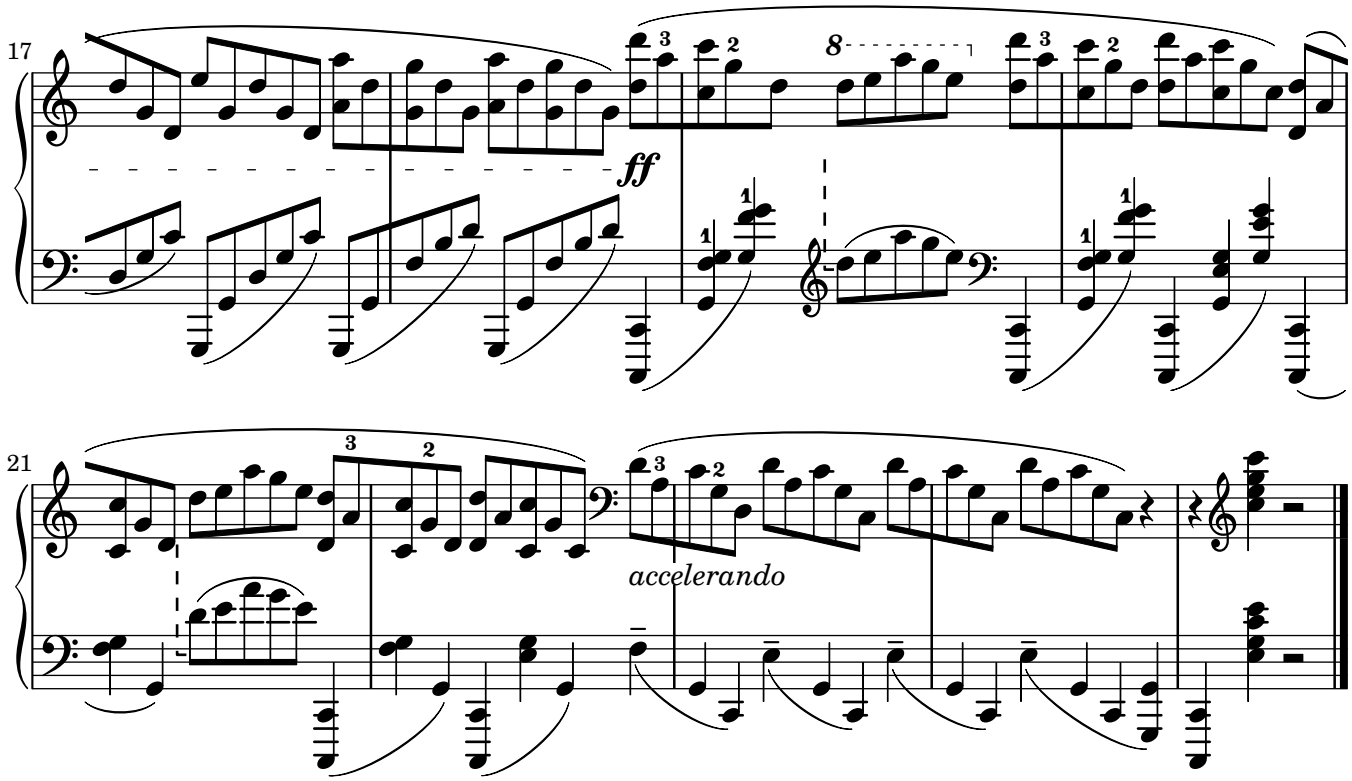
A. Scriabin (1872-1915) - 24 Preludes, Op. 11 (1888-1896)

Level 9 · about 1 min

The first of Scriabin's 24 preludes, which follow Chopin's plan through all the keys. Rippling quintuplets shared between the hands, with the melody in the top notes: think of the groups of five as one gesture, not five notes.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1779, typeset by Keith OHara (public domain).




17
ff
8
21
accelerando
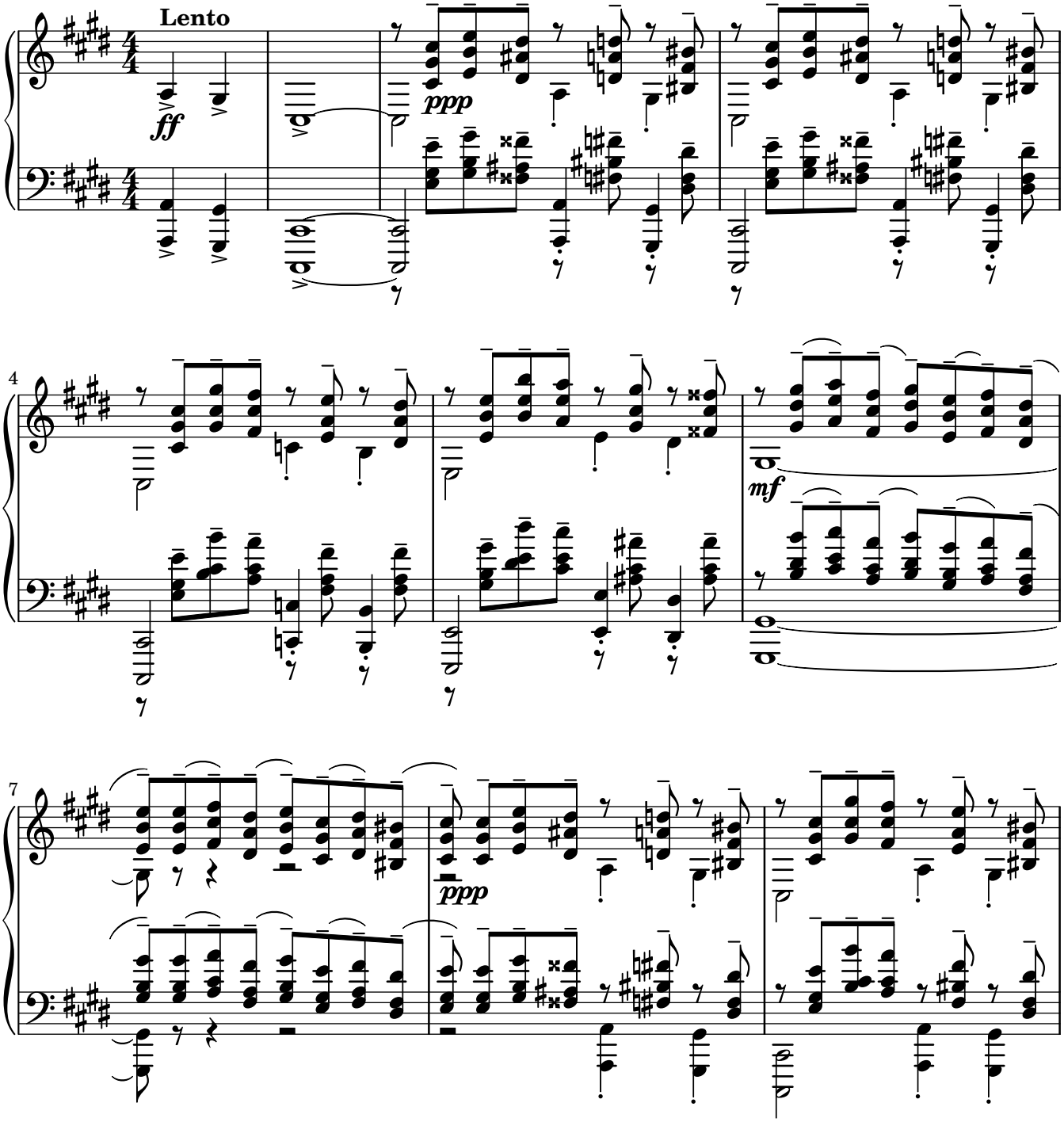
Prelude in C-sharp minor, Op. 3 No. 2
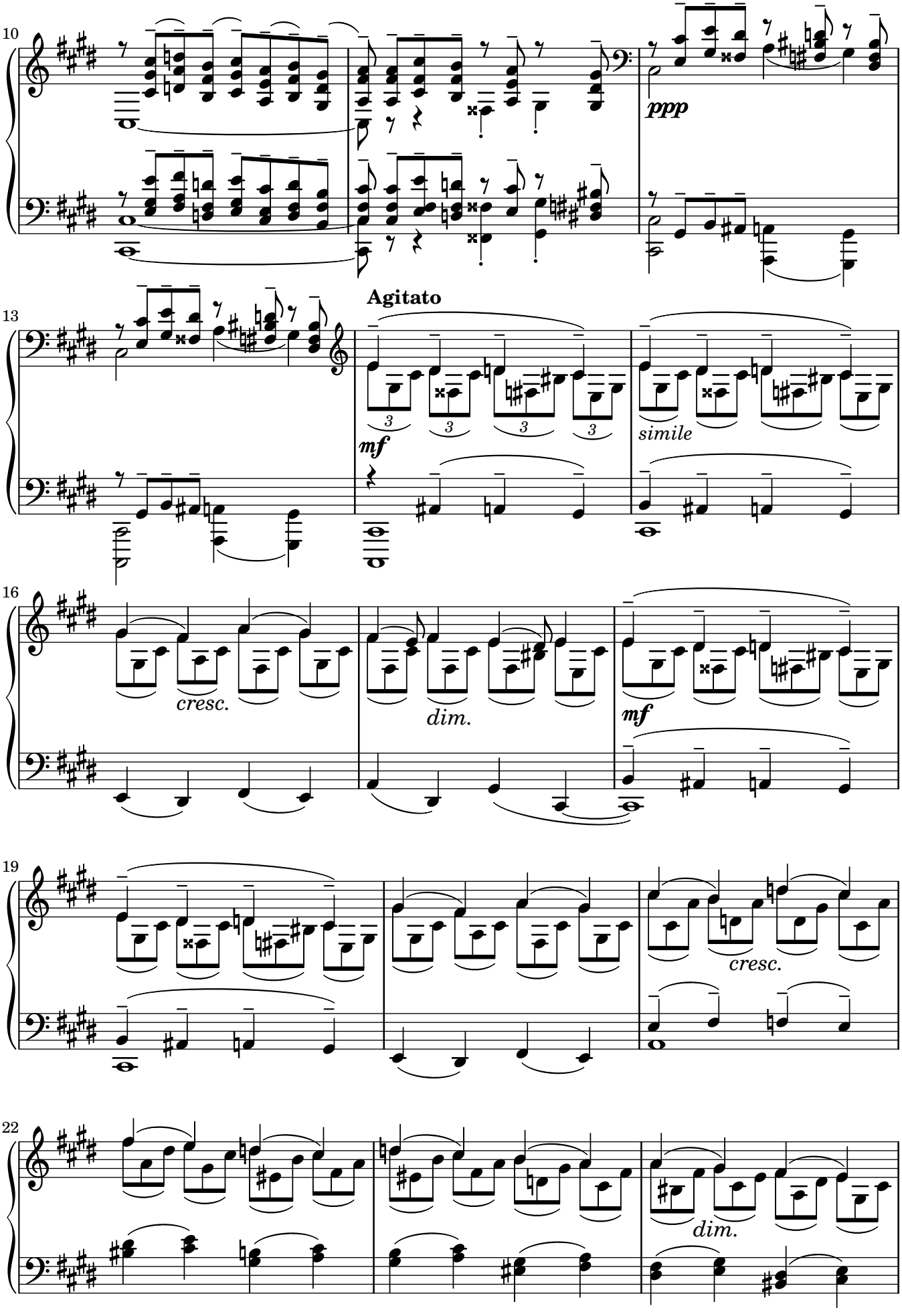
S. Rachmaninoff (1873-1943) - Morceaux de fantaisie, Op. 3 (1892)
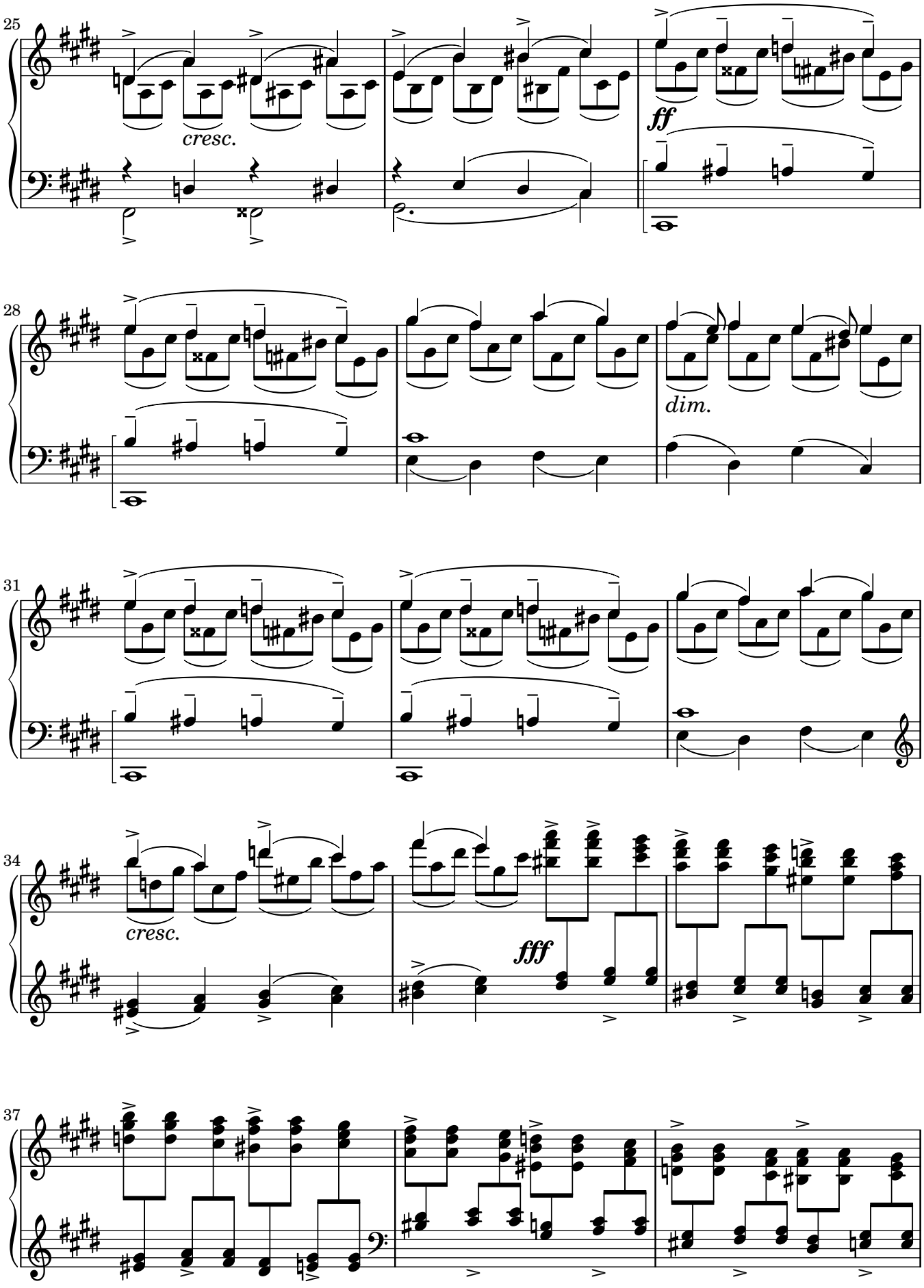
Level 10 · about 4 min
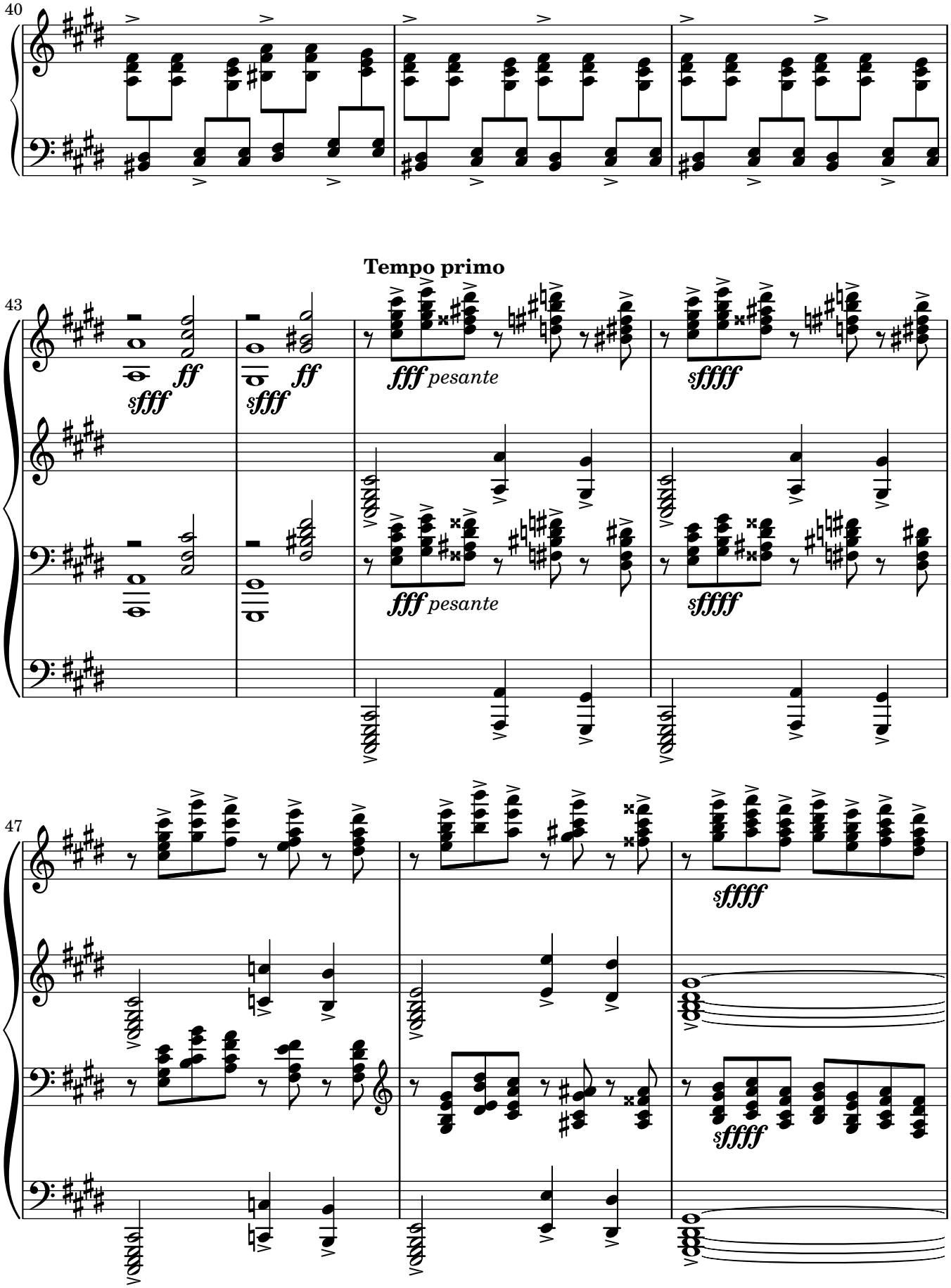
The prelude that made Rachmaninoff famous at nineteen (two excerpts were in Volume 6): three bell-like chords, a quiet chordal section, a stormy middle in triplets and a climax on four staves. Plan the hand positions for every chord of the climax; play the opening chords with the weight of the arm, not by hitting.
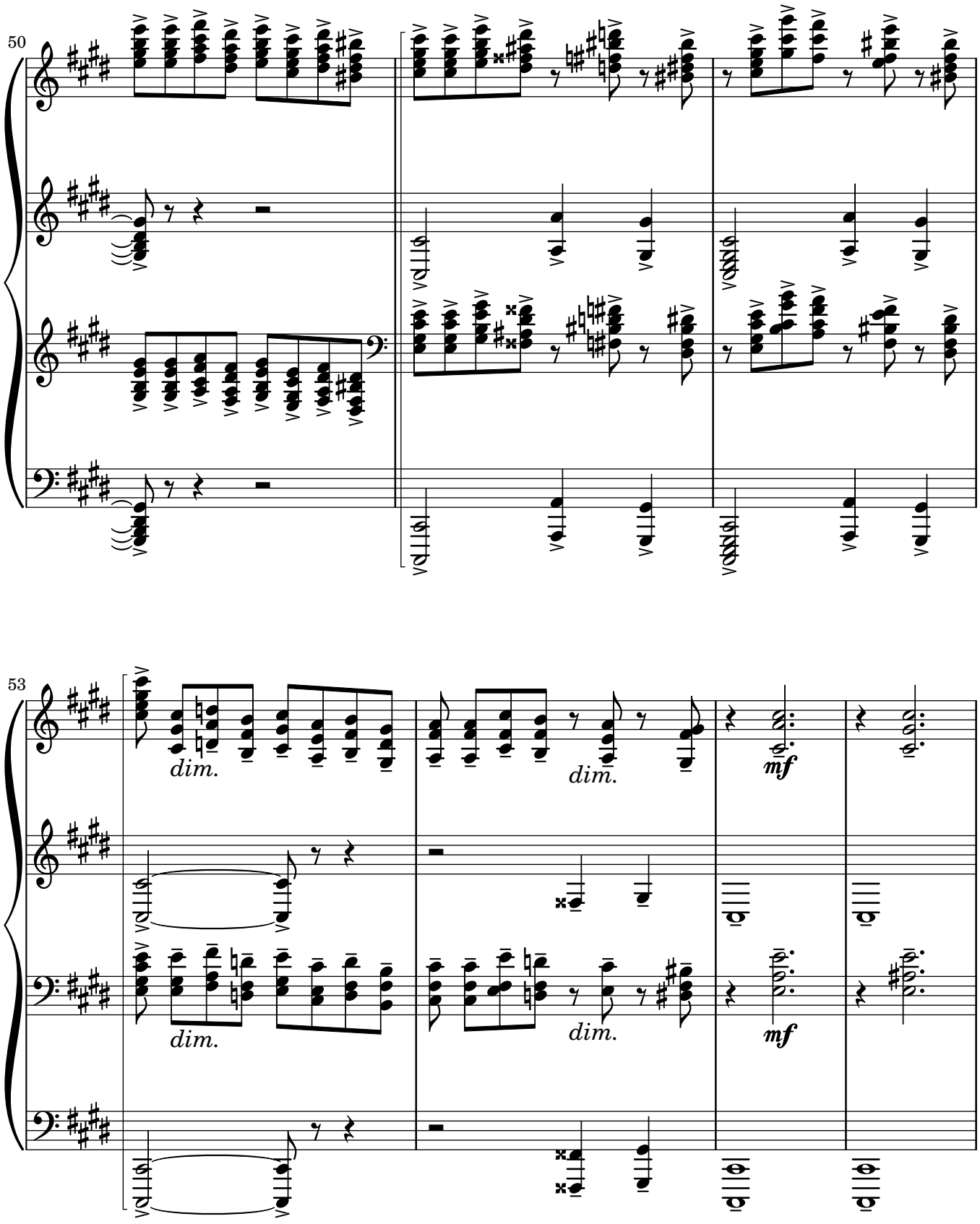
Source: Mutopia Project no. 2033, typeset by Petro Kostandy (CC BY-SA 4.0).
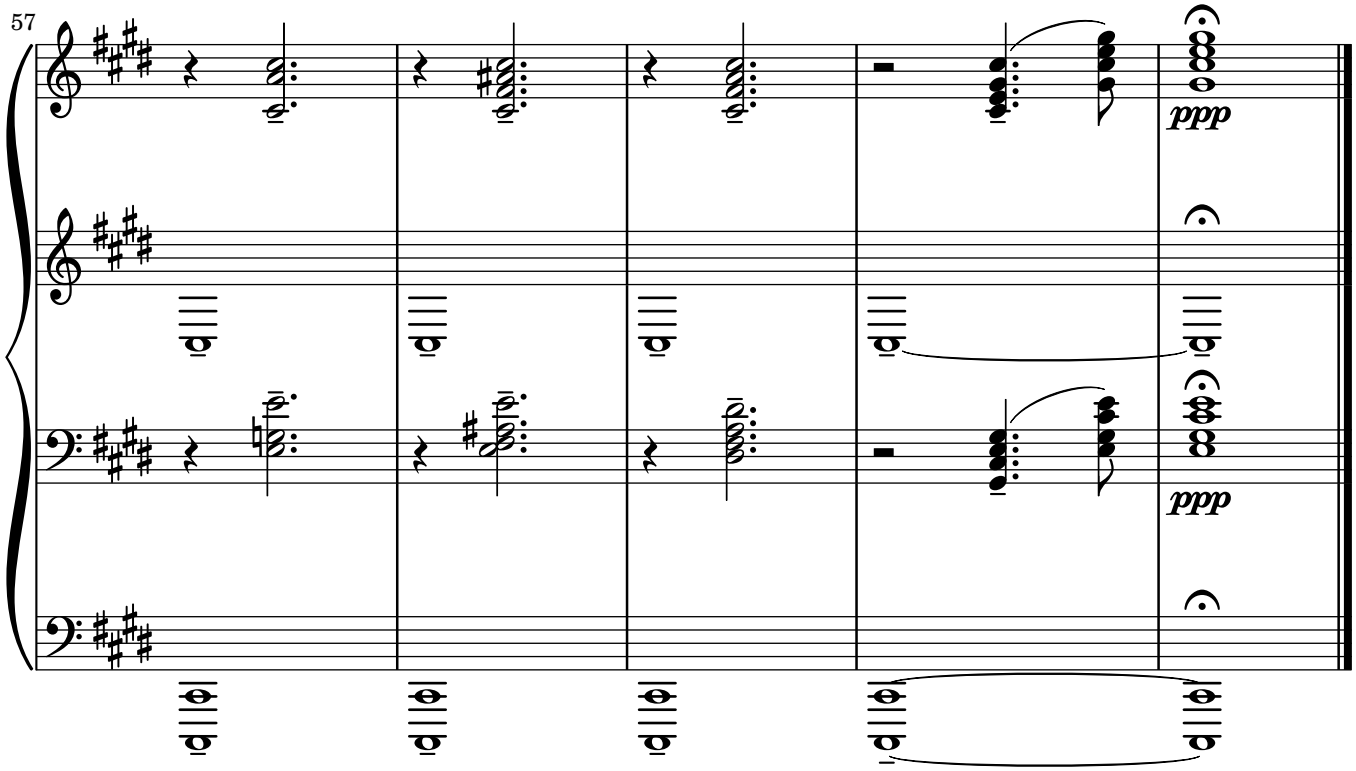



10
ppp
13
Agitato
mf
simile
16
cresc.
dim.
mf
19
cresc.
22
dim.


25
cresc.
ff
28
dim.
31
34
cresc.
fff
37


40
Tempo primo
43
sfff ff
fff pesante
sffff
47
sffff


50
53
dim.
dim.
dim.
dim.
mf
mf


57
ppp
ppp

Section 5
Into the twentieth century

Around 1900 three very different composers turn away from the Romantic piano: Satie with slow, bare dances; Joplin with ragtime, the syncopated piano music of America; and Debussy with harmony heard as colour.

What it asks of you

For Satie: absolute calm, an even left hand and a pedal changed on every bar. For Joplin: a strict, steady left hand ('never play ragtime fast', he wrote) under a syncopated right hand, crisp and light.

In this section

S. Joplin: Maple Leaf Rag *(Level 9)*

C. Debussy: Arabesque No. 1 *(Level 9)*

C. Debussy: Arabesque No. 2 *(Level 9)*

C. Debussy: Clair de lune *(Level 9)*
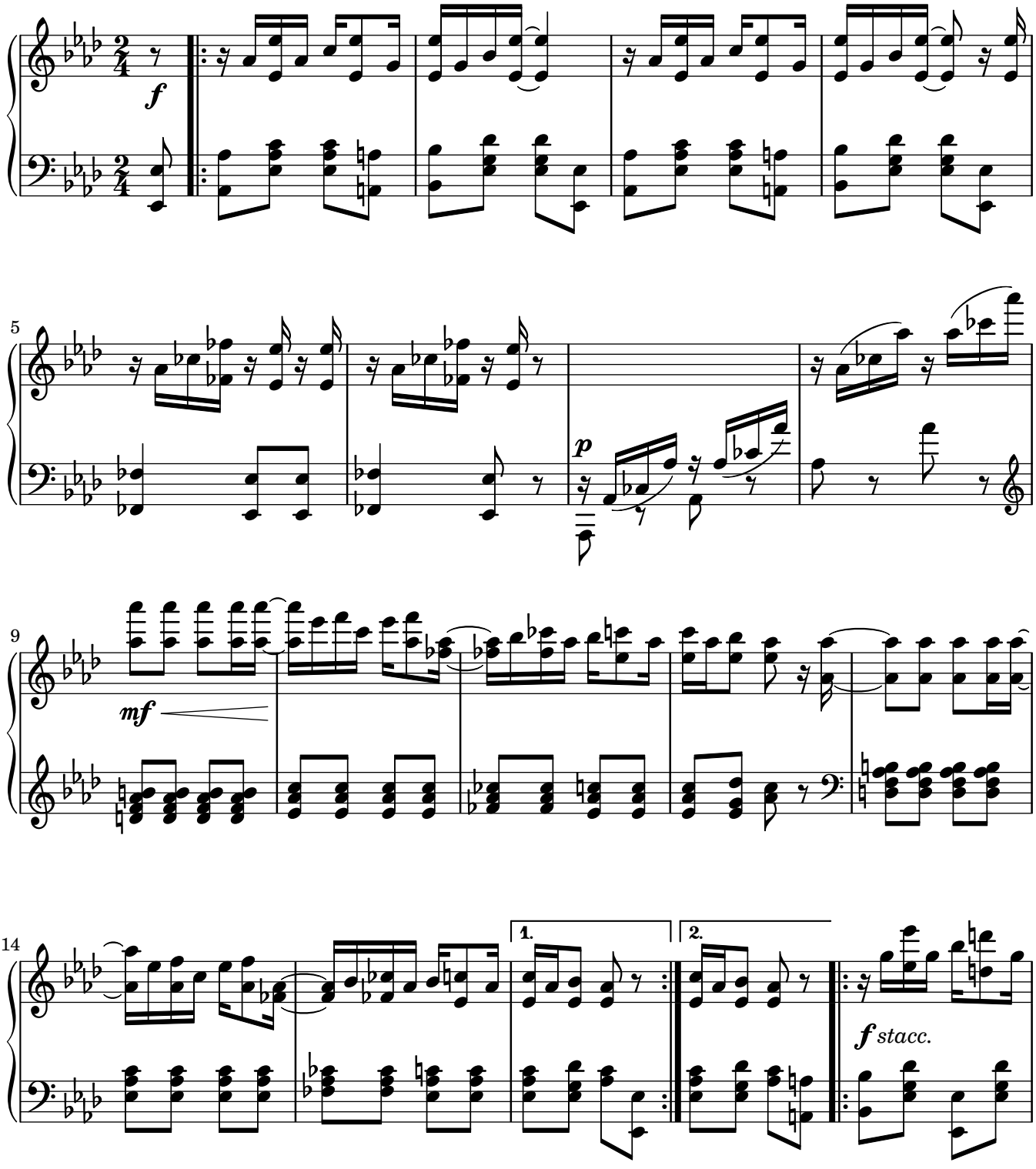
Maple Leaf Rag
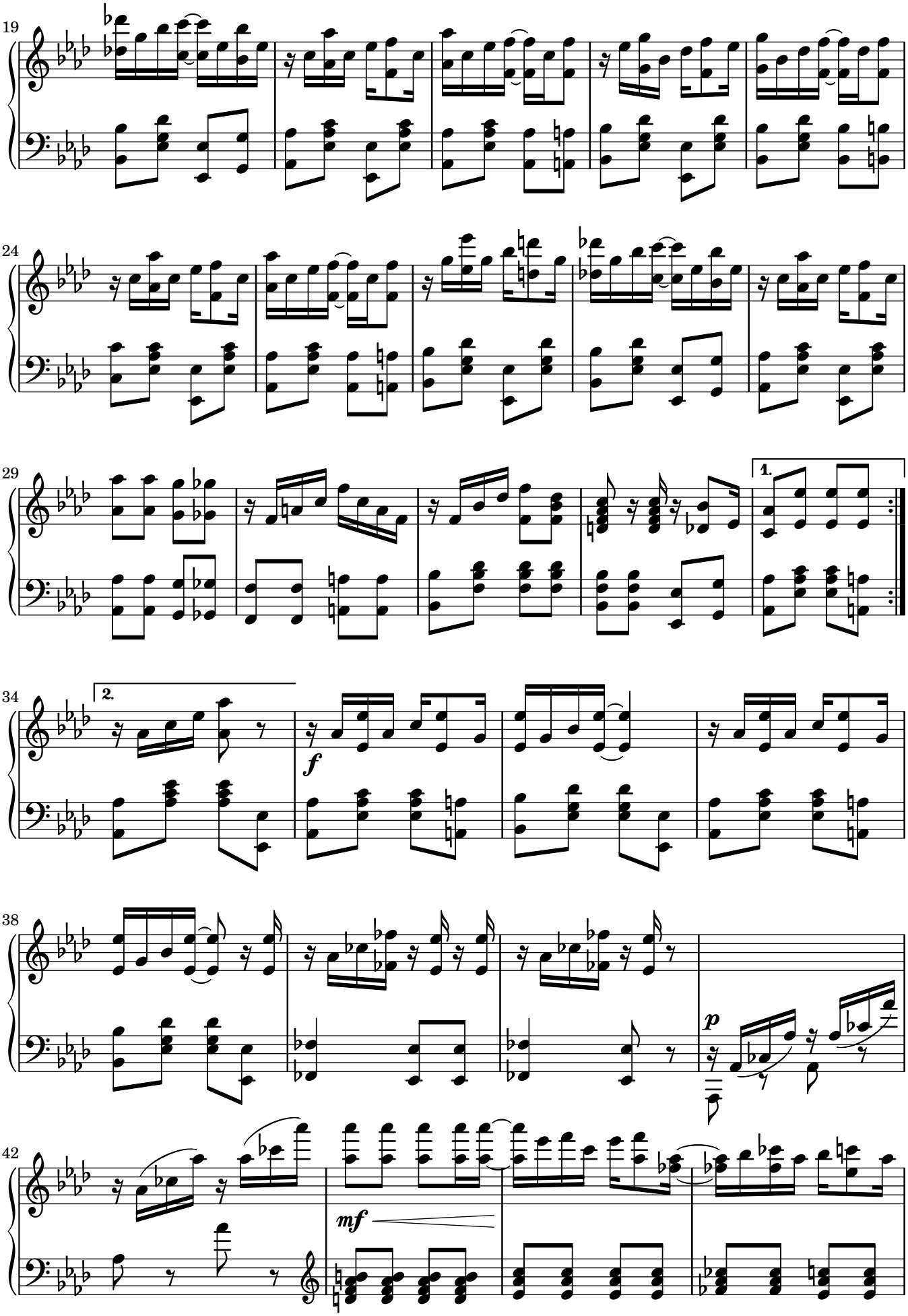
S. Joplin (1868-1917) - (1899)
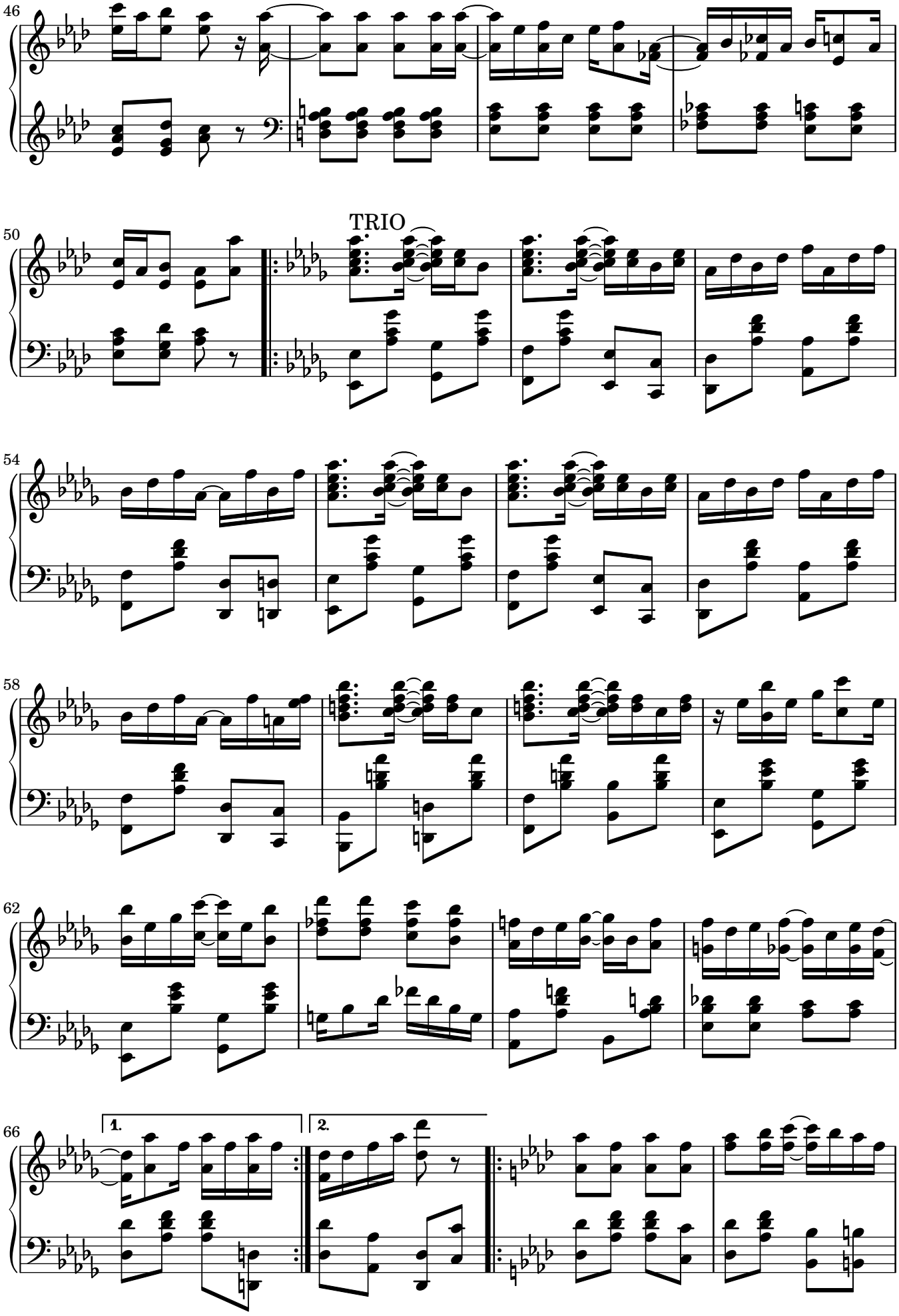
Level 9 · about 3 min
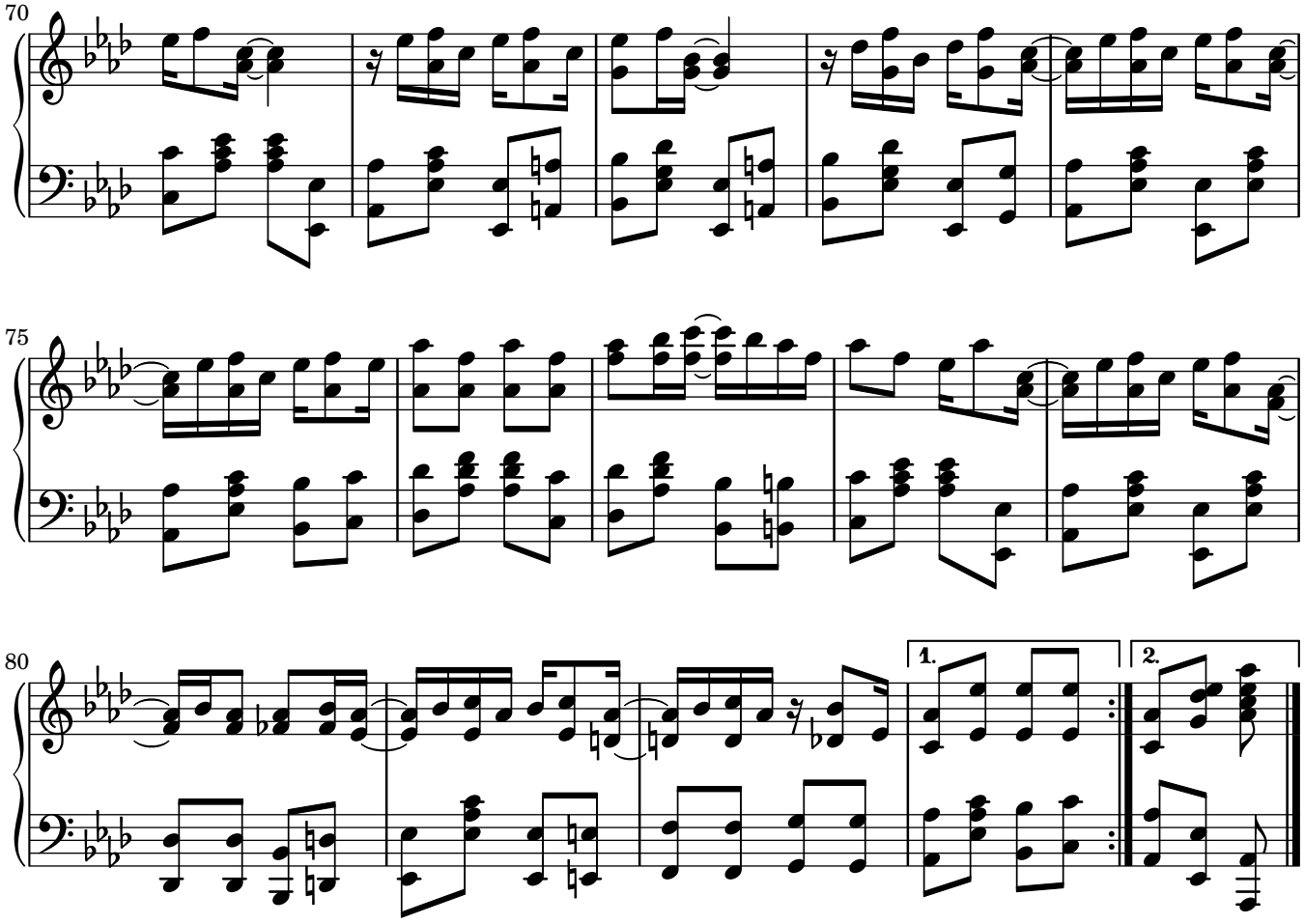
Joplin's first great success, which made ragtime famous and him 'the King of Ragtime'. Four strains with wide left-hand jumps between bass octaves and chords; learn the left hand alone until the jumps are safe. 'Do not play this piece fast', Joplin wrote.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 23, typeset by Chris Sawer (public domain).




19
24
29
1.
34
2.
f
38
p
42
mf


46
50
TRIO
54
58
62
66
1.
2.


70
75
80
1.
2.
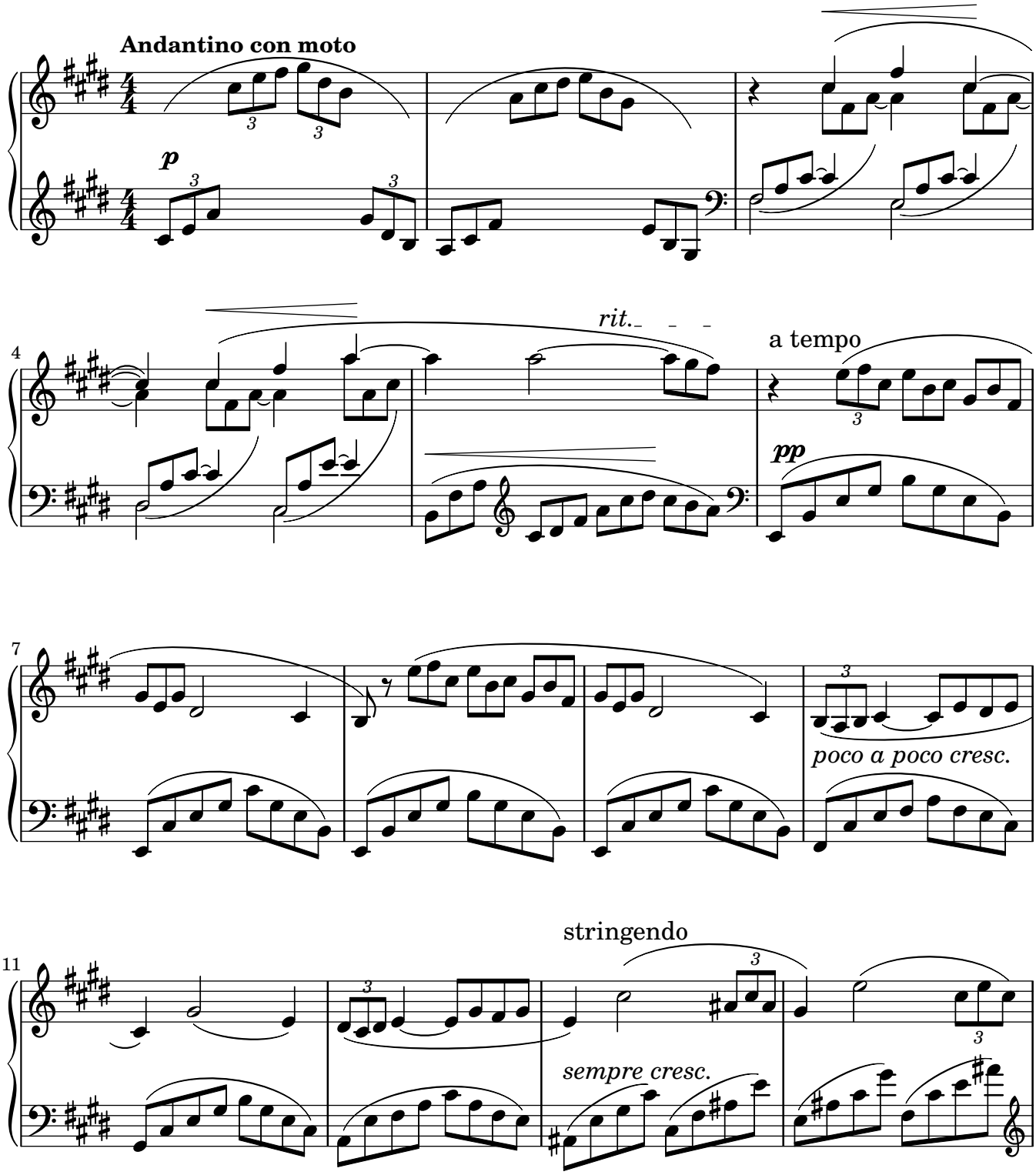
Arabesque No. 1
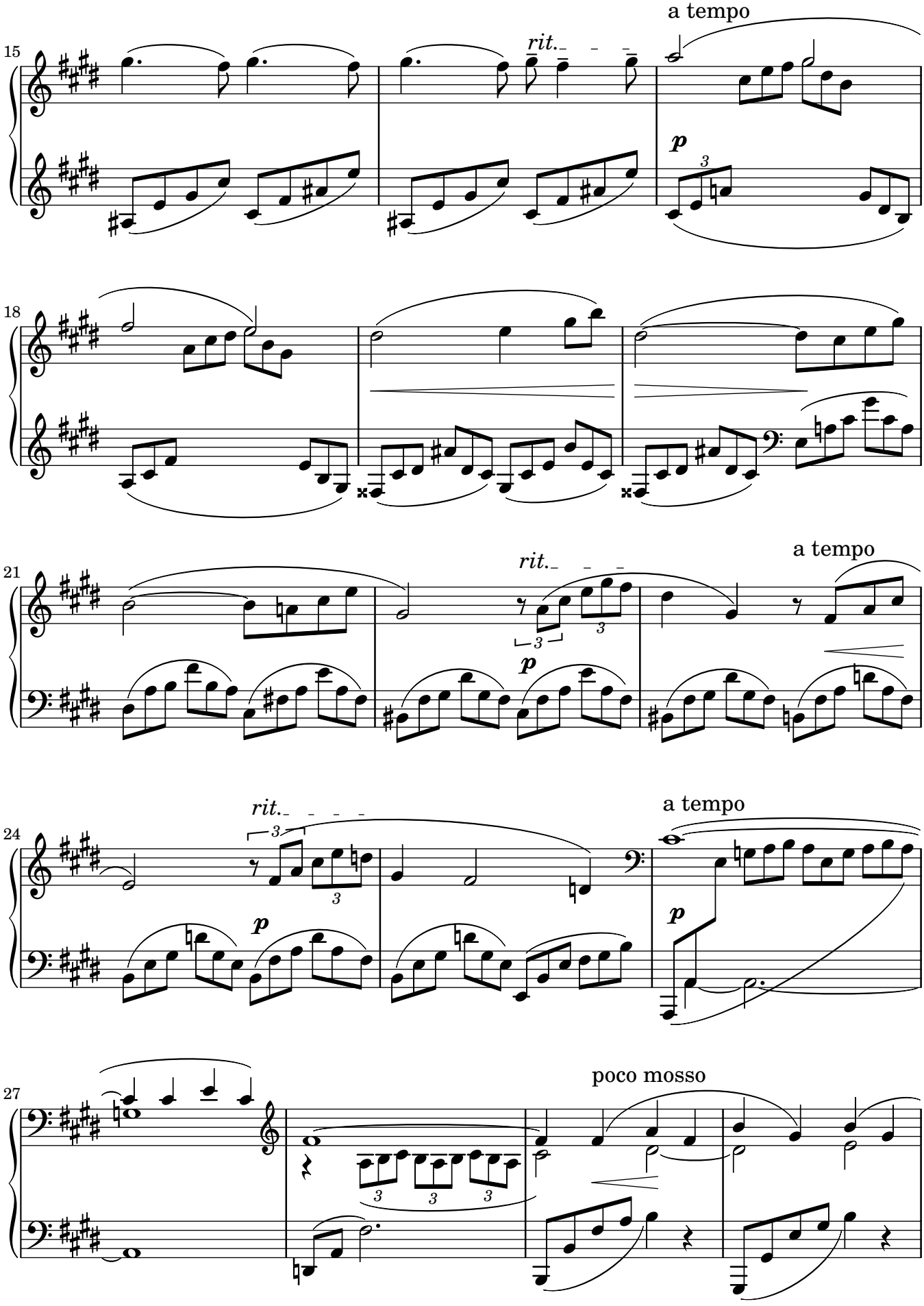
C. Debussy (1862-1918) - Deux Arabesques (1888-1891)
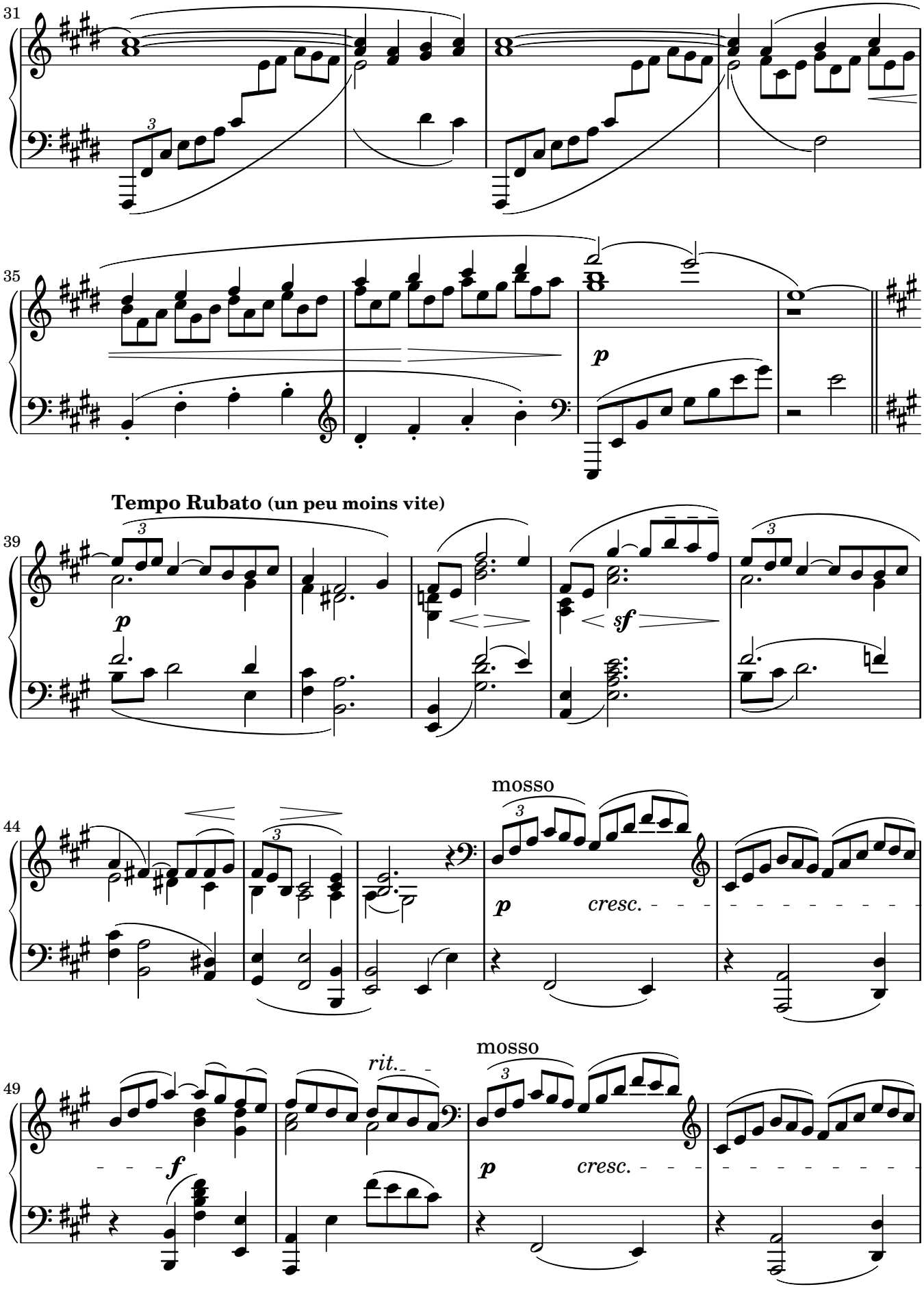
Level 9 · about 4 min
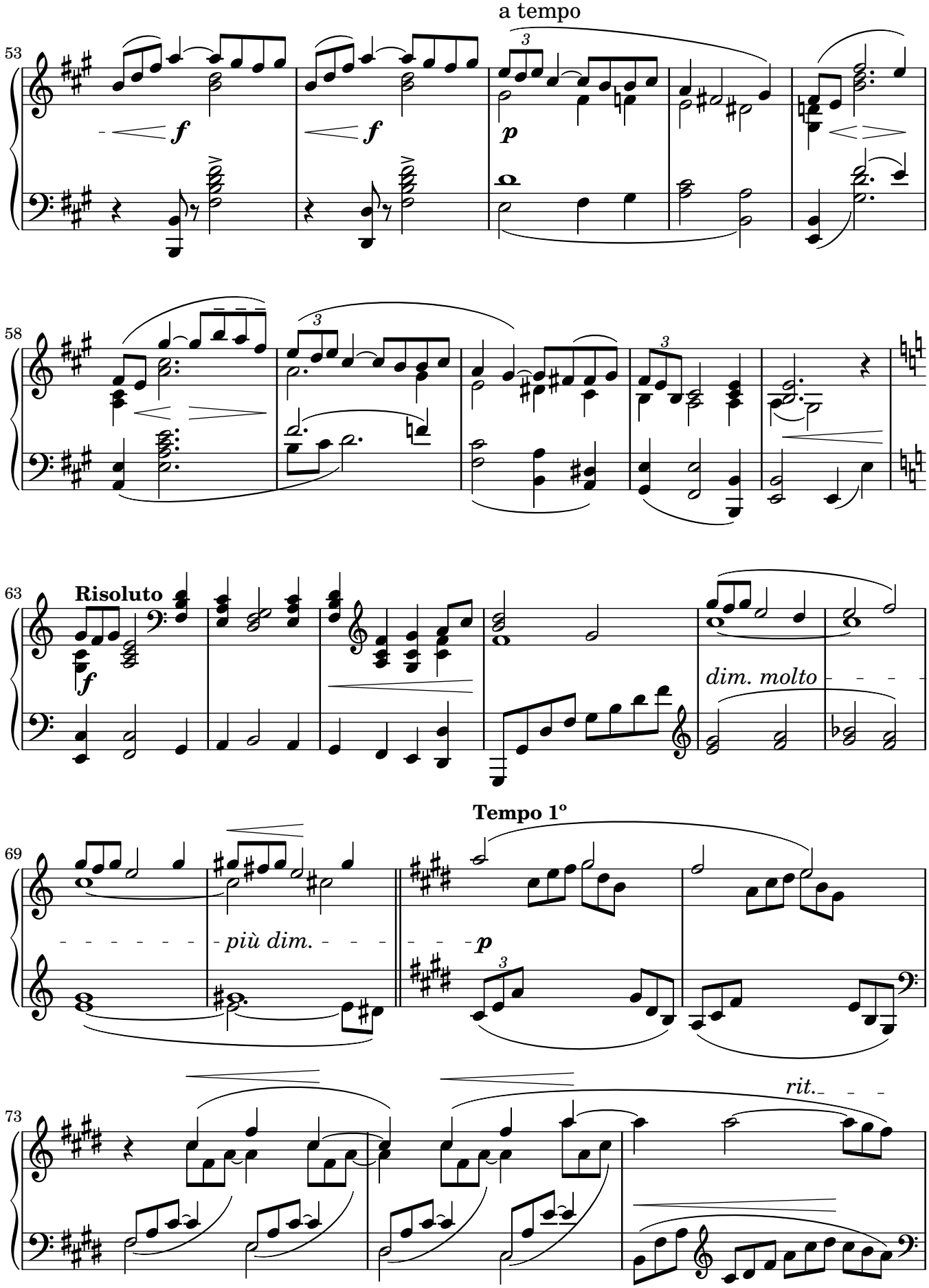
Flowing triplets in both hands and a melody that floats above them (the opening was an excerpt in Volume 6). The two-against-three passages need slow practice; then let the music move freely, with the pedal blurring nothing.
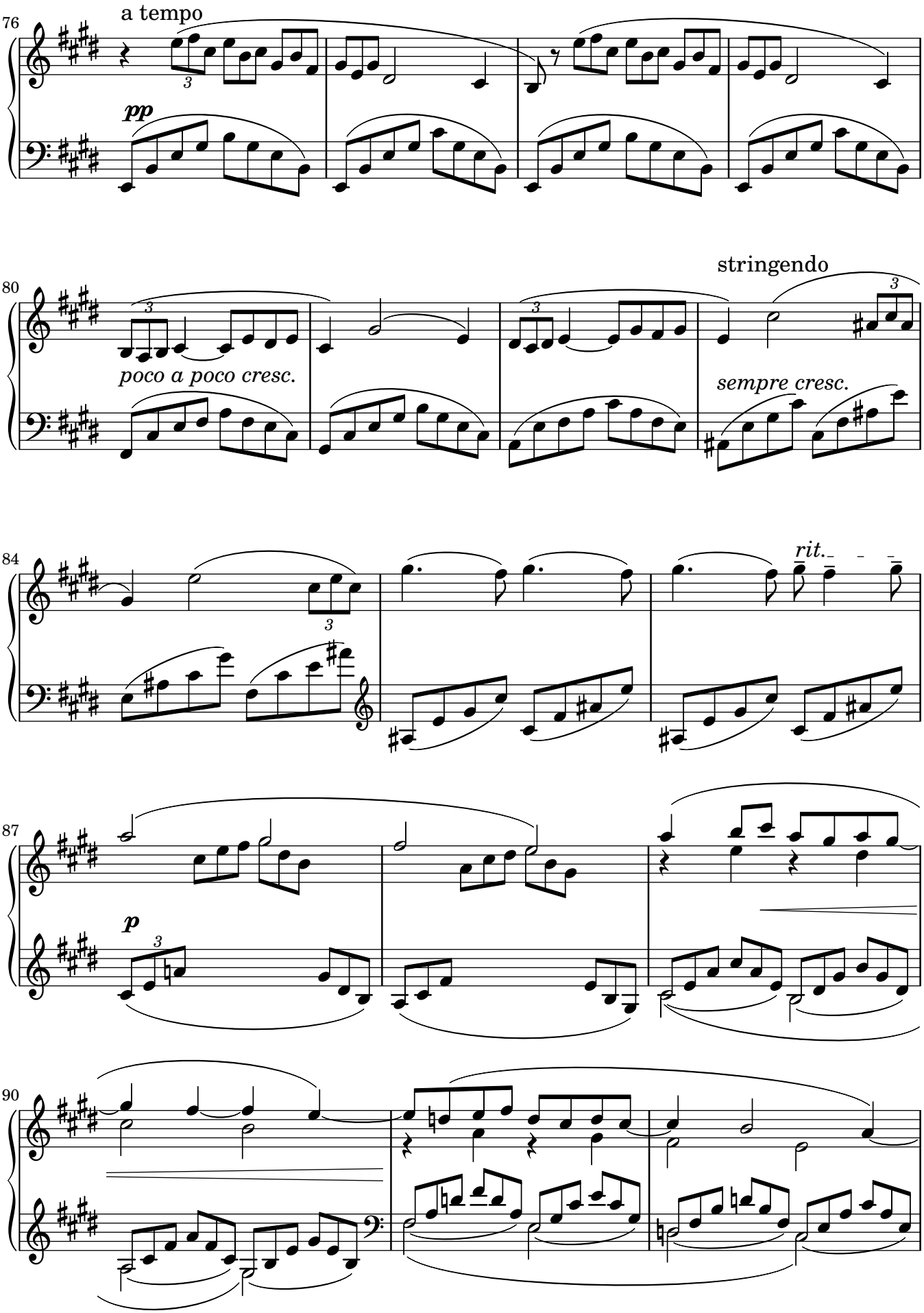
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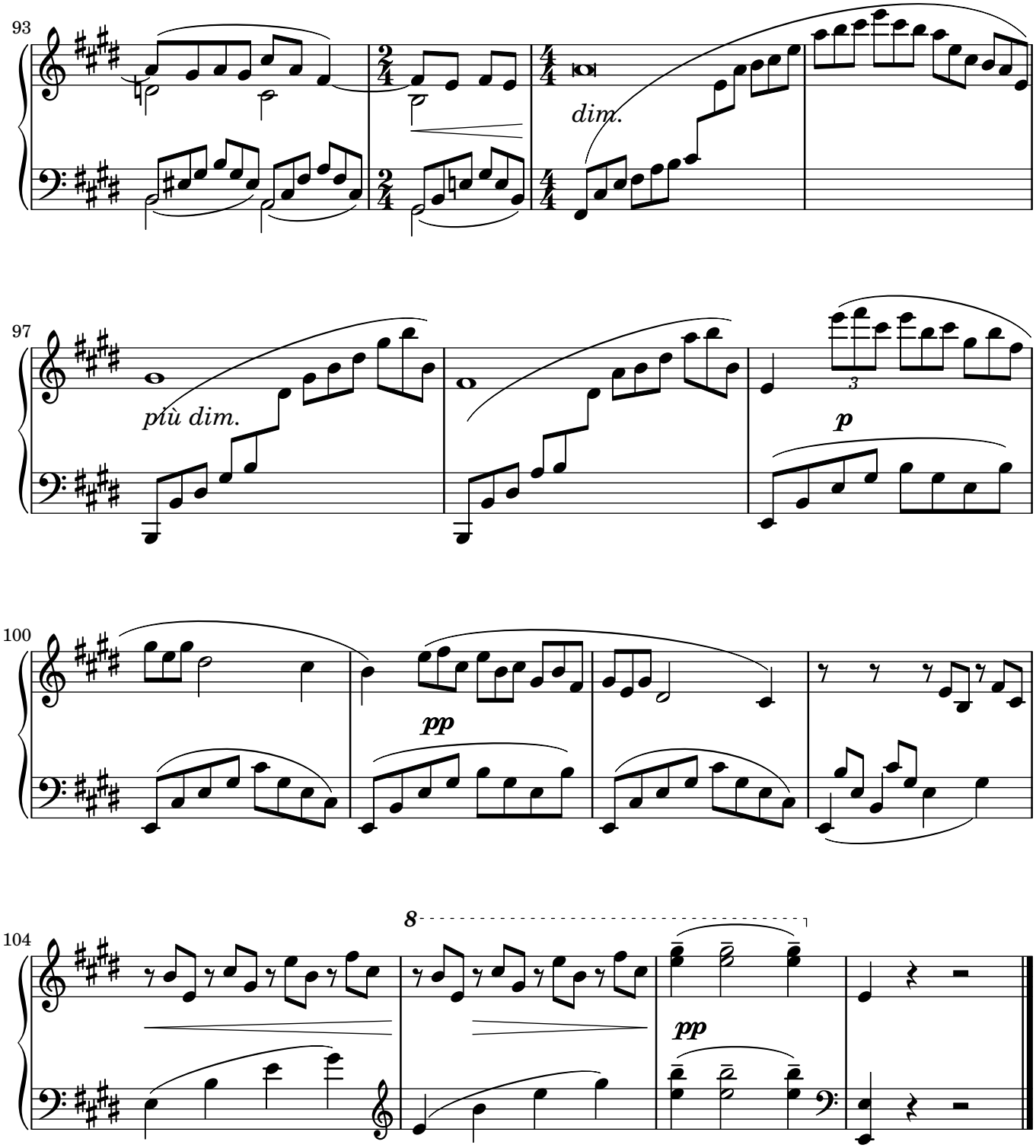



15
rit.
a tempo
p
18
21
rit.
a tempo
p
24
rit.
a tempo
p
27
poco mosso


31
35
p
Tempo Rubato (un peu moins vite)
39
p
sf
44
mosso
p
cresc.
49
rit.
mosso
f
p
cresc.


a tempo
53
f
f
p
58
63
Risoluto
f
dim. molto
69
Tempo 1º
più dim.
p
73
rit.


76
a tempo
pp
80
poco a poco cresc.
stringendo
sempre cresc.
84
rit.
87
p
90


93
dim.
97
più dim.
p
100
pp
104
8
pp
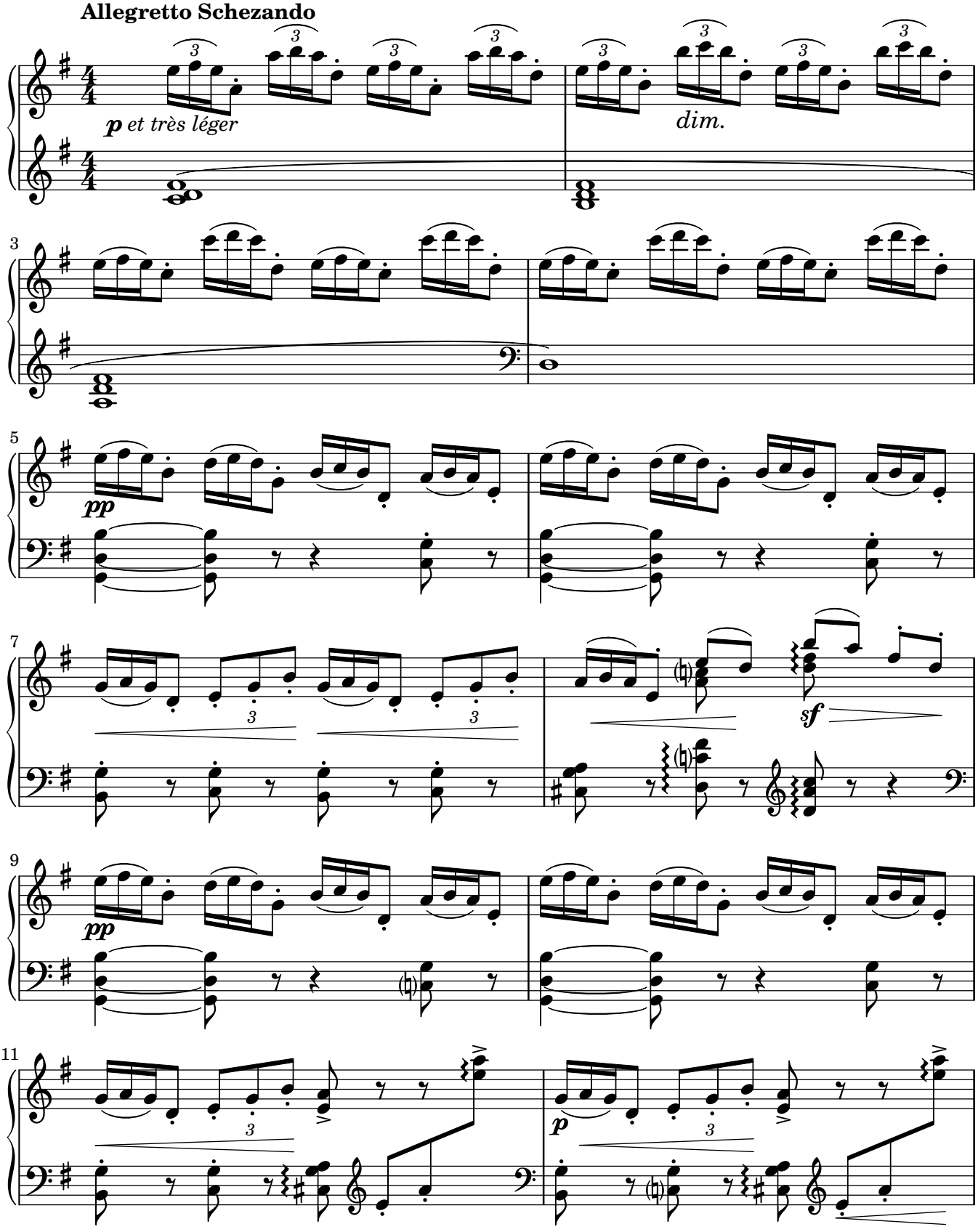
Arabesque No. 2
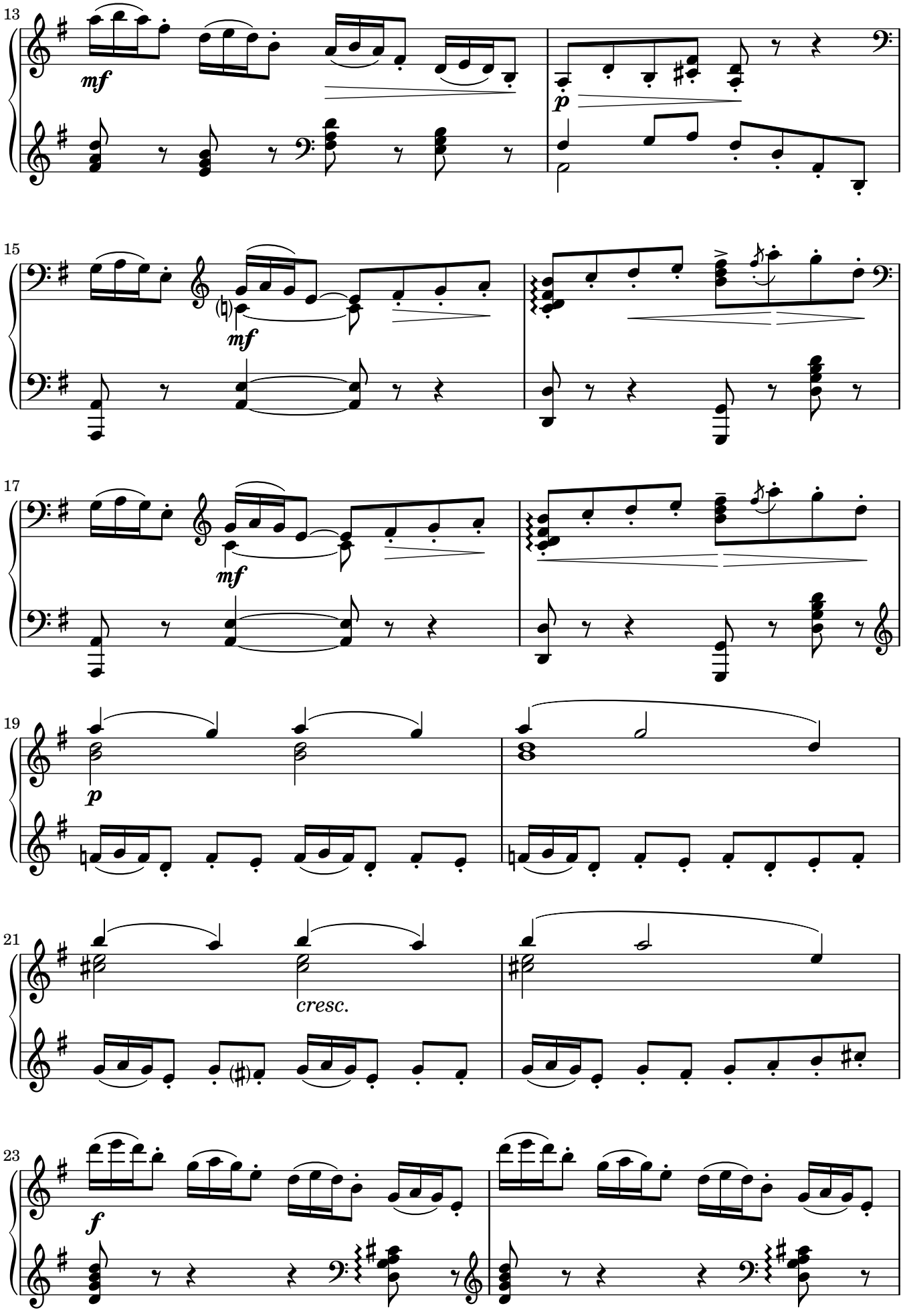
C. Debussy (1862-1918) - Deux Arabesques (1888-1891)
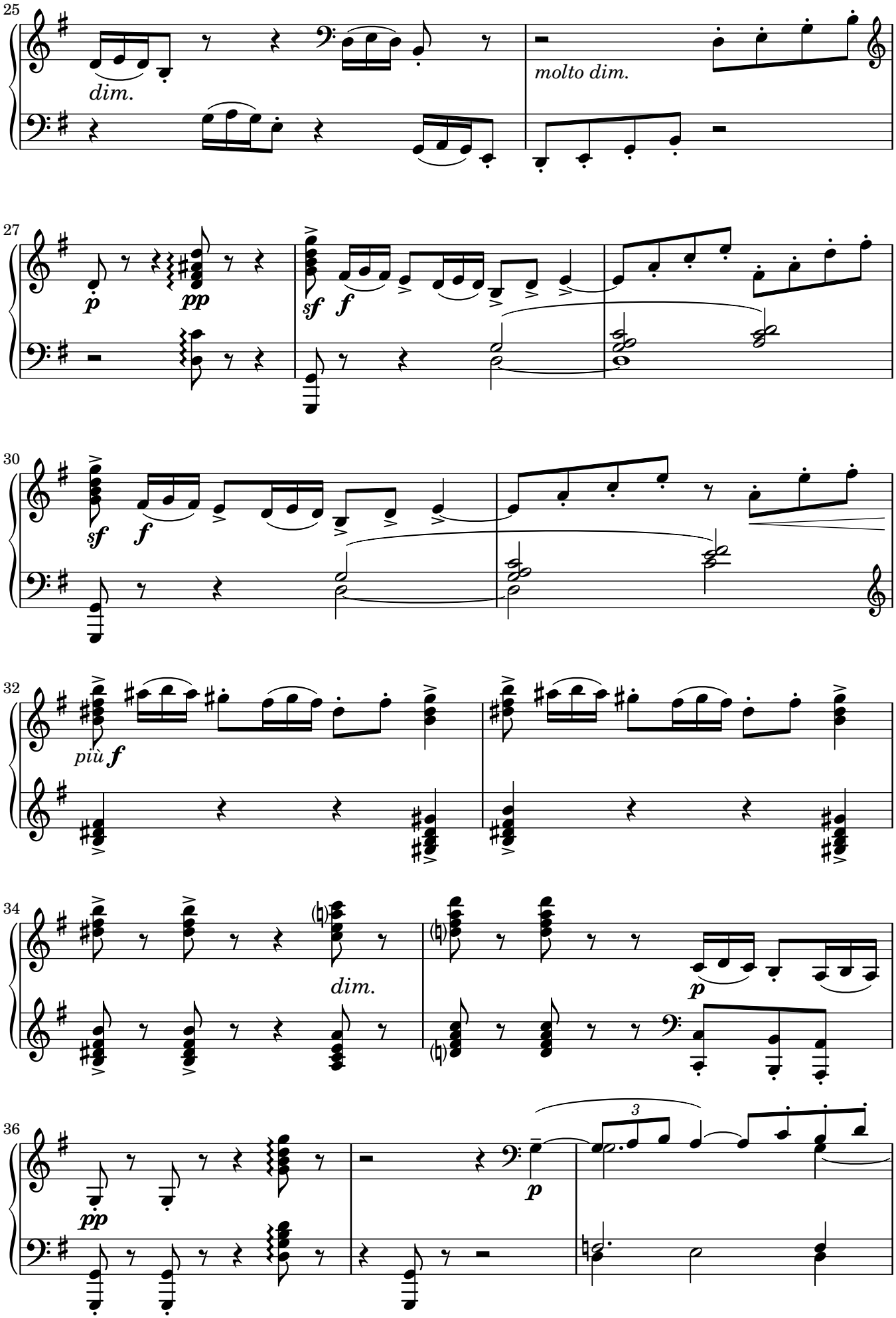
Level 9 · about 4 min
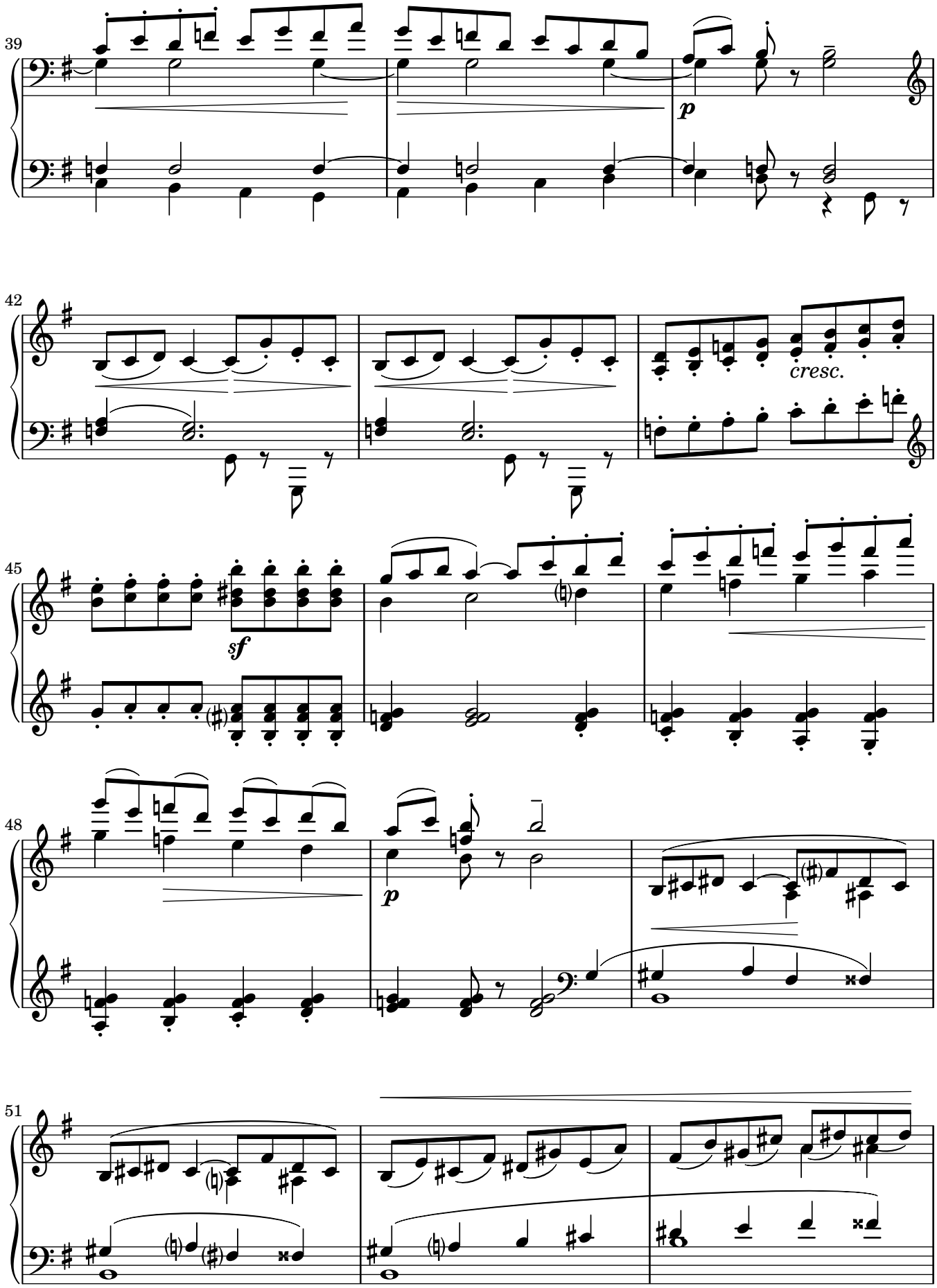
A quick, playful companion to the first Arabesque: light trills and triplet figures over staccato chords. Keep everything light and exactly in time, as if it were a dance.
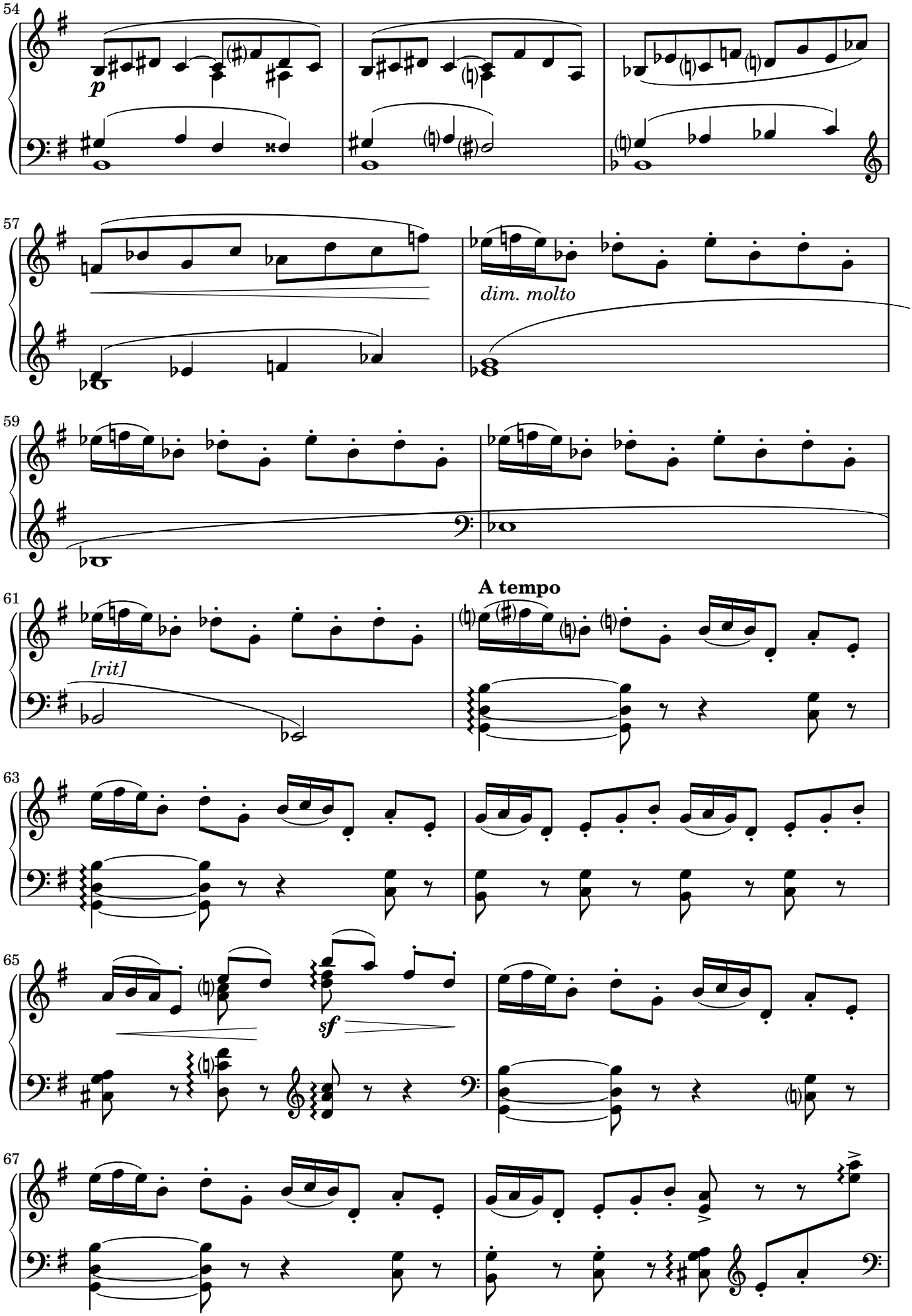
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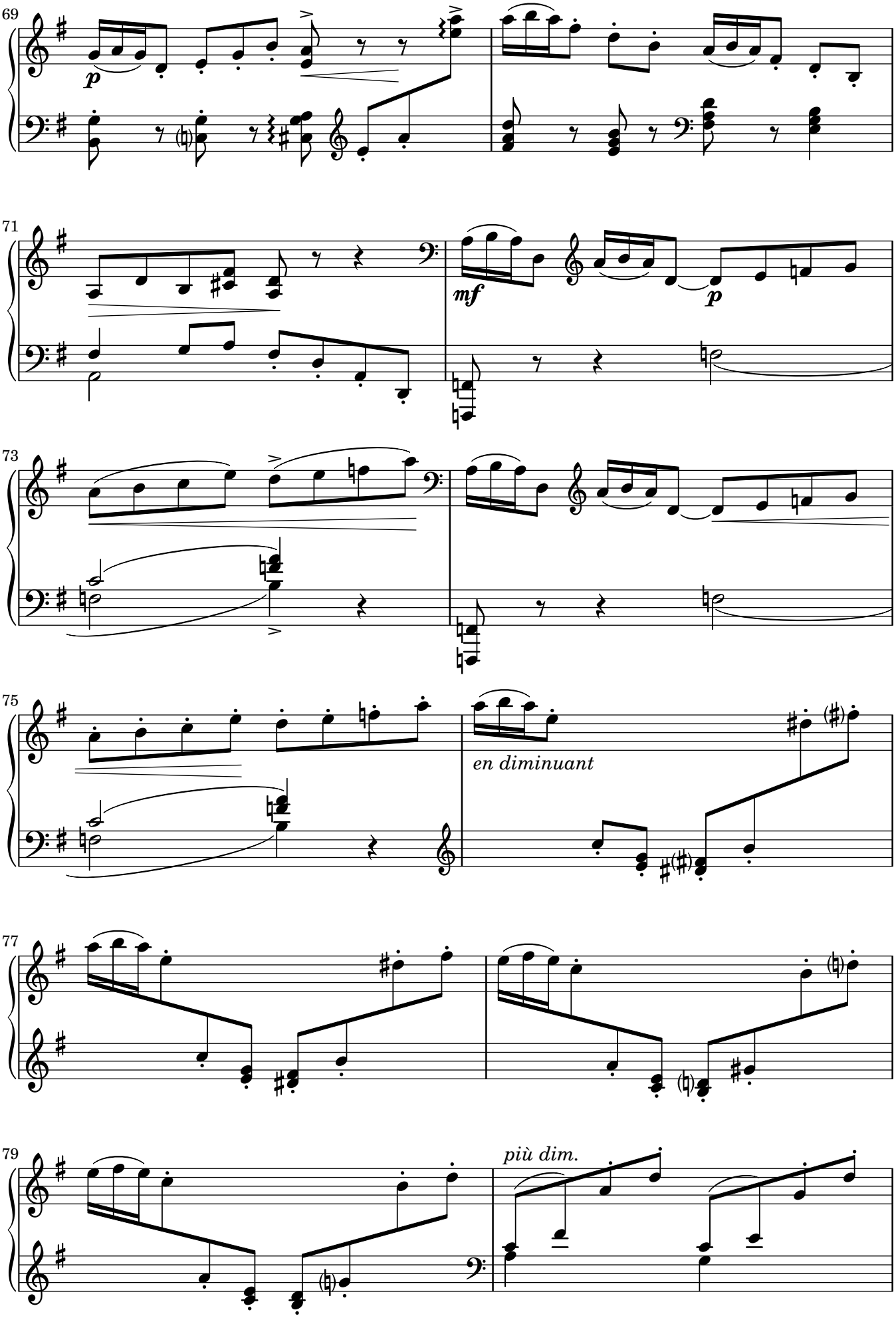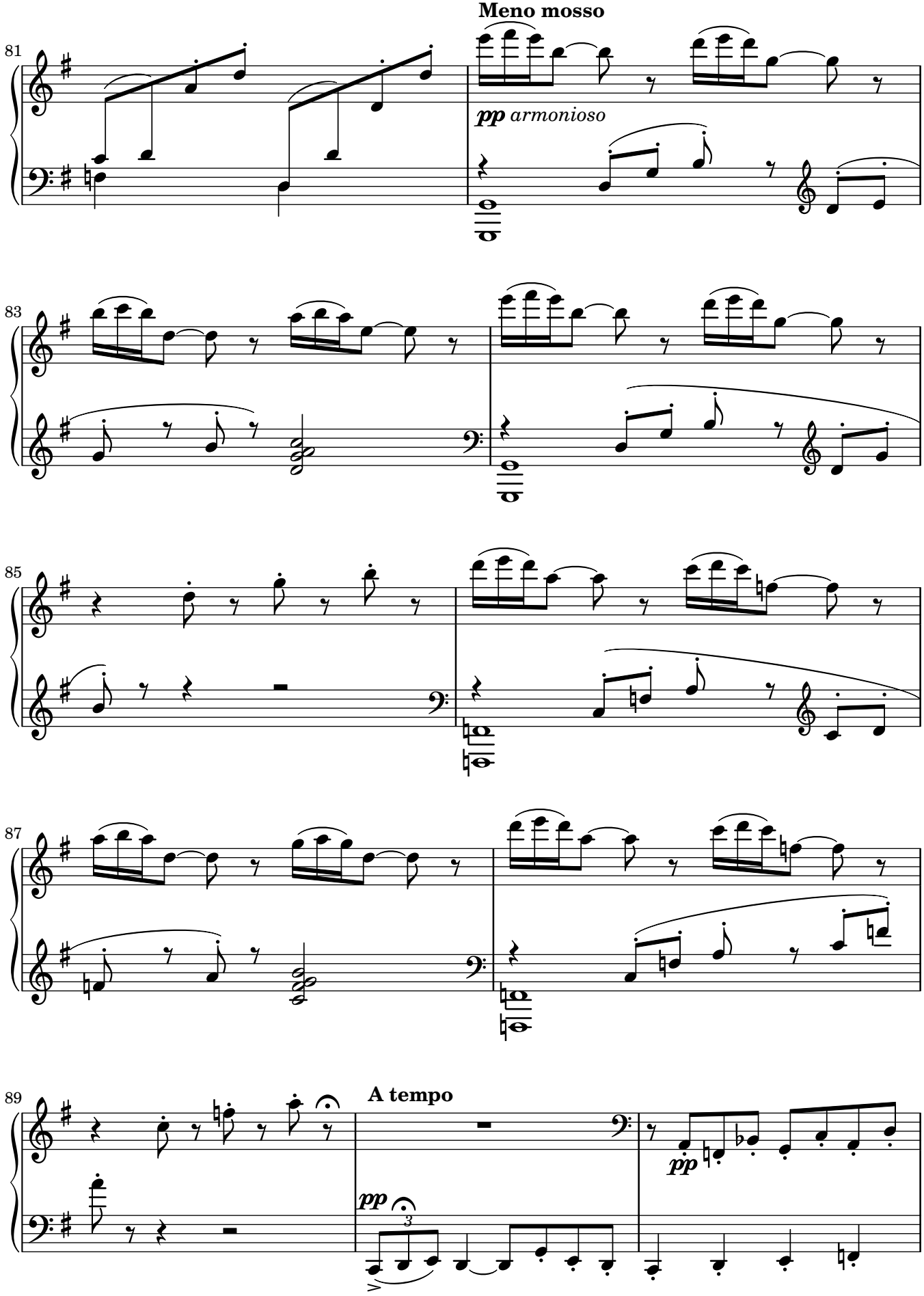



13
mf
p
15
mf
17
mf
19
p
21
cresc.
23
f
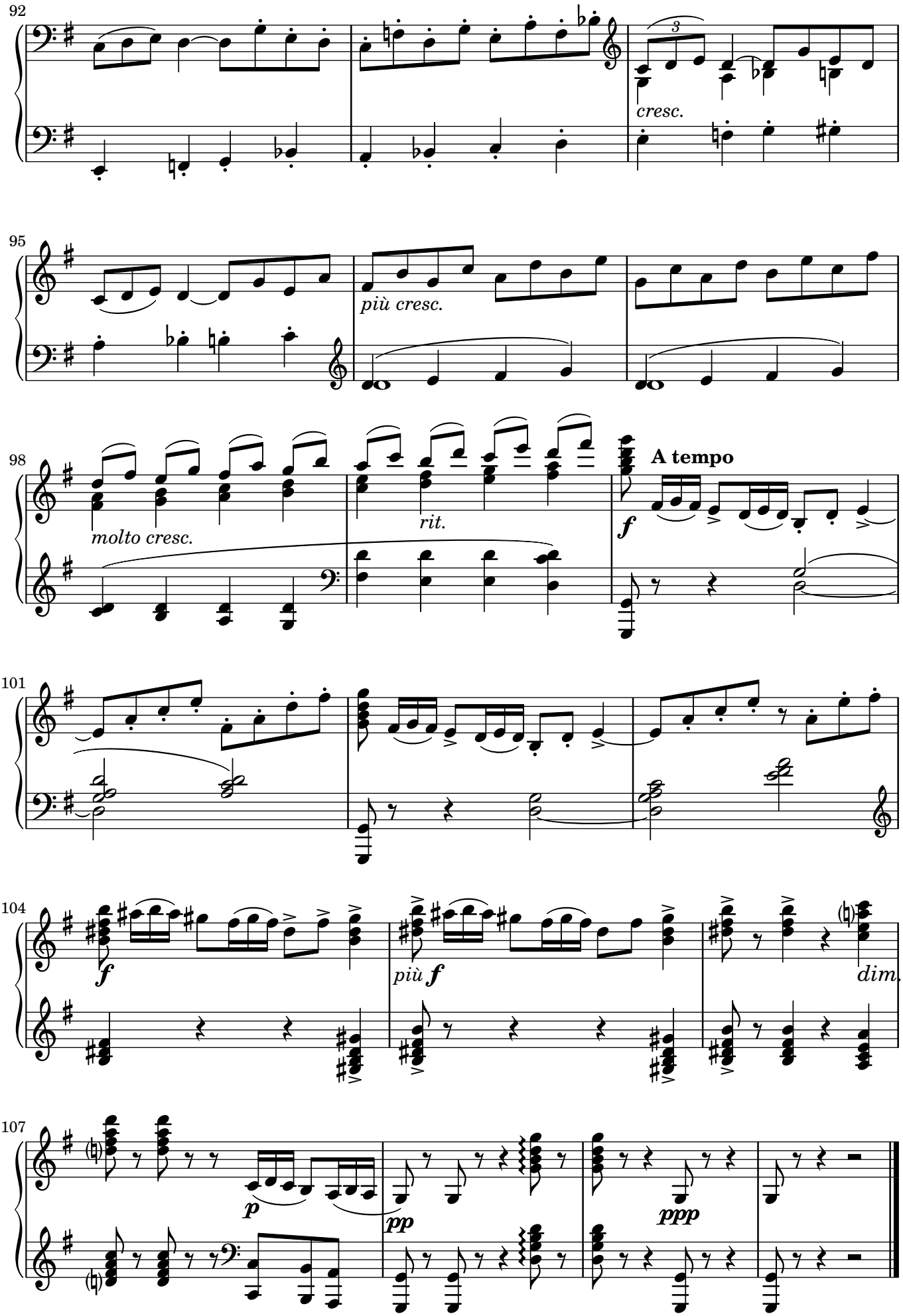

25
dim.
molto dim.
27
p
pp
sf
f
30
sf
f
32
più f
34
dim.
p
36
pp
p
3


39
p
42
cresc.
45
sf
48
p
51


54
p
57
dim. molto
59
61
[rit]
A tempo
63
65
sf
67


69
p
71
mf
p
73
75
en diminuant
77
79
più dim.


Meno mosso
81
pp armonioso
83
85
87
89
A tempo
pp
pp


92
cresc.
95
più cresc.
98
molto cresc.
rit.
A tempo
f
101
104
f
più f
dim.
107
p
pp
ppp
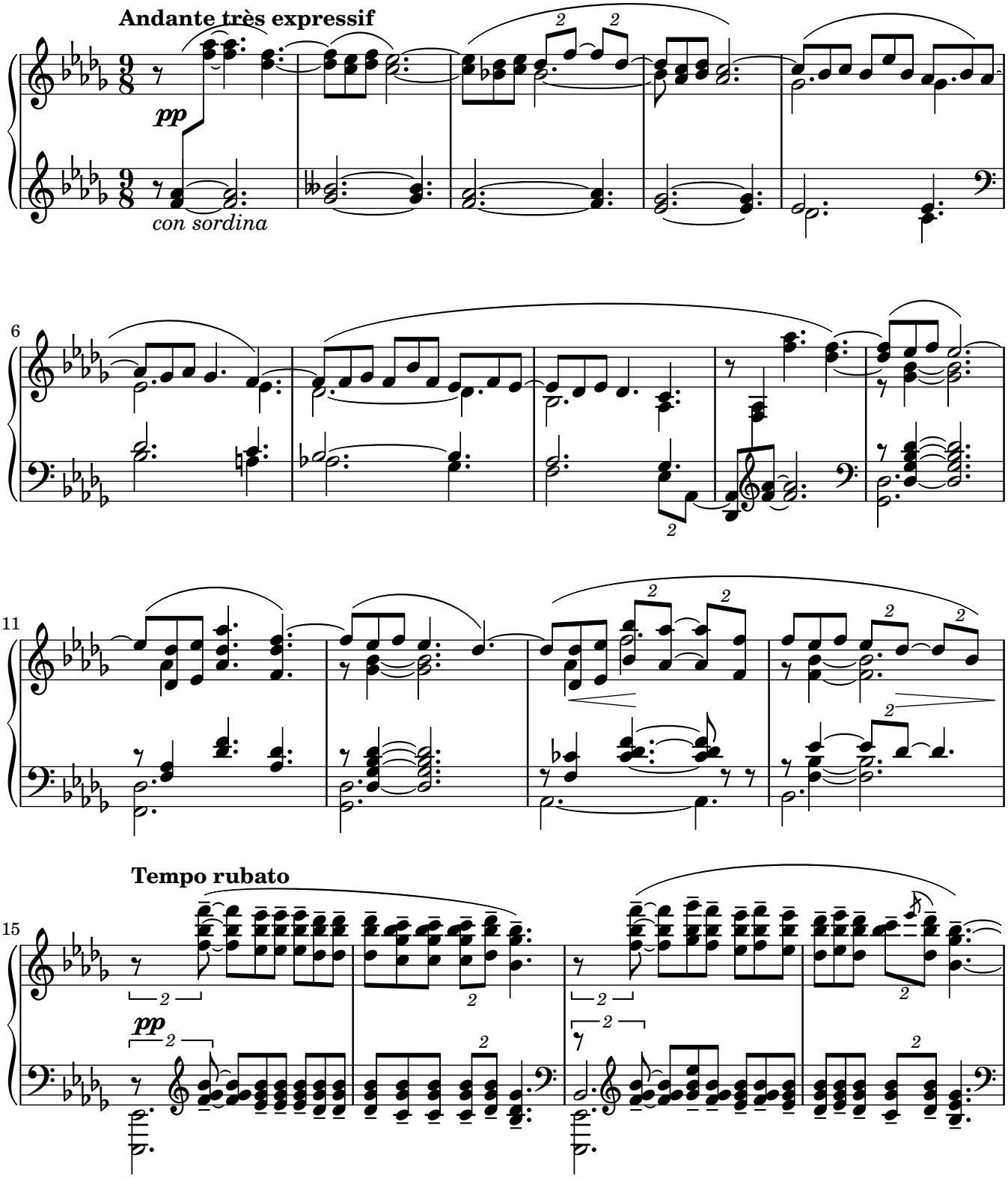
Clair de lune
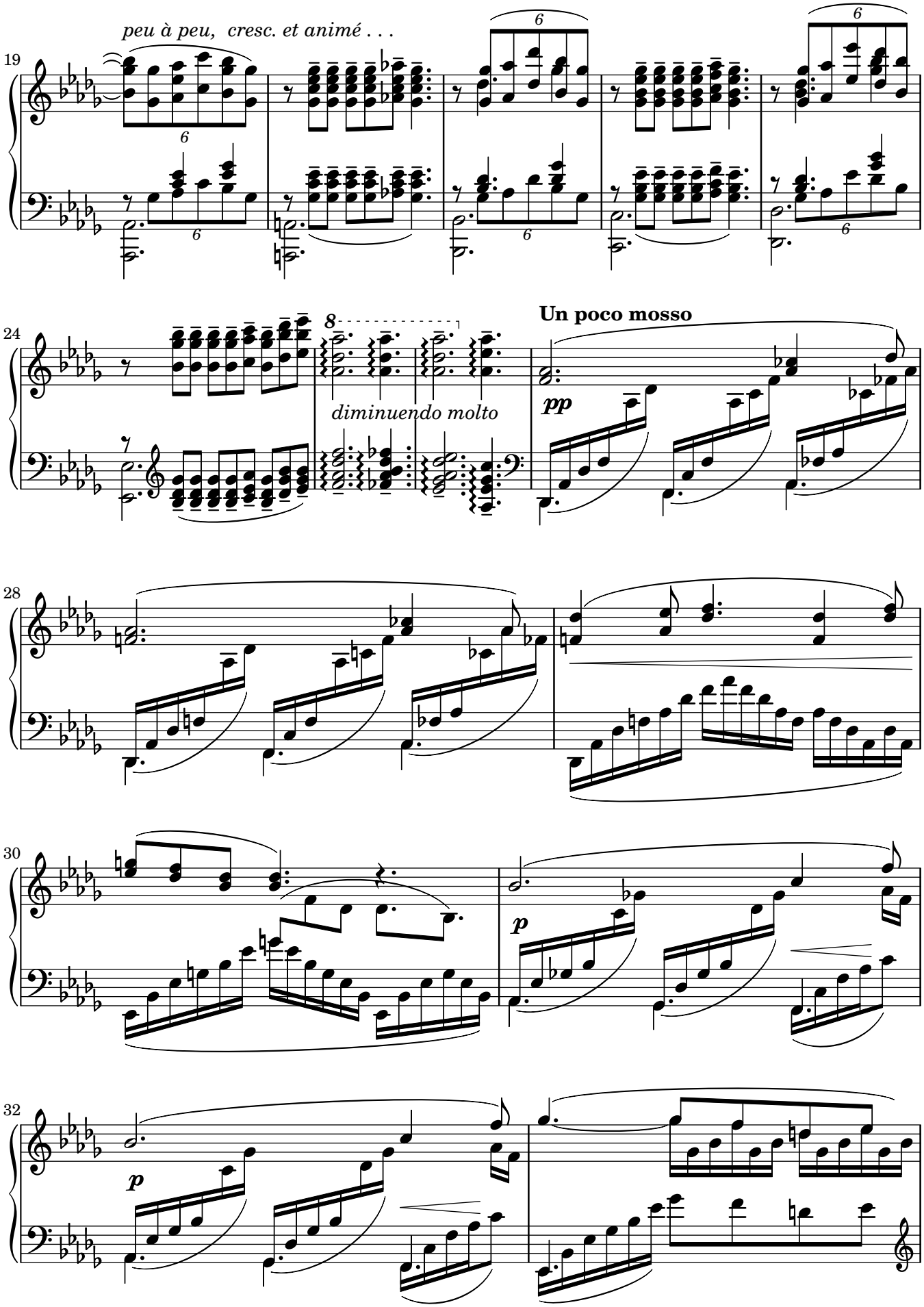
C. Debussy (1862-1918) - Suite bergamasque (1890, revised 1905)

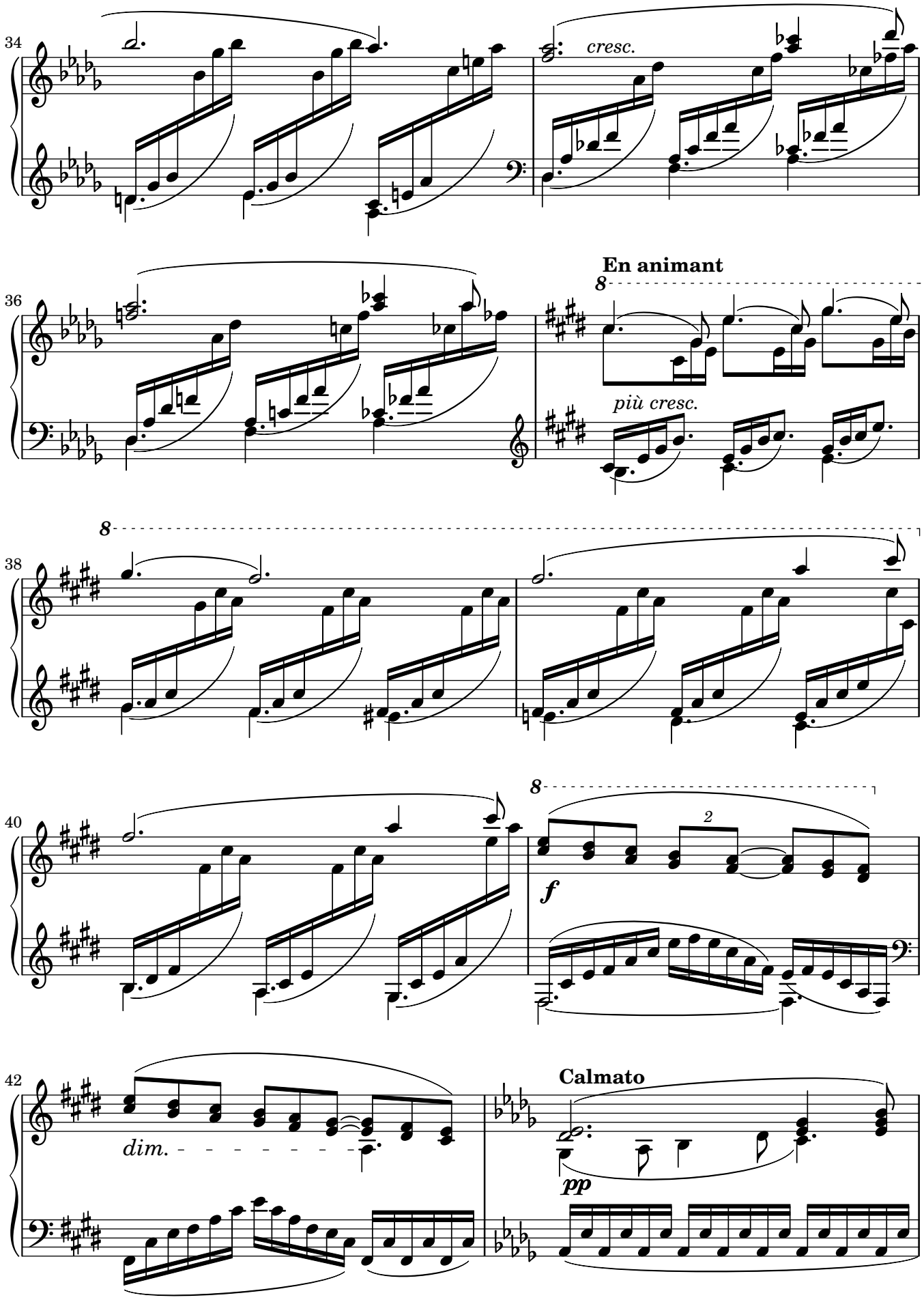
Level 9 · about 5 min

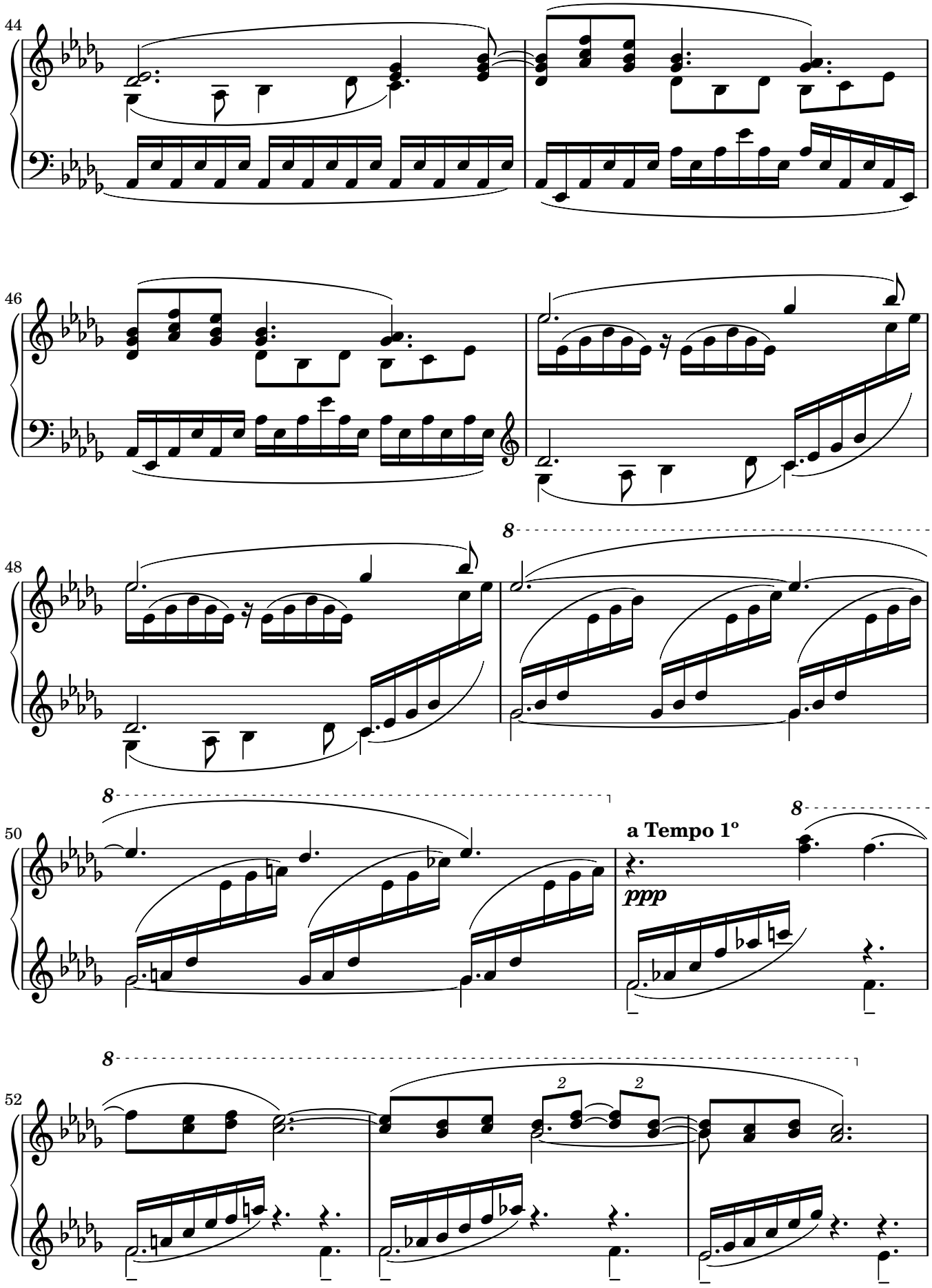
'Moonlight': the most famous piece of French piano music (the opening ended Volume 6). Soft, floating chords in 9/8 with two-against-three rhythms, then a flowing middle section over rolling arpeggios. Change the pedal with each harmony and keep the sound very quiet.
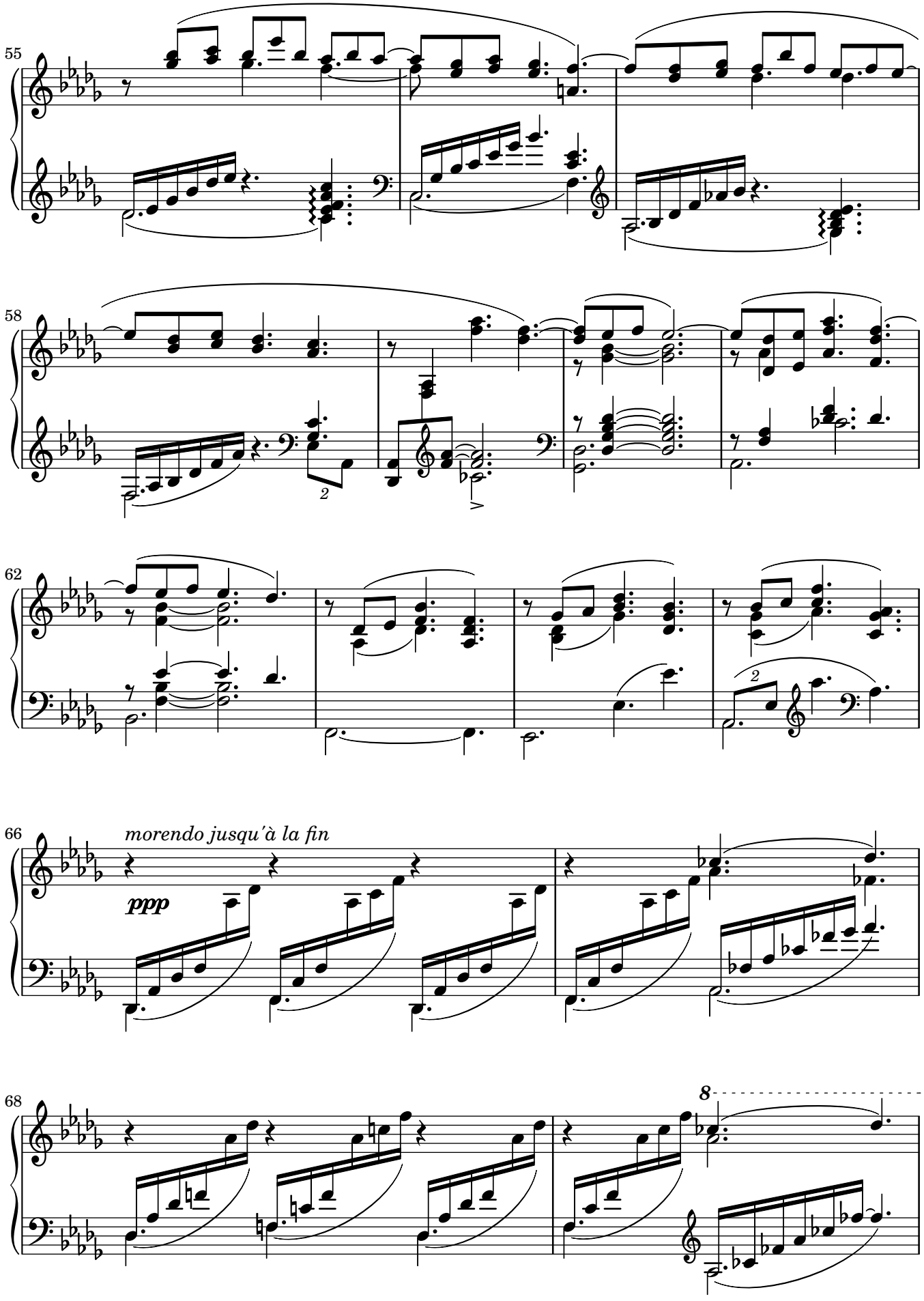
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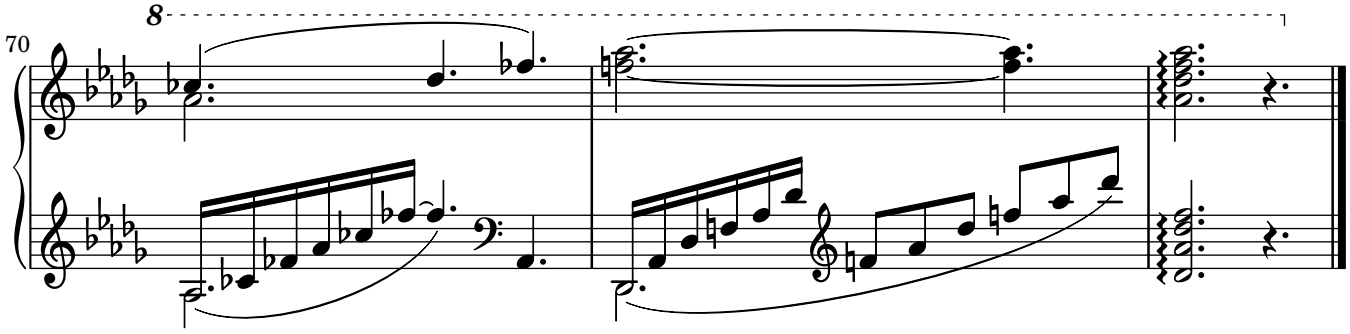



peu à peu, cresc. et animé . . .
19
24
8
diminuendo molto
Un poco mosso
pp
28
30
p
32
p


34
cresc.
36
En animant
8
più cresc.
38
8
40
8
2
f
42
dim.
Calmato
pp


44
46
48
8
50
8
a Tempo 1º
ppp
8
52
8
2
2


55
58
62
66
morendo jusqu'à la fin
ppp
68
8


8
70

Pieces by level

A suggested order: start at the top of Level 9 and choose freely within a level. Mix the eras: a Baroque piece trains the fingers and the ear for voices, a Romantic one the pedal and the singing tone.

Level 9

J. S. Bach: Fugue in C minor, BWV 847 5
D. Scarlatti: Sonata in G, K. 455 8
W. A. Mozart: Sonata in A, K. 331: III. Rondo alla turca 13
L. van Beethoven: Sonata in G, Op. 79: I. Presto alla tedesca 26
L. van Beethoven: "Pathétique" Sonata, Op. 13: III. Rondo 33
F. Schubert: Impromptu in G-flat, D. 899 No. 3 72
F. Mendelssohn: Folk Song in A minor, Op. 53 No. 5 106
R. Schumann: Romance in F-sharp, Op. 28 No. 2 111
F. Chopin: Nocturne in E minor, Op. 72 No. 1 115
F. Chopin: Waltz in D-flat 'Minute', Op. 64 No. 1 119
J. Brahms: Intermezzo in A, Op. 118 No. 2 136
F. Liszt: Consolation No. 3 in D-flat, S. 172 141
E. Grieg: Wedding Day at Troldhaugen, Op. 65 No. 6 146
P. I. Tchaikovsky: January: By the Hearth, Op. 37a No. 1 157
A. Scriabin: Prelude in C, Op. 11 No. 1 162
S. Joplin: Maple Leaf Rag 171
C. Debussy: Arabesque No. 1 175
C. Debussy: Arabesque No. 2 181
C. Debussy: Clair de lune 189

Level 10

W. A. Mozart: Sonata in C minor, K. 457: I. Molto allegro 18
L. van Beethoven: "Pathétique" Sonata, Op. 13: I. Grave - Allegro 41
L. van Beethoven: "Moonlight" Sonata, Op. 27 No. 2: III. Presto agitato 54
F. Schubert: Impromptu in E-flat, D. 899 No. 2 81
F. Schubert: Impromptu in A-flat, D. 899 No. 4 93
F. Chopin: Fantaisie-Impromptu, Op. 66 123
S. Rachmaninoff: Prelude in C-sharp minor, Op. 3 No. 2 164

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